The Quest

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/63900502.

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Not Rated

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Thief Catra, Martial Artist Adora, Original Charactors - Freeform, Minor Character Death, Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra)

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by masternoveller

Summary

Catra is a thief, just wanting to live her life with the people she's gotten to know.
Until it's all turned upside down.

Adora is on her way to a tournament to compete at the world martial arts championships.
Glimmer and Bow tag along with her for support.

They'll meet, but it won't be in the best circumstances...

Notes

Hello again!

As per usual, tags may or may not be updated.
Chapter count is up for debate (in my brain).

Apart from that, enjoy the first chapter!

CW - Violence, minor character death... swearing.

See the end of the work for more notes

The Start

“Hey! Come back! Thief!” A man wearing an apron shouts after the wily magicat that’s just stolen a loaf of bread from his food stand, “Get back here! Thief!”

The magicat turns back, the load of bread safely tucked inside their jacket as she waves apologetically to the man, the baker, in thanks for her breakfast, lunch and dinner for the next day or so, “Sorry!”

She sprints off in between the crowds, carefully avoiding any authority figures as she makes her escape, eventually scaling up and over a stone wall and dropping down into the outside of the markets, disappearing into the trees.

“Did you get it? Did you get it?” Excited voices shout out as soon as the magicat appears from the trees and into the small camp hidden within, “Catra! She’s back!”

The magicat, Catra, grins as she walks towards the group, “Miss me?”

A few of the kids hug her legs, effectively making her stop in her tracks as they cling to her, “Did you get it?”

“Cool it, kids.” Catra says trying to shake them off and then pulls out the loaf of bread hidden in her jacket, “Here. Tonight we eat!”

The kids all cheer, one of them grabbing the loaf and running towards the rest of the group, waving it in the air like a trophy and shouting out elatedly, “Catra did it! We have food!”

An older woman comes out to greet the magicat, she’s got blue hair and green eyes, a little older and very much the mother of the group, though she’s barely older than Catra herself, the

magicat grins as the older woman wraps her up in a hug and sighs, “Thank the stars you’re back, Catra.”

“You worried about me, Delia?” Catra chuckles, “I wasn’t even gone that long.”

“You always worry me, Cat.” Delia sighs again.

“You know, we could always hunt and gather around these woods…” Catra says as she pulls back from the hug to get a good look at Delia before she frowns, narrowing her eyes at the Delia’s injured eye, “What happened?”

Delia hisses out when Catra touches her blackened eye, “It was nothing. Don’t worry about it.”

“This isn’t nothing.” Catra tilts her head and repeats, “What happened?”

Delia shakes her head, and as she’s about to answer, a young man interrupts, “Catra. Good to see you’re back.”

Catra eyes him, “You’re limping, Fagen.”

“I am.” He replies, “I’m fine. You don’t need to worry about us.”

This time Catra shakes her head, “What happened? I was only gone 2 days…”

“We were ambushed.” Fagen replies looking sheepish, “Took our weapons and all our supplies.”

“Who did this?” Catra asks angrily.

“You know who.” Fagen replies, “Said they’d be back if we didn’t clear out by the end of the week.”

“What do they want?” Catra asks trying to keep her anger in check.

Fagen looks at Delia, the latter shakes her head, “Look, we can go somewhere else. It’ll be easy enough to pick up and leave…”

The magicat shakes her head, “No. Our camp has grown threefold. There’s no way we’ll be able to get everyone up and out of these woods by the end of the week. Especially if there’s nowhere to go.”

“We aren’t giving you up, Cat.” Delia declares, “They can get someone else to do their dirty thieving jobs for them.”

“Besides, there’s nothing to stop them from taking you and then offing us.” Fagen argues, “It’s not worth it. We’ll just leave. All of us.”

“Catra, please.” Delia squeezes Catra’s elbow, “Just… help us get everyone ready to go.”

Reluctantly, the magicat nods, “Okay. Fine.”

“Great.” Fagen smiles, throwing an arm around Catra and Delia, “Come on, let’s eat before all those kiddies eat all the bread.”

Catra awakes to the sound of screaming, her claws unsheathe as she jumps to her feet and rushes out of her tent to find most of her camp on fire, a scattering of people running around trying to put the fires out as the magicat shakes her herself awake.

She looks over and sees Fagen trying to run, hampered by his injury, “Fagen! What’s going on?!”

“We’re under attack!” He shouts back, “We need to get to Delia!”

Catra stops Fagen, “I’ll get her. You make sure the rest of our people are safe. Go. Now!”

Fagen nods and rushes over to gather up the other people while Catra runs towards Delia’s tent, the fires spreading faster, smoke

growing darker and heavier the closer she gets to the tent. The magicat shields her face with her arm, trying to keep under the smoke as she slashes open the side of Delia's tent only to find the woman still in her bed, not moving.

"Delia!" Catra slides over to the other woman, collecting her into her arms and running back through the gap she's made, "Fuck… don't you dare die on me!"

The magicat coughs, trying to keep the smoke out of her lungs as she sprints as fast as her legs will let her towards the clearing. Delia jostles around in her arms while Catra spots her group, running towards them in a much slower pace as her lungs scream for air until…

"Oof!" Catra goes down to the ground, Delia rolls out from her grasps as the magicat finds her feet again, her head bleeding from a cut she doesn't know where it came from as she looks around frantically trying to find the attacker, "What…? Oof!"

"Stay down." A hoarse voice calls out.

Catra turns over onto her back and glares up at the voice, "Of course it'd be you, Rex."

"Shut up." Rex, a dark green lizard hybrid growls out.

"Delia! Catra!" Fagen shouts out upon seeing Rex loom over the pair, he limps towards them, a makeshift spear in his hand as he gets closer, "Get away from them!"

Rex straightens up and draws his sword, a sneer on his lips as Fagen gets closer, "Come at me."

"Fagen, no!" Catra grunts out as she gets up, just in time to push Fagen to the side, pain radiating from her side, "Oof… Fuck…"

Rex steps forward, digging his heel into Catra's shoulder as he slowly pulls the blade out of her side, "I don't know why you bother, thief."

Catra groans out in pain as she tries to get up again, only to be kicked in the face, black spots begin to appear in her eyes, feeling heavier as she tries to reach out to Delia, "No… stop…"

Her ears twitch back upon hearing the sound of a scream.

Fagen.

Catra tries to push herself up, but everything in her body screams out in pain, her body feeling heavier as she only manages to turn her head to see Rex running Fagen through with his sword. An evil laugh on his lips as he drops Fagen to the ground, the man gasping for air as he stares back at the magicat, unable to speak while Catra watches the life drain from his eyes.

Rex stomps over, steps over Catra and towards Delia, "Leave. Her. Alone." The magicat manages to grunt out weakly.

"No." Rex simply replies as he bends down to check on her before he huffs out a laugh, "She's already dead. Too fucking easy."

Catra grits her teeth, "Liar…"

Rex doesn't even bother to reply, instead using his boot to roll her over, Delia's body flopping lifelessly onto her back, her eyes are shut and her face blackened by the smoke as Rex kicks her once more to be sure. Looking back at Catra, he smirks, "Me? I'm not a liar." He steps back towards Catra and crouches down, "Well, looks like your little thieving hands belong to me now."

With one last ditch effort, Catra launches herself up and clamps her sharp teeth down on his throat as he violently thrashes around, trying to get her off, but it's to no avail as the magicat bites down just a little harder and crushes down on his carotid artery until it splits, and he goes tumbling down.

"Fuck you." Catra grunts out as she rips his throat out, spitting out the flesh to the ground as she falls back down again, crawling over to Delia, "Dee… Dee… wake up…"

Delia stays unmoved.

“Dee… please…” Catra pleads as she manages to put her hand on top of Delia’s, “Dee… wake up.”

“There she is!” Someone shouts, and it’s not a voice Catra recognises, “Get her! Don’t let her get away!”

“Oh fuck…” Catra curses, interlacing her fingers with Delia’s, “Wake up, Dee… please…”

Just as Catra gets picked up by a new force, a new attacker, she feels a gentle squeeze of her hand, the magicat grunts out as she’s pulled away harshly, her fingers ripped away from her friend’s as one of the soldier’s slugs her once in the gut, just below her stab wound, “You fucking killed our captain.”

“Makes us even.” Catra heaves out, “He killed Fagen and… oof! Fuck!”

The soldier strikes her once more in the gut, “On your feet, thief.”

“Fuck you.” Catra spits back as she’s once again punched in the stomach again, “Argh… fuck…”

“Keep that up and we’ll just report you missing to the boss.” The soldier threatens before he’s hit in the back of the head, “Ow! What the fuck, Will?!”

“She needs to be brought back to the ship, alive!” Will shoves the other soldier harshly, “Or did you forget that part where if she’s dead or missing, it’s going to be us getting killed, a thousand time worse than what’s going to happen to this thief.”

“Fine.” The soldier grunts out as he turns to look at Catra and glares at her, “Goodnight, thief.”

“Wha…?!” Catra manages to say before the soldier knocks her out with a metal baton, her body doesn’t even hit the ground when she’s dragged off with the soldiers.

“Adora! Wait up!” Bow shouts out as he runs after the blonde, panting after her, “What’s the rush?”

“I’m just excited!” Adora gushes as she runs just a little faster, “The tournament is next week. I can’t wait!”

Bow smiles as he manages to find a comfortable rhythm next to Adora, “Hey, have you packed yet?”

“Oh, shit.” Adora stops suddenly, “When’s our train?”

“In a few hours.” Bow hunches over with his hands on his knees, “We’ve got a car coming to pick us up to get to the train station in an hour.”

Adora turns around, “I’ve gotta go! I’ll see you out front! Bye!”

Bow watches, shaking his head with a smile as Adora sprints off back home to pack.

“Get up, thief!” Someone kicks Catra in her injured and still bleeding side, jostling her awake painfully, “Get the fuck up!”

Catra groans out in pain as some grabs her by the messy mane of long hair, lifting her up to her feet as she growls out in pain, “Fuck…”

“I have an idea, boss.” One of the soldier’s say and pulls out his sword and slices through Catra’s main, dropping the magicat down to the ground once more, the soldiers laugh as they circle the injured magicat, “It looks a little uneven… maybe I need to cut more off.”

Catra’s held in place as her hair is hacked off with the sword, barely missing her ears as she slowly gains consciousness through all the pain, “I’m going to kill all of you.”

The guards, all seven of them standing around her laugh as punches reign down on her once more, she passes out once again.

"We're finally here!" Glimmer announces once the she exits the train, quickly turning back, "Oh, Bow! Grab our bags please!"

"On it!" Bow enthusiastically calls back as he grabs his and Glimmer's bags, Adora pulling on her backpack and grabbing her suitcase, "Hey, 'Dor, can you grab this?"

"Sure." Adora takes the laptop bag from him and lets him depart first, "Right behind you, Bow."

He nods, smiling forward, "I'm so excited to be here!"

"Me too!" Adora grins widely as they join Glimmer on the platform, the blonde passing the laptop bag to the other women, "Okay. Where are we going?"

"This way!" Glimmer points to the exit and the trio start walking out of the station and towards the taxi rank.

"Hey! Hey! Boss! Car's a coming!" A soldier shouts out, pointing to the taxi that's oncoming, "I'm not carrying this piece of shit on the back of my horse all the way to the ship."

"You're not even fucking carrying her." Will points out, "Your horse is."

"Whatever. She keeps threatening to fall off and break her fucking neck." The soldier scoffs, "Besides, it'll be quicker in a car than on horse."

Will gets an idea, "You're right, soldier."

The solider looks around smirking at the others.

“You, Travers and Klay will take our horses to the ship. Me and the rest will go with the thief in the car.” Will says, raising his eyebrow in challenge as he watches the soldier’s jaw drop, “Good. Now, you three. Go get that taxi.”

“Hey, there’s someone on the side of the road.” Glimmer points out.

“Bandits.” The taxi driver simply says, “We don’t stop. It’s dangerous to stop on this road.”

“Oh.” Glimmer says surprised, “Really?”

“Yes.” The taxi driver replies with a nod.

“Oh, okay.” Glimmer sits back down in the front seat as she eyes the person trying to wave them down, “But… what if they need help?”

“They don’t. Trust me.” The taxi driver glances over at Glimmer for a moment before going back to the road.

As they get closer, the person on the side of the road seems to sense that the car isn’t going to stop and they wave back towards the tree line, dragging out someone or something towards the road.

“Oh, my stars… is that a person?!” Bow’s eyes widen.

“Bandits.” The taxi driver repeats, “Ignore them.”

The trio watch as they get closer to the group on the side of the road. The taxi driver’s breathing speeding up slightly as he grips the steering wheel just a little tighter and then…

CRASH!

The taxi driver swerves, spinning the car around 180 before coming to a stop. The windscreen is smashed in, blood, flesh and hair smothered across it as the object says on top of the bonnet.

"Is everyone alright?!" Adora shouts out to the occupants of the car, unbuckling her seatbelt and checking on Bow next to her in the backseat.

"I'm okay!" Glimmer calls back before she reaches over to check on their driver, "Oh… I think our driver needs help."

Adora opens the door, helping Bow and Glimmer out first before heading to the driver's door, "Hey! Hey! Are you okay?!"

Pulling open the driver's door, the driver slumps out sideways, blood all over his face as he's held in place by his seatbelt, the blonde checks him over and breathes out in relief. Bow comes around and unbuckles him, they pair pull him out to the side of the road, "He's still breathing."

Adora rolls him off to the side, "Call an ambulance!"

"On it!" Glimmer shouts back as she goes to pull out her phone before, "Hey! What the…ow?!"

"Glim?" Bow quickly gets up and sees a group of 7 people walking towards them, some on horses but all brandishing weapons, his eyes widen, "Adora? We've got trouble!"

Adora looks up and sees the group, "Oh no…"

Will dismounts his horse once they are close enough and grins, "We'll be taking your car now."

The others get off their horses too, holding their weapons out, one of the soldiers walks to the front of the car and puts his hand out, “The thief is still alive, boss.”

“Good. Keep it that way.” Will says before turning back to taxi occupants, “Get on the dirt over there and get on your knees.”

Bow goes over and quickly checks on Glimmer as he quickly kneels down next to her while Adora slowly gets to her feet, her hand up as she slowly makes her way to the side of the road, “Look. No one needs to get hurt, okay? Just… let me help the driver.”

Will signals something to the soldier at the front of the car and then…

BANG!

The trio on the side of the road cover their ears in shock as the soldier walks back and nods to Will, “No need to help the driver now.” He narrows his eyes at the trio on the side of the road, “Now… what to do with you three…”

“I’ve got an idea boss!” One of the soldiers shouts out and makes a lewd gestures that makes the others laugh, “Come on, boss! When are we even going to get to another brothel?”

Adora glares at them and warns, “Take the car and leave us alone.”

“Or what, blondie?” Will snarks as on of his soldiers cockily approaches Adora.

“Or this!” Adora gets up and tackles the soldier down, Glimmer and Bow quickly rising to their feet to do the same as Will signals for his team to take them down.

Glimmer goes down first, a fist to the face knocks her to the ground, her head spinning with pain as Bow loses concentration and is kicked in the chest hard, before a haymaker makes contact with his head as well and he goes down to the ground next to Glimmer. Adora takes down two of the soldiers, but she's completely outnumbered as they start to circle her with more people now that Glimmer and Bow are both down.

"Not bad, blondie." Will snarks out as he gives the go ahead to attack, "Don't worry, we won't be gentle."

Adora puts up a hell of a fight, but she's unable to overturn the fact that's she's well and truly outnumbered, brought down to her knees as she's pinned down, she grunts, trying kick and punch to no avail as Will steps in front of her, "Not a fair fight." Adora spits out.

Will shrugs, "Don't care."

Adora watches as Will lifts a metal baton up with a grin, she shuts her eyes waiting for the baton to make contact…

Except, it doesn't.

Instead, Will screams out as the grip on Adora loosens and she finds herself free. She looks around and sees Glimmer and Bow still collapsed on the side of the road, Glimmer looking after Bow as their attackers are drawn away from her, every single one of them.

The blonde pushes her up to her feet with great effort to find the 7 attackers, torn to shreds and scattered all over the road and roadside, one person stands in front of the turned around taxi, as Adora takes in the form of a magicat with short and hacked up hair, torn and ripped clothing and bloodied all over. The magicat turns around and heterochromatic eyes meet Adora's grey blue ones for a moment before Catra's eyes roll back from exhaustion and she starts to collapse.

Adora rushes over as fast as she can and manages to catch the magicat just before her head makes contact with the road. The magicat's eyes open again briefly and breathes out, "Dying…"

"What?!" Adora panics with the magicat in her arms as she feels a large amount of a sticky substance just under the magicat's torn jacket, over her ribs, she pulls her hand out and gasps at her completely bloodied hand and then feels the magicat go limp in her arms, "No… NO! Glimmer! Help!"

A Prime Appearance

Chapter Summary

The trio and Catra getting to know each other.

Chapter Notes

Finally! Sorry for the wait... enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's ears twitch at the sounds of chatter not too far away from her. The voices are different from the ones she's been hearing since her kidnapping as she feels a sharp pain in her chest, a hiss inadvertently leaving her lips as her eyes snap open.

"She's awake!" Someone calls out frantically, "Glimmer! Bow! She's awake!"

"We're coming, Adora!" Bow calls back as warm hands find their way to Catra's face.

"Hey! Hey!" Adora says trying to say a little calmer as her hands move from Catra's face to her shoulders, "You're okay. You're safe."

Catra groans out as she feels Adora's hand brush against a sore spot on her left shoulder, the blonde's hand instantly recoiling.

"Adora!" Glimmer says as the pair stop a step short from Adora, "Is she really awake?"

"I think so." Adora replies as one hand goes back to Catra's face, she whispers, "Hey, it's okay. You're safe."

"yousaidthatalready…" Catra grumbles out almost incomprehensibly as she hisses out in pain.

"What did she say?" Bow asks.

Adora narrows her eyes down at the magicat, ignoring her friend for the moment, “Can you tell me your name?”

“Water…” Catra mutters out instead, a cough on the verge of destroying the slight peacefulness of calm in her body as her throat gets drier, “…water.”

“Water!” Adora repeats almost too excitedly before getting up and grabbing a water bottle before returning just as quickly, she gently nudges the magicat, “Can you sit up?”

Catra shakes her head.

“Do you mind if I move you a little so you don’t end up breathing in this water?” Adora asks.

Catra nods once and that’s all it takes for Adora to gently move herself so that the magicat’s head is pretty much in her lap. Catra looks up and sees the concentration on Adora’s face, a small smile paints her lips at the sight as she’s gently propped up so she can drink.

“Is this okay?” Adora whispers.

“Yeah.”

“Okay. Bow holds the water bottle out to Adora, the blonde takes it and unscrews the lip before gently cupping Catra’s cheek, “Ready?”

“Mm.” The magicat hums back a response.

Adora places the bottle against Catra’s lips and tilts it up slowly until she can hear the sound of the magicat drinking the water, after a few moments, the blonde pulls the bottle away, “How’s that?”

“Better.” Catra replies looking straight up into Adora’s soft eyes before she remembers Delia and the rest of her camp, “I have to go.”

“Woah!” Adora holds Catra down as the magicat tries to get up, “You’re hurt.”

“Uh huh.” Catra replies with a grimace on her face, “What doesn’t kill me right?”

Adora rolls her eyes, “You can’t just *go.”*

Realisation dawns on the magicat, “Oh, I get it.”

Adora looks to her friends confused, “Get what?”

Catra scoffs despite the pain in her body, “What do you need me to steal now?”

“Steal?” Adora repeats bewildered.

“Yeah. That’s why you won’t let me go.” Catra surmises, “What do you need me to steal?”

“Nothing…?” Adora answers confused, “We don’t need you to steal anything.”

“Sure.” Catra nods, “Then you wouldn’t mind letting me free so I can go.”

Adora frowns down, “You are in no condition to go anywhere.”

“Whatever, princess.” Catra grunts out as she once again tries to get up only to be wrapped up in the blonde’s arms, “What are you doing? You said I was free to go.”

“Can you stop being so stubborn? You’re hurt. Like really hurt.” Adora tries to reason, “I don’t know if you remember, but you got hit by a car.”

“I remember that.” Catra replies flatly, “Pretty sure I’ve also been stabbed, electrocuted and have a few broken ribs.”

“And a gash on your forehead.” Bow happily provides, “It’s not so bad since Adora fixed it up.”

“Adora?” Catra says as she looks up.

“Me. I’m Adora.” Adora introduces herself, “And that’s Bow and Glimmer. My best friends.”

“I’m… I’m out of here.” Catra tries again, “Thanks for fixing me up or whatever but I need to go.”

Adora turns to her friends, “Guys, can you give us a minute?”

“Sure. We’ll be over here trying to get a fire started.” Glimmer calls back as she grabs Bow’s hand and walks back towards the little area they’ve decided to make camp for the night.

Catra looks up, the sky is still dimly lit, the light is starting to fade fast, “You haven’t got a fire started yet?”

“No.” Adora sighs out, “It’s not like we can just get one started out of nothing.”

“Where’s the car?” Catra asks as she tries to look around only for her head to protest at the movement, “Why didn’t you just take the car?”

“It wouldn’t start.” Adora replies, “Look, it’s not like we had much of a choice.”

“And the horses?” Catra ignores Adora’s comment.

“You are in no state to ride a horse.” Adora looks down at the magicat with furrowed brows.

“Not me, idiot.” Catra snarks out, “It’s not safe to be out here at night…”

“We’re not leaving you.” Adora snarks right back.

“Take the horses and get to the closest town.” Catra orders, “If you can’t get a fire started before dark comes over, we’re as good as dead.”

“Hey, wait, no.” Adora says, “We’ve got torches if it comes down to it.”

“No. The creatures around here aren’t scared of artificial light.” Catra reasons, “And in these woods, without fire, we’re as good as dead. So, either get that fire started now or get on those horses and get the fuck out of here.”

Adora turns her head to her friends still struggling to get a fire lit and then over to the horses tied up by the trees, weighing the two options up, “Do you know how to start a fire?”

Catra, despite the pain in her body, lets out a small and pained chuckle and nods, “Help me up.”

“Quit moving princess.” Catra grumbles as Adora tries to reach for her bottle, jostling the magicat who’s got her head in lap a little before giving up and leaning back against the tree.

“Is there a reason you’re using our best friend as a pillow right now?” Glimmer points out as her and Bow sit on the other side of the fire, “Because Bow made a bed up for you over there.”

“No. I’m not moving again.” Catra retorts as she glances at the poor excuse for a bed, “I can already feel my rib scratching up against my lung.”

“You didn’t have to move.” Adora says with an air of frustration, “You could have just instructed us and not actually get up and do it yourself.”

“No, I couldn’t.” Catra replies with a small victorious grin on her face, “You three yahoos can’t seem to follow instructions.” She looks up and sees the glare and pout on Adora’s face, “Besides it would have taken longer and I definitely would have killed Sparkles over there for making things worse.”

“Hey?!” Glimmer shrieks as Catra tries to hold back a laugh at how easy it is to rile up the woman, “Whatever…”

“You were doing really well, Glim.” Bow tries to reassure her.

“Shut it, Bow.” Glimmer pouts, crossing her arms over her chest, “I’m hungry.”

As if on cue, Adora’s stomach growls too as she shuffles a little making Catra growl out, “Shush.”

“Are you talking to me or your stomach?” Catra jests as she nestles a little more into Adora’s lap, “Didn’t you bring any supplies?”

“The taxi ride was only meant to be a couple of hours.” Adora replies as she tries once more to grab her bottle, “It’s not like we planned to be ambushed and fighting for our lives today.”

“Tell me about it.” Catra agrees closing her eyes once more, “When daylight hits, we’ll take the horses into town. And then we can part ways.”

“You’re in no condition to travel…” Adora tries to recall the magicat’s name before she remembers that she doesn’t know it, “Uh, what did you say your name was?”

“It’s Catra.”

“Fitting.” Glimmer snarks from the other side, a huff of a laugh behind it, “Creative.”

“Shut it, Sparkles.” Catra growls out and winces in pain, “I didn’t name myself.”

“We need to get you to a hospital.” Adora says, “Actually, we all need to get checked out.”

Catra’s eyes open once more, and that’s when she notices the darkness around Adora’s face and eyes, her hand reaches out

involuntarily and gently caresses the blonde's cheek, "You're hurt too, princess."

"It's nothing." Adora brushes off Catra's concern but then finds herself leaning into her hand, "I'll be fine. I've just got some bruises."

"I'll go to my bed." Catra offers only for Adora to quickly grasp her hand that's on her cheek, "You need to rest too."

"It's fine." Adora repeats, "Besides, I feel like you're a flight risk."

"Can't stop me taking off if you're asleep." Catra tries to joke but it's met with a look of concern on Adora's face, "But then again… my body isn't exactly listening to me."

"Thank the stars for that." Adora smiles down in a little relief.

Catra nods slightly, "Did you check the horses for supplies?"

"Huh?"

"The horses." Catra repeats a little louder, "Those idiots that caught me had supplies."

"If those guys were idiots, what does that make you? Since you got caught by them." Glimmer asks with a smug look on her own battered face, not that Catra can see her through the fire's flames.

"Me? I was outnumbered and surprised." Catra tries to shrug, "I wasn't trying to save myself anyway."

"What do you mean?" Bow wraps an arm around Glimmer.

"Delia and Fagan… my friends were just trying to protect me." Catra sighs, "I wanted to give myself up, they were more than happy to up and move the entire camp for me. To keep me safe from those… idiots."

“I fear to ask…” Adora says more to herself than the group as she squeezes Catra’s hand.

“Fagen’s dead.” Catra eyes glaze over as she tries not to think about the look of life leaving his eyes that fateful night, “And Delia… I… I don’t know. I hope she made it. But, I’m not sure of that. Which is why I need to get back.”

“I’m sorry.” Adora breathes out.

“Not your fault.” Catra tries to shrug again, and then grabs Adora’s hand, “I need to get back.”

“We’ll help you get back, but only once you get better.” Adora’s voice still soft, “I’m not going to let you just walk out and probably bleed out and die before you get to where you need to be.”

“Why do you care so much, princess? You barely know me.” Catra narrows her eyes at the blonde.

“You saved me. Saved us.” Adora says.

“I was trying to escape.” Catra replies.

“That’s not true.”

“Yeah, it is.”

“No, it’s not.”

“Why the fuck are you arguing with me about my own motivations?” Catra asks instead.

“Because.” Adora starts with a smirk on her face when she looks down at the magicat in her lap, “If you were planning on escaping, you would have just left and not taken every single one of them out.”

“Well, I’m not an asshole.” Catra defends, “I know what they’re like. And a pretty girl like you… well, I wasn’t going to let that happen.”

“I know you’re not an asshole and wait…” Adora starts and then pauses, “Did you just call me pretty?”

“No.” The magicat quickly denies.

“Oh my stars… you did!” Adora beams out as Catra tries to get out of the blonde’s neck before being quickly held in place, “Woah, where do you think you’re going?”

“Away.” Catra tries again only for second time, “Argh, you’re so annoying!”

“And pretty!” Adora laughs out as she gently cradles the magicat into her arms, “But you still shouldn’t move again.”

“Uh huh.” Catra winces a little in pain at the jostling, “Should have just let me die.”

“That’s not funny, Catra.” Adora says sincerely.

Catra’s taken aback by Adora’s sincerity, she looks elsewhere for a distraction and a change of subject, “What are you doing here, in the Waste?”

“I’m supposed to be competing in a tournament at the end of the week.” Adora replies looking a little dejected, “If we get there.”

“What tournament?” Catra presses on.

“It’s a martial arts tournament. All styles.” Adora perks up a little upon speaking about it.

“You’re a martial artist?” Catra asks.

“Sort of.” Adora replies with a blush, “I’m okay…”

“She’s more than okay.” Bow adds in, “She’s won multiple events.”

“Yeah, Adora’s going to win this one too.” Glimmer pipes up.

“That’s… pretty cool.” Catra agrees, “Just as long as you don’t beat me up too.”

“Definitely not.” Adora rolls her eyes, “I don’t start fights.”

“Huh.” Catra just says and then she winces a little differently, “Uh, I think I’ve sprung a leak…”

“Hm?”

Catra reaches beneath her jacket and then scrunches up her nose in confirmation, pulling her hand out and sighing out, “Pretty sure whatever you did to put me back together again has split.”

“Oh, shit!” Adora reaches down and finds that the entire bandage she had wrapped around the magicat’s stab wound completely drenched, “Glim!”

“On it!” Glimmer and Bow quickly rush over, “Told you we should have stitched it up while she was still out.”

“Stitch me up?” Catra asks before realising what was going to happen, “Oh… right.”

Adora grimaces, “The bleeding seemed to stop when we had you all bandaged up…”

“Where are you stitching me?” Catra asks in lieu of dealing with Adora’s comment, “Front or back?”

“Both, probably.” Glimmer replies as she starts going through their bags for her first aid kit and then finds what she’s looking for with an, “AHA!”

“You’re kidding… Sparkles is going to stitch me up?!” Catra asks shocked.

“You wish it was me.” Glimmer sticks her tongue out childishly at the magicat, “Bow’s the medical guy in the team.”

“Uh huh… which makes you?” Catra says with a wince.

“Management.” Glimmer smirks, “Now, get your jacket and shirt off.”

Catra looks up and sees Adora’s face go red, “Uh, Adora? Help me out here, would you?”

“Mhm.” Adora replies without any eye contact, “Um, what do you need me to do?”

“Undress me, princess.” Catra says with a little chuckle at how bashful Adora is being, “Stop being weird. I’m going bleed out if you don’t hurry up.”

“Oh, right.” Adora snaps out of it and gently helps Catra out of her jacket and shirt, the blonde’s eyes dart away upon realising Catra doesn’t have anything on underneath the two layers, “Stars…”

Catra looks down at herself, “Yeah, no point for support when there’s not much there to support.”

“HA!” Glimmer laughs out, breaking the tension as Bow gloves up and grabs the suturing kit, “I’ve got a bottle of booze if you want to numb the pain a bit.”

“What kind?” Catra looks over at Glimmer.

“Whiskey.” Catra thinks about it, “It’s not for drinking, idiot.”

“Oh, then what’s it for?” Catra asks as she looks to Adora doing her best to keep her eyes stare in a respectable spot, which so happens to be the magicat’s eyes, “What’s it for, if not drinking?”

“I’ll show you.” Glimmer smirks as Bow gets into position next to Catra on the ground, Adora’s hands placed gently on the magicat’s

shoulders. Glimmer cracks the lid on the bottle and brings it over, "Ready?"

"Not sure what you're… oh, FUCK!" Catra almost leaps up, only to be held down by Adora when Glimmer pours the whiskey onto the magicat's leaking stab wound on her chest, "WHAT THE FUCK, SPARKLES!!!"

"Now, Bow." Glimmer calmly instructs.

"On it!" Bow quickly wipes off the remnants of alcohol before he starts to sew up the small stab wound.

"GEEZ-FUCK!" Catra grunts out as she writhes around.

"Stay still, Catra." Glimmer chastises, "Or Bow will have to start again."

"It's okay." Adora's voice breaks through the magicat's thoughts of swiping her claws through Bow, "You're doing great. He's nearly done."

Catra relents, her breaths become shorter and faster as she grits her teeth through the pain until she hears Bow say, "DONE!"

"Fuck, finally…" Catra breathes out.

"Turn her over." Glimmer says.

"Wait, what?!" Catra turns her head frantically to Adora.

"Just to your side, Cat." Adora says with an apologetic smile on her lips.

Catra closes her eyes and takes a deep breath in, "Fine."

Adora helps Catra to her side and once again Glimmer splashes the whiskey over the wound before Bow gets to work.

"You're okay. You're doing really well." Adora repeats calmly and soothingly as she holds the magicat in place, "Nearly done. I've

got you. I've got you."

"Promise…?" Catra grits out.

Adora nods despite the magicat not being able to see her, "I promise."

Catra claws dig into the earth the longer Bow stitches, "Fuck…"

"Breathe, baby. Breathe…" Adora says and almost instantly she feels Catra still, "What?"

"What did you say?" Catra asks, the line of questioning taking her mind off the pain.

"I said… breathe?" Adora answers not sure what the problem is.

"You said something else with it…" Catra probes.

"Uh…"

"Done!" Bow calls out for the final time.

"Saved by the bell. Or should I say by Bow." Catra smirks as Adora gently rolls her back, "That was… a lot."

"I know." Adora nods, "You should rest."

"We all need to." Glimmer announces, "Argh, I knew I should have brought more snacks."

"Check the horses." Catra says absentmindedly, "Will and his cohorts should have supplies. They weren't hunting when I was held captive with them that's for sure."

"Why didn't we think of that?" Bow asks Glimmer, "Come on, Glim. Let's raid their stuff. Maybe they've got swags or something too."

"Grab a torch, fire torch." Catra reminds them, "Each."

Bow nods, "We won't be too far."

“Thank the stars for supplies!” Glimmer declares as she bites down into a protein bar, “Also, yuck.”

“Eat up, Sparkles.” Catra chuckles, “It’s either that or starve.”

“They’re not that bad.” Adora says as she polishes off her second bar, “Would be nice if they were berry flavoured or something.”

Bow grimaces as he eats his bar, “Could be worse, I guess.”

“What about you?” Adora asks as she unwraps a third bar, “You have to eat too.”

“Aren’t you afraid I’m going to choke?” Catra says and Adora smiles down at her.

“Do you want me to feed you, Cat?”

“Maybe.”

“Gross.” Glimmer sticks her tongue out at the pair, “Get a room.”

“Would love to.” Catra replies without turning her head, “Bit hard when we’re in the middle of woods next to the fucking road though.”

Bow yawns out exaggeratedly, “I don’t know about you guys, but I’m literally beat.”

“Come on, Bow.” Glimmer grabs his hand and a torch and head to where they’ve set up to sleep for the night using what they’ve raided from their attacker’s supplies.

“What about you, princess?” Catra asks, “You need your beauty sleep too.”

Adora nods, “Eat first, then sleep.”

“Feed me?”

Adora laughs a little before nodding and then bringing the bar up to Catra's mouth, "Just so you know I'm going to be spooning you tonight."

"Why's that?"

"Because I've got a feeling that you're going to run." Adora replies, "And it'd be easier to just trap you in my arms than anything else."

"How long have you been thinking about spooning me?" Catra smirks as s takes a bite of the bar in front of her.

"Not long." Adora shrugs, "I'm only doing this for safety though."

"Uh huh. Safety." Catra repeats unconvinced.

"Yep. Safety." Adora confirms, "Plus it means I can put pressure on the stab wound on your back and keep an eye on it if it starts to leak again."

"It's fine if you want to touch me, Adora." Catra says completely surprising the blonde, "I'm not going to turn down a warm body."

"What? You'd be happy with any warm body?" Adora questions playfully as Catra takes another bite.

Catra shrugs, "Your body will do. And it helps that you smell pretty good too."

"So full of compliments, aren't you?" Adora rolls her eyes as Catra takes the last bite of the bar and the blonde scrunches up the wrapper and pockets it, "Okay, ready?"

"Nope, but spoon away." Catra says in amusement, "Actually, toss that wrapper out of your pocket. Don't want anything pawing at you trying to find the source of the smell of the wrapper."

Adora pulls the wrapper out of her pocket, "Uh, I'm just going to…"

“Yep.” Catra says as she winces while she rolls off to the side with the help of Adora, “I’m good.”

Adora giggles a little as she gently settles the magicat down on the ground so she can get up and put the rubbish away before coming back, “Okay. So, how are we doing this?”

“Well, roll me over and then I’m all good.” Catra muses, “Just don’t crush me, princess. I’m already broken.”

“Okay.” Adora chuckles at that before moving herself behind the magicat, “Just let me know if I am crushing you, okay?”

“Sure.” Catra says as Adora carefully adjusts the magicat on her side so she can properly spoon her, before trying to shut down the purr that involuntarily rumbles out of her chest.

“Oh my stars…” Adora whispers out, a coo and a grin on the blonde’s face upon hearing that, “Did you just… are you…?”

“Shut up, princess and go to sleep.” Catra chastises, “This is not because I like you.”

Adora pulls the magicat closer into her chest, “Whatever you say.”

“I do say.” Catra yawns.

“Goodnight Catra.” Adora whispers after a tired yawn and a smile on her face.

“Night, Adora.”

Adora wakes up to the sound of a someone beeping their horn loudly. She opens her eyes, laying on her back as she rubs the sleep out of them and yawns and then groans out when the horn sounds again.

“Ugh.” The blonde grumbles, “Glim? Bow? You guys awake?”

“It’s too early!” Glimmer bemoans as the couple slowly wake up, “Wait… is that help?”

Bow springs up, pulling Glimmer up with him, “Oh, that’s good! Maybe they got our message!”

“Woah!” Adora quickly stops the pair, “What if it’s not?”

“What do you mean?” Bow questions looking around.

“What if they aren’t here for us?” Adora says, “I say we check it out before we give ourselves away.”

“You’re right, Adora.” Glimmer agrees, “We don’t know what other kind of crazies are out there.”

“I’ll take a look, you guys stay here.” Adora instructs as her friends’ nod.

“Be careful.” Bow whispers out.

Adora nods back to him as she quietly steps forward towards the sound of the car making so much noise so early in the morning. The sun has just risen, and the coolness of the air still lingers as Adora gets to the edge and peeks out from behind a tree.

“Hello! Anywhere alive?!” A policeman calls out, except the vehicle he drives is not marked as a police car, it’s a rather fancy sports car of sorts, definitely not something the police would be using, “Hello? Anyone?!”

Adora watches as a second person exits the vehicle, another man, taller and a lot more intimidating that the first, though he is not dressed in any type of uniform. Instead, he wears white. A white suit that doesn’t belong in this environment. He puts his hand on the first man’s shoulder, “Find that magicat and bring it to me.”

The first man nods, “Yes, sir.” And then starts to make his way towards the woods as the man in white leans against the car,

pulling his phone and tapping on it a few times and then holding it to his ear.

He grunts out when no one answers his call, pocketing the device and then crossing his arms over his chest, he mumbles out, "I gave you one simple job Will. Bring that magicat back to me in one piece. It cannot be that difficult to take care of one wretched beast."

Adora gasps slightly to herself before backing away and back to her friends, the man in white seems uninterested as he looks at his nails in the meantime.

Adora quickly ducks behind a tree when the first man approaches, running back to the man in white, "Sir! Come quickly!"

"What is it, Paxton?" The man in white scowls back, "You better not be wasting my time. And if you mess up my suit… there will be hell to pay."

Paxton gulps down, "Uh, yes sir, mister Prime."

"That's *Lord* Prime." He growls out and the other man cowers.

"Yes, Lord Prime." He corrects himself, "This way. I think you should come see this."

Adora quickly rushes back to her friends, harshly whispering to the pair, "We have to go. Now!"

"What? Why?" Glimmer whisper shouts back.

"No time!" Adora gestures for them to follow her before she realises the magicat's missing presence, "Where's Catra?"

Bow and Glimmer shrug as they look at one another, and then all three turn there heads to where there's noise coming towards them, "No time. Come on!" Adora gestures to them to start moving.

The trio pick up their bags and start to move further into the woods, just out of sight from the newcomers, panting softly as they hold tight in the safety of the thick brush. Adora brings a finger to her mouth to signal silence, her friends nod as they watch the newcomers go to their camp site.

“Lord Prime, the horses!” Paxton points out, “But what happened to Will and the rest of the squad?”

“Did you not see the road?” Prime reminds the other man, “The damn cat shredded them to pieces.”

“Oh.” Paxton gulps down, “What, uh, what do we do now?”

“Go find that magicat!” Prime orders angrily, “Bring it to me. Now!”

“By myself?” Paxton visibly shakes, “But… that thing did that to Will and the whole squad…”

Prime glares at him and she cowers once again, “Are you disobeying me?”

“No, Lord Prime.” Paxton backtracks, “But, if that magicat can take out 7 people single handedly… oof!”

Prime grabs the man, pulling him up so that his legs dangle off the ground as he glares into Paxton’s eyes, “Find it or I will make you wish that beast would have killed you.”

“Y-yes, my Lord. S-sorry Lord Prime.” Paxton quickly stammers out, “I’ll get the magicat for you. On my life.”

Prime drops Paxton down to the ground, “Get going then.”

“Come on, we need to move!” Adora gestures to her friends once Paxton and Prime have both moved on, “We can take the horses.”

“Good idea.” Bow agrees.

“It’s not too far.” Glimmer says as she sees the horses up ahead, “Quick!”

The trio start to sprint towards the horses, they sling their bags over the top of their chosen horses, Bow and Adora easily mount their horses, “Shit, Glim!” Bow quickly jumps back down to help her up, “Come on, I’ll give you a boost.”

“Okay.” Glimmer puts a hand on the horse and the other on Bow’s shoulder as he gets ready to boost her up and then… “Oof! Bow!”

“Hey! What the?!” Bow manages to get out before he’s picked up and flung against a nearby tree, “Ow…” and then blacks out.

“Bow!” Glimmer shouts out before she’s grabbed by the hair and yanked back, “Ow! What the fuck?!”

“Ah… what do we have here?” Prime’s breath grazes Glimmer’s ear.

Glimmer manages to turn around and kick Prime in the shin as he grunts out but doesn’t drop her, “Let go!”

“Hey!” Adora comes up from behind and charges full speed at him with her horse, “Let her go!”

Prime doesn’t have time to move out of the way as Adora knocks him to the ground, his grip on Glimmer loosening enough for her to run away while Adora turns her horse around to get to Bow who’s on the ground.

BANG!

A loud gun shot sounds from where Prime gets to his feet.

BANG! BANG! BANG!

"Woah!" Adora's horse drops down to the ground all of sudden, trapping the blonde's leg under it she goes down with it, "Ow! Glim! Run! Don't worry about me!"

Glimmer looks between her best friends.

Bow is knocked out on the ground from the knock to against the tree.

Adora's trapped under her horse as Prime growls out, making his way towards them with an angry scowl on his face, "You will pay for that."

He raises his gun to Glimmer, "Please! No! Don't kill us! Please!"

"Where is that beast?" He growls out and cocks the gun, pointing it directly at Glimmer, "And don't lie to me."

"I don't know!" Glimmer shouts out and then screams as Prime pulls the trigger, a bullet landing close to her foot, "I don't know! I'm telling you the truth!"

"Well, in that case." He points the gun directly at Glimmer's chest, "You are of no use to me then."

Glimmer slams her eyes shut as she waits for the killing shot.

"Oof!" Prime goes down as Paxton lands on him, the gun knocked out of his hand as he tries to get up, "Get off me you buffoon! Paxton! Get off!"

Paxton doesn't respond. The man's mass pinning Prime under him as Glimmer quickly gets up and collects the gun and then spots

Catra. The magicat sprinting over and lands a hard punch to Prime's face, knocking him out cold.

"We have to go." Catra grunts out, "Get your boy and I'll grab the princess."

"What?!" Glimmer frowns.

"Do it, Sparkles!" Catra shouts out as she pulls Adora's leg free, "Can you walk, Adora?"

"I… I don't know…" Adora replies as she gets to her feet with Catra's help and then hisses out when she puts weight on her right leg, "Ow… my leg!"

"Fuck." Catra grunts out before getting under Adora's arm, "Come on, I'll be your crutch. We need tot get to the car."

"What car?" Glimmer asks as she starts to drag Bow by the leg towards the magicat and Adora.

"Prime's car." Catra replies before looking down at Bow, "Is he dead? Because if he is dead, there's no point dragging his body around."

"He's not dead." Glimmer growls out.

"Can you carry him?" Catra asks seriously and Glimmer just stares at her with an obvious look of *no.* "Help Adora to the car. I'll grab your boy."

"Cat…" Adora tries to argue as Glimmer props herself under Adora for support.

"I'm fine, princess." Catra smirks back, "Magicat genes help me heal faster than the average bear."

"You're still hurt!" Adora calls out.

“So are you!” Catra crouches over Bow and thinks about how she’s going to lift him up, “Get going before Prime wakes up!”

“Come on.” Glimmer gestures for Adora to start moving, “I’ll grab our bags once you are safe in the car.”

“The bags don’t matter, Glim.” Adora says as she grimaces and winces with every step, she glances back quickly to see Catra sling Bow over her shoulder, her eyes widen, “How is she doing that?”

“Magicats, am I right?” Glimmer shrugs, “Come on.”

“We’ll be right back.” Catra says as she grabs Glimmer by the arm, “We’re going to grab the rest of our stuff quickly and then be back.”

“Be careful.” Adora says to both of them, “If you can’t get them, don’t worry about them.”

“We’ll be fine, Adora.” Glimmer smirks and then brandishes the gun to show her, “I’ve got this if he tries anything or wakes up.”

Catra rolls her eyes, “Come on.”

A few minutes later, the boot opens and Glimmer gets into the backseat of the car with Bow who’s still knocked out while Catra shoves the trio’s bags into the boot before getting into the drivers seat. Adora breathes out in relief from the front passenger seat upon seeing the pair reappear.

“Keys… keys… keys…” Catra repeats looking around before slamming her fists on the dash when they aren’t obvious to their whereabouts, “Fuck it.”

“What are you doing?” Adora asks as she watches Catra rip out wires under the steering wheel.

“Hot wiring this thing.” Catra replies with a wince and then…

Vroom!

Catra smirks as she looks at Adora, “Got it.”

Adora rolls her eyes but there’s a smile on her face, “Can you even drive this thing?”

“I can drive anything, princess.” Catra grabs a pair of stray sunglasses from the dash and puts them on, “Now, let’s get the fuck out of here.”

Chapter End Notes

> It's been a long and tough week.
> I've got a bruise on my hand from hitting it with a hammer... yeah, not the smartest thing to do 20m up in the air hanging off steel...
> Anyways, not that I'm no longer dehydrated and sleep deprived I've had time to write... so good for you. 😁
> DW - this writer is all good!
>
> Ah, Prime... already here to ruin things...
>
> Thanks for reading, commenting (@Liseo - my only comment so far...), kudos, subscribing and bookmarking.

Hospitals

Chapter Summary

The group gets checked out medically.

Chapter Notes

new chapter! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Catra! Hospital first!” Adora grunts out frustratedly as the magicat pulls into a motel parking lot.

“Room first.” Catra argues back.

“No. Hospital.” Adora repeats, “My leg is… not good. Bow’s got a concussion and so do the rest of us probably and you’re most likely bleeding internally right now!”

“Geez, dramatic much?” The magicat rolls her eyes, “Could you just trust me on this?”

“Why? Why are we here?” Adora gestures around her.

“Because if we don’t get a room or two now, we won’t get one tonight.” Catra replies simply, “So, stay put, princess. Me and Sparkles will sort this out.”

“We will?” Glimmer pipes up from the backseat.

“Yep. We will.” Catra grins as she gets out from the car and goes around back to open the door for Glimmer to exit too, “Come on, Sparkles. Move it.”

“What makes you think I have the cash for this?” Glimmer whisper shouts at the magicat as they head towards the reception doors, “I’m not made of money, you know.”

“I know.” Catra replies pulling out a wallet from her back pocket, “We aren’t using your money, Sparkles.”

“Huh? Where did you get that?” Glimmer eyes the brown wallet in Catra’s hand.

“Here and there.” Catra shrugs, “Thief, remember?”

“Uh huh…”

“Most places need a credit card left on file. I don’t have one and I can’t use the ones I’ve lifted.” Catra explains in hushed whispers, “I just need you to use your credit card to leave on file if they ask for one.”

“Oh.” Glimmer says in understanding, “And… how are we paying for the rooms?”

“Cash, baby.” Catra grins waving the wallet in Glimmer’s face, “Also, you’ll need to do the talking. I can’t exactly show my face…”

“You’re showing your face now, idiot.” Glimmer reminds the magicat.

Catra rolls her eyes as she flicks her sunglasses back down over her eyes and pulls out a beanie from her jacket, flopping her ears back and hiding them under the headwear, “As long as I don’t talk, we’re good.”

“This is stupid.” Glimmer grumbles out as they get to the reception desk, Catra standing behind Glimmer to partially obstruct her from the receptionist’s view. When the receptionist doesn’t look up, Glimmer clears her throat, “Ahem. Hello?”

“Bug spray is $10.” The receptionist says without looking up from the computer.

“No, we’re not here for bug spray.” Glimmer says before she furrows her brows in concern, “Wait, do we need bug spray?”

The receptionist looks up finally, “What can I help you with?”

“I need 2 rooms for the night.” Glimmer replies.

“I’ve only got the 2 rooms left. Lucky you.” The oldish man behind the desk says as he glances behind him at the last 2 sets of keys on the hooks.

“Great. We’ll take them.” Glimmer says.

“That’d be $250 all up.” The receptionist says as he starts to type something into the computer and then turns around to grab the set of keys, and as he’s about to hold up the EFTPOS machine, Catra slams down the cash on the counter. He looks up a little startled, pulling the cash towards him and counting it before nodding and then puts the keys on the counter. He pulls out a sheet of paper with the motel’s floor map, “Room 19 is on this side of the building, right down the end. Room 40 is around back. Park only in the spaces marked for your room. Check out is at 10am. Any questions?”

“No.” Glimmer replies as she takes both sets of keys, “Uh… did you need me to sign anything?”

“Why?” The receptionist asks completely unbothered, “Your friend paid double what the rooms are worth. As long as you don’t burn the place down, I don’t care what you do.”

“Okay…”

“Also, no orgies.” He adds, “No more than 4 in a room at a time and like I said, parking is only in the spaces marked for your room. Also please take out your trash, condoms and whatever else and place them in the bins provided. Have a lovely stay.”

Catra pulls Glimmer out of the reception area before the sparkly woman can ask more questions, “Hey! What the fuck was that?”

Catra shakes her head, “Doesn’t matter. We have a proper room tonight.”

“Do we need bug spray?” Glimmer asks as they walk back to the car.

“Get some later, Sparkles. I’m not paying $10 for a small can of bug spray that’s probably already expired.” Catra replies as the pair get back into the car, “Okay, so… hospital?”

“You got him, Sparkles?” Catra asks once she’s parked up in the hospital’s parking lot, turning around with a wince as she addresses her.

“You couldn’t have just dropped us off at the front?” Glimmer huffs out.

“Nope.” Catra replies.

“Why not?”

“Yeah, I’m not welcome in hospitals…” Catra admits with a grimace, “Well, I’m pretty sure I’m not after I sort of lead a bunch of kids through this joint on a wheelchair race slash scavenger hunt…”

“Scavenger hunt?” Adora asks, the topic piquing her interest.

“It wasn’t like they stole anything…” Catra admits with a forced smile, “Just… you know, just finding stuff on a list of things I made up.”

“Like what exactly?” Adora asks quirking an eyebrow up at the magicat.

“Oh, it wasn’t anything bad…” Catra tries to brush it off, “Stuff like finding a one armed patient, green jello… which nurse has the keys to the good drugs… you know, stuff like that…”

“You’re a terrible influence…” Adora shakes her head, but there’s a hint of a smile in her voice, “Now, help me out of this thing so we

can get checked out."

"Not we, you and your manager and medical guy." Catra corrects, "But I can probably wrangle up a few wheelchairs…"

"I thought you said you weren't welcome in this hospital." Glimmer gently shakes Bow awake, "How are you going to even get wheelchairs for us?"

"Just watch." Catra smirks and then exits the car with another wince.

"Hey." Adora tries to reach out for the magicat and misses, "You're still hurt, Catra."

"Sure am." Catra doesn't deny, "But, I'll be fine. Always am."

And before Adora can retort, the magicat's shut the door and walked off towards the hospital, the blonde breathes out exasperatedly, throwing her head back against the head rest, "Unbelievable…"

Glimmer laughs from behind, "You're so into her."

"I am not." Adora whines out with a pout despite knowing that it's an absolute lie, "She's just… so… so…"

"So what?" Glimmer goads.

"So stubborn!" Adora settles on, "I mean, where was she even when that Prime guy and his friend were trying to kill us?"

"Guess you'll have to ask her." Glimmer shrugs as she shakes Bow again, "Come on, Bow… wake up…"

"Hm?" Bow rouses slowly, "What happened?"

"You got thrown against a tree." Adora provides, "After you tried to help Glimmer get on a horse."

“Oh, I thought I’d dreamed that…” Bow blinks his eyes open a few times, “Where are we?”

“Hospital.” Adora replies, “Well, the parking lot.”

“Mm…” Bow hums out and then hisses as he tries to sit up, “Ow… my head.”

“How are you feeling?” Glimmer asks, fawning over him as Adora looks down at her leg and winces, her friend turns her attention to the blonde, “How’s your leg?”

“Hurts.” Adora simply says.

“What happened?” Bow asks with a wince.

“Fell off my horse.” Adora shrugs, “My leg happened to be underneath it.”

“Oh. Ow.” Bow says and Adora chuckles, “Think you’ll be able to compete?”

“I don’t know.” Adora shrugs a little deflated, “It’s kind of thrown off my preparation for the tournament.”

“Fuck the tournament.” Glimmer scowlers at the pair, “We’ve got bigger things to worry about than that.”

“Glim’s right.” Bow smiles at her in agreement, “Besides, if your leg is hurt, there’s no point making it worse. It could end up being much worse in the long run.”

“You’re right.” Adora nods, “It just… sucks.”

“I know.” Glimmer reaches forward and squeezes Adora’s shoulder reassuringly, “No one could have predicted this happening.”

CRASH!

The trio all yelp out at the sound and the impact of something or something hitting the side of the car as they all turn towards to sound and then see Catra there, preening.

“What the fu..?!” Glimmer grunts out and then sees Catra grinning victoriously with 2 wheelchairs nonetheless, “Are you fucking kidding me?”

“Told ya, Sparkles.” Catra smirks out as she pushes the wheelchairs into the side of car doors yet again, denting them in the process, “Did you really doubt me?”

Adora laughs upon seeing Catra’s bounty, “How did you even…?”

“Don’t ask.” Catra replies as she opens Adora’s door, “Now, do you need help getting into it or should I carry you into the hospital like the princess you are?”

“Please don’t.” Adora replies as she turns in her seat, “Help me out?”

“Sure.” Catra nods holding out her hand to the blonde, “Did you want the wheelchair?”

“Only if you push me around in it.” Adora replies with a grin.

Catra shrugs, “You’ll get my valet services until the front doors. And that’s it.”

Adora pouts as she manages to use her good leg to get out of the car and swivel into the wheelchair, “Wait, what if someone else needs them?”

“They’ve got plenty. Trust me.” Catra smiles at her genuinely, “Besides, you need one. Crutches are overrated. I should know.”

“Do I want to know?” Adora asks as she moves her bad leg into a more comfortable position.

“Probably best you didn’t know.” Catra replies and then looks over at Glimmer struggling with Bow, “Uh, I’m going to give Sparkles a hand.”

“Sure.” Adora smiles back.

“Go get sorted. I’ll wait for you guys in the car.” Catra says as she starts to head back to the parking lot after wheeling Adora to the front doors, she turns to the blonde, “Will you be alright?”

“My arms are still good.” Adora flexes her arms a little, making the wheelchair roll back a little, “Woah!”

The magicat quickly stops her rolling back further, rolling her eyes with a chuckle, “No need to show off, muscles.” Catra leans in so she can whisper into Adora’s ear, “Make sure you get some good stuff for me in there too.”

“Stars…” Adora breathes out, “I can’t lie to save my life…”

“Just get Sparkles to do it for you.” Catra stands back upright, “I’m sure she’s got a lot of experience in that field.”

“Huh?” Glimmer looks over at the pair, “Are you talking about us behind our backs?”

“Nope. I’m talking about you from the side.” Catra replies with a smirk, “Anyways, I’ll be in the car when you’re done.” And just as the magicat is about to walk off she turns back around and says, “Oh, make sure princess keeps both hands on the wheels or she’s going to roll back and probably crack her head open.”

“I will not… woah!” Adora quickly catches herself, “I was meant to do that…”

“Sure you were.” Catra shakes her head with a chuckle, “You’re right though. You’re a terrible liar. Absolutely terrible.”

Catra's leaning back in the drivers seat when her ears pick up the sounds of talking, not just any talking, talking about her and her new found companions.

"I can't believe that cat got the jump on Prime." One of the men says as they walk a little bit away from where Catra is parked up, "Even stole his car. And he calls us fuckups! HA! Who's the fuckup now?!"

The pair laugh as they continue to walk around, "I know! But there's not much we can do about it, can we?" The second man says, "We're fucked either way. Though, I'm surprised that cat didn't just kill him when she had the chance. I know I would have. Then we'd be free of that asshole."

"That sounds like traitor talk." The first man says seriously, a few moments later, they both break out in laughter again, "Glad I'm looking for his stupid car instead of whatever stupid task he's got the others doing."

"What has he got the others doing?" The second man asks.

"Rigging that martial arts tournament." The first man replies, "There's supposed to be some big prize on offer. And since he's not allowed to enter the tournament, he's getting the rest of us to fight it out to represent Horde. Glad I'm too incompetent to qualify."

The second laughs out, "Yeah, me too."

"Anyways, he's got another team out to get that thief back." The first man remarks carelessly, "Prime's got another team heading to the tournament's competitor accommodation to see… what was the word he used again… ah yes, recruit new people to the cause."

"Suck them in like we are."

"Pretty much." The first man shrugs, "What's he got on you anyways?"

"My family." The second sighs, "Said if I didn't submit to the Horde, he'd kill them and everyone I know."

"Me too." The first man sighs as well, "If I get the chance… I'd gut the bastard myself…"

"Woah…"

"Yeah." The first man shakes his head, his hands balled into fists, "An eye for an eye, right. He killed my little brother. And if I get the chance… I'm going to kill him."

"INSOLENCE!" The second man's voice changes tone completely, his eyes turned green in anger as he growls out at the first man.

"AH! ARGH!!!" The first man screens as he clutches at his neck, there's a crackling sound and then a loud pop, resulting in the man dropping to the ground, dead.

"AH! NO! FUCK!!!" The second man goes down in identical fashion.

Both men now lay dead in the middle of the hospital parking lot.

"Fuck…" Catra peers over to see as both men hit the ground, a small cloud of black smoke bursts out before dissipating into the air and then slamming herself back against the driver's seat and exhaling deeply.

Pulling the keys out of her pocket, the magicat puts it into the ignition and starts the engine up, moving her seat back up into a proper seated position before tearing out of the parking lot.

“Do we really need to be wheeled out in these wheelchairs?” Adora grumbles as a nurse pushes her towards the exit, Glimmer and Bow leading from the front, “I can just use the crutches, you know? My leg isn’t even broken.”

“Quit your belly aching, love.” The middle aged nurse scolds from behind, “And let me enjoy my exercise for the day.”

“Sorry…” Adora mutters out sheepishly, she looks back at the nurse, “Will I get crutches?”

“You’ll get one.” The nurse replies as they reach the last reception desk before the exit, “You’ll need to fill out some forms and leave a deposit for it.”

“It? One?” Adora’s voice raises slightly in shock, “I’m only getting one crutch? How am I supposed to move around on one crutch?”

“I’m sure you’ll figure it out.” The nurse replies nonchalantly, “Now, let me get those forms for you. Do you have a credit card? Cash maybe?”

“Uh…” Adora looks ahead at her friends, “Glim? Help?”

“Coming!” Glimmer says turning back.

“The hospital wants a deposit for the crutch.” Adora says.

“What? Why?” Glimmer turns Bow around in the wheelchair and doubles back to the blonde, “Your health insurance should cover it. As it should cover all the costs involved with today’s visit.”

“Oh, right.” Adora nods, “I have health insurance?”

Glimmer rolls her eyes and groans out, “How do you not know if you have health insurance?!”

Adora shrugs, a sheepish look on her face.

“Yes, you have health insurance.” Glimmer turns to the nurse, “She has health insurance.”

“Oh, that’s good.” The nurse smiles back, “I just need the details.”

Glimmer nods and heads towards the reception desk to deal with it.

“Where the fuck is Catra?” Glimmer frowns at the parking spot where Catra had parked in earlier, now currently occupied by another vehicle in its place, but no sign of the magicat or the car, “Seriously?! Why do we even trust her?!”

“Hey, what’s going on over there?” Bow points out to the small crowd gathering in another part of the carpark, using Glimmer as his support, “We should go check it out.”

“I hope it’s not Catra…” Adora says under her breath as they head to the small crowd of people.

“What’s going on?” Adora asks as they get to the back of the crowd.

“Don’t know.” The man replies holding his phone out and recording everything, “But it looks like someone died.”

“What?! Why are you filming this?!” Adora shrieks out, “Put that thing away!”

“No way!” He moves his phone out of reach and takes a few steps away, “Get the fuck away from me, bitch!”

“Adora! No.” Bow reaches out and grabs her shoulder before she does some damage, “You can’t hurt yourself again.”

“Yeah, blondie. Take it from your boyfriend there and get the fuck away from me… Hey!” The man turns around when Glimmer snatches his phone out of his hand from behind and throws it down hard on the ground, “Hey! What the fuck!? You’re totally going to pay for that!”

“Oops.” Glimmer says uncaring, “Bill me, dickhead.”

The man huffs, bending down to pick up the remnants of his phone as Adora calls out to the crowd, “Has anyone called the paramedics? Or cops? Or… anyone?”

The crowd murmur, obvious that no one has as the blonde sighs out and then looks up gratefully at Bow who’s on the phone, giving her thumbs up as they see 2 men laying dead on the ground in front of them.

And not long after, there’s a few people running out from the hospitals in scrubs and wheeling a couple of gurneys with medical kits on top, “Unbelievable…” Adora shakes her head at the people standing around recording everything on their phones, “And no one thought to help?”

SCREECH!

“Get in!” Catra’s rounds the corner in a black 4WD that’s modded up to the max as she comes to a screeching stop, waving her arms towards her new vehicle frantically to get the trio moving faster, “Come on!”

“What…?” Adora manages to say before the magicat has leapt out of the car and sprints towards the blonde and, “Woah! Catra!”

“You’re like the slowest person alive, princess.” Catra says as she lifts Adora up and over her shoulder and sprints back to the car, “Hold onto those crutches.”

“Cat!” Adora squeals out as Glimmer and Bow hurriedly make their way to the car too, “What is going on?!”

Catra settles Adora into the front seat before leaping over the blonde and into the driver’s seat, as Adora shuts the door. “Hurry up, Sparkles!”

“Don’t wait for us!” Glimmers growls out as Catra puts the car into gear just as Glimmer and Bow get into the back seat, panting and out of breath, “What the fuck?!”

“Prime’s people are coming!” Catra shouts out as she peels off and out of the carpark and back onto the main road, “We can’t be here when that happens!”

“Uh… where did you get this car from?” Adora gestures around her.

“I swapped the old one with this one that a bunch of kids that just purchased it and drove it out of the dealership.” Catra replies with a sly grin, “Dumbasses bought my story about that car being bullet proof…”

The magicat chuckles as the trio turn to look at each other, “Uh…” Bow sounds out.

“Where are we going?” Adora asks.

“Motel.”

“Did you get fed in hospital?” Catra asks the car’s occupants.

“No.” Glimmer replies, “We did spend a shit load of time just waiting around though.”

“That’s normal.” Catra replies, “So… I’m guessing you guys are probably hungry?”

“Definitely.” Glimmer replies.

“There’s a pizza place not far from the motel. We can grab a few and some drinks and head back.” Catra suggest, “Yeah?”

“Yes, please!” Bow happily agrees, “I can’t wait for some real food.”

Catra laughs, “Cool.”

“You two going to be okay?” Catra asks as she drops Bow and Glimmer off outside their room, Glimmer holding onto the boxes while Bow holds the drinks and tries to open the door, “Oh, hang on. I’ll grab your stuff.”

Bow finally gets the door open and the pair head inside, Catra quickly grabbing the pair’s bags and placing it inside before heading back out, Bow smiles at her as he takes a seat on the bed, “Thanks Catra. What time are we heading off tomorrow?”

“Check out is at 10am.” Catra shrugs, “So… any time before then.”

“Is Adora joining us in here?” Glimmer asks as she looks out to the car, “We’re used to sharing a bed if you want to your own room.”

“Uh… maybe talk to Adora about that.” Catra clears her throat, “I don’t mind either way.”

Glimmer steps out to the car, “Best Friend Squad sleepover?” she asks the blonde, “More than enough room if you want to join us.”

Adora blushes as she looks between her friend and Catra, she’s in two minds about her sleeping arrangements but she really wants to spend more time with the magicat and have definitely more room than sharing a bed with 2 other people. She bites her bottom lip as she contemplates her options and it’s more than

enough for Glimmer to smirk and shake her head at the blonde. Adora narrows her eyes at her friend, “What’s so funny, Glim?”

“Nothing.” Glimmer replies and then heads back to her room, grinning at Catra before she shoves a finger in the magicat’s chest, “If you hurt her, I will kill you myself.”

“Uh… what?” Catra steps back and pushing the finger in her chest off.

“You know exactly what.” Glimmer warns, “We’ll see you in the morning. Take care of her.”

“Of course.” Catra replies confused as she watches Glimmer shut the door to their room. The magicat heads back to the car, “Okay, now where is our room…?”

“So… how’s your leg?” Catra asks as she sits on the chair at the small table in the motel room while Adora hobbles over to the bed, “What did the doctor’s say?”

“Its not broken.” Adora replies, “But, yeah, I’m supposed to keep off it or a few weeks. Which means my tournament is a bust now.”

“Oh, sorry.” Catra scratches the back of head.

“Why are you sorry? It’s not your fault.” Adora replies with a hiss as she gets herself into a comfortable position.

“Uh…” Catra gets up from her chair and hovers around the bed, “I can sleep in the car tonight. That way you’ll have the whole bed to yourself.”

“Catra.” Adora voice is soft as she says the magicat’s name, “No, I’m not making you sleep in the car or the floor. Sleep here. In bed. With me.”

“Are you sure?”

“Yes.” Adora breathes out, “I don’t want to be alone tonight.”

“Well, as long as you’re sure…” Catra repeats as she makes her way to the other side of the bed and before she gets in, “Do we need to do anything with your leg? Elevate it or something?”

“I need to ice it.” Adora says, “You wouldn’t happen to know where I could get some ice, do you?”

Catra smiles, “I do, actually.” The magicat grabs the keys and heads towards the door, “Be right back.”

Catra returns with the ice in a bucket and then shrugs off her jacket, dumping the ice into it before wrapping it up and holding it out to Adora, “Here. I’ll grab something to tie it around your leg.”

“Thanks.” Adora says as she watches Catra disappear into the bathroom and reemerge with a towel, wrapping it around the ice and Adora’s leg securely.

“How’s that?” Catra asks.

“Good. Thanks.” Adora nods and relaxes back into the bed, “Uh… probably should have changed into my sleeping clothes first, huh?”

“Leave it on for at least 15 minutes then you can get up and shower or changed, princess.” Catra says as she makes her way back into the bathroom, “Speaking of showers… I think I need one.” The magicat says after sniffing herself, “Yep, definitely need one.”

Adora giggles at Catra sniffing herself, “Go on then. I don’t want to sleep with you if you’re all stinky.”

Catra grins, “Yes, you will. Just… not tonight.”

Adora blushes, “We’re not…” the blonde looks down at her leg, “I’m injured.”

“I’ll do the work.” Catra shrugs with a smirk, “I’m more than happy to get you very dirty…”

“Stars…” Adora shifts awkwardly on the bed, trying not to move her leg before turning her head and coughing, “Go. Go shower already.”

Catra laughs, “Whatever you want, princess.”

And when Catra disappears back into the bathroom, the blonde breathes out, “Stars…”

Chapter End Notes

I know it's been a little bit of a wait, but, thanks for waiting! 😁

Will there be spicy bits in the next chapter??? I dunno yet... haha
perhaps... perhaps...

Anywho... thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, subscribing and bookmarking!

Showers

Chapter Summary

Catra helps Adora shower.

Chapter Notes

new chapters! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Do you need help?” Catra asks as Adora thinks about how she’s going to get changed into her sleeping clothes, the magicat standing at the end of the bed, ready to help in anyway she can, “Do you know what you want to wear? I can get it out for you.”

“Could you grab me a fresh pair of shorts and tshirt, please?” Adora requests.

“Sure.” Catra nods as she unzips the blonde’s bag and starts to rummage through it, the magicat looks up at the blonde, holding up a pair of shorts and a tshirt, “Will these do?”

“Yes, thank you.” Adora nods with a thankful smile.

“What about a change of underwear?” Catra asks as she stumbles upon them in Adora’s bag, the magicat turning her head to the blonde in question, “Did you want to try to shower or something? Sleeping out in the woods hasn’t been the… cleanest. And I know I feel a heap better after one.”

“I probably should.” Adora admits with a sigh and then realises something, “Where did you get a change of clothes? I didn’t see you with any bags or anything…”

Catra shrugs as she looks down at the black long sleeve shirt and a pair of dark brown cargo pants, “I don’t think you’d approve if I told you…”

“Told me what, exactly?” Adora furrows her brows with quirking one up.

“Told you that I ‘lifted’ them from a major retail store while I was boosting the 4WD.” Catra says looking away, not wanting to see the judging look that’s surely on Adora’s face.

“Wait… I thought you said you got the car from random teens…” Adora recalls.

“Uh… no.” Catra rubs the back of her neck, “That… that didn’t happen. I boosted the car from an airport long term parking lot…”

“You did?”

“Yeah.” Catra says and then grimaces as she waits to be told off for doing the wrong thing, except Adora just sits there and… thinks, the magicat not 100% sure about what exactly until the blonde speaks and it truly surprises her.

“Well, in that case, we’ll need to return it back to the lot when we’re done with it.” Adora says, “If possible, back in the same spot it was parked in.”

“Assuming that it’s still in one piece…” Catra mumbles before she looks back at Adora with a wry smile and says a little louder, “Sure. I can do that… but…”

“But what?”

“But… what if it’s… not in the best condition when we’re done with it?” Catra asks, the same wry smile on her face from before, “Considering Prime is after us… or me, specifically…”

“We can always get a hire car.” Adora suggests, “They don’t know us.”

“And… what makes you think I’m in any position to rent anything?” Catra crosses her arms over her chest.

“Not you, dummy.” Adora chuckles, “Glimmer or Bow could rent one.”

“No need.” Catra brushes the offer off, “We’ve got a ride.”

“It’s fine, I’d rather total a rental than some one’s private property.” Adora reassures, “They’ve rented cars before.”

“No, that’s… that’s not what I mean.” Catra frowns down at her feet, “Look… after tonight, I’m taking off.”

“What?”

“Well, that was the deal, wasn’t it?” Catra says, “I get you guys here, safe and sound.”

“We were all injured, Cat.” Adora points out.

“Safe and sound.” Catra repeats despite Adora’s argument, “I need to find out what happened to my friends. I need to make sure they’re safe.”

“You’re going to get caught.” Adora whispers out, fear in her voice, “Prime and his people are going to catch you if you go back to find them.”

“Probably.” The magicat nods in agreeance, “But, also… maybe not. He’s barely got his hands on me as it is.”

“Catra.” Adora’s voice is tainted in concern, “Please. Don’t go. It’s a trap and you know it is.”

“I know.” Catra confirms, “But I can’t leave my friends at his mercy.”

“Look.” Adora sits up with a wince, Catra quickly coming over to help her up, “Thank you.”

“No problems, princess.” Catra sits down on the bed next to Adora.

“Look.” Adora starts again, “We know where he’s planning to go next. Why not beat him at his own game?”

“I… I don’t understand.” Catra narrows her eyes forward, “I’m not a fighter. Far from it.”

“You are.” Adora corrects, “A little scrappy… but still, better than some of the trained fighters I’ve faced in tournaments.”

“I’m not even going to compete.” Catra says dumbfounded, “I’m not even entered into the comp.”

“But I am.” Adora points out, “And I’m going to nominate you to take my spot.”

“Yeah, no thanks.” Catra shakes her head, “I’m not going to fight in that rigged comp. I’m going to definitely get killed if I fight.”

“Not necessarily.” Adora says as she thinks about it, “If you compete, they’ll need to play by the rules.”

“They won’t play by the rules.” Catra flatly says and then repeats, “The whole thing is rigged.”

“Actually, it’s not.” Adora counters, “If it was rigged, then Prime wouldn’t need to pick his best fighter to enter. Would he?”

The magicat shrugs.

“The tournament…” Adora starts.

“Competition.” Catra corrects.

“Same thing.” The blonde glares lightly at the magicat for the interruption, “Back to what I was saying, the tournament is still official and as such it’s going to be run as per regulation with international judges.”

“And what makes you think they’ll let me fight in your place?” Catra asks, “It’d make more sense if you just pulled out and they

have you forfeit your matches."

"Yeah, this is one of the weird rules…" Adora says as she tries to remember something, "I think it's like section 4 or section 5 of the rules that say that in the case of injury or the inability to compete, which let's face, I'm not going to be able to… I'm allowed to put forward someone else to take my place."

"That… that makes no sense." Catra looks at the blonde quizzically, "At all."

The blonde shrugs, "I didn't make the rules."

"I mean, what if you picked some random off the street to replace you?" Catra asks.

"Well, I wouldn't do that to start with." Adora rolls her eyes at the magicat.

"Uh huh."

Adora chuckles, "I wouldn't because the results still reflect on me."

"Uh…"

"Essentially if you do badly… I'm going to lose a lot of points." Adora explains, "And if you lose first round then I'm automatically downgraded and won't get seeded at future tournaments for a year."

"I have no idea what that means…" Catra scratches the back of her head.

"It means that for all future tournaments, I'm going to have to go through more qualifications before I get to the main draw." Adora breathes out, "Basically I have to expend more energy on more rounds than being straight in the main draw with a ranking."

“Sounds like it sucks more for the other qualifiers.” Catra says, “They won’t get the points to move up.”

“It just means they’re not good enough to move up yet.” Adora refutes, “Plus competing against me would be good practice for them, you don’t get better fighting easier opponents.”

“Cocky, aren’t we?” Catra quirks an eyebrow at the blonde, “What makes you think I’m even at your level?”

“Did you forget that you took out 7 people? While injured?” Adora reminds the magicat, “Or that you took out Prime, also while injured?”

“Yeah, but they weren’t exactly the *best* fighters.” Catra brings up, “Now you want me to compete with some of the best fighters in the world? You’re out of your mind, princess.”

“I’ve seen you fight, Catra.” Adora doubles down, “And… I think I might have a plan to get Prime off your back.”

“What’s that exactly?” Catra asks.

“If you compete, then you can’t be thieving.” Adora says with a smug smile on her face.

“He’ll think of a way around that.” Catra retorts.

“Well, I think my plan is going to work.” Adora crosses her arms over her chest, “Pass me my phone?”

Catra looks around, picking up the device and handing it over to Adora, “What are you doing?”

“What’s your last name?” Adora asks instead.

“What? Why?”

“Last name?” Adora repeats.

“I don’t have one.” The magicat admits, “It’s always just been just Catra.”

The blonde looks up from her phone, “Really?”

“Yeah, really.” The magicat replies with a slight frown, “We aren’t all fortunate enough to have anyone care enough to add a last name when we’re born.”

“I… I uh, I didn’t mean anything by that.” Adora stumbles out, “I was just asking…”

“Well, now you know.” Catra huffs out and deflates.

“Well, I think it’s kind of cool not to have one.” Adora says surprisingly, “Kind of like a superhero, you know? Just without the alter ego… which just makes you… uh… a superhero?”

Catra turns her head to the blonde perplexed, “You’re an idiot.”

Adora grins back, throwing a thumbs up at the magicat who can’t help the smile that breaks out of her, the blonde quickly going back to her phone and when she tries to save whatever she’s doing, her eyebrows furrow and she groans, “Okay, this thing is stupid. Apparently, you need a last name, or I can’t submit it.”

“What are you talking about?” Catra leans over to look at whatever is on Adora’s phone, the blonde quickly bringing it to her chest so the magicat can’t see, “What are you hiding from me?”

“Oh… nothing.” Adora smiles innocently back at the magicat.

“Uh huh…” Catra reaches over for the blonde’s phone, “Don’t make me claw you, princess.”

The blonde grins wider as she sees the magicat getting closer before squealing out, “Okay! Don’t claw me!” she shows Catra what’s on her screen and sighs, “I’m just changing the details for the tournament so you can take my place and then I can keep you safe.”

“I don’t need you to keep me safe.” Catra rolls her eyes, “I was doing… well, not great, but I would have gotten out of it… eventually…”

“Catra.” Adora’s voice stern, “I want to keep you safe. So, let me. Please.”

“How exactly am I going to be safe if you’re throwing me into a martial arts comp? I’m not exactly an expert in such things.” Catra says, “I’m just going to get beaten up by someone else before Prime gets me to steal something for him after.”

“Just… trust me on this, would you?” Adora pleads as she gives the magicat her saddest puppy dog eyes and a pout to match, “Please?”

“Stars… does that work on anyone?” Catra looks away.

“Well, hopefully… you?” Adora replies reaching out for Catra’s hand, “Please?”

“Ugh! Fine.” Catra gives in when she accidentally sees the look on the blonde’s face, rolling her eyes at Adora when the blonde smiles in victory, “If I get hurt, it’s on you.”

“Deal!”

“Also, I need to find out what happened to Delia.” Catra says seriously, “I need to know if she made it out and that’s she’s okay. As well as the rest of my camp.”

“I think Bow might be able to help you out with that.” Adora says after thinking for a moment, she taps on her phone a little more, “Okay, I’ve put a request in to switch you into my place in the tournament. Also, I hope you’re okay with using my last name…”

“What is your last name?” Catra asks.

“Grayskull.” Adora replies with a soft smile, “So… you’re going to be Catra Grayskull.”

“Fuck… sounds like you’re my wife or something.” Catra breathes out, feeling a little warm at the feeling of calling Adora her wife, “Not that it’s a bad thing or anything…”

Adora blushes upon hearing the word *wife,* clearing her throat as she continues on, trying to ignore the feeling in her stomach for now, “Like I was saying, Bow might be able to help you with finding out what happened to your friends.”

“How?”

“He’s got really smart friends.” Adora replies with a smile and then quickly taps something on her phone, “I’ve asked him to get in contact with one of his friends that’s really into… uh… illegal activity…”

“Hm…” Catra hums, “Sounds like my kind of friend.”

“She’s… Entrapta is more…” Adora waves her hand around in the air for a moment, “She’s kind of like an… ethical hacker…”

“Uh huh… sure.” Catra shrugs and then turns back to the blonde, “So, are you taking a shower?”

“I want to…” Adora admits, brushing back a few stray strands of hair back behind her ear, “But… I don’t think I can do it by myself…”

“Want me to get Sparkles in here to help you?” Catra offers.

“No. I don’t want to bother her.” Adora replies with a look of defeat, “They both looked so tired.”

“Okay. So… no Sparkles.” Catra gathers, the magicat straightens up a little at the next option, “Do you want me to help you?”

Adora turns away with a blush and a small nod, “If… if that’s not too weird…”

“It’s weird if you make it weird.” Catra says, nudging Adora’s shoulder, “I promise not to stare.”

Adora laughs, “I mean… I don’t mind if you look…”

The magicat grins, “You know what this means, right?”

“What?”

“I’m going to have to get into the shower with you.” Catra say and Adora turns bright red.

“So, how are we doing this?” Catra asks as she helps Adora into the bathroom after making sure there’s dry towels for the both of them, “What do you need me to do?”

Adora swallows down the lump in her throat, “I guess… I should undress?”

“Are you asking me? Or telling me?” Catra says without sounding sleazy, “I can turn around if you want.”

The blonde takes a deep breath in and out, “No, it’s fine.” The blonde moves Catra’s hands onto her waist, “Just make sure I don’t fall, okay?”

“Sure.” Catra replies with a nod, “I can close my eyes for the next part.”

“You’re making this weird.” Adora says as the magicat closes her eyes, “If you can’t see, I know we’re going to have an accident.”

“Okay! Okay!” Catra opens her eyes again and nods solemnly, “I won’t let you fall.”

“Thank you.” Adora smiles and with Catra holding her in place, the blonde reaches down to the hem of her shirt and pulls it up and

over her head, her hands knocking against the magicat's nose in the process, "Oh, shit! I'm so sorry!"

"It's fine." Catra replies shaking her head after the unexpected impact and makes sure to keep her eyes on the blonde's face.

"Can you help me with my bra?" Adora asks as her face heats up.

The magicat doesn't look down at the blonde's chest, her hands blindly reaching behind Adora's back for a clasp when she realises that Adora's in a sports bra, "Can't you reach that too?"

"I don't want to whack you in the face again." Adora replies biting her bottom lip sheepishly and then grabs onto Catra's shoulders, "Also, I'm sorry if it's really sweaty."

"It's fine." Catra says between gritted teeth, her eyes focussed on the blonde's forehead, her hands finding the bottom of the material and gently lifts the material up and over Adora's breasts and then up and over her head, "There." Catra hands the garment back to the blonde who rolls her eyes at the magicat, "Next?"

"Have you never seen another naked person before?" Adora quirks an eyebrow up at the magicat, Catra glaring back, "Because you're making this weird."

"Yes. I've seen another naked person before, princess." Catra replies in a huff, "But it's usually because I'm trying to… well… you know…"

"I definitely think I know." Adora replies with a chuckle, earning her an eye roll from Catra, "Can you help me with my pants?"

"…yes?"

The blonde cups Catra's cheeks, "Cat, I'm okay with you seeing me like this. And just because we will both probably be naked doesn't mean we're going to have sex."

"I know that." Catra says trying to turn her head.

The blonde holds Catra in place, "But… this doesn't mean I don't want to… with you… when my leg is better and all…"

Catra brings her eyes back to Adora's, a thought comes to her mind, "If I win… do I get to *win?"*

"You want me as your trophy?" Adora asks amused, "Because I'm not some kind of sex object, Cat."

"No. Not as a trophy, princess." Catra replies, "As motivation not to lose. Motivation to win."

"Well…" Adora wraps her arms around Catra's neck, "If it means that you'll be safe… then I am more than happy to be your… motivation."

Catra's eyes dart back to the blonde's, "Yeah?"

"Yes." Adora smiles as she brings her lips to Catra's cheek, "If you win the first round, I'll even kiss you on the lips."

The magicat's face breaks out in a grin, "Well… that's some… motivation."

"Good." Adora leans back, satisfied, "Now, help me shower."

"Yes, princess." Catra replies as her fingers make their way to Adora's pants and underwear, pulling them down swiftly and smoothly and then moving Adora so she's able to use the wall to lean on, "Stay here for a sec while I get the water warmed up."

Adora uses the wall to brace herself as she watches Catra get the shower ready, the magicat turning around with her hand outstretched, the blonde takes it and feels the water, "Mm… perfect."

"I know." Catra says staring at Adora, "Get under. I'll help you."

"But…" Adora starts and then stops in her tracks when Catra strips off completely before holding out her hand again, the blonde

blushes furiously at seeing the stripes along Catra's fur, with a deep breath, the blonde puts her hand in Catra's, letting the magicat guide her into the shower, "Thank you."

"You're very welcome, Adora." Catra says as the water wets Adora's hair, "If I'm being inappropriate or whatever… just tell me."

Adora simply nods as she pushes her wet hair out of her face with a smile.

"Stars… I feel so much better." Adora declares as Catra dries the blonde's air with the hair dryer, "Too bad my hair takes so long to dry…"

"At least it's only your hair." Catra remarks as she looks down at herself, "My fur is going to take forever to dry…"

"I can help you with that." Adora offers, "After you do my hair, I can help you out with drying your fur."

"This is going to be a long night." Catra grumbles as she hears Adora's phone ping with a new message, "Also, who is messaging you this late at night? Have you got a girlfriend or something that I don't know about?"

Adora laughs out at that, "Stars no."

"Then…?" Catra glances down at the blonde's phone.

"Oh, hang on." Adora grabs her phone and looks at it, "It's Bow."

"And why is Arrow's texting you so late?" The magicat quirks an eyebrow up and then adds with a tease, "Or is he sexting you? Because I wouldn't put it past you guys to be *that* close."

"We are not sexting." Adora rolls her eyes, "I am also not romantically involved with my best friends, because ew, no."

“What does his text say then?” Catra asks as she turns off the hair dryer once she’s happy the blonde’s hair is adequately dried, “Why is he texting you so late?”

Adora unlocks her phone and reads the text before answering, “He said that Entrapta’s found something.”

“Yeah? What has your ethical hacker found?” Catra jests as she gets up from the bed and puts the hair dryer on the table.

Adora looks up at the magicat, an unreadable expression on her face until she bites her bottom lip and looks down at her lap and then back at her phone, “Here. Maybe… maybe you should read this.”

Catra takes the phone out of Adora’s hand a little confused, the magicat taps on the screen to light it back up to read the text. Her brows furrow as she looks back up at Adora once she’s read it, “Is this… Entrapta person sure?”

Adora nods, “I think so.”

“You think so?”

“We can call her.” Adora offers, holding her hand out for her phone.

Catra puts the phone in Adora’s hand, the blonde patting the spot next to her, “I’m still wet, princess.”

“Just grab a towel.” Adora says as Catra does just so and sits on the bed next to her, “I’ll put her on speaker so you can talk to her too, okay?”

“Okay.” Catra agrees.

Adora pulls up Entrapta’s contact and dials up the other woman. It takes roughly 3 rings before Entratpa answers.

“Adora! When did you get married?!” Entrapta asks in lieu of a greeting, “Congratulations are in order! Perhaps some tiny food and drinks when you decide to invite me your celebration… assuming you got married on a whim…”

“Entrapta. What are you talking about?” Adora asks thoroughly confused, “I didn’t get married.”

“Yes, you did.” Entrapta refutes, “Or else why would you swap yourself out of the tournament with your wife?”

“My wife?”

“Catra Grayskull.” Entrapta concludes, “She’s your wife, correct?”

“Wrong.” Catra cuts in, getting impatient with this line of questioning, “Listen, Traps, is it?”

“Hello! I’m Entrapta.” Entrapta corrects with a giddiness in her voice, “Though, Traps is also sufficient. I do love a nick name.”

“Great.” Catra says swiftly and then gets to the point, “What do you mean my friends have been taken? What happened to them?!”

“Oh.” Entrapta sounds taken aback, “You didn’t know?”

“No.” Catra growls out. “Know what?”

“This Prime character has taken them. All of them.” Entrapta says, “He wants to make a deal of sorts.”

“What kind of deal?” Catra asks cautiously.

“He wants you to steal something from the tournament in exchange for your friends.” Entrapta explains, “Though looking at his past… I don’t think you can trust him.”

“I know that.” Catra sighs, “But… what can I do? He’s got my friends.”

Entrapta hums in thought, “Oh, I forgot to mention, Delia is alive. But she’s not in good shape…”

Catra’s jaw clenches at the thought, “But she’s alive?”

“Yes.” Entrapta confirms, “Though, I have concerns she’s only being kept alive as a means for your cooperation…”

“Do you know where they are?” Catra grits out.

“Yes!” Entrapta confirms, “But I’m not letting you go after them alone like I know you plan to do.”

“You don’t know that.” Catra argues.

“If I know Adora, I don’t think she’ll want to be widowed so soon after being married…” Entrapta brings up as Adora pinches the bridge of her nose and shakes her head, “Anywho… go to the tournament with Adora and her friends. I’ll meet you there with reinforcements!”

And before Catra can retort, Entrapta has hung up.

The magicat throws her head back in exasperation as Adora pulls the magicat into her, wrapping her up in her arms, “We’ll get them back.”

“I hope so.” Catra deflates.

“We will.” Adora doubles down, “You’re not alone in this.”

Catra sighs, “My fur is still wet.”

“Grab the hair dryer.” Adora suggests, doing her best to take the magicat’s mind off Prime and her friends, “I’ll help you get dry.”

“Okay.” Catra nods, pushing herself out of Adora’s arms to grab the hair dryer once more, handing it to the blonde and turning around after pulling off her shirt, “Not too long on one spot, please.”

Adora nods and gets to work.

"Oh my stars…" Adora says under breath and then coos a little too loudly once she's finished drying the magicat off.

Catra huffs out at the response, knowing damn well why the blonde is making that sound.

"You are so cute!" Adora can't stop herself from saying as she takes in sight of Catra looking all… fluffly, "I have to get a photo of this!"

"Nope!" Catra quickly grabs Adora's phone and puts it far away from the blonde who just sits there with a pout on her face as he crosses her arms over her chest.

"Not fair, Catra." Adora grumbles out lightly.

"If you take a photo then I'm not cuddling with you tonight." Catra threatens, much to Adora's delight, "So?"

Adora makes grabby hands for the magicat, "Cuddles!"

The magicat rolls her eyes, "Let me just check the door is locked and turn off the light."

"Okay. Hurry!" Adora grins, "You're cutting into valuable cuddle time."

"Dork." Catra says fondly as she finally turns off the lights and gets into bed with Adora, "How's your leg?"

"Sore. But it's not too bad now." Adora admits as she pulls Catra arms over her, letting the magicat hold her from the side, "Sleep well, Catra."

"Goodnight, princess." Catra yawns.

Chapter End Notes

Chapter 4 already?
Definitely going to be upping the chapter count on this one since I haven't even got to the tournament yet...

Thanks for reading, comments, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing!

Entry Fees

Chapter Summary

They're on their way to the tournament!

Chapter Notes

It's not the end yet!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“We’ll come pick you up from the airport once we get this car sorted.” Glimmer says as her and Bow get out of the car that Catra has boosted yesterday, she turns to Adora, “I’ll let you know when we’re done and then send us a pin to where you guys are at.”

Adora nods, “Okay.”

“Why don’t you just stay with your friends?” Catra asks Adora, “Your leg would be better if you weren’t getting in and out of cars.”

“No.” Adora quickly replies as she wraps her fingers around Catra’s arm, “You’re a flight risk. There’s no way I’m leaving you alone.”

Catra rolls her eyes at the blonde, knowing that Adora is 100% correct in that assumption if her thoughts throughout the night are anything to go by, the magicat sighs, “You can’t keep an eye on my *all* the time, princess.”

“You’re right, I can’t.” Adora confirms deflating a little bit, she looks back up into Catra’s eyes with hope, “But, I thought I had convinced you to stay…”

“With a kiss and possibly sex?” Catra returns in jest but it’s marred in a cynicism, scoffing out, “I’m pretty sure I can get a

kiss and definite sex if I didn't stay."

"You would so easily seek someone else?" Adora's face drops slightly as her grip loosens around Catra's wrist, "That I was so, am so… replaceable."

"Princess." Catra pulls Adora's hand back, letting it rest in hers as she takes a breath in, "You are definitely not replaceable. Not by a long shot. And I'd wager that I could sleep with all the women on this planet and they still wouldn't live up to you."

"Then… why?" Adora asks softly, "Why leave?"

"Because. I don't want to disappoint you." Catra replies after a few moments of silence before she jumps in her seat, hitting her head on the roof as someone interrupts their moment, growling out, she turns to her window, "We were having a moment. Or could you not see that?"

"You're an idiot." Glimmer snarks out, whacking the magicat on the shoulder lightly, "She's already dealt with your shit. And the oncoming shit that's coming is just icing on the fucking cake. So quit being an ass, Adora's not going to be disappointed if you lose first round or the final round. But if you don't at least fucking try… well, then you really are an idiot."

"Great speech, Sparkles." Catra grunts back, "Name calling really works."

"Ha!" Glimmer rolls her eyes and slaps Catra on the shoulder again, "If you think disappointing her is the worst that can happen to you, think again. If you hurt her, I will personally come after you and do unspeakable things…"

The magicat glares at Glimmer for a moment before she can't help herself and starts to laugh, "This is stupid."

"You're stupid." Glimmer throws back with a smile, "And seriously, work your shit out."

“I’m working on it, Sparkles.”

“Good.” Glimmer nods, “Now, get going. We’ll see you guys soon.”

“How’s your leg, Adora?” Catra asks as she wraps an arm around Adora’s waist to help her walk over to the vacant bench at the bus stop for the airport transfers, “Sit.”

“I’m not a dog.” Adora huffs out as, hissing as she sits down on the bench as directed, *“Cat-ra.”*

The magicat smirks, taking a seat next to her and looks Adora dead in the eyes and says, “Good girl.”

“Shut up.” The blonde blushes at that and shoves Catra playfully, “And don’t call me that.”

“The look on your face says otherwise.” Catra shrugs as she slouches down on the bench, “Have you heard anything more from Traps?”

“No. Not yet.” Adora replies as she pulls her phone out of her pocket and sends Glimmer a pin location of where her and Catra are, “Entrapta is… elusive. Hard to find her something especially if she doesn’t want to be found or communicated to.”

“You managed to get her on the phone last night.” Catra points out.

“Only because Bow had already reached out and I guess she was already anticipating my phone call.” Adora concludes, “Besides, she said she’d meet us there. So, there’s a good chance she’s not going to communicate with us until then.”

“That’s… that’s very inconvenient.” Catra surmises with a frown as she looks at her feet.

"Tell me about it." Adora groans out lightly nudging Catra playfully, "When we went on a trip with her and a few other friends, we got a flat tyre and since she's… not the most… reliable in some aspects…" Catra turns her head, wondering where the blonde is going with this story. The blonde takes a breath and continues, "Anyways, long story short, because we couldn't contact her, she wasn't aware that we were going to be late and as such wouldn't be able to make the dinner reservation that night. It wasn't until she realised we weren't going to show up, it took about half an hour after the booking time for that to happen."

"Wasn't there anyone else with her?" Catra asks.

"She went up on her own." Adora shakes her head, "The rest of our friends were going to meet us the next day. Entrapta said she wanted to run some experiments at the restaurant and hotel we booked out."

"I'm guessing she does that a lot. Travel alone. Do weird and wacky experiments." Catra says and Adora nods.

"Anyway, once she figured out that we weren't turning up, she finally called or more specifically returned our calls." Adora chuckles to herself, "And then not long later, she'd made her way back with a tyre repair kit, another spare and changed our flat there and then."

"What happened, princess? You couldn't do a tyre change?" Catra jests after having thought about Adora changing a tyre on a car.

"Uh… we may have taken the spare out along with the kit and the jack…" Adora admits sheepishly, "It was stupid but Glimmer thought it'd make more room for… drinks."

"I'm surprised you didn't call out that stupidity. Or Arrows for that matter." Catra points out making Adora laugh out at it, "Or was it really *you're* idea?"

"I don't really drink." Adora replies quickly, "And yes, I should have told her it was a stupid idea. But I… *had* a drink or maybe

two too."

"You were drunk." Catra states and Adora nods, "Okay… so… also you're a lightweight."

"Hey! Not cool!" Adora slaps Catra on the shoulder, "I am *not a lightweight."*

"Denial only makes it more true." Catra replies nonchalantly.

"That! That doesn't even make sense!" Adora throws her hands up in the air but there's a smile on her face as she nudges Catra with her shoulder, "You're insufferable."

"Yet you continue to suffer me." Catra shrugs, nudging Adora back.

The blonde giggles and then rests her head on Catra's shoulder, "I'm glad I met you."

"Likewise." Catra sighs, leaning her head back on top of Adora's after placing a slow kiss in her hair.

"So, princess was telling me about the time you guys had a flat and you couldn't change it due to you dumbasses replacing your spare and kit with… beers." Catra grins as she sits in the backseat with Adora's bad leg propped onto her lap.

"In my defence…" Bow glances back from behind the steering wheel as he drives, "I didn't even know they did that."

"You didn't see the spare wheel, jack and kit not in the car?" Catra asks.

"Well… how often do you check to see the spare tyre and kit are actually in the boot?" Bow asks right back and the magicat takes a minutes to think before nodding in agreeance, "See?!"

“I get it.” Catra replies with a chuckle, “You don’t expect your dumbass friends to get rid of the spare to put drinks into the boot.”

“Exactly!” Bow agrees like no one had agreed with him on it before, “And those two were not being very helpful when we did breakdown.”

“I was drunk.” Glimmer happily supplies, “And you’d already agreed to drive us up and said it was fine if me and Adora had a big night so we could celebrate her birthday.”

“I did.” Bow nods, “But I never said to compromise our ability to get out of an easily fixed situation like a flat tyre…”

“Well, at least we were hydrated…” Adora brings up, “Not that alcohol is really that… hydrating.”

“Did you only stash beers in the boot?” Catra asks.

“No. It was ciders and a few bottles of wine.” Adora replies, “I’m not really into beer.”

“I’ll remember that.” Catra says with a slight smile, “What… what do you drink?”

“Water, mostly.” Adora says readjusting herself in her seat, “Sometimes a soda or maybe even a juice.”

Catra chuckles, “What apart from water, sodas and juices, princess? What do you celebrate with?”

“A sports drink?” Adora replies in question.

“She’s a cider girl.” Glimmer answer the question for the oblivious blonde, “The apple kind.”

“Thanks, Sparkles.” Catra nods to the other woman.

“And I’m a wine girl. If you know what I mean.” Glimmer adds with a wink.

“Hey! Save that wink for your boy, Sparkles.” Catra laughs, “Pretty sure he’d get the sads if I started wining and dining you.”

“I’d be okay with that as long as it didn’t lead to more.” Bow shrugs with a grin, “Though I wouldn’t say no if you did win and dine her and then brought her back home to me afterwards so I can give her dessert.”

“I’m not doing your dirty work, Arrows.” Catra declares with another laugh, “Besides, I’m saving all my stolen cash on princess, here.”

“Stars…” Adora groans, shaking her head, “I’m not going out with you if we’re going to be doing anything illegal.”

That statement has the magicat grinning mischievously, “Oh yeah? So, I guess fucking you in public is out of the question…”

“Ha!” Glimmer laughs out as Adora’s face goes bright red, “Please don’t do that. I really don’t want to see my best friend in… that predicament.”

“Wouldn’t do it for real, Sparkles.” Catra returns, before leaning closer to the blonde, “There’s no way I’m sharing you in anyway with anyone else…”

“Catra!” Adora whisper shouts as she covers her face, “You can’t say stuff like that!”

“Why? It’s the truth.” Catra shrugs and then gently sets to massaging Adora’s leg around her knee, making the blonde sigh out happily, “Feel good?”

“So good.” Adora says in almost a moan, both her friends turn back to her in surprise as Adora blushes again, “She’s massaging my leg… that’s all.”

“Uh huh.” Glimmer smirks at her friends, “Maybe I should ask Catra for a massage later…”

“Nope.” Catra quickly shuts that down and then lifts her hands up to Glimmer, wiggling her fingers in a show as she adds, “These babies are for Adora and Adora only.”

“Not just for her legs, I take it.” Glimmer quirks an eyebrow up at the magicat before she laughs, “Whatever. Just make sure you don’t go under her clothes while you’re in this car.”

“No promises.” Catra grins back and resumes her massaging Adora’s leg again, “It may not be today or tomorrow… but when I win this stupid ass tournament, I’m going to be fucking Adora and if the closest and most private spot happens to be this car… so be it.”

Adora gasps at that, “What?! We are so not having sex in a car.”

“Why not, princess?” Catra replies with a smirk, “The backseat here is quite spacious…”

“Catra! No!” Adora groans out, “If you win, I get to pick where and when.”

“I didn’t know that was part of the deal.” Catra tilts her head in question.

“Wait… you promised to have sex with Catra if she won?” Glimmer asks Adora who nods sheepishly after a moment, the sparkly girls breaks out in a laugh, “Stars! That is classic! Go girl! I didn’t think you’d have it in you to offer something like that.”

“Ugh… stars…” Adora groans out at all the attention.

“Also, gross. Please don’t have sex in this car.” Glimmer says, “I don’t need the added smells and… bodily fluids…”

“And images.” Bow unhelpfully adds.

“And images.” Glimmer repeats, “Not in the car. Not in the backseat.”

“We’ll see.” Catra shrugs with a smirk.

“I’m so glad this is a rental…” Bow says under his breath.

“We’re here.” Bow announces after a few hours driving on the road and pulling into the parking lot at the venue, he stretches his arms over his head and turns to the occupants of the car, “I am ready to get out of this tin can.”

Catra gently lifts Adora bad leg off her lap and unbuckles her seatbelt, Adora doing the same as the magicat quickly rounds the vehicle and helps Adora out, once the blonde is out, her arm supporting the Adora, she turns to Bow, “So, where to?”

“We need to get you registered.” Adora says.

“Can we get settled first? Maybe something to eat or drink first? Scope out the place for Prime and his bag of dicks…” Catra looks around the car park cautiously, “We shouldn’t hang out here in the open too long…”

“Let’s find the registration area first.” Adora doubles down, “And then Prime won’t be able to touch you. Not until the end of the tournament anyways.”

“You can’t know that. He has a lot of people working for him.” Catra points out.

“Just… trust me on this. Please.” Adora shifts so she can look Catra in the eyes to show the magicat she’s not lying, “It won’t take too long.”

“I don’t even have ID, princess.” Catra reminds the blonde.

“It’ll be fine.” Adora smiles and then turns to her friends, “Can we go get Catra registered first?”

“Yes. Definitely.” Glimmer agrees, “It should be in that building over there.”

“Let’s go.” Adora gestures forward.

“Oh, Adora. What happened?” The lady with green hair in a bun at registration, wearing a light purple blazer and a white blouse asks as she sees the blonde approach with a limp and needing assistance from Catra.

Adora waves to the woman in recognition, “Hey Barb, it’s good to see you again.”

“And you.” Barb replies still with a concerned look on her face, “I was concerned when I saw your email come through with a change of competitor to replace yourself.”

“I fell off a horse. And it kind of… landed on me.” Adora replies as Catra helps her to sit down on one of the two chairs at the table the registration is taken place, “Nothing is broken. But I won’t be able to compete in this tournament.”

“Such bad luck that is.” Barb tsks in pity before turning over the papers in her hand, “I was hoping it wasn’t going to be too bad.”

“Yeah, it’s not too good. But it’s not broken but will take a few weeks to heal.” Adora confirms before turning her focus on Catra next to her, “Anyways, this is Catra. My replacement.”

“Sup, Barb.” Catra greets with a two finger wave, “It’s nice to meet you or whatever.”

The other woman looks at the magicat, tilts her head with a look of concern and says, “You’re hurt too.”

“Huh?” Catra says in confusion.

“You’re hurt too.” Barb repeats, “I can see it in the way you hold yourself.”

“You can?” Catra looks down at herself and shrugs at Adora.

“Yes.” Barb nods before going on, “You’ve probably got or are recovering from broken rib or ribs. Your leg is most likely bruised, not from a horse falling on you and your ear… well, that one is pretty obvious. I’m sure there are other ailments too, but I don’t know you that well and can’t gauge if the other injuries are actually injuries.”

“I’m fine. Fit as a fiddle.” Catra brushes off Barb’s accurate assessment of the magicat’s injuries, “So… am I in or not?”

“Can do.” Barb smiles at the magicat, “I just need some ID and the entry fee.”

“I… I don’t have ID.” Catra says staring at Adora, “Also, what entrance fee?”

“Oh, I’ve got that covered.” Adora pulls out some cash and puts into the table, Barb quickly counts it up and puts it in the lock box on the table.

“Okay, the fee is fine. I just need ID.” Barb says looking at Catra with a smile.

“I don’t have ID.” Catra repeats.

“Oh… then how can we verify you?” Barb says more to herself than to the pair across from her, “Hm… do you have any prior history of tournament results?”

“No.”

“Can I contact your martial arts club or dojo?” Barb asks.

“No. Don’t have any.”

“Oh… so… what belt do you hold?” Barb tilts her head in question.

Catra looks back at her confused and then looks down, “Uh… I think this is black. I’m not too good with colours…” the magicat contemplates unbuckling it to show the woman when Adora puts her hand over Catra’s to pause her movements.

“She’s not graded.” Adora cuts in, “She’s going to be replacing me in the tournament.”

“Oh, okay. I wasn’t sure if what you wrote on the change of place form was correct…” Barb flips through the papers again and then says to the magicat, “So, Catra Grayskull. Correct?”

“Uh, yeah.” Catra rubs the back of her neck at hearing her name associated with Adora’s last name, “So, am I in?”

“Not quite.” Barb replies with a sigh, “Since this rule hasn’t really been used much, there is one thing that you will need to do before I can officially have you take Ms Grayskull’s place.” She looks between the pair, “Congratulations by the way. You two make a really cute couple.”

Adora blushes and looks away while Catra takes it all in her stride, “What can I say? Adora is my princess.”

“Oh, that’s just so sweet.” Barb sighs happily before getting all serious again, “There is one test you need to do before I can have you take Adora’s place.”

“Sure. What is it?” Catra asks.

Barb stands up, she’s tall and muscular and smirks at Catra as she says, “Fight me and win.”

“Say what?” Catra turns to Adora quickly and then back to the green haired hulk of a woman, “I’m not fighting you.”

“Come on, Catra.” Barb goads, “We’re not fighting to the death or anything. Regulation rules.”

“I don’t know what any of that means” Catra says rooted to her seat as Barb starts to stretch her muscles out.

“It’s simple. First to 3 wins.” Barb says and looks to Adora to explain.

“This wasn’t in the rule book.” Adora says pulling out her phone and trying to find the rules and regulations, “It just says that I can nominate another fighter as long as I take the risk of them losing first round and essentially dropping me down a level.”

“There’s the little asterix at the end of that regulation.” Barb pulls out the rule book and opens it up to the correct page, bringing it over to Adora to show her, “It says as per the discretion of the registrar, which is me, I can test possible competitors in however way I wish.”

“Uh… you never mentioned a showdown, princess.” Catra says trying to stay calm.

“It’s…” Adora starts but is interrupted by Barb.

“Essentially you need to prove to me that you deserve to be here.” Barb says, “That you deserve to take Adora’s place.”

“And what… I have to fight you?” Catra voice coming out a little higher, “That’s a little… fucked, isn’t it?”

“No. Not really.” Barb shrugs, “So? Yes or no? If you don’t want to fight, I’ll just have Adora forfeit all her matches”

Catra throws her head back and growls out, “Fine. Yes. I’ll fight you or whatever. How does this work exactly?”

Barb grins, “Main Arena is set up. Meet me there in 15 minutes.”

And with that, ushers the pair out of the room.

“Are you serious?!” Glimmer’s voice goes up an octave as the group goes into main arena, “Barb. As in Barbarian Barbarella Barb?” she turns to Catra, “Oh, you’re so fucked.”

“Thanks for the confidence, Sparkles.” Catra replies as she pulls off her jacket and gives it to Adora and then starts swinging her arms around to warm them up, “I get it, I’m dead.”

“Not exactly.” Adora folds Catra’s jacket over her arm as Bow helps her to sit down on a chair on the side of the fighting area, “Thank you, Bow.” He nods with a smile before she goes back to Catra, “I know her weaknesses. I’ve fought her before. You’ve got a chance.”

“Great.” Catra rolls her eyes, “So she’s a former fucking fighter…”

“Yeah…” Bow nods, “I remember her beating Adora’s ass for the first few years she was on the circuit.”

“Not helping, Arrows!” Catra growls as the doors open to the main arena and barb walks in, dressed in her competitive gear with a smirk on her face, the magicat gulps down and says to Adora and her friends, “I am so dead.”

Chapter End Notes

Ah... a fight to get into a fight... what could go wrong?

thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing.
I don't know if 8 chapters is going to be enough to finish this fic... but we'll see.

Trials

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Rules are, get to 3 points first and you win.” Barb explains simply as she stretches her arms out over her head, “Nothing below the belt, if you know what I mean.”

“No. I do not know what you mean.” Catra replies as she does a few squats and shakes her legs out, “Unless you’ve got a dick or something… not that I care…”

Barb laughs, “No, fortunately for you, I don’t.”

“Why is that fortunately for me?” Catra asks back as Adora hobbles over to her, “Doesn’t seem like much of an advantage if I can’t kick you in the dick.”

“It just means no attacks to the groin area.” Adora explains as she sits down on a chair by the sidelines with the help of Glimmer, “It’s more a fairness thing than anything.”

“Uh huh.” Catra nods in understanding, “Again, how is that fortunate for me that she doesn’t have a dick for me to kick?”

“Catra! Focus!” Glimmer shouts out from the sidelines angrily, “You have to play fair.”

The magicat rolls her eyes, “Fine. Whatever. No kicking in the crotch area.” She turns back to Barb, “Anything else?”

“Try not to bleed on the arena floor. We don’t have cleaners until the tournament starts.” Barb says with a wry grin, “Okay. Are you ready?”

“Fuck no. But let’s get this over with.” Catra replies as she stands in the middle of the arena, the other woman stares back at her

unimpressed, “What?”

“Catra… you need to go to back to your starting line.” Adora whisper shouts from the sidelines.

“What line?” Catra asks, turning around and seeing the white painted line on the blue mat, “Oh, right.”

The magicat walks back to her line as Barb waits on her own and then asks, “Do you have any other questions?”

“Yeah.” Catra replies and lifts her hand up, unsheathing her claws, “Can I use these?”

Barb’s eyes widen upon seeing Catra’s claws, sharp and glistening in the arena lights, without blinking away, the other woman says, “No. No claws.”

The magicat groans, sheathing her claws back and dropping her arm, “Okay, fine. No claws.”

“Okay, good.” Barb nods and cricks her neck, “Enough talking. Let’s start.”

“Hold up…” Catra takes a step back off her mark, “Who’s judging this exactly?”

“I am.” Bow steps into the middle of the ring with a big grin on his face, “I’m unbiased and I’ve been a judge before in the past before.”

“Okay…” Catra says eyeing the man.

“Great.” Barb claps her hands together and gets herself ready on her start line, “Let’s begin then.”

Bow grins, gesturing for Catra to get into position too. The magicat sighing before taking a step forward and back to her starting position, “Now what, Arrows?”

“Bow.” He says, “To each other.”

The pair bow to each other, Barb getting into her attacking stance right after as Catra just stands there and shakes out her body.

“Fight!” Bow calls out.

“Oh, that’s bullshit, Arrows!” Catra growls out as Barb falls to the floor after the magicat manages to land a solid hit, just in the wrong spot, “The head was never out of bounds!”

“It is when you guys aren’t wearing helmets.” Bow stands between Barb and the magicat protectively, “Also, you can’t grab their throat either.”

“What kind of fucked up fight is this?” Catra huffs out, taking a few steps back.

“It’s not a life or death fight, Catra.” Bow breathes out shaking his head, “You only need to score hits. That’s it. The aim is not to hurt or kill. Just hits.”

“That’s stupid. This is stupid.” Catra shakes her head annoyed, “These rules are stupid.”

“This is only your test.” Barb gets back to her feet with a grunt, “This is not the real fight.”

“Uh huh.” Catra scoffs, “And what’s the difference between this and the real fight?”

“Well, this year… is going to be different.” Barb replies with a shake of her head.

“Different how?” Catra asks as she watches Barb rub her chin where the magicat made contact with when she landed an illegal hit apparently.

“If you beat me. You’ll find out soon enough.” Barb says as she gets back into an attacking stance, looking over at Bow and nodding once, “Until then, it doesn’t matter until you beat me.”

“Continue.” Bow signals for the fight to continue, stepping back to get out of the way.

Barb moves to attack, quickly throwing punches left, right and centre as the magicat dodges all of them easily, “Attack me!” the woman grunts out as she continues to miss the magicat by mere millimetres.

Catra rolls her eyes, ducking under a roundhouse kick before shoving Barb off the mat and out of bounds, “There. Happy? This is still stupid.”

“Catra.” Bow sighs out as he looks at her with a somewhat uncomfortable look on his face.

“What? Don’t I get a point if she goes off the mat?” Catra argues, “I saw that on sumo wrestling!”

“No. Not in these rules.” Bow pinches the bridge of his nose, “It’s essentially just a time waster. And in this competition, it’s not good for the sport.”

“This is a stupid ‘sport’.” Catra repeats, “And I use that word very loosely.”

Barb rolls her eyes at the magicat, “What’s the score?”

“It’s still nil all.” Bow sighs looking at the clock on the wall, “I’m really tired, Catra. Can you either win or lose soon?”

“Do you want me to win or lose?” Catra asks.

“Catra…” Adora’s voice permeates the air, “Please don’t make me look bad…”

“Oh, sorry, princess.” Catra sighs, “I forgot this is important to you.”

“It is.” Adora nods solemnly, “Please. Can you take this seriously?”

“Fine.” Catra grumbles and goes back to her starting mark, “Come on Barbie. Let’s get this over with.”

Barb growls at the magicat with that nickname, “Shut it, kitty.”

“Whatever. Would you hurry up and kick my ass?” Catra cocks her hip out and looks at her claws boredly.

“Fight!” Bow calls out again.

This time when Barb attacks, Catra blocks her punches and quickly lands a shot of her own on the woman’s side, making her grunt out, grasping at it.

“Point! Catra!” Bow shouts out, much to the cheering and excitement of Adora and Glimmer.

They pair reset as Barb glares at the magicat, “Lucky shot.”

“Sure, it was.” Catra replies, “Because I look like someone that possesses that much luck.”

Bow gets back into the middle, looking over at each of the fighters, ensuring they are back on their marks before shouting out, “Ready. Fight!”

And sure enough, Barb advances quickly again, this time using a series of kicks and sweeps as Catra leaps up and out of the way. Backflipping over Barb and landing a kick of her own to the woman’s back, knocking her forward and onto the ground with a grunt.

“Point! Catra!” Bow announces.

“Argh!” Barb growls out even angrier than before, punching the mat hard enough to dent it slightly, “Dammit!”

“One more, Catra!” Adora cheers out from the sidelines.

“Hurry up, Cat! I’m fucking tired and hungry! I’m fucking HANGRY!” Glimmer shouts out, stomping her foot to emphasize the point, “You’re taking too long!”

“Hey! You’re the one that talked up the She-Hulk!” Catra returns, “Also it’s hungry and angry, dumbass!”

Glimmer stills and thinks about it and then says, “Oh, well, I’m that too. So, hurry it up!”

“Enough!” Barb gets to her feet again, “It’s not over yet!”

They get back into positions. Bow steps back into the middle, “Score is Barb zero, Catra two.” He nods to the pair, “Okay, ready and fight!”

Barb smirks at the magicat, “You still think you can beat me?”

“I’m two up, so yeah, I think I’m doing pretty well.” Catra shrugs as Barb throws a few punches and then backs off again.

“You know you’re going to get killed in the real competition.” Barb and Catra start to circle each other, “This year’s comp is different.”

“Are you trying to scare me, Barb?” Catra ducks under a wild kick from the other woman followed up by a side kick.

“No. It’s just a warning.” Barb grins as she tries to grab the magicat.

“Woah! Hands off the goods, Barbie.” Catra rolls out of way and then yelps as she feels Barb’s fingers wrap around her tail, “Hey! Let go of that!”

The other woman grins, “So… this must be your *weakness…”*

Catra growls out, spinning around and throwing a split spinning kick, landing hard against Barb's face and knocking the woman down, releasing Catra's tail in the process. "Don't fucking touch my tail." She looks to Bow, "Am I disqualified for that?"

"Uh… no." Bow goes over and checks Barb out, "That was actually legal."

"Oh, so… does that mean I win?" Catra asks as she goes over as well, crouching down to check on the other woman, "Is she… alright?"

Bow gently shakes Barb and then yelps when she pulls him down, pinning him under her, "Ah! It's me! It's me!"

"Oh, sorry Bow." Barb replies, getting up to her feet and helping him up too, "I thought you were…"

"Me?" Catra steps up and behind Bow, "Low blow, Barb. Low blow."

Barb rolls her eyes at the magicat and then sticks her hand out.

"What?" Catra looks down at the hand, "I'm not falling for that."

Barb rolls her eyes again and reaches out, grabbing Catra's hand and shaking it, "Congratulations. You're in."

"Were you even trying?" Catra asks confused, "Those three idiots talked you up like you were some unstoppable amazon or something..."

"Of course I was trying." Barb says with a raised eyebrow before swiftly throwing the magicat up and over her shoulder, Catra lands on the mat with an 'oof' as Barb stands over her with a smirk on her lips and her hands on her hips, laughing out, "Had to get one in."

"Of course you did." Catra wheezes out as she lets herself lie on the floor.

“You passed.” Barb says with pride and a nod, “Not many people can get one up on me. But you… you surprised me.”

“Thanks.” Catra replies as she rolls over and gets up, “Now, what were you saying about the competition changing?”

“Oh right.” Barb signals for Bow and Catra to follow her to the sidelines where Glimmer and Adora sit, she sighs first, “This year isn’t like the other tournaments. This one is essentially… anything goes.”

“And… what does that mean?” Bow asks squeakily.

“It means…” Barb sighs again shaking her head, “This is going to brutal.”

“It’s always brutal.” Adora says.

“No. The fights that you’ve been in have been regulated.” Barb informs, “Those are proper fights with officials and rules. No. This tournament… it’s going to be a bloodbath.”

“That sounds horrible.” Glimmer says with worry on her face as she looks at Catra, “Can we back out of this?”

“No. We can’t.” Catra says, “Prime will get me if I back out.”

“She’s right.” Adora agrees, “We can’t let that happen.”

“What does he even want?” Bow asks.

“Prime… Prime…” Barb says to herself and then the name finally resonates, “Oh, Prime. He’s got a fighter in the tournament too. Pretty jacked.”

“Pretty much on drugs.” Glimmer scoffs out.

“Doesn’t matter. This tournament is different.” Barb speaks up louder, “Point is, this fight isn’t going to be points based.”

“What… what do you mean?” Adora frowns out in confusion, “Isn’t this an internationally regulated tournament?”

“No. They’ve been bought out. Or scared out by Prime and the others.” Barb shakes her head, “This tournament is essentially you get knocked out or knocked down…”

“You’re kidding…” Catra grumbles under her breath.

“No. It’s bloodsport.” Barb says, and then pats Catra on the shoulder, “Sorry kid. It’s out of my hands. But… good luck.”

“Thanks…” Catra says cynically, “I’m so dead.”

“Yeah, you actually might be.” Barb says with a consolidatory look on her face as she moves off the mat and grabs her stuff, “Sorry kid. But you did good today. You’ll go far.”

“How many rounds are there?” Catra asks instead ignoring the sorry looks from everyone else, “How many people do I have to beat to not die?”

“Is it still a knockout tournament?” Adora asks, “Who’s officiating this?”

“Horde Industries.” Barb replies.

“Woah! If this isn’t a regulation tournament, then Adora won’t lose any points or whatever, right?” Catra turns to Barb in question, “So… I should technically be able to just… not show up, right? Not get pummelled to death or whatever…”

“Not right.” Barb says with a shake of her head, “All competitors were supposed to be notified.” She turns to Adora, “Did you not get a letter or at least an email regarding the change?”

“No.” Adora replies confused, “I didn’t receive anything.”

“They wanted you to compete, princess.” Catra says as she crouches down on the floor before dropping her ass and sitting

cross legged, “They probably needed some legitimate fighters in there so it wouldn’t arouse suspicions.”

“This is bad.” Bow voice drops in realisation, “Really bad.”

“Horde Industries… they can’t do that. Can they?” Glimmer asks.

“They can and they have.” Barb breathes out, “I really thought our organisation was better than that. I can’t believe they just… sold out.”

“All of them?” Adora asks deflated but hopeful.

“Not all of them.” Barb says, “Most of them. The one’s that folded got paid off as long as they promoted the event.”

“And the ones that didn’t?” The sound of Glimmer’s voice is tinged with concern.

“They… they were made an example of.” Barb’s voice turning angry, “I’m too low on the ladder for them to do anything to.”

“But, you’re still here.” Catra points out.

“Look. I’m not proud that I took the money. too” Barb says sheepishly, “They threatened my family if I didn’t comply. But I got out of this fairly lightly. I just look after registrations.” She looks at Adora, “And when I saw you limping in here today, I thought you were here to pull out.”

“Maybe I should have.” Adora sighs out, “Then Catra wouldn’t be in more danger.”

“She may not have been, but you definitely would have been.” Barb says looking around at the group as she recites the next part like she’s memorised it word for word, “Any competitor that has qualified and does not compete, whether due to injury or current circumstances will need to either find a replacement fighter or face the black box.”

“The black box?” Adora asks clearly confused, “What’s the black box?”

“Yeah, surely you’ve head of it before.” Barb’s voice surprised.

Adora shakes her head, as does Bow and Glimmer whilst Catra drops herself so she laying on the floor, staring up into the arena lights, the magicat speaks up, “What is this black box?”

“It’s your worst fears.” Barb stands over the magicat, “Literally put in a box with you.”

“That sounds…” Bow starts.

“Like what?” Catra interrupts, “What would they put in the box with you?”

“Like… say your worst fear is… I don’t know… snakes?” Catra shrugs, while Glimmer and Bow both nod in unison, “Okay, well, if your worst fear is snakes then you’ll be shoved in a coffin like box with snakes until one of 2 things happen.”

“Do we really want to know?” Catra asks.

Counting on her fingers, Barb says, “One, you die, either from being bit from the snakes or the prolonged stay in that box. And two, you relent and compete.”

“Those are terrible options.” Catra remarks as she rolls over and gets up, “So, what do I get if I win. Apart from sex with Adora?”

The others all turn their heads to the blonde, questions all over their faces as Adora blushes and flushes red, coughing into her fist and then glaring at the magicat.

Glimmer smirks at her best friend, “So that’s what it takes to get you into bed… you have to beat a whole bunch of people?”

“Shut up.” Adora tries to grab Glimmer only for the smaller woman to easily step aside, “It… it wasn’t like that.”

“She said I’d get a kiss if I won my first round.” Catra adds unhelpfully, grinning as an embarrassed Adora covers her face, “Hey, princess. Do I get anything for getting into this stupid ass tournament? That’s probably going to be the death of me?”

“What… what do you want?” Adora asks, her friends and Barb all whip their heads to the blonde at the question, Adora ignoring their looks, instead focusing on the magicat smirking at her confidently, “Well? Cat. What do you want?”

The magicat pretends to think and then simply points to her cheek, grinning widely, “A kiss. Here. Just one.”

Adora rolls her eyes good naturedly and then grins back, happy for the distraction as she stands up with the help of Bow, “Well, get over here and I’ll give you it.”

Catra grins wider as she walks over and stands in front of the blonde, “Well, here I am.”

Gently patting Bow on the arm so she can move freely on her own, Adora braces herself onto Catra’s shoulders, the magicat holding her up by the waist as the blonde presses a gently kiss on Catra’s cheek and then rests her own cheek against the spot she’d just kissed.

Catra nuzzles a little against Adora’s face, “Best day ever.”

“Really?” Glimmer asks sceptically as she watches Adora be held in Catra’s arms, “The fact that you’re now stuck in an actual life or death tournament makes this your best day ever?”

“Yes.” Catra replies, “Besides, if I win. I *win.”*

“Ew, gross.” Glimmer sticks her tongue out as she looks at Barb, “Can we go now?”

“Yes.” Barb makes a face at the magicat and the blonde still holding each other, “Do you know where your accommodation is located?”

“Yes.” Bow answers and slumps forward, “I could really go for some food and then a long nap.”

“That sounds really good.” Glimmer agrees before making her exit and then turning back when she realises Adora and Catra aren’t following, “Guys! Come on! I’m hangry!”

“We’re coming, Sparkles.” Catra growls out as she puts Adora’s arm over her shoulder, “Ready to go, princess?”

“Yes.” Adora nods with a smile.

“Lord Prime.” A foot soldier comes running into Prime’s accommodation, stopping in front of the man and kneeling before him, “They’re here.”

Prime nods to the foot soldier, “Thank you. Now get out.”

“Yes, my lord.” The foot soldier quickly gets to his feet and rushes back out of the room.

“Release the draw now that our final our final competitor is here.” Prime orders, sitting back in his chair and tensing his fingers, a sick smile on his lips, “Welcome to the tournament, Catra. I look forward to seeing your blood splashed around the arena.”

Chapter End Notes

The black box reminds me of the 'boo box' from the movie Hook.

Finally! The tournament is about to begin!!!

Thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing!
You'll have to forgive me if my fics gets a little muddled up, it tends to happen when I have multiple fics running concurrently...

Opening Ceremonies

Chapter Notes

It's a longer chapter...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“How’s the leg, princess?” Catra asks as she helps the blonde settle onto the queen bed in the room, “Did you need to ice it more?”

“No more ice.” Adora replies as she winces while she repositions her leg, “I think the swelling is going down though.”

“That’s good.” The magicat says as she goes to sit on the single bed next to Adora’s, “What’s the plan for tomorrow?”

“The tournament starts tomorrow.” Adora says, looking up in thought to remember the proceedings and then gestures for her phone, the magicat quickly retrieving it for the blonde, “Thank you.”

“So? Who do I fight?” Catra asks as she sits back down on the single bed again.

Adora looks up from her phone to see Catra sitting on the edge of the other bed and frowns over, “You can sit here on the bed with me, you know?”

“I can.” Catra replies flatly and unmoving.

“Catra!” Adora whines, “Get your ass on this bed so you can see as well.”

“Ugh, fine.” The magicat dramatically huffs and gets up and then shuffles herself onto Adora’s bed, right up next to the blonde’s shoulder, “Okay, happy?”

“Much.” Adora nods and then holds her phone so the both of them can see, “Okay, so this is the schedule.”

“Opening ceremony?” The magicat’s ears perk up, “What the hell is this? Why the fuck is there an opening ceremony?”

The blonde giggles at the magicat’s lack of knowledge in these types of events, “I forget that you’re not from this world…”

“You say that like I’m not from this planet, princess.” Catra rolls her eyes as she scrolls down on the blonde’s phone, “I’ve never had the privilege for such things, like sports… or hobbies.”

Adora puts the phone down much to Catra’s surprise, as the magicat looks for an answer, all she sees is the soft look on Adora’s face, “Oh, Cat…”

“It’s fine, Adora.” Catra brushes off, “I’m not angry or whatever because I didn’t get to live a life of wants and needs.”

“But…”

“No, don’t.” Catra stops the blonde, “I’m at peace with my life. Well, however long I have left of it…”

“You’re not going to die in this tournament.” Adora reassures, “I’m not going to let that happen.”

“You’re not going to let that happen, huh?” The magicat repeats somewhat amused, “And how exactly are you going to do that? Limp over and defend me?”

“I am the best fighter here.” Adora pouts as she crosses her arms over her chest, “If it wasn’t for that horse hurting my leg…”

“Then you’d be in my position and screwed too.” Catra shakes her head, “Honestly, I’m glad that horse took you out. I shudder to think of you acting all righteous and taking on the black box.”

“I could handle it.” Adora huffs out, “And then you wouldn’t be in this mess.”

Catra huffs out a laugh, “That’s cute, princess. Real cute.”

“I’m not being cute.” Adora pouts out again, “If anyone here is cute, it’d be you. I mean… those ears…”

At the mention of the magicat’s ears, Catra’s ears twitch and the blonde coos out, “Oh, shut up. I am not cute…”

“Yes. You really are.” Adora giggles at how bashful the magicat is being, “See! So cute I could kiss you!”

“Then why don’t you?” Catra tilts her head and the blonde instantly stops giggling, turning her head as a red blush covers her cheeks, “What? I’m not kissable to you?”

“I didn’t say that.” Adora refutes looking anywhere but at Catra, “I just…”

“You just… what?” Catra grins.

“Ugh… you’re so…” Adora groans out and as she finally turns her head back to face Catra, her breath hitches at how closer the magicat’s face is from hers, not realising that Catra’s leaned in closer, “W-what…”

Catra continues to hover closer to Adora’s lips, her eyes flitting between the blonde’s eyes and lips, “I’m so… what, Adora?”

“So, fucking cute.” Adora breathes out before closing the gap and pulling the magicat in close by the shirt front. The blonde hums happily into the unexpected kiss, feeling a smile come across Catra’s lips as she breaks off the kiss and leans her forehead against the magicat’s, “Fuck…”

“Yeah.” Catra whispers back into Adora’s lips, “And here I thought I had to win a round to get a kiss.”

“That wasn’t a real kiss…” Adora tries to rationalize.

“Oh, no?”

The blonde shakes her head, a smile on her face, “No. That…” the blonde takes a breath in and out and then says, “That was a preview.”

“Mm… that was… quite a preview, princess.” Catra licks her lips and grins, “Quite the motivation…”

“Well, I hope it’ll be enough…” Adora bites her bottom lip.

“Well, the promise of sex is more than enough motivation for me to win this stupid thing.” Catra says with an air of amusement before she drops her voice, “I definitely do not have any plans to lose. That’s for sure.”

The blonde leans in again, the magicat grinning at the possibility of getting another kiss tonight, except Adora stops just before their lips meet, the blonde tilts her head slightly, her eyes hooded as she says, “You’re so bad…” before pushing the magicat back and chuckling, “Stop trying to steal more kisses!”

Catra laughs as she quickly rights herself, “I can’t help it. I have to steal kisses… it sort of goes with my thieving job description.” The magicat grins at the statement and then adds, “Hopefully one day, I’ll also steal your heart…”

“Stars…” Adora rolls her eyes, “Does that line work on anyone?”

The magicat shrugs, “I’ve never tried that one before.”

“Huh.” Adora nods before clearing her throat and picking her phone back up again, “Okay, back to the schedule, yeah?”

“Sure.” Catra replies as she gets back to her original spot shoulder to shoulder with Adora, “How many rounds are there?”

“Six.” Adora replies as she scrolls back up again on her phone, “But the opening ceremony is first thing tomorrow morning. You’re going to need to get some proper clothes to fight in.”

“What’s wrong with what I’m wearing now?” Catra gestures down to herself, “Oh, maybe I should have gotten changed first…”

“You don’t even have a change of clothes, remember?” Adora says.

“Oh, yeah… right.” Catra rubs the back of her neck, “I don’t think there’s anything open right now though to get, well, any clothes.”

“Hold on.” The blonde holds the phone closer to herself and starts tapping on it, and then looks over at Catra, “What size are you?”

Catra tilts her head in question, “No idea. I’ve never had much of a choice in clothes.”

“That’s…” Adora starts to say when she sees the magicat’s ears droop down looking embarrassed at the admission, “Well, that’s going to change now that you’re with me.”

“I’m not with you.” Catra replies with a chuckle, “You’re with me.”

“Nope. You’re with me.” Adora turns it back around once more.

“We can do this all night.” Catra laughs out, “Whatever, you and your friends are tagging along with me.”

“Whatever.” Adora brushes the conversation off, “It doesn’t matter who’s with who or who is following who. What matters is that I’m going make sure that you are going to get clothes that fit and are comfortable to fight in.”

“Great. As long as I’m not fighting in those skintight wrestling outfits, we should do just fine.” Catra says and then thinks about

Adora in said outfit, “Hm… what do you wear when you compete? Is it skintight?”

“No. Why would I…? You know what, forget it.” Adora shakes her head, “And get that image out of your head! Besides I usually wear a white gi with gold accents. With my black belt of course.”

“Of course.” Catra repeats seeing the smug look on Adora’s face, “I bet you look hot in it.”

“Stars…” Adora shoves the magicat, “Do you even know what I’m talking about? Or what a gi is?”

“Some kind of uniform I’m assuming.” The magicat watches as Adora pulls up a photo of herself in her uniform and holding a massive trophy, “Geez, that looks heavy.”

“That’s what you got from the photo?” Adora replies surprised.

“Oh, well, you look really sweaty and gross too.” Catra says nonchalantly before breaking out in a grin, “Is that how you look after you… ow!”

“Quit thinking about sex, Catra.” Adora punches the magicat on the shoulder, “Focus. This is important.”

“Okay, okay.” Catra rubs her arm, “If I lose in the first round, it’ll be your fault for injuring me.”

The blonde rolls her eyes again, “If you lose, it’ll be because you weren’t ready.”

“Okay, master Adora.” Catra mocks, “Teach me the way of the white and gold gi.”

“You’re such an ass.” The blonde laughs, this time bumping Catra’s shoulder, “But seriously, do you want a gi to compete in or something else?”

“Can I just wear like shorts and a shirt?” Catra replies, “Your *gi* looks… flappy.”

“Flappy?” Adora makes a face or confusion.

“You know…” Catra moves her arms like she’s trying to fly, “Flappy. Like it’ll take me off into flight if there’s a gust of wind.”

Adora isn’t sure what to say to that, “I literally have no words…”

“I just feel like I’m going to be too easy to grab wearing one of those.” Catra points out, “Too much… flapping about, you know?”

“I’ve never had that problem before.” Adora says still a little unconvinced.

“Well, your fights have been fair and regulated.” Catra points out, “This ‘tournament’ is anything but fair and I doubt the referee or whoever is going to step in if someone *hits below the belt.”*

“Hm… well, what kind of shorts and shirt were you thinking?” Adora asks.

“I’m pretty sure I’ll be able to steal something.” Catra replies with a grin, “I’ll duck out at some point when you fall asleep.”

“No. No stealing.” Adora sighs, “What time is it?”

“Check your phone.” Catra says pointing to the blonde’s phone and then leans over to see, “It’s 7pm.”

“Oh, the shop is still open.” Adora says, “Help me up?”

“Why?”

“Just help me up, Catra.” Adora holds her hand out for the magicat, “We’ve got about an hour before the fight shop shuts.”

“Oh, right.” Catra quickly gets to her feet and helps Adora up, “I don’t have money though…”

“Don’t worry about it.” Adora waves off Catra’s concerns, “I’ll take care of it. It’s the least I can do to help you win.”

“You say it like it’s a sure thing, princess.” Catra drawls unconfidently, “I’m totally going to get my ass kicked and possibly get killed…”

“You’re not. You’re going to do well.” Adora declares with enough confidence for the pair of them, “And my gut tells me… you’re going to win.”

Catra laughs, “Yeah, sure, princess.” The magicat shakes her head, “I really doubt that.”

“Well, I don’t.” Adora says seriously, “I’ve seen you fight. And you are a fighter Catra. You’re incredible and amazing and brave and…”

“Okay!” Catra’s face heats up with all those compliments, “Can we go, please?”

Adora smirks at making Catra fluster, “So… that’s all it takes, huh?”

“I don’t know what you’re talking about.” Catra looks away but her tail flicks around giving her away, before she grabs the appendage and growls out, “Go, now?”

“Sure.” Adora lets the magicat off the hook, “We’ll grab Glimmer and Bow to come too.”

“So, see anything you like?” Adora asks as she leans on Bow for support, “They’ve got like muay thai stuff. Boxing gear.” The blonde holds up a pair of bike shorts, “I have no idea what sport this is for.”

The magicat grabs a pair of cargo shorts and a plain tshirt to go along with it, the trio in the shop with her don’t dare point out

that they are the cheapest items in the shop, Catra grins, "I think I've found what I'm going to compete in. Just need to alter the shorts for my tail and we should be good."

"Are you sure that's what you want?" Glimmer asks, "Those shorts don't even look like fighting shorts. Are you even allowed to compete in those shorts? There's like way too many pockets."

"Competitors are allowed to wear whatever they want." Bow says, "There's no specific dress code of this tournament due to the fact that it's not just one discipline."

"Huh." Catra says, "I'm just not allowed to use my claws though."

"Actually… I think you can in this medium." Bow rubs his chin in thought, "Though, they may consider them as weapons and…" he grimaces before he continues, "they might… uh, declaw you…"

The look of shock and horror on Catra's face as Adora quickly intervening, "Just, uh, don't use them and you'll be fine."

"That's not very reassuring." Catra replies shaking her head, "Are they also going to rip out my teeth too if I use them as well?"

"Let's… uh, we'll cross that bridge when we come to it…" Adora sighs out, "So… are you sure about those shorts?"

"They're flexible and stretchy. That's all I care about." The magicat shows the trio by tugging the garment and then grinning, "And the shirt… well, I can always rip the sleeves off if it gets annoying. But yeah, I reckon I can fight in them."

"Great. Let's go pay for them." Adora declares happily.

"Oh, you don't have to…" Catra meekly says, "I can…"

"No." Adora shuts the magicat down, "No stealing. I'm buying them for you. No arguments."

“Fine.” The magicat rolls her eyes and hands the clothes to Glimmer to bring to the counter while Catra gets on the other side of Adora so Bow can go pay with Adora’s wallet, “So, what time is the opening ceremony? And do I need to dress up for that too?”

“All competitors need to be in the main arena by 9am. The ceremony will start at 930am and then the first round commences at 11am.” Bow answers matter of factly, “And you can just wear Adora’s gi over your clothes for the opening ceremony.”

“Huh.” Catra says, smirking at the blonde, “You want me to wear your clothes?”

Adora shrugs, “Well, you are representing me. So, it’s fitting.”

“Fair.” Catra replies as Glimmer holds out the magicat’s newly purchased clothes to her, “Thanks.”

Adora grins, “Plus I think you’d look really cute in my gi.”

“Yes!” Bow agrees readily, “So cute!”

“Stars…” Glimmer rolls her eyes at the pair and for once, Catra is glad the sparkly woman agrees with her before turning to the magicat, “Adora’s gi is totally going to swamp you. You’ll be like a toddler wearing their parent’s suit.”

“Oh, that would be totally cute!” Bow coos out at the thought, “Remind me to get lots of photos of the opening ceremony.”

“You’ll need to film her matches anyways so we can review them after and see what needs to be improved on.” Adora says matter of factly and then turns to Catra with a serious look on her face, “You’ll be able to see if there are any areas that are lacking.”

“Did you see your first opponent?” Glimmer asks as they get back on track.

“No…?” Catra says, “Am I supposed to see them before the thingy starts?”

“W-what? No. That’s not what I meant.” Glimmer pinches her brow and shakes her head, “I meant… never mind. Bow?”

“Don’t worry, Catra!” He beams, “I’ll help you prepare for your first round. Me and Adora will coach you!”

“Great…” The magicat looks between the pair and then looks to Glimmer who’s actively avoiding eye contact, “I’m so dead, aren’t I, Sparkles?”

Glimmer just looks back, staying silent with no response apart from a purse of her lips.

“Hey! We are great coaches!” Adora pouts.

“Yeah! We are!” Bow joins in.

“Just because you can fight, doesn’t mean you can coach.” Catra says flatly, “But… look, I’m happy for whatever pointers you can give me.”

“I’ll give you so many pointers you won’t know where I’m pointing!” Adora declares with a grin on her face, “Wait… that didn’t… whatever! My point still stands!”

“Pun away…” Catra mumbles under her breath, “Okay, so 9am then, right?”

“Yes.” Bow nods, “We’ll go grab breakfast in the morning before it starts before these things usually take a long time.”

“Do I even have to be there?” Catra asks.

“Yes.” Adora answers simply and then addresses the group, “So, meet at my… um, I mean, our room at 7am?”

“7am?” Catra repeats with a groan, “I’ll just skip breakfast. I fight better on an empty stomach anyway.”

“Nah uh.” Adora shakes her head, “You’re going to have breakfast because you probably won’t be able to eat once the event gets going.”

“Okay, whatever. See you guys at 7am.” Catra concedes holding out her new clothes to the blonde, “Hold please.”

“Why-oh! Catra! Put me down! I can walk, you know?” Adora shrieks as the magicat picks her up into a bridle carry, “Uh… you’re not going to put me down, are you?”

“Nope.” Catra grins back, “If I have to up and ready for 7am, I’m going to get us back to our room as soon as possible so I can get some shut eye.”

“Oh, that’s a great idea!” Bow nods in agreement to Glimmer who just rolls her eyes at the display in front of her, “We better go and rest up too! Big day tomorrow! See you guys at 7am!”

“It’s too fucking early.” Catra grumbles as Adora’s alarm goes off, the magicat reaching over and glancing at the time before handing the still ringing device to Adora, “Why is your alarm for 5am?!”

“Sorry.” Adora turns off the annoying sound coming from her phone, “It’s a habit. I usually like to get up early before my first fight.”

“You’re not fighting, princess… My fight isn’t even until midday.” Catra rolls onto her back, eyes still closed, “Can we go back to sleep?”

“Yeah.” Adora breathes out as she taps on her phone, “But just another half hour.”

“No.”

“Yes.”

“No, Adora.” Catra turns over to look at the blonde, “I’m not getting up until 645am. I only need 15mins to get ready to eat breakfast.”

“But I need help.” Adora pouts, “I need to have a shower, get dressed and then brush my teeth.”

“And how long will that all take?” Catra enquired as she shuts her eyes once more still facing Adora.

“Maybe an hour?”

“An hour?!” Catra eyes open wide, “When you say shower… do you actually mean bath?”

“I have a routine, Catra!” Adora whines out, “I don’t like not sticking to my routine especially on fight days.”

“But you’re not fighting, princess. I am.” Catra grumbles, pointing out that face once again as she shuts her eyes again, “You’re only a spectator.”

“I’m your coach.” Adora pouts out again, “And as your coach, I have a responsibility to you.”

“You’ll do great as my coach, princess.” Catra yawns, “Let me sleep another 2 hours and you’ll do great…”

“Half an hour.” Adora says and Catra just grunts in response, the blonde taking that as a win, “Do you want me to set up another alarm… just in case?”

Catra grunts again, turning over and burying her head under her pillow.

Adora laughs, “I’ll set another alarm. Just in case.”

“Okay, so after the opening ceremony, we need have a little time before your first match against Castiel.”

“Castiel? Sounds like some kind of angel.” Catra replies as she sits back and sips on her black coffee, savouring the drink that she hasn’t had for a while now, “Does this *Castiel* have powers? Wings? Wrath of God?”

“Stars… no.” Adora laughs before remembering, “Oh, hang on… yeah, he’s got wings.”

“Have you fought this dude before?” Catra asks as she watches Adora roll up her pancake and take a bite, “Have you fought anyone in this tournament before?”

“Yeah, there’s a few familiar names in there.” Adora says covering her mouth as she chews, “But they are all fighting random competitors that I’ve never heard of in the first round.”
“Sounds like it’s rigged.” Catra shrugs as she takes another sip, “Is this Castiel a good guy or a bad guy? I’m assuming you’ve beaten him since you know him.”

“Of him.” Adora corrects, “He never fought me.”

“It’s true.” Bow chimes in, “They’ve never been in the same division.”

“And… what division is that?” Catra asks.

“There’s a magic division and a non-magic division.” Bow starts to explain, “Adora doesn’t have magic… as far as we know…”

“I’m a magicat. I don’t have powers.” Catra says, “Am I even in the right division?”

“This… this isn’t a normal tournament, Catra.” Glimmer points out, “You know it’s not. It’s definitely rigged.”

“Glimmer! You can’t say that!” Bow chastises.

“But… she literally said it not so long ago.” Glimmer brings up whilst pointing at Catra, “How is that any different?”

Bow turns to Catra, “You can’t say that either.”

“Uh, why not?” Catra asks putting her cup down and scratching her head and looking at Bow dumbfounded, “This whole thing is stupid anyways. How is this even fair that I’m fighting some flight of fancy schmancy angel guy?”

“You actually got lucky in your first round.” Glimmer says with elaborating, “The other fighters we know have random opponents.”

“Why is that a bad thing?” Catra asks unconvinced that’s she’s lucky.

“It’s harder to prepare against a rando than someone that you know.” Glimmer replies matter of factly, “Randoms means you have no idea what to expect.”

“Well, yeah. That’s a given.” Catra states like Glimmer should know, “Besides, the real fighters should be good enough to beat whoever, right?”

“Not if they aren’t fighting fair.” Glimmer argues, “And it’s not fair if the regulation fighters are all well known.”

“Yeah, well, sucks to be them then.” Catra shrugs, “Gives me a chance if I have to come against them.”

“Speaking of opponents…” Bow cuts in before Glimmer can get another word in, “You’ve got a slight advantage too.”

“Yeah, and a disadvantage since I can’t use my claws.” Catra points out.

“Actually, we’ll see about that.” Adora says, “It’s a good thing you aren’t scheduled first right after the opening ceremony. Gives us a chance to see what other fighters can get away with it.”

“So… what should I expect against this Cas, guy?” Catra asks quirking an eyebrow up at the Adora.

“Cas only really goes one round and one round only.” Bow answer instead.

“Which means…?” Catra waves her hand in the air for someone to continue.

“If you can prove you can go the distance with him, he’ll generally throw the second round.” Glimmer replies, “But it won’t be obvious… obviously.”

“Huh?”

“Just… trust us.” Adora gives the magicat a soft smile, “He’ll be looking to see whether or not you are worthy to beat him or not.”

“That’s… stupid.” Catra shakes her head, “So, he’s going to throw the fight if I win the first round.”

“Not exactly.” Adora hums out loud, “You still have to work to beat him.”

“Basically it means he’ll give you an opening and you better take it.” Glimmer surmises, “And if you don’t… well… you better get ready for third round.”

“And… how am I supposed to know what this… opening even is?” Catra asks with a frown, “You do realise I’m not a professional fighter or anything of that kind, right? I’ve only fought when my life depended on it. And that includes against Barbie even if it didn’t seem like it.”

“Well, your life does depend on it.” Glimmer scoffs out, “And ours too.”

“What?” Adora whips her head to her friends, “It is?”

“Stars…” Glimmer shakes her head.

“Glim… she doesn’t know.” Bow scolds lightly and then sheepishly pulls out a note from his pocket and holds it out to Adora “Here. We didn’t want to worry you, but, you should know.”

“What…?” Adora takes the note and opens it, reading it and then looking back up at her friends, “When, when did you get this?”

“We found it this morning. It was slipped under our room door.” Bow replies as he grabs Gimmer’s hand and squeezes it.

“Well? What does the note say? Who’s it from?” Catra peeks up, trying to look over at the note in Adora’s hand, her head tilting as she realises something, “It’s from Prime, isn’t it?” The magicat sighs, “He wants my head, doesn’t he?”

“Not in those words… but yes.” Glimmer replies sadly before she gets a determined look on her face, “But we are not going to let that happen.”

“No. We aren’t!” Bow stands up defiantly, “The Best Friends Squad will do everything in our power to make sure that he doesn’t get you!”

Catra looks at the pair and then at Adora, “Can I see the note?”

The blonde looks up and sighs, holding the note out to Catra and just as the magicat takes the slip of paper, Adora says, “I’m not going to let anything happen to you either.”

“I know.” Catra smiles back at the blonde genuinely, “I know.”

“I don’t know what I’d do if something happened to you.” Adora sadly adds, “Not after everything we’ve already been through.”

“I know.” Catra repeats as she nods and then proceeds to read the note, her brows furrowing, “This is a threat. Against you and them.”

Adora nods, “I know.”

The magicat growls out angrily, “I can’t let him do this to you or them.”

“Cat… what are you…?” Adora tries to stand up when the magicat gets to her feet abruptly, “Don’t. You can’t just give in!”

“I’m not giving in. I’m going to take him out, once and for all.” Catra declares with another growl, “Then maybe this won’t be a murder arena.”

“Ahem.” Someone clears their throat from behind them and Glimmer instantly frowns at them, “It seems like that was a threat.”

Catra doesn’t need to turn around to know that smug voice, “It was a threat.” The magicat steps out in front of the group, “And what are you going to do about it?”

CLICK! CLICK! CLICK! CLICK! CLICK!

“You’re going to shoot me?” Catra looks around at his henchmen with guns all pointing at her and then starts to laugh, “Go ahead. Shoot me. Then who’s going to steal the prize for you?”

Prime chuckles evilly, “I’m not getting my hands dirty, not on you.” He sneers at Catra, “Besides, if I wanted you dead, you already would be.”

“Doubtful. Really doubtful.” Catra retorts trying to stare him down despite the height difference, “You need me, Primey.”

“I don’t need anyone.” Prime responds, lifting his chin up egotistically, “Least of all. You.”

“Sure.” Catra goads, “If that’s the case, then go on. Kill me. Put me out of my misery.”

“Catra… can you stop goading him!” Glimmer whisper shouts to the magicat.

Prime chuckles once more, “Kill you? Ha! And why would I do that?”

Catra looks around at all the guns pointing towards her, “Then why bring all your boyfriends? You should know well enough, I don’t play with the boys.”

“Oh, I know that very well… seeing how you stole most of the sisters I had…” Prime gripes, “You corrupted them. All of them.”

“Well, as you love to say so much… I made them see the light.” Catra throws back at him with a smirk, “What’s the matter, Prime? Sad that they saw through all that darkness?”

He growls out, breaking his resolve for a moment before recomposing himself, “Hm… I think when you are finally defeated, beaten to a pulp and barely breathing, I will take your friends and force them to see my light. Serve me and my… men.”

Catra unsheathes her claws and rushes towards Prime, Adora quickly pulling her back, “No!”

“Yes, listen to your lover and soon to be my plaything.” Prime taunts as he signals for his goons to lower their weapons, a smirk firmly on his face as he looks over Adora and her friends, “You three will be quite the prizes. Such… pretty little things.”

“When I win this tournament, I’ll be coming after you.” Catra threatens, “And you won’t have anyone to hide behind.”

“Do I look like I’m hiding?” Prime asks mockingly, “I stand at the front. I am their Lord.”

“Then why aren’t you in the fight?” Catra asks, “If you really stood at the front, you wouldn’t need someone to fight for you, would you? You’re nothing but a coward.”

The statement makes Prime snarl out, his hands curling into fists, "Call me that again. I dare you."

"What?" Catra feigns innocence before she grins, "Oh, you mean… coward?"

Prime throws his arm, taking a swing at the magicat who easily dodges it and pushes him back and then someone shouts out loudly, "Hey! No fighting! Save it for the tournament!" the official comes storming over before realising who he's talking to, "Uh, sir…"

"Lord." Prime corrects.

The middle aged and balding man clears his throat, trying to get his tact back, "Mr Prime, please no fighting in the mess hall. You can be removed from this tournament if it happens again…"

Prime grins at the man, teeth and all as he stands over him intimidatingly for a moment before straightening back up and shrugging and then turns to Catra, "If you make it to the finals and win, then I will deem you worthy of stealing the prize here."

"I'm not stealing for you." Catra spits back.

"Oh, but you will want to." Prime replies looking at the magicat with a smirk, "Because, you'll be stealing my title and trust me, that is something worth stealing."

"Lord Prime. It's time." One of his hench men whispers from behind him with a shaky voice, "We need to get to the opening ceremony."
Prime nods and then with faux politeness, he addresses the group, "Well, I hope you enjoy your time at this tournament, no matter how short it may be."

"Fuck you." Catra replies flatly.

"See you at the opening ceremony." Prime says as he signals for his group to go, "Oh, and Catra?"

“What?” the magicat says narrowing her eyes at him.

“Break a leg.” He replies with a sick grin, “Or maybe two.”

“Fuck off.” Catra hisses out as she watches Prime and his people walk out.

“What a jerk.” Glimmer huffs out as she moves to stand next to Catra, glaring at the back of Prime, “Come on, we need to get ready for the opening ceremony.”

“Why would you need to steal the prize if you win it?” Bow asks scratching his head.

“No idea.” Catra replies as she props herself under Adora’s arm to provide support, “Guess we better do like Sparkles said and get ready for the opening ceremony.”

“That was way too long.” Catra grumbles when the opening ceremony processions finally conclude, “I feel more tired than before when I woke up. Do I need to hang around here until my fight?”

“You don’t want to see the other fights?” Adora asks.

“Nah, it’s really not my thing.” Catra replies as she blinks her eyes slowly trying not to fall asleep, “Besides, it’s going to be a long while before my match if they are literally only using just the one floor.”

“Not necessarily.” Bow speaks up, “I heard from around the arena that the fights can go from a few seconds to half an hour. There’s no time limit. Or breaks…”

“It’s still points based, right?” Adora asks furrowing her brows.

“Uh… no.” Bow sheepishly replies and chuckles awkwardly, “From what I heard, there’s no tapping out.”

“Which means?” Catra asks as the first fight gets underway and Bow doesn’t get a chance to explain.

First round! Representing Horde, Rachet! Versus Quaid, representing Eadine!

The fighters both enter the ring, facing the 3 judges, the judge in the middle nods and the fighters turn to face each other before the sound of a gong is heard and the fight has well and truly started.

Quaid goes on the offensive, the man is shorter but muscly as he uses his speed to throw a few quick punches and try to get some kicks into the much taller and even more muscular Rachet. The Horde representative is caught off guard momentarily, his opponent managing to land a few punches to his sides and his gut. But once he’s got his bearing back, manages to grab Quaid’s leg mid kick and elbows down hard into the middle of the smaller man’s leg, the sound of a loud crack and subsequent scream from the Eadine representative has the crowds cheering even louder as Rachet throws the other man down.

Quaid lands hard on the floor of the ring in a heap, his leg bent out of shape from the break as he tries to assess the injury, but it’s short lived when Rachet body slams him further into the floor and then lands the a harsh blow with a deft elbow to the smaller man’s neck and then finally finishing off his opponent with a one, two punch against his head.

Rachet stands up from Quaid’s now lifeless body, stepping back and grinning over at Prime who simply nods back as they wait for the result.

The gong sounds once more to signal the end of the fight as Quaid’s body is dragged off the floor, a medic does a quick observation of the man before shaking his head.

The crowd of Horde supporters cheer loudly, whilst the rest of the audience turn their backs.

Catra watches as the Eadine team pick up their fallen comrade and take him out of the arena. Once Quaid and his team have exited, the gong sounds again to signal the next fight.

"That… yeah, I'm so dead." Catra says once the next fight starts, she feels herself starting to sweat more and the anxiety begins to take over and then repeats, "I'm so going to die today…"

"No, you're not." Adora quickly grabs the magicat's shaking hands, "You're first round is against Castiel. He won't kill you."

"Didn't you hear, Arrows? There's no tapping out!" Catra's voice getting more anxious, "And I don't want to kill anyone either!"

"You don't have to kill anyone." Adora calmly says, "Just, knock them out."

"Yeah, because that's so easy…" Catra swallows down hard.

"Look." Adora turns her head over to the fight currently happening, "They all have flaws, weaknesses. Most of them aren't going in for the kill."

"Except the Horde, you mean. Prime's Horde." Catra scoffs out as she watches the fight a little more intently and winces when one of the cops a punch to the face, "There's no way I'm going to survive six rounds let alone one…"

Adora squeezes Catra's hands, "Apart from the Horde… no one else is planning to kill to get to the next round… I think..."

"That's really not reassuring." Catra says as she throws her head back and groans, drawing a few stares from around them.

“You’ll be fine. Trust me.” Adora smiles softly, ignoring the other people watching them, “I believe in you.”

“Yeah, me too!” Bow adds with a thumbs up and a beaming smile.

“Yeah, you’ll be fine, Cat. Just believe in yourself and stop being such a whinger.” Glimmer rolls her eyes, “And if you need to fuck someone up, just do it. By the looks of things, you can pretty much get away with anything if that goatman gets to use his horns.”

The gong sounds, signalling the end of the fight when the goatman’s opponent, an athletic looking tanned man lies unconscious on the floor, but he’s still breathing as the goatman puts his arms up in victory. The defeated man’s team quickly rush onto the floor to collect their teammate as the ring is cleared and quickly mopped before the next match.

“See!” Glimmer points out happily, “That guy just got knocked out! He is definitely not dead. I saw him breathing!”

“Uh huh…” Catra just stares at Glimmer confused.

“They didn’t die!” She states repeats pointing to the now emptied ring.

“Right…” Catra groans out.

“Oh, shit!” Bow looks at his schedule, “You’re going to be on in another few rounds!”

“Great…” Catra groans out, “Should I be warming up or something?” she looks around at the other competitors, “Because no one seems to be…”

“Do you need to warm up?” Glimmer asks.

“I guess not.” Catra sighs as she feels Adora squeeze her hands once more.

“Representing Haven, Castiel. Versus Catra representing Bright Moon!”

“Okay, go get them!” Glimmer punches the magicat on the shoulder in encouragement, “Just remember what I told you.”

The magicat rolls her eyes as Adora pulls her into a hug, “You’ll be fine.”

“Thanks…” Catra sighs out as she stands up once Adora releases her from the hug and takes a deep breath, “Well, it’s been nice knowing you…”

“You’ll be fine.” Adora gets to her feet with Bow’s help, placing both hands on Catra’s shoulders, “And when this is all over… I’ll…”

Catra smiles back, cutting the blonde off and pressing a chaste kiss on Adora's cheek, “When this is all over, I’m going to take you on a date, princess.”

Adora grins back, a hopeful lilt in her eyes, “And I expect it to be the best date I’ve ever been on.”

Catra laughs as she walks backwards towards the fighting ring, “You got it, princess!”

The blonde smiles back even wider and Glimmer and Bow help her get to the side of the ring, Bow whispers to the Adora, “She’ll be fine.”

“I hope so.” Adora nods back as the gong sounds once both Castiel and Catra are in the ring.

Chapter End Notes

I know I've been MIA... I've been busy and literally just finished a 12 day stint of work days in row.
Funny story... I kind of... accidentally ran over my line trimmer/whipper snipper with my ute in my haste to get to another site... oops...
lucky my boss didn't kick up a stink and found the funny side to it...
It's a mangled mess...

I've upped the chapter count so I can get the fighting rounds in as one more chapter seems too short for all the things I want to write...

Oh, I've got a social! Kinda...
Check me out on tumbler @masternoveller
I've posted a couple of happy snaps from my latest work trip...
And I'll post up a pic of my mangled whipper snipper as well at some point... haha

First Round

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Get up, Catra!” Glimmer shouts from the sidelines as the magicat is caught off guard by a stray wing and then the resulting punch to the face, “Get up!”

“Come on, Catra!” Bow joins in, his fist up in the air as he screams out in encouragement, “You can do it!”

“Shake it off! Go Catra!” Adora struggles to her feet as she shouts out both in encouragement and concern, “Watch out for his wings!”

“Duh…” Catra grumbles to herself as she shakes off the punch and gets back to her feet as quick as she can before dodging a barrage of punches from her opponent, “Fucking hell…”

“Surrender!” Castiel demands as he flies around, circling the magicat, “Surrender now and I will not have to kill you!”

“Surrender is not an option, dipshit! There is no surrender here!” Catra shouts back as she watches him fly around her, turning in time to keep him in front of her, “Get your ass back down here and fight fair!”

“There is no fair fight.” Castiel replies as he flutters himself in front of Catra, crossing his arms over his bare chest, the muscles on display rippling, his veins on show as he shakes his head, “There is no such thing as a fair fight.”

“Oh, well, in that case…” Catra shrugs back and then leaps up and brings Castiel down, her claws burying into her opponent’s back as she flips herself over him and wraps and arm around his throat, “Bring us down, flyboy!”

"No." Castiel grunts out as Catra tightens her hold around his neck.

"Don't make me kill you!" Catra growls into the side of Castiel's head, "Because I will. I will!"

Castiel shakes his head, before flying around the arena haphazardly, doing his best to shake the magicat off his back, but her elbow wrapped around his neck makes it harder to do so as his oxygen supply starts to dwindle, "Get off!" He manages to grit out as he continues to fly around dangerously before he gets an idea and speeds off and up towards the ceiling and then…

CRASH!

"Catra!" Adora shouts out when Castiel slams her into the ceiling, the force making the roof crackle, dust and debris falling onto the floor below as there's a nervous energy around the arena as Castiel does it again and again and again.

CRASH! CRASH! CRASH!

"Catra!" Adora shouts out once again, shielding her eyes from the falling dust and ceiling pieces, "Catra!"

"Look out!" Bow shouts as a wooden beam falls from the rooftop, he quickly gathers up Adora in his arms as Glimmer leads them out of the arena before the whole roof caves in.

"Oof! Ow!" Adora winces when she's put down on the floor outside as Bow and Glimmer turn back towards the arena, the entire building starting to collapse in on itself as the blonde grips

onto Glimmer and Bow, trying to get back to her feet, stumbling forward, "Fuck!"

"Woah!" Bow gently sits her back down again, "You're going to hurt yourself."

"Catra's in there!" Adora shouts out, "She's in there!"

"I know!" Glimmer pulls her back down, "You can't go in there! You're going to get hurt!"

"But! But!" Adora pleads helplessly with her friends, "She could be hurt!"

The trio watch as everyone else makes their way out of arena before it completely collapses, they all stand gathered a distance away from the venue, coughing and shouting in anger at the impromptu exit until…

BOOM! CRASH!

Silence befalls the land as the entire arena building collapses completely, a large grey dust cloud mushrooming up and then spread out when it finally comes to ground. Everyone moves back and out of the dust, covering their faces with there shirts or sleeves.

Eyes all on the fallen structure, smoke and fire starting to take over from the grey smoke turning it black and then…

"Over there!" Adora shouts out, pointing to the silhouette of Castiel flying up and out of the ruins and into the sun's glare, "Up there! It's Castiel!"

Everyone looks up and sure enough, Castiel has flown up and out of the wreckage, his wings on fire as he flaps them trying to

steady out his flight. It works for a little bit until too many feathers burn off and makes his ability to fly go out of whack and then he begins to fall.

“Look out!” Glimmer shouts out as he starts to fall directly over them from quite a height, going down head first as he tries to take flight once more, but it’s to no use.

Everyone below gets out of the way as Castiel makes his descent to the ground at great speed and then…

THUD!

“Oof!” the familiar voice of the magicat fighter is heard in the small puff of dust when Castiel hits the ground, “Ow… that’s another life…”

“Catra!” Adora shouts out, limping over as fast as she can, dropping next to Castiel and pushing him over and off the magicat, “Catra! Stars! Are you okay?!”

“No.” Catra takes in a few deep and painful breaths, “I think I broke… everything.”

Adora chuckles wetly as she brings Catra in for a relieved kiss, “I thought I lost you…”

“You didn’t.” Catra sighs out after the kiss and then looks around at the crowd gathering, “Uh, princess?”

“Hm?” Adora says as she nuzzles into Catra’s neck.

“Uh, Adora?” Catra tries again, clearing her throat right after.

“What’s wrong? Am I hurting you?” Adora pushes herself off quickly and assessing the magicat, Catra just looks back with a

smirk on her lips as the blonde frowns, “What?”

“I don’t think my fight is finished yet.” Catra replies as she presses her lips on to Adora’s once more and then grunts, getting up to her feet to face Castiel who has also managed to get back to his feet and growls out to him, “Let’s finish this, flyboy.”

“Adora!” Bow quickly pulls Adora back up, bringing her back with him and Glimmer as the crowd forms a circle around Catra and Castiel.

Castiel wipes the blood off his face and then reaches back to find his wings are mostly gone, a low growl on his own lips as he turns to the magicat and nods, “Yes. Let’s finish this.”

Catra has barely anytime to move out of the way as he comes charging at her, bowling through the side of the crowd that’s formed a circle around them, and they come crashing back into the collapsed building.

Catra gets to her feet first, clutching at her chest as she looks around to see flames and debris all around her and then sees Castiel kneeled down on the ground, as if he’s catching his breath.

“Fuck. 2 lives in one day…” Catra grumbles out as she stumbles towards him, claws out and at the ready.

Without turning his head, Castiel simply says, “You are worthy.”

“What?” Catra frowns as she’s forced back when a bright white light erupts from where he’s knelt and she’s blinded temporarily before the light expands and throws her back and to the ground, “Oof!”

“Catra!” Adora shouts out, an arm slung over Glimmer’s shoulder as Bow rushes in behind her and goes over to the magicat laying on the ground, “Is she okay?!”

Bow puts a hand up so he can check her.

“Bow!” Adora shouts out as Adora tires to get closer, “Is she okay?!”

Bow turns back, “She is.”

Adora breathes on out in relief for the second time, “Glim, help me over there.”

Glimmer nods and moves them closer to the magicat, Adora dropping down to the ground once more next to the magicat and looks at her friend, “Is the fight over now?” the sparkly girl asks no one in particular as a gong sounds, signally the end of the fight.

“Looks like you made it though the first round, little sister.” Prime comes over with a smug look on his face, “Though, we’ll see how much longer you’ll last since you nearly died… twice.”

Adora glares at him as Catra’s eyes open, her ears twitching a little at the sound of Prime’s voice as she growls under her breath, despite not seeing being able to see him she manages to snark out, “At least I’m not a coward like you, I’m fighting and you’re just hiding behind your boyfriends.”

The look on his face quickly changes to rage as he rushes over and shoves Glimmer out of the way just so he can leer over the magicat, “Do not think you have won just yet.”

“I don’t need to think I’ve won.” Catra looks up at him with a smirk on her face, “Because as long as I’m alive, I am winning.”

“We’ll see for how long.” Prime threatens as someone behind him clears his throat, he turns around and sees a few burly officials behind him and rolls his eyes at them before looking back down at Catra, “You got lucky the first round. But your luck will run out in the next.” He backs up, shoving himself back and through the officials, “I’m done.”

“Yeah, you are.” Catra says and then chuckles despite the pain, “You’re done. And get the fuck out.”

“What happened to Castiel?” Glimmer asks once Catra is now set up in bed back in the room she shares with Adora, “He just… disappeared.”

“I have no idea, Sparkles.” Catra replies with a wince, “Can I get some medical attention or something?”

“That’s me!” Bow beams holding up the first aid kit and the magicat gives him an unimpressed look, “What? I’m qualified to perform first aid.”

“I’m sure you are.” Catra replies flatly, “Okay… I think, I think I’m broken.”

“Oh, uh…” Bow furrows his brows, looking down at her, “I… I’m not sure what to do with that…”

“Yeah, figured, medical boy.” Catra rolls her eyes, “Can I at least get some food? Water would be good. Actually, scratch the water. Get me some alcohol. That should numb the pain for a bit.”

“No. No alcohol.” Adora chastises, “It’s going to make things a lot worse if you get drunk.”

“Pretty sure there’s some kind of… drunken kung fu or something.” Catra thinks to herself, “I mean, it’s got to have come from somewhere, right?”

“It’s make believe drunk, Cat.” Adora scolds the magicat as she gets on the bed as well, “They aren’t really drunk. It’s like when they pretend to be animals as a technique.”

“Oh.” The magicat says, “There’s no magicat technique… and that sucks.”

“Guys, can we get Catra some food and water or sports drinks?” Adora asks her friends and then pulls her phone out, her friends nod and then quickly exit the room, “So, there’s 2 rounds tomorrow.”

“Are you serious?!” Catra sits up and then flops back down with a grunt of pain, “I barely got through one round!”

“There’s one in the morning and then one in the afternoon or night.” Adora says as she ignores the magicat’s concerns for a moment as she scrolls through her phone, “I don’t know this fighter. Must be another one of the fighters that took someone else’s place.”

Catra tries to look over, but Adora’s sitting up and she can’t get up close enough, “Who is it?”

“Uh, Flame.” Adora scrolls up and down her phone a few more times, furrowing her brow, “That’s it. Flame. That’s the name.”

“Oh, yeah. I know her.” Catra says off the cuff, “Piece of work, she is.”

“Oh. Well, I guess that’s a good thing.” Adora puts her phone down and lays down next to the magicat, “You’ll know how to fight her.”

“I’m going to get burnt more than I got burnt today.” Catra says with a sigh, “There’s a reason her name is Flame.”

“She shoots fire?” Adora asks turning onto her side to look at the magicat.

“Like Superman or Cyclops. It comes from her eyes and it’s more like lasers.” Catra replies, “She’s nearly killed me a few times already. And that’s before she even had the motivation to do it.”

“She’s from the Horde?” Catra nods.

“Yeah.” Catra says turning her head to look Adora in the eyes.

“Wait… how do you know her?” Adora asks.

“Uh… no reason.” Catra looks anywhere but into Adora’s eyes, “No reason at all…”

“Somehow that doesn’t sound true.” Adora grabs the magicat’s chin and makes her look back at her, “How do you know her?”

“I might of… got into her pants?” Catra sheepishly admits, “But that was before I knew she was Horde… and all…”

The unimpressed look has Catra shifting a little uncomfortably as Adora scoffs, “Of course you did.”

“It was a while ago, princess.” Catra says with a sigh, “I was… I was not in a good place.”

“Oh.” Adora says a little surprised, “I didn’t know.”

“My whole life before you was mostly not in a good place.” Catra adds with a sad smile on her face as she looks back up, “I hope Delia is okay. I hope Delia and the camp is okay.”

“Do you think the Horde have them?” Catra shrugs in answer to Adora’s question, “Is there anyway to find out?”

“Prime has them. That’s what that Trap’s chick said.” Catra says and then her ears perk up, “Hey, you reckon we can get her to check on them? See if they’re safe or nearby?”

“Uh…” Adora hums out and then pulls out her phone, “Hang on…”

Catra nods, closing her eyes while she waits and then…

“Hello?” Adora answers her phone, the magicat figures it was on silent, “How did you…? Oh, yeah, she’s right here. No. We didn’t… Entrapta…”

“What is she asking?” Catra chuckles knowingly.

“She’s just being… Entrapta.” Adora sighs, “Here, I’ll put her on speaker so you can hear her too.” She taps a few times on her phone and then says, “You’re on speaker.”

“Hello!” Entrapta’s voice booms through the speaker of Adora’s phone, “Congratulations on your first round victory, Catra!”

“Thanks, Traps.” Catra replies, “I wanted to ask you about…”

“Yes! They are fine!” Entrapta answers the question without even hearing it, “Delia and the rest of your family are fine! And also, very close!”

“How close?” Catra tries to sit up but hisses in pain and then flops back down again, “Ow…”

“You sound hurt.” Entrapta observes, “Hm… hold on.”

“Huh?” Catra looks to Adora confused as the blonde just shrugs in response.

“Hello!” Entrapta bursts through the door, making Adora jump up in surprise, “I’m here!”

“Stars! Entrapta!” Adora calms herself down while glaring at her friend, “What are you doing here?”

“You’re a magicat!” Entrapta says instead and then narrows her eyes at Catra, “And you appear to be injured… most likely internally!”

“And why do you sound so happy about that?” Catra replies, “Also, *you’re* Entrapta?”

“Yes, I am!” The purple haired woman nods in confirmation, “But… I thought I already introduced myself…”

“You did.” Adora confirms and then repeats, “What are you doing here?”

“I’m here to help, of course!” Entrapta walks over to the Catra’s side of the bed and pulls out a stethoscope, “I’ve been told I need to ask for consent before I start touching people.”

“Uh…” Catra looks over to Adora.

“Catra. Can I touch you?” Entrapta leans in close to Catra’s face as she asks the question, “It’s the only way I can assess you medically.”

“Oh, yeah, sure. Go nuts.” Catra replies with a slight nod, “Just… don’t stick anything in me.”

“Um… okay.” Entrapta replies with a raised eyebrow before shrugging it off, “Okay. Good! Now… just so you know, my hands might be slightly cold…”

“So, where did you say Prime is holding my friends, again?” Catra asks feeling a lot better after Entrapta’s help, “Is it somewhere I can break into and get them out?”

Entrapta wipes her hands after washing them in the bathroom, “I would advise against mounting a rescue mission for them just yet.”

“Why?” Catra frowns, “If we can get them out…”

“No. That would be detrimental to their well-being.” Entrapta says, “Besides, their freedom depends on you.”

“Say what now?” Catra asks, her ears flicking around on top of her head, “I doubt that Prime is going to keep his word.”

“Oh, he definitely won’t.” Entrapta agrees with a nod, “But he also won’t give up his advantage on you by killing them. As long as you’re in the tournament, your friends will be safe. Though, I will have Emily on standby in the event that you don’t win.”

“What’s going to happen to them if Catra loses?” Adora asks and then grimacing right after, “Not that Catra’s going to lose…”

“Just in case Catra is unsuccessful, I have Emily on standby anyways.” Entrapta repeats, “But in answer to your question, if Catra was to lose, her friends, including you, Bow, Glimmer and myself will be in grave danger of people… and uh, removed from existence.”

“Way to not put pressure on me, Traps.” Catra says with a grumble, “Can you give me some of those happy meds now, so I can sleep?”

“But it’s still so early!” Entrapta returns, “Can we go get some of those tiny cupcakes I saw in the food hall? I know I’m not a competitor but I can be part of your team, right?”

“Uh, sure, I guess.” Catra replies tiredly, “Go find Sparkles and her boy and you can go nuts. I think I just need to sleep this pain off since I’m not getting any happy meds tonight.”

“I have some of those happy meds…” Entrapta looks at Adora, “Can she have drugs?”

“I don’t think there’s really any rules in this tournament considering we saw a few people die or be on the verge of death today.” Adora replies, “Actually, can I have some too?” Entrapta quirks an eyebrow at the blonde as she elaborates, “For my leg. It’s really quite sore.”

“You should probably keep off it, Adora.” Entrapta does a quick assessment of Adora’s leg, the blonde hissing when the purple haired woman pokes her in the knee, “Sorry. The swelling is not so bad considering a horse fell on top of it. Oh! I have just the thing!”

“Wha-?” Adora starts to say before she yelps when the smaller woman yanks her down the bed and pulls something out and wraps it around the blonde’s leg, “Entrapta! What are you doing?!”

“Helping you.” Entrapta simply replies as she does up the contraption, “There. It’ll help with the swelling and keep your leg stable. Especially if you’re going to continue to hobble over to Catra every time she takes a hit.”

“I do not!” Adora pouts out in denial despite knowing that it is true, groaning out exasperatedly, “She nearly died! Twice!”

“Yeah, Traps. Twice.” Catra agrees with a grin and a nod, “But I still won.”

“Hm…” Entapta thinks to herself, “I think we need to think of a strategy so that you don’t die.”

“Yeah, and what would that be?” Catra asks cynically, “Win?”

“Yes! Exactly!” Entrapta stands up and punches the air, “I’m going to go work on that. Get the low down on your next round! I’ll see you tomorrow!”

“Uh, see ya Traps.” Catra waves a little at the other woman, forgetting to get those happy drugs as she then turns to Adora, “So… I won my first round.”

“And?” Adora looks over, crossing her arms over her chest.

“Well… you did say you’d kiss me if I won the first round…” Catra gestures into the air, “So…”

“I already kissed you.” Adora replies with a blush and a small smile on her lips.

“Wait. That doesn’t count!” Catra groans out and before she can get another word in, Adora pulls her in for a longer and deeper kiss, the magicat grinning widely into it and when they part, Catra chuckles, “Fuck… that preview had nothing on the real thing…”

“You’re an idiot.” Adora rolls her eyes and brings Catra back in for another kiss, resting her forehead on the magicat’s, “You really scared me. Twice.”

“I’m… I’m sorry, Adora.” Catra replies and the blonde nods with a sigh, “But for what it’s worth, flyboy did say something before he disappeared.”

“Oh yeah?” Adora opens her eyes and looks into Catra’s, the magicat nodding, “What did he say?”

“He said,” Catra starts and takes in a breath, “He said, I was worthy.”

Adora smiles widely, pressing her lips back onto Catra’s before moving her lips up to the magicat’s ear, “You are worthy, Catra.”

“Sure.” Catra dismisses and looks away.

“No.” Adora isn’t having any of the magicat self-depreciation as she tilts Catra’s chin back towards her a second time, “You are. Stop. Whatever you’re thinking. Just stop.”

“I’m not…” Catra tries to argue.

“What did I just say?” Adora chastises, “You are. And if Castiel told you. It has to be true.”

“Why? Why do you believe whatever that flyboy says, anyway?” Catra narrows her eyes and looks away again despite Adora’s hand still on her chin, “Why does it matter what he thinks?”

Adora sighs, “You have no idea who he is, do you?”

“Obviously.” Catra snorts out a laugh.

“Stars…” Adora rolls her eyes and then says, “Castiel is an actual angel.”

“Bullshit. Flyboy was not an angel.” Catra scoffs out a disbelieving grin on her face, “If he was…”

“The wings really should have given it away, Cat.” Adora laughs.

“If he really was an angel… what the fuck is he doing in this tournament?” Catra questions, scratching her head, “I mean, if he’s all so powerful, why not just smite me on the spot?”

“He… he doesn’t work like that.” Adora replies, “Look, I don’t know a lot about him but I did a search on his name and yeah, from all accounts, Castiel is the real deal. Though…”

“What?” Catra asks with a sigh.

“He’s never lost before.” Adora admits.

“Then how’d you guys know about the whole… worthy thing?” Catra asks, “Wait… you did know about him, didn’t you?”

“I never fought him.” Adora replies, “But there have been rumours.”

“Uh huh.” Catra rolls her eyes, “I’m guessing since no one’s beaten him, he’s won pretty much every tournament?”

Adora shakes her head, “He refuses to fight past the first round. It’s… it’s like he just wants to test himself and get a workout.”

“Why the fuck was he even in this tournament?” Catra asks, “What was the point?”

“I think he rigged it.” Adora says as she thinking and then nods like she knows for sure, “Definitely, he rigged it.”

“Why? Why would he rig this tournament?” Catra groans out.

A smile comes over Adora’s face, “To see if you are worthy.”

Catra just stares back at the blonde, still unconvinced.

“Catra. Do you know what this means?” Adora cups the magicat’s cheeks.

“Mm-no?” the words coming out a little muffled as Adora squishes her face.

“It means you’re worthy!” Adora repeats like Catra should understand what she means as the blonde presses her lips onto Catra’s once more for another kiss and then whispers into the magicat’s lips, “You’re worthy. You’re going to win.”

“Yeah, and if that happens, it’ll be a miracle.” Catra returns sarcastically as she feels Adora’s lips back on hers again accompanied by a shake of the head.

“You’re worthy and going to win.” Adora repeats, “And it won’t be a miracle because if anyone can do it, it’ll be you.”

“You’re crazy.” Catra smiles, still not feeling what those words mean, “And an idiot.”

“You’ll see.” Adora grins wider, “And then you’ll take me on a date and we’ll have… um, I’ll uh… yeah.”

Catra grin mirrors the blonde, “Yeah. I can’t wait until that whole thing happens, princess. But… one fight at a time.”

“Yep. One fight at a time.” Adora nods, “And then at the end when you win… You’ll believe what we all think. And you’ll know, that you are worthy. We’ll get Delia back. We’ll get everyone back. We’ll be free of Prime and all his threats and-mmphf…mmm…”

Catra stops the blonde’s rambling, crashing her lips onto Adora’s and grinning, “Stop talking, please, princess…” the magicat breathes out when she pulls back from the kiss, “The end is looking really far right now… so, can we just focus on the next fight?”

“Of course.” Adora wraps her arms around Catra’s neck, “So… what do you know about Flame? Apart from her eyes being literally lasers that will hurt you?”

Catra thinks about it for a moment and then says, “She hates it when I touch her knees.”

“Stars…” Adora rolls her eyes and whines out, “Catra!”

The magicat laughs, “What?! She does! Maybe if I touch her knees enough I can distract her enough to knock her out or something… I haven’t quite thought it through yet… but it’s late and I’m tired…”

“Sleep on it.” Adora says as she moves to lie the pair back down on the bed, “Actually, don’t sleep on it just yet.”

“Why not?” Catra asks with a yawn and a lazy stretch.

“Glimmer and Bow are coming back with dinner soon.” Adora tells her, “So, eat first and then you can sleep on it. Maybe Glimmer and Bow might know more about this Flame girl.”

“Okay.” Catra smacks her lips and closes her eyes, “I’m just going to rest my eyes for now.”

“Don’t fall asleep, Cat.” Adora warns only to be met with soft snores coming from the magicat, the blonde sighs, leaning over and pressing a soft kiss to Catra’s forehead and whispering, “I’ll wake you up when they get here.”

“Mm…” Catra smiles as she continues to sleep.

Chapter End Notes

First round done!
Also, yes, the reference to Castiel is sort of from Supernatural - though it's just very loose.

And also, yes for Entrapta randomly being there!

Thanks for reading, kudos, commenting, subscribing and bookmarking.
I've had to reread previous chapters so I don't end up contradicting myself too much... 😬

Rounds 2 and 3

Chapter Notes

CW - Violence/Blood/Injury

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Flame on!” Catra snarks out sarcastically as she lands a kick to the back of her opponents knees, making her stumble forward, anger coming out in the way of lasers coming from her eyes as the audience shrieks and gets out of the way of them as Catra grimaces, “Whoops!”

“Catra! Laser Safety!” Bow shouts out as he heaps Adora over his shoulder so they aren’t in the firing line, despite the fact that all the fights are now held outdoors due to the destruction of the arena yesterday, “Why don’t they have protection for spectators!?”

“You do know where you are, right?!” Glimmer grunts back, “They don’t care about the audience!”

“Oh, right!” Bow scrambles behind a low wall, gently putting Adora back down on the ground and then scratching the back of his neck, “I knew that.”

“Guys! I can’t see how she’s doing!” Adora whines out, doing her best to get back to her feet and with the help of Glimmer, manages to use the wall to prop herself up, “Oh, she seems to be… winning?”

“Why does that seem to surprise you?” Glimmer asks looking over at her friend before they all have to duck when Flame gets a kick to the face, her head turning towards where the trio are currently hiding as her eyes open and a blast of laser light beams towards them, “Fuck! Catra! You asshole!”

“Are you okay?” Adora pats Glimmer on the back reassuringly, “That was close.”

“Yeah, I know!” Glimmer grunts out, “She’s doing it on purpose! EEP! FUCK!”

“Hello!” Entrapta pops up right in front of Glimmer, “Oh, did I scare you?”

“YES! FUCK!” Glimmer shouts out her shock as she sinks back down against the wall trying to calm her heart down, “Can everyone stop fucking scaring me or trying to kill me!?”’

“I wasn’t trying to scare you.” Entrapta says feeling a little sad and it instantly makes Glimmer guilty, “And killing you was definitely not my intention.”

“Oh shit, no.” Glimmer quickly tries to cheer up Entrapta, “I didn’t mean it like that. It’s just that…” the sparkly woman sighs, “You just surprised me, is all. I’m sorry.”

Entrapta looks up at Glimmer and slowly a smile creeps onto her face, “Apology accepted! Also I’m also sorry for surprising you!” the purple haired scientist then shouts out, “DUCK!”

“Oof!” Glimmer, Entrapta and Adora all grunt out as someone pushes them out of the way and then the sound of a body hitting the ground with a thud sounds nearby as the trio look up and sees Bow rushing over.

“Guys! Are you alright?!” Bow asks voice ladened with concern.

“Yeah, we’re fine.” Adora replies for the trio, “What happened?”

CLANG!

The gong sounds loudly as the group look up and see Catra standing over them, hands on her hips and staring over them with

a wry grin, a line of blood trailing down her face from a cut that's just above her right eye.

Catra grin turns into a smirk at the group and simply says, "I won."

"Uh… congrats?" Bow squeaks out as he looks around, "What happened to Flame?"

The magicat rolls her eyes and points to her defeated opponent laying on the ground not too far from them, "Told you, her knees don't like to be touched."

"But how did you?" Adora frowns as she asks the question, "And what about…?"

Catra moves forward, crouching down in front of Adora, "Are you hurt, princess?"

"Ahem!" Glimmer clears her throat loudly, "Are you going to ask if we're okay too?"

"Yes." Catra looks around at the group, "You all look okay. But unfortunately, there's only one of you with a preexisting injury, isn't there, Sparkles?"

Catra stares down the other woman until she sits back against the wall in a huff, grumbling out, "You ass. You nearly got us killed."

The magicat ignores Glimmer and goes back to Adora, "Are you hurt?"

"No more than before." Adora replies as she cups Catra's face, "You've been cut."

"It's just a nick." Catra smiles, leaning into Adora's hand, "Feel a whole heap better than my first fight."

Entrapta gets up and checks over Flame, "She's still alive."

“Good.” Catra replies.

“Isn’t her team going to help her?” Entrapta asks as Bow grabs the first aid kit and kneels down next to her.

“She works or I should probably say, worked, for Prime.” Catra replies as Adora starts to fuss over her and then the magicat chuckles, “I’m okay, princess.”

“You need to get that cut cleaned or it might get infected.” Adora says softly, relief in her voice as she pulls Catra forward for a kiss, “And then we need to get you ready for your second fight.”

“Mm… I could get used to winning…” The magicat hums out happily, “What time is that again?”

“Late. After dinner late. Supper late.” Glimmer supplies as she gets up to grab some saline, butterfly bandages, gauze and some iodine, trudging back over, “I’m not your nurse. Here, you do it, *princess.”*

Adora sticks her tongue out at Glimmer as she takes the supplies, “Thank you. Also, how’s Flame doing?” the blonde takes the saline and squirts it over the magicat’s cut, smiling at the way Catra winces but doesn’t make a sound before quickly cleaning it up and then bandaging over it.

“She’s alive.” Bow says, “She’ll need a hospital though. She has a concussion and it needs to be monitored by professionals.”

“Doubt Prime is going to foot the bill.” Catra says as she helps Adora up to her feet, “I saw medics or what looked like medics yesterday. Where the fuck are they now?”

The rest of them look around in the realisation that no one was coming, Entrapta comes to the conclusion first, “Prime has told the medics not to bother. As they’ll bill him for the medical services and he isn’t going to pay it if she’s already been knocked out physically and out of the tournament.”

“That’s fucked up.” Catra says with a shake of her head, “But, not exactly unexpected.”

“She’s got bleeding under her head.” Bow observes with a wince, “I can wrap it, but she’s going to need proper medical attention.”

“Do it, Arrows.” Catra instructs, “Also cover her eyes too with the bandage. Don’t want her waking up and frying the staff in the hospital.”

Bow nods and starts to bandage Flame’s head wound up as Glimmer pulls out her phone and starts to make a call, walking off just far enough to get a little peace so she can talk without shouting.

Glimmer comes back to the group, “Okay, I spoke to the medical centre here and they will accept her as long as she pays the fees for her stay and care.”

“I doubt she’s got any cash on her.” Catra says defeatedly, “They aren’t going to take her if she can’t pay. And I don’t have any extra cash either.”

“Don’t worry about it.” Entrapta says, “I’ll take care of it.”

“You will?” Glimmer asks incredulously, “How?”

“I can’t tell you.” Entrapta says with a grin, “It’d be better if you didn’t know.”

“Uh… okay…?” Glimmer looks to Bow who just shrugs as a response, “Well, I guess that’s sorted then now we’ll just need to transport her over there.”

“I’ll bring Emily!” Entrapta declares, pulling out a remote and pushing down on a large red button, she grins to the group, “She’s coming!”

They all turn around with shocked looks on their faces when a robot shaped like a sphere with legs comes stomping towards

them as Entrapta waves at it brightly until it comes to stop next to her. Bow's eyes widen in excitement, "Oh. My. Stars! Is that a real robot!?"

"Why yes! This is Emily." Entrapta pats the robot on the side like a pet before continuing the introductions, "Emily, this is everyone."

Emily blinks a red light in response as it await further commands.

"Emily, please gently pick up the unconscious woman on the ground and transport her to the nearest hospital." Entrapta instructs as the robot does what it's told, then turns to the group, "Okay! I'll see you later at Catra's next fight!"

They watch as Entrapta hop on top of Emily and then take off down the road.

"So… Who's hungry?" Bow turns to the group and then adds, "But I really need to wash my hands before eating anything or touching anything really…"

"Your next opponent isn't Horde." Glimmer casually says as their food finally arrives at their table, "Also, I'm really happy to finally sit at a place that serve food to your table. I'm sick of the mess hall food."

"Well, the mess hall food it free." Catra points out with a frown, "Plus the money I have is from stealing."

"You're not paying for this, dumbass." Glimmer snarks at the magicat, "I am."

"Why?" Catra asks suspiciously, "Is it poisoned? Drugged? Are you secretly slipping me steroids? Because I'm pretty sure it's already too late for steroids."

"Shut up." Glimmer rolls her eyes, "It's not poisoned or drugged or whatever you think it is. Can't you just take it at face value and

just enjoy my rare generosity?”

“She wouldn’t have time to poison or slip you drugs.” Adora supplies with a chuckle, “And besides, it’d make no sense to do that considering all our fates are tied to you and your ability to win this tournament.”

“Hm… true…” Catra nods as she waits for the rest the group to eat first before tucking in herself, a low moan indicating how good the food is, “Fuck me…”

“No thanks.” Bow chuckles, “I think we’ll leave that for Adora.”

“Guys!” Adora groans out.

“What? Did you want one of us to do it?” Glimmer asks with a quirk of an eyebrow and it earns a glare from the blonde and a loud boisterous laugh from the magicat.

“Nope. Not happening Sparkles.” Catra quickly takes that off the table, turning to Bow, “And no offence dude, but no dudes. Just Adora. That was the deal.”

“You make it sound like I’m selling myself to you.” Adora grumbles.

Catra shakes her head, “I thought it was more… motivational…”

“Okay! Whatever!” Glimmer stops the incessant flirting between the pair, “Like I was saying, your next opponent is not from the Horde.”

“Who are they representing then?” Catra muffles out through a mouthful of food that she covers with her hand.

“Gross. Don’t talk with your mouthful.” Glimmer chastises, “And to answer your question, your next round is against a fighter from the Waste.”

“Crimson Waste?” Catra asks after swallowing down her mouthful.

“The one and only.” Glimmer confirms, “It’s a dude. Lizard dude. Goes by the name Lashor.”

“Weaknesses? Strengths?” Catra asks and then looks at Adora, “You fight him before?”

“Hybrid division, so no.” Adra replies ruefully, “Though, he doesn’t look so tough. Carries around a whip and fights in a leather jacket. I mean, who really does that? It’s so… uncomfortable and restrictive!”

“Take a breath, princess.” Catra says with a smile at how passionate the blonde is, “You’re going to explode if you don’t.”

Adora takes a few calming breathes before leaning back in and grinning, “You’re definitely going to win this one tonight.”

“Don’t jinx it, babe.” Catra replies with a laugh, “No such thing as sure thing.”

“Well, we will be when you win.” Adora declares defiantly and uncaring that her friends are giving her looks, “You can count on that being a sure thing.”

Bow whispers to Glimmer, “This ‘motivation’ technique is all sorts of wrong…”

“Well, if it works, it works.” Glimmer shrugs, “Plus if she wins, we won’t die. Which is a really good thing in my books.”

Bow nods, “Yeah, you’re right.”

“So, how do I beat this Lashor guy?” Catra asks and the trio smile at one another before the three of them start talking at the magicat all at once before arguing amongst themselves while Catra steals food off their plates while they are distracted.

“Why is this round so fucking late? I’m about ready for bed.” Catra complains as she rubs her eyes knowing that she definitely would have been better off taking a nap between fights than ‘strategizing’ against the next fighter, “It’s nearly bloody midnight!”

“Quit your complaining. You sound like an old person.” Glimmer scolds, “I’ve been out partying way later than this.”

“Hate to break this to you Sparkles, but this isn’t exactly a party.” Catra says, “I’d rather much prefer to be at an orgy than be here.”

“Wouldn’t we all…” Bow says under his breath surprising the group as he quickly realises exactly what he’s just said out loud, “I mean… because it’d be a lot better than fighting.” He laughs nervously and then adds, “Make love not war.”

“I’m with Bow on this one.” Glimmer unsurprisingly agrees, “I’d rather be fucking than getting fucked up.”

“Can we please stop talking about… that.” Adora pleads with a groan, “This really isn’t helping Catra prepare for her fight.”

“Actually, it is.” The magicat grins, “It’s definitely woke me up a bit.”

“That’s good.” Adora nods with a smile.

“Just don’t think about orgies with Adora.” Glimmer teases and Catra instantly growls surprising the smaller woman, “Woah… I was not expecting that…”

“Shut up, Sparkles.” Catra grunts out.

The blonde sensing the jealousy in the magicat’s demeanour and she can’t but help tease as well, “What’s wrong, Cat? Thinking about me and… other people…”

“No.” The magicat quickly disputes, “I don’t care what you do or who you do.”

“Sure, you don’t.” Adora drawls as she leans in and nudges Catra, “Don’t worry. I’m very much into monogamy. And I’m definitely very much not sharing the person I’m with.”

Adora winks at the magicat and it seems to relax Catra enough to stop growling, “Well, that’s lucky for the person you’re with then, isn’t it?”

Adora laughs, “It really is.”

“Good for them.” Catra adds nudging Adora with her elbow as they play wrestle a little, the magicat careful not to hurt the blonde’s still recovering knee.

“Guys! Stop mucking around!” Glimmer scolds the pair, “You’re going tire yourself out before you even fight!”

Still laughing the pair pulls back from one another, the blonde grabbing Catra’s hand and squeezing it, “Just in case it wasn’t clear, that lucky person is you.”

“I know.” Catra whispers back letting herself lean into Adora’s side.

“Gross.” Glimmer teases the pair and then the sound of the gong sounds, signalling the end of the round before, “Oh! Oh! You’re next! Get up!”

Catra takes a deep breath in and then stands up, pulling off the hoodie she ‘borrowed’ from Adora’s suitcase, the blonde standing up too a little shakily and says, “I’m not going to wish you good luck…” the magicat looks at her strangely as Adora continues, “Because you won’t need it. You’re going to win, Cat. I know you are.”

The magicat nods, “I hope you’re right.”

“I know I am.” Adora smiles at her, “Now, go get them, tiger!”

“Kiss for good luck?” Catra jokes, a grin on her face as she stares at Adora.

“You don’t need it.” Adora laughs, “Plus you’ll get one when you win, remember?”

“Definitely.” The magicat grins, “Just thought I could get a freebie.”

Adora rolls her eyes and pulls the magicat in by the shoulders, pressing her lips onto Catra’s chastely before pulling back, “There’s more of that when you win…”

“Hey!” A loud voice snarks from behind them, Lashor’s voice, “Are we fighting or kissing women?”

Catra growls out and faces her lizard-folk opponent, “I’d much rather kiss women than have to dirty my hands on you.”

“You better get going.” Adora says patting the magicat on the back, “We’ll be cheering for you.”

Catra nods and starts to head to the centre of the outdoor space and stands on her mark as Lashor goes to his as they wait for the start of the fight to sound.

“Gotcha!” Lashor announces triumphantly as he pulls Catra up by the legs so she’s upside down and staring at him, “I’m going leave your broken body as a warning to all who cross Tung Lashor, strongest in the Crimson Waste! And the strongest in this competition!”

Catra laughs, surprising the lizardman.

“What?! What is so funny?!” He snarls out at the magicat still upside down in his grasp, “You dare to laugh at Tung Lashor!”

“Dude, one, did you just refer to yourself in the third person and secondly, Tung Lashor? Like did you lose a bet or something?” The crowd around them all laugh as he looks around mortified at the reaction to his name before snarling down into the face of the magicat.

He tightens his grip around Catra’s legs and then goes eye to eye with her, “I’m going to rip you apart, kitty. Maybe feed you to the dogs.” He laughs out at his own words as Catra does the same, surprised and also infuriating the lizardman who shakes the magicat violently around in his arms, “What, is so funny?”

“This.” Catra grins swiping her claws across Lashor’s waist and then taken his whip, the pain of the slash on his body gives her just enough time to get out of his grip as she clamber onto his shoulders and wraps the whips around it, digging the claws of her feet into his back as she tightens the pressure around his neck, as he tries to pull her off his back, “Woah! And I thought this thing was useless!” she laughs out referring to the whip, “Also what kind of an idiot doesn’t restrain the arms of the person they’re threatening?!”

He starts to stumble around and then sees the many trees around and decides to do what Castiel did in the first round and ram the magicat into them. Lashor grunts out, “I’m going to crush you!”

“Them fighting words!” Catra mocks as she tightens the whip around his neck as she begins to pick up speed.

As he starts to run, his pants begin to fall, Catra’s slash to his waist slicing through his belt and the waistband of his pants. He starts to stumble, unable to reach his pants and run at the same time as Catra rolls him forward and throws him up against the tree that he was planning to use against her. She punches him hard to his face and he goes down like a stack of bricks as she removes the whip from his neck and steps back, breathing heavily as she glares at him.

“I’m keep this. And your jacket. Thanks, Lasshole.” Catra goes over to the Waste’s team and take the jacket with a grin.

“Catra! Look out!” Adora shouts out when Lashor gets back up to his feet and charges at her, this time ramming her into a tree on the opposite side.

“Oof! Fuck…” Catra grumbles as she drops the jacket and the whip.

“Hands off my jacket and my whip, kitty.” He grunts out and starts to swing wildly at the magicat’s head, connecting a few times in Catra’s moment of relaxation, “I’m going to win this round and you’ll be dead. Guess I’ll be kissing your woman tonight.”

“Fuck. You.” Catra growls out and slashes out with her claws against his face, pushing him backwards as she kicks him hard in the gut, pairing it with a one-two punch and finishing it off with a upper cut, the sound of his neck cracking is enough to indicate that he won’t be getting back again once he’s body hits the ground with a thud, “You’re not going to be kissing anything except the dirt, Lasshole.”

The gong sounds and Catra drops down to her knees in exhaustion, the cut above her right eye opening back up again and bleeding down her face as she hisses when she feels her sides throb in pain.

Bow gets to her first, “Catra! Are you okay? Can you walk?”

Catra looks at him.

“Can you walk or do you need Bow to carry you?” Glimmer clarifies the reasoning for the question.

“I-I… help me up?” Catra asks instead as Bow keeps hold of her as she gets to her feet and leans on him, “I-I think I can walk… slowly…”

“Okay.” Bow nods, Adora limping over with a wry smile on her face, “We’ll get you back to your room and then sort you out, okay?”

“Sure, Dr Bow.” Catra snorts out a laugh and regrets it immediately as pain shoots through her sides and then she feels someone nudge her from behind, it’s one of Lashor’s team members, a lizardwoman, “You want revenge for him?” the magicat asks trying to be as intimidating as she can while in her pained state.

The lizardwoman shakes her head, instead holding out Lashor’s jacket to her, “Here. You beat him, so you are the strongest in the Waste.”

“We’re not in the Waste.” Catra points out.

“Take it.” She pushes it towards the magicat’s hand, “You are the only one worthy of this jacket now.”

“You mean until someone else takes me out?” Catra asks with a quirk on an eyebrow at the lizardwoman nods, “No thanks. I don’t want this. You take it. I’ll make you the leader of the Waste now. Enjoy.”

The lizardwoman grins as she takes the jacket back and puts it on before turning to her team, “Looks like I’m in charge now, bitches!”

Catra watches on as the Waste’s team start to argue amongst themselves and soon enough a fight breaks out amongst their small group, Adora shakes her head at the sight, torn between breaking them up or leaving them to fight it out amongst themselves. She signs and the turns to Catra, “Come on, we need to get you cleaned up before I can give you that kiss.”

“Awesome.” Catra grins letting herself lean more of her weight on Glimmer and Bow as they all head back their rooms and then realises there’s someone missing from their group, “Hey. What happened to Entrapta?”

“She said something about getting some dirt on Prime.” Glimmer replies, “Said she’d be back for your fight tomorrow.”

“Quarter final fight.” Adora corrects, “Quarter final, semi final and then grand final. Three more rounds and then you’re done!”

“Correction. Three more rounds for me to win this tournament.” Catra says as she slowly walks back to their accommodation, “Is it two rounds tomorrow too?”

“No. Just the one.” Adora replies as she slowly limps next to them, “I’ve got to check the schedule when we get back to the room and see what time…”

“Catra.” Prime’s voice interrupts their conversation, “I believe this belongs to you.”

“Oof!” Entrapta slides towards them, a sheepish look on her face that looks like she’s been beat up as Primes tosses her towards the group.

“What did you do to her?!” Catra turns to Prime and snarls.

“You’re lucky I didn’t kill her.” He threatens in an eerily calm tone, “Though if I catch her again snooping around me or my team, she won’t be so lucky next time.”

He spins on his heel and walks off without another word as the group watch him leave.

“Traps. Are you okay?” Catra asks as she leans on Glimmer while Bow helps Entrapta up to her feet, “What the fuck were you doing?”

Entrapta gives her a guilty grin, “I was just trying to get some information on what Prime is up to or where he’s keeping your friends.”

“Oh.” Catra says taken aback, “I thought you said it was a bad idea to mount a rescue for them.”

“It is!” She confirms, “But… I hope I haven’t stuffed everything up now…”

“Are they still alive and okay?” Catra asks and the small purple haired woman nods, “Well, then you haven’t stuffed it up. Just… stay away from Prime, please.”

“Okay.” Entrapta nods as Bow turns her head to get a better look, “I’m okay, Bow! This is from the sneaking in and out of vents and wall spaces.”

“Oh, okay.” Bow nods to her and stands up back, helping Entrapta up with him, “We better get back. I still need to fix up Catra.”

“I can help!” Entrapta offers.

“Well, they do say two hands are better than one.” Bow replies with a grateful nod.

“But you do have two hands.” Entrapta replies looking at his hands, “Unless one of those hands aren’t real…”

“Guys! Can we please go?” Adora grumbles, “It’s late and by the time Catra’s fixed up, it’s going to be even later.”

“Sure thing.” Bow replies and gets back under Catra’s other arm to help Glimmer with the weight of the magicat, “Let’s go.”

Entratpa walks behind the group, watching and observing Catra’s movement. Her eyes flicker over to green for a few seconds before going back to normal as she jogs to catch up.

“Everything okay back there, Traps?” Catra asks as her ears twitch to the sound of Entrapta running.

“Everything is… perfect.” Entrapta replies as her eyes turn green again for a moment as the group continue looking forward before her eyes revert back to normal once more, “I look forward to the next round…”

Chapter End Notes

Uh oh...

Thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, subscribing and bookmarking!
I'm probably going to need to up the chapter count... QF. SF. F.
I don't know if I can do it all in the next chapter... so just a heads up.

You Shall Not Pass!

Chapter Summary

Quarter Final fight!

Chapter Notes

CW - violence/blood

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Are you okay there, Traps?” Catra asks as the purple haired woman seems unusually subdued as they sit in the mess hall with empty plates in front of the magicat after breakfast, “You haven’t tried to poke or prod me since my last fight…” she looks at the empty space in front of Entrapta and adds “And you haven’t grabbed any tiny foods. Are you sure you’re okay?”

“I’m fine.” Entrapta replies with a tilt of her head, no beaming smile or anecdote to be seen as she goes back to staring off into space and then asks just as flatly, “Why do you ask?”

“No reason.” Catra looks away as she touches the bandage over cut just above her eye and sighs, “Any idea who I’m up against next?”

“Yes.” Catra’s ears twitch as she waits for the answer, Entrapta turns her head to look the magicat in the eyes, “Bulrog.”

“Sounds like a meathead.” Catra says as she smooths over her messy short hair, “Reckon I can beat him? Her? Them? It?”

“Him.” Entrapta replies flatly and then pulls out her phone and taps it a few times and then holds it up to Catra to see, “This is him. Bulrog. Your opponent for the quarter final.”

Catra takes the phone out of Entrapta’s hand and looks at the photo, “Oh. I’m so dead. This isn’t even a man or even from this

plane of existence!” She frowns at the photo and then looks back at the purple haired woman staring off into space once more and sighs, “Well?”

“Well, what?” Entrapta continues to stare off into space, her eyes looking like they’re glazing over.

“Any tips?” Catra tries to get Entrapta’s attention once more, but the other woman simply shakes her head, “Great… maybe I’ll go ask Adora, she usually know a ton of fighters.”

“Okay.”

The magicat heads towards the door and raises her arm up in a wave, “I’ll see you at my next round, I guess…”

“Maybe.” Entprapta replies flatly, not even looking as Catra leaves.

“Okay…” Catra looks back before making her exit to find Adora and her friends.

“There you are!” Glimmer grabs Catra by the arm and drags her in to their room, Adora already inside with Bow, the blonde laying on the bed with her leg elevated while Bow lounges on the couch by the wall watching some program on the television, “Where have you been?”

“Breakfast.” Catra replies confused, “I got hungry. Am I not allowed to eat?”

“By yourself?” Glimmer squeezes the magicat’s arm ignoring the question.

“No. Traps was there. She didn’t eat anything though. Didn’t even grab a plate of tiny foods or drinks.” Catra pulls her arm out of Glimmer’s grasp, “She was acting… weird.”

“You noticed that too?” Glimmer says surprised at the confirmation, “What did *you* notice?”

“You mean apart from the fact she wasn’t trying to get ‘samples’ from me?” Glimmer nods, “I saw a tinge of green in her eyes.”

“Fuck.” Glimmer mutters under her breath and then turns to Adora and Bow, “See! I’m not crazy! And I’m not making any of this!”

“No one called you crazy, Glim.” Bow says from the couch, still unmoving as he watches the tv.

“Yeah, Glim.” Adora agrees easily as she lays on the bed, “We never called you crazy.”

Catra walks over to Adora and looks the blonde over, “You didn’t come to breakfast.”

“Wasn’t hungry after I already ate earlier.” Adora replies as she taps her fingers on her own stomach.

“Uh… okay.” Catra replies as she takes a sit on the bed next to Adora, “How’s the leg?”

“It’s fine.” The shortness of Adora’s replies making the magicat concerned as she leans in and presses a soft kiss on the blonde’s cheek, the blonde turns her head to face Catra for the first time since she walked in, “Are you ready for your next fight?”

“No. I have no idea how I’m supposed to be ready. I’m not a fighter. Besides I’m just going to wing it like I have every other round.” Catra replies lightly but there’s no sense of amusement in Adora’s eyes as the magicat shuffles a little uncomfortably, “Uh, I’m sure it’ll be fine. I’m going to win.”

“Good.” Adora replies unmoving.

“Right.” Catra nods and then promptly gets off the bed, she walks over to Glimmer, “Hey, Sparkles. Can I get you to help me with something?”

“Uh… sure?” Glimmer lets herself get pulled out of her room by the magicat and back into the room Catra shares with Adora, “What’s going on?”

“I was going to ask you same question, Sparkles.” Catra shuts the door and locks it behind her, her reply hushed as it is forced, “What the fuck is going on?! Why is everyone acting so… weird?”

“I literally just asked you that, ass.” Glimmer snarks, the attitude makes Catra sigh out in relief, “Something is up with Entrapta. I know it is.”

“Same with Adora and your boy.” Catra adds as she looks around to make sure no one is trying to get in, “They aren’t acting… normal.”

The magicat looks Glimmer up and down, the smaller woman frowning at her, “What? What are you doing?”

“Checking you out.” Catra replies as she pokes Glimmer with a finger, not caring about the double entendre of what she just said, “You seem like you.”

“Of course, I’m me!” Glimmer shoves Catra back, “Quit poking me!”

“Okay, okay…” Catra steps back and thinks to herself, “I think Traps, Bow and Adora are all… tainted.”

“Tainted?” Glimmer repeats with furrowed brows, “What the fuck are you talking about? Tainted?”

“I saw a tinge of green in Trap’s eyes.” The magicat starts to pace around the room as she repeats what she had said from before, stopping when she turns to Glimmer to ask, “Did at any time between last night and this morning when you weren’t either Adora or Bow?”

Glimmer thinks back and then says, “Breakfast. I wanted a sleep in, so I passed on getting breakfast this morning with them. I

suppose you had the same idea?”

Catra nods with a small smile from the morning events before she pinches the bridge of her nose, “Fuck… that means they got to them.”

“They? What they?!” Glimmer huffs.

“Prime, dumbass! Who else?!” Catra throws her arms up in frustration and then the sound of a phone’s alarm goes off, “What the…” the magicat rounds the other side of the bed and grabs her phone, turning off the alarm that Adora had set so she’d have at least an hour before her fight started, “Fuck… we don’t have a lot of time…”

“What time is it?” Glimmer stands next to the magicat to look at the time on her phone, “You’ve got an hour before your fight. Fuck… what are we going to do?!”

Catra takes a deep breath in and then looks at Glimmer as she says, “I’m going win is what I’m going to do. Beat this Bulrog guy.”

“Bulrog?” Glimmer says and then her eyes widen, “Fuck. Fuck. Fuck…”

“What now, Sparkles?” Catra grunts out as she pockets her phone and then heads to her closet, pulling out her fighting clothes and then swiftly turning around to get dressed, not caring that Glimmer is still there, “Why aren’t you talking?”

Turning around once she’s dressed, she sees Glimmer sitting on the couch and staring intently at her phone, “Huh? Did you say something?” the sparkly woman then realises Catra has just literally changed with her in the room and then shakes her head, “Did you just…?”

“Yeah, I did. Get over it.” Catra replies as she takes a seat next to Glimmer on the couch, “What are you reading?”

“This Bulrog guy… yeah, not good. Not good at all.” Glimmer breathes out, “He’s fucking huge. Like… huge, huge.”

“You better not be talking about his junk.” Catra jests as Glimmer nudges her for not taking the issue seriously, “Fine. Whatever. How do I beat him?”

“How the fuck am I supposed to know?!” The sparkly woman groans out, throwing her head back and nearly hitting her head on the wall behind, “That’s like Bow and Adora’s area of expertise. I just look after the accommodations and transport. Literally, if I didn’t have to attend these things because of my best friends… I wouldn’t even bother coming. It’s boring as batshit and I really don’t like watching my best friend get beat up from time to time.”

“Uh huh.” Catra replies “So, I’m fucking dead?”

“Pretty much.” Glimmer consoles poorly.

“Can you look up to see if he’s got any… soft spots?” Catra asks as she slumps down on the couch next to Glimmer, “Anything that will stop the inevitable?”

“No.” Cara groans once more as Glimmer pats her on the thigh, “You’re fucked. And not even in the good way.”

“Great. I’m dead.” Catra eventually surmises.

“You’re dead. I’m dead. Bow’s dead. Adora’s dead and Entrapta’s going to be dead.” Glimmer lists out flatly, “You die. We all die. So for the love of the stars, don’t die. Find a way to win.”

Catra takes a deep breath in, “You know what really sucks?”

“What?”

“When I beat this Bullshit guy, I’m not even going to get that kiss from my Adora.” Catra sighs out.

“Well, I’m not going to get to kiss Bow either. So, we’re both in the shit, aren’t we?” Glimmer angrily adds, “What are we going to do about Bow and Adora?!”

“And Traps.” Catra rolls her eyes, “She’s important too, Sparkles.”

“Yes. And Entratpa.” Glimmer corrects herself with a guilty look on her face at forgetting the other woman, “What are we going to do if they’re tainted?”

“I think…” Catra starts and then slumps back down, “I think I need to win this fight first and then we’ll have to figure it out later.”

“That’s a shit plan.” Glimmer scoffs out with a roll of her eyes.

“Yeah, but at least I have a plan.” Catra grunts out a little angrily, “What have you got?”

“Your back, you ass.” Glimmer shakes her head, “And you better have mine.”

“Of course, Sparkles.” Catra nudges Glimmer with her shoulder, a small smile on her lips as they try to reassure each other, “Now, come on. I have to get ready for this fight and we can’t let on that we know something is up with Adora, Bow and Traps.”

The gong sounds as Catra gets into a defensive stance as she faces up to Bulrog.

Literally.

Her opponent is 3 times taller than the magicat, maybe even 4 times taller. And Glimmer wasn’t joking, he is fucking huge. His muscles look like rocks and the horns on the top of his head make him a lot more dangerous that Catra may become skewered on one of them. And the worst part, he seems to be oozing flames and lava. Not a good combination for a fleshy meatbag like Catra.

“Oh, shit…” Catra mouths out as Bulrog roars and flames around him grow brighter and more heated, “I’m dead…”

“Go Catra!” Adora shouts from the sidelines, her cheers sound hollow, more like she’s just screaming it for the sake of it, “You can do it!”

“Woo! Go Catra!” Bow shouts out in the same manner as Adora, hollow and lifeless despite the volume of his cheers.

Glimmer moves herself closer to the ring in the guise of being there to put the magicat out in case she catches on fire, her peripheral vision on her friends as she wonders where Entrapta could be.

Bulrog roars louder this time, fire breathing out from his mouth as Catra runs for her life and around the outdoor arena as the audience moves back a good distance as the magicat continues to sprint around avoiding being burnt a crisp from the flames her opponent is breathing out at her.

“Get back in there!” A few of the Horde contingent shout out as they push her back towards the fighting area, “Fight! You fucking coward!”

The magicat growls out before her ears pick up the sound of Bulrog getting set once more to breathe fire on her like a dragon, she glares at the Horde people and simply says, “You might want to move.”

“Get back in ther-ARGH!” Catra manages to get out of the way before Bulrog sets the entire section of Horde backers on fire. They all scream out, running around on fire and finding no relief until one by one they drop to their deaths. Their corpses still burning whilst everyone moves away from them.

“Warned you…” The magicat shake her head as she gets back to her feet, staring up at the huge horned opponent trying to kill her as she manages to get herself back closer to Glimmer, “Help, Sparkles? Any tips or help?!”

“Get away from me to start with!” Glimmer recoils and then something comes to her as she snaps her fingers in a *eureka* moment, “Oh! Oh! I know! Argh!”

“Watch out!” Catra shoves Glimmer out of the way as they avoid getting with fire, “Fucking just spit it out!” she yells to Glimmer.

“Hang on! I’ll be back! I need to get something!” Glimmer runs off leaving Catra to fend for her life shouting out encouragement over her shoulder before she disappears out of sight, “Just… don’t die yet!”

“Fucking Sparkles….” Catra leaps up and out of the way for the… she’s lost count already, rolling out of the way mostly unscathed, “Fucking Prime…” another leap and roll, “Fucking Bullshit!”

Bulrog growls and roars out angrily at not getting his target as he changes tact from trying to set Catra on fire to trying to crush the magicat with his hand and then his massive foot, growling out again as he misses Catra’s with his attempts.

“Sparkles! Where the fuck are you?!” Catra shouts out, her eyes go to Adora to see if the blonde will react, but no, Adora is still cheering her on like nothing is out of the ordinary, “Damn it! Oof!”

Catra goes down from Bulrog throwing pieces of himself at her, she grunts out in pain, landing on the sharp rocks of his skin as she quickly scrambles back to her feet as narrowly avoids the impact of Bulrog’s foot coming down right next to her head. Her eyes catch Glimmer’s silhouette as she rubs her back with a wince.

“Catra! Catch!” Glimmer screams out at the top of her voice, so loud that even the audience turns to see her in surprise as she throws a fancy looking staff towards Catra.

Forcing herself up and then sprinting once more with pain radiating through her back when she lands on the sharp rock,

leaping through the air to avoid Bulrog's grasp as she manages to catch the staff. Landing on her feet and looking at it confused, "How the fuck is this supposed to help me?!"

"Figure it out! Just use it!" Glimmer shouts back angrily like Catra should know what to do with the staff, the sparkly woman makes a motion with both hands, like she's got an invisible sledge hammer that she's… *stabbing* it into the ground or is it… smashing it into the ground?

"What?!" Catra shouts back as she uses the staff to swat at her opponent, the action having zero effect on the huge horned creature/man/monster, "I don't think I'm even allowed to use this!"

"This whole stupid tournament is rigged. Who gives a fuck what you use?!" Glimmer screeches back, "And how is it fucking fair that that *thing* is essentially indestructible?!"

"ARGH! FUCK!" Catra howls out in pain as a hot and sharp rock strikes her on the back of leg, making her stumble and fall to the ground, the staff the only thing from making her face plant completely as she gets back to the feet, limping away uselessly against Bulrog who seems to be smirking down at her, "What the fuck am I supposed to do with this?"

"USE! IT!" Glimmer shouts out again as she grabs Bow and Adora, pulling them further away from the fighting area, "DO IT NOW!"

Catra places both hands on the staff, there's a weird feeling of power that runs through her hands and to the staff as the decorative top part of it starts to glow and the magicat's eyes widen.

"I will kill you." Bulrog growls out the declaration in a low and ominous voice, "No one can defeat me. I am BULROG!"

Catra watches as Bulrog raises an arm up in the air, his hand balled into a fist, no doubt in another attempt to crush her once more. The magicat straightens up, the glowing staff in her hands

as she swallows down hard and looks up, raising the staff up as high as her arms will let her, before slamming it down.

CRASH! CRACK!

The staff crashes into the ground, embedded, cracking it open into a chasm, bright light blinds the magicat as the ground shakes violently around her. There's a lot of screaming and shouting all around her, no doubt the force of the staff's power wreaking havoc across the outdoor arena and then suddenly the ground beneath Catra's feet gives way and she feels herself starting to fall.

"Fuck! Shit!" Catra shouts out, still blinded and helplessly clawing at whatever she can get hold of, "Woah!"

Her claws manage to dig into the sides of the wall, the weight of her abruptly stopping has her hissing out in pain as she tries to blink away the black spots in her vision, until…

"Catra! Grab my hand!" Adora voice shouts over the edge, "Catra!"

"Adora?" Catra looks up but sees nothing but spots, "Is… is that you? For real?"

"Yes! I can't reach you!" The blonde screams out desperately trying to reach for Catra, the magicat just out of reach as she tries to get closer, "Don't let go!"

"Adora?" The magicat repeats, her claws and her muscles starting to wane as she comes to terms that she may actually fall to her death, never to be seen again, "I'm… I'm sorry… I don't think I can win this fight…"

"NO! Don't! PLEASE!" Adora shouts out, a sob breaks out as she says softer, "I can't live without you… so… please…"

"…okay." Catra resigns herself, pulling out one hand and reaching up, her fingertips touching Adora's as she grunts out, "I can't get any higher…"

"Just a little bit more, Cat…" Adora grits out the words and Catra knows that if she manages to reach the blonde's hands, she'll pull Adora over too, "Come on, Catra…"

Catra reaches up and digs it above her, getting a little more reach before doing the same on the other hand, her right hand claws dig in securely into the rock as her left one gets hold of Adora's outreached hand, "Got it…"

"I've got you!" Adora says with relief as she wraps both hands around Catra's one arm, doing her best to pull the exhausted magicat up when…

"ARGH!" Catra howls out as Bulrog falls down the chasm, his sharp, red hot claws slicing down Catra's back as he tries to drag her down with him, only to narrowly miss grasping the magicat as he disappears into the depths of the planet, a loud roar slowly getting further and further away until it's no longer able to be heard.

"Glimmer! Help me!" Adora shouts out as her grip on Catra's arm begins to slip, unable to pull her back due to her overstretched position, "HELP!"

Glimmer rushes over, helping Adora pull Catra back up to the surface. The trio flops panting to the ground as the gong sounds to signal the end of the round.

"Catra!" Adora shouts out as she pulls Catra into her arms, the magicat winces and hisses when the blonde touches the new wound on her back, "Stars… you're really hurt this time!"

"I know." Catra grins tiredly, the blood loss from her wounds starting to affect her, she reaches up and touches Adora's face, "Is it really you?"

Adora nods, “Yes.”

“How?”

“Explain later!” Glimmer pushes herself up to her feet with a grunt as she takes in the pool of blood under the magicat starting to get bigger, “We need to go. You need medical attention before you bleed out.”

“I do need medical attention, don’t I?” Catra laughs, she doesn’t even know why, “I-I can’t get up… everything hurts.”

“Come on.” Glimmer crouches down and with Adora’s help, they get Catra up and to her feet, “I’m not carrying you. You’re fucking heavy even though you don’t look it.”

The magicat laughs again, “Where’s Bow and Traps…?”

“Talk about them when we get you back to your room.” Glimmer replies as Adora ducks under Catra’s other arm and helps her to walk, the sparkly woman looks at Adora, the limp barely noticeable, “Your leg…”

“Later.” Adora waves her friends off, “We can’t talk here.”

Glimmer nods, grunting a little in effort at taking Catra’s weight, despite Adora holding her up as well.

Catra’s lying on her stomach as her back is patched up, with her face in a pillow she asks, “How did you get back to yourself, princess?”

Adora reaches behind her neck and sighs, “The staff’s magic, I think. I don’t know why… but I was trying to push you under Bulrog’s foot when you activated the staff’s magic and then *whoosh* I’m flung backward and this green chip thing detached from my neck and then I came back to myself.”

“What green chip thing?” Catra asks, her voice still muffled into the pillow.

“Look.” Adora pulls the small green chip out of her pocket and holds it out to Catra, “It came off when I hit the ground and I must have landed on it somehow.”

Hissing, Catra manages to push herself up and sit on the bed, Adora wrapping an arm around her shoulder to keep her steady as the magicat gingerly takes the foreign object out of Adora’s hand and inspects it. Without taking her eyes off the small object, she asks, “Where’s Sparkles?”

“Getting some more bandages and then I think trying to muster up some food.” Adora replies, her eyes dart down to the chip in Catra’s hand, “What do you think that is?”

“Some kind of mind controlling device is what I think.” Catra says with a wince as she tries to straighten up and then folds her fingers over it, “Show me where it was on your neck, princess?”

Nodding, Adora pulls her hair back and to the side, leaning forward and running her fingers over the red mark that still looks angry, small scabs forming over the edges of it, “I think it was around here somewhere. I can’t see where since it’s kind of on the back of my neck…”

“Lean forward a little more?” Catra gently pushes Adora forward so she can get a little look and then notices a green spot staining the wound, and without warning, Catra flicks her claws out and digs in just enough to remove the spot, her other hand holding the blonde down as Adora cries out in an attempt to push the magicat off.

“OW! HEY!” Adora flails under Catra’s hold as the magicat flings the green ooze off her claw and to the floor, “What the hell?!”

Catra lets her back up again, “You had some green ooze in your neck still and I had to make sure it was all gone.”

Adora reaches behind her neck and sure enough she's bleeding from where the chip was, "I'm bleeding!"

"Grab me the med kit and I'll clean it and bandage it up." Catra replies without apologising for doing what she did, and when Adora just glares at her the magicat sighs, "Do you want to bleed out too? Give me the med kit, princess."

Adora turns around and grabs the med kit, unzips it and gives it to Catra, the magicat winces as she starts to clean and bandage up the wound on the blonde's neck, Catra clears her throat, "What was it like? Being chipped."

Adora breathes out and furrows her brows, "Like a nightmare."

"How so?" The magicat continues to work on Adora's neck.

"It was…" Adora starts and then pauses to think about how to explain it, "It was like I was watching myself do all these things and I had no control over it."

"Sounds frustrating." Catra surmises.

"It was." Adora hisses a little as Catra dabs her neck with antiseptic, "I felt like a prisoner in my own body."

"Yeah." Catra nods.

The blonde's eyes widen in realisation of something, "Bow and Entrapta! They're both chipped!"

"I know."

"You know?" Adora tries to turn her head, only for the magicat to hold her in place as she huffs out, "How do you know?"

"You were all acting weird." Catra simply says as she finishes up bandaging up Adora's wound.

"Oh." Adora looks down at her hands, "I'm sorry."

“Not your fault.” Catra shrugs as the door opens and Glimmer comes in with a few more supplies and some food, “All good, Sparkles?”

“I had to dodge Prime.” Glimmer replies and then frowns, “He’s got Bow and Entrapta working for him.”

“We already knew that.” Catra says as she goes back to laying on her stomach on the bed, “But you know what?”

“What?” Glimmer asks as she places the food on the table for them.

“There’s a way to unchip them if you can get that staff working again with magic.” Catra says with a grin.

“Is that how we got Adora back?” Glimmer sits next to Adora, wrapping an arm around the blonde in a side hug.

“Kind of.” Catra’s voice muffled into the pillow, “We’ll have to smash the chips too.”

“That… that doesn’t sound safe…” Glimmer mutters under her breath, “I don’t want to paralyse our friends!”

“We’ll figure something out.” Catra says.

“We will.” Adora reassures and Glimmer nods.

“Okay, I’ll have to retrieve the staff after. It’s still rooted in the ground where you left it.” Glimmer replies as stands up from the bed, “Food?”

“Definitely. Don’t retrieve it alone. We’ll come with you.” Catra says into the pillow as she tries to reach out for Adora and then smiles, “Are you forgetting something, princess?”

“Hm?”

“My motivation?” Catra’s ears flicker happily on the top of her head and Adora’s chuckles as she remembers their deal.

“Right, right.” Adora sits closer to Catra’s head, “I can’t kiss you with your face buried in that pillow.”

Wincing once more, Catra pushes herself up and grins at Adora in anticipation, “Okay, okay… I think I’m good now.”

Adora rolls her eyes, “You’re going to hurt yourself.”

“No, I’m not.” Catra replies, “I’m going to get my reward for winning first.”

“Idiot.” Adora mumbles as she leans forward and presses her lips on the magicat’s in a slow and soft kiss, ignoring Glimmer making gagging noises in the background.

Chapter End Notes

I had to do a LOTR reference in here - it just came about 😂😁

SEMI FINAL next chapter!

Thanks for reading, kudos, comments, bookmarking and subscribing!

And yes, I've upped the chapter count.

Semi Final

Chapter Summary

Semi Final vs... you'll have to find out!

Chapter Notes

CW - Violence/blood

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra stares at Glimmer holding the staff that had helped her defeat Bulrog, the sparkly woman twirling it around in her hands as they wait for Adora to return from her shower. The magicat clears her throat and then asks, "Where'd you get that?"

"Get what?" Glimmer stops twirling the staff.

"That. The staff in your hands, Sparkles." Catra clarifies, "And how'd you know it would work?"

"Oh this?" Glimmer holds the staff up and Catra nods, "I saw it the first day we were here. When you were off fighting against Barb."

"Yeah? And?" Catra gestures for Glimmer to continue.

"Well, this is going to sound really dumb…" Glimmer starts to say, "But I saw something like that monster in a movie."

The magicat pinches the bridge of her nose and shakes her head, "Were you expecting me to yell, *you shall not pass* as well?"

"Ha!" Glimmer laughs out, "That would have been funny! But… yeah, that's the one."

"How did you know that thing even had magic at all?" Catra points to the staff.

“I didn’t.” Glimmer shrugs, “Figured you’re a magicat, so… magic kind of comes with it, right?”

“Wrong.” Catra says incredulously, “I don’t have magic.”

“Nah uh!” The sparkly woman retorts, “You definitely do. How else do you explain what happened?”

“Coincidence.” Catra says as the door to the bathroom opens and Adroa steps out in just a towel, surprised to see Glimmer still in the room and readjusting it so she doesn’t accidentally flash her best friend. She looks over at Catra questioning as the magicat simply says, “Sparkles feels safer with us.”

“Oh.” Adora says surprised before turning to her best friend, “You’re welcome to stay with us in this room, Glimmer.”

“Thanks, Adora.”

“I’m just going to get dressed.” Adora says walking over to her bag to retrieve her clothes, her leg no longer in pain as she easily makes the distance.

“How’s your leg, princess?” Catra asks watching the blonde move around with ease.

“Better.” Adora replies with a soft smile.

“That’s good.” Glimmer breathes out, “But… how?”

“I think it’s to do with the chip and that green ooze.” Adora turns her back to her friends and slides on her underwear.

“Stars…” Glimmer shuts her eyes and turns her head, “A little warning would be nice.”

“I’m still covered with the towel, Glim.” Adora chuckles as she reaches for her bra.

“Unfortunately.” Catra adds as her eyes keep watch over the blonde, she clears her throat, “Do you want me to turn around or cover my eyes too?”

Adora looks over her shoulder, Glimmer has her eyes covered with her hands while the magicat just stares at her, licking her lips. The blonde smirks, “Do you want to do either of those things?”

Catra shakes her head, “Stars no.”

“Then don’t.” Adora grins as she drops her towel, giving Catra a full view of her near naked body before pulling on her bra and then getting dressed the rest of the way, “Was that worth it?”

This time the magicat nods, “Stars yes…”

“Are you don’t yet?!” Glimmer grunts out, “Can you two please stop flirting already? It’s not fair when my Bow is under Primes hands.”

“Sorry Glimmer.” Adora apologises, guilt in her voice as she gently pulls Glimmer’s hands off her eyes and offers a consoling smile, “We’ll get him and Entrapta back. We will.”

“I hope so.” Glimmer sighs.

“We will. Nothing will happen to them.” Catra speaks up, “Not as long as I’m still fighting in this stupid tournament.”

“I guess.” Glimmer sighs once more, “Do we even know who you’re fighting next?”

“Nope.” Catra replies, “I think I’d rather not know.”

“You’re not a little curious?” Adora asks as she looks over at the magicat, “I know I’d be wanting to know. Do some research, you know?”

“I know.” The magicat chuckles, “But you’re a prepper. Me? Not so much.”

Adora looks around, “Where’s my phone?”

“Where’d you leave it last?” Glimmer asks right back.

“Uh…” Adora thinks back to before she was chipped, “Oh! It’s in my bag!”

The blonde quickly walks over and rummages through her bag and pulls out her phone, holding it in the air triumphantly, “AHA!” she taps on it a few times and then her face drops, “My battery is dead. I better charge it up.”

Catra looks over at Glimmer, “What time is my fight today?”

“How should I know?” Glimmer replies staring into the end of the staff.

“Can you check for me, Sparkles?” Catra presses as she leans forwards and gently pulls the staff out of Glimmer’s hands, the weight of it feeling comfortable in her hand, her question more of an attempt to take the other’s woman’s mind off Bow, “So? Look it up, would you?”

“Fine.” Glimmer concedes, pulling out her phone and tapping on it a few times, her eyes running through the information in her hands as her eyebrows furrows and then reads aloud, “Semi final starts at 7pm. Prime time. HA!” the sparkly woman scoffs out, “Of course he’d name it after himself, jackass…”

Catra laughs under her breath, “7pm, huh?”

“Yeah.” Gimmer replies with a nod, “Against…”

“Against?” Catra repeats with a drawl.

“Against…” Glimmer says dragging out the word as she searches for the name of the opponent.

“Stars… you’re killing me here, Sparkles.” Catra sarcastically says with a roll of her eyes as Adora sits down next to her friend and

looks over her shoulder, she instead directs her question at the blonde, "Well? Who is it?"

"I don't remember seeing this fighter?" Glimmer looks at Adora, showing her the screen, "Do you? I thought they were banned from all forms of tournament…?"

Adora nods, "Yeah… that's what she's supposed to be…"

"Fuck! Who?" Catra gets to her feet frustrated at the fact she's on the outside of their conversation, "Why do you two look so… so… surprised?"

"Uh…" Glimmer grimaces as she looks at the magicat and then turns to Adora instead.

"Her name is Red." Adora says with a sigh, "She's… different."

"Different, how?" Catra frowns.

Adora grabs Glimmer's phone and taps on it a few times before her eyes widen, "Oh shit…"

"Wha- oh no…" Glimmer agrees with the same wide eyed look, "Really? No… that's… that's really bad…"

"For fuck's sakes!" Catra growls out, "What is going on?! Who the fuck is Red?!"

"She's a…" Adora catches Catra's eyes, "A-a werewolf."

"A werewolf?" Catra repeats and both women nod their heads back, the magicat shrugs, "So? Can't be worse than my last round."

"That's… true." Glimmer agrees, "But… that was yesterday and this is today. So, get over it and focus on the next round."

"Fuck you, Sparkles." Catra grumbles as she puts the staff down onto the couch as she starts to pace around, "I barely survived

Bullshit.” The magicat grumbles again before taking in a calming breath, “Two more rounds then.”

“Yes.” Adora looks up at the magicat who’s now hovering over them, “And then we’re free.”

Catra shakes her head, “I don’t know, princess.”

“What do you mean?” Glimmer frowns, “What do you mean, you don’t know? Prime said…”

“Prime says a lot of things.” Catra cuts Glimmer off abruptly, “A lot of it is bullshit. So, I wouldn’t take his word that once this tournament is over, it’ll actually be over. And if I remember right… it’s a win-win for him each way.”

“Why do you say that?” Adora asks grasping Catra’s wrist and pulling her towards the pair sitting together, “He said…”

“He said this was a test.” Catra shakes her head and pinches the bridge of her nose, “If I lose, well, I lose and probably die in the process. If I win… well, there’s no saying what he’s planning to do with that… fact.”

“Hm…” Adora hums to herself and closes her eyes, “That… that kind of triggered something…”

Catra crouches down in front of Adora, her hands on the blonde’s knees, “What? What is it?”

“I remember knowing what would happen if you won clearly. But now… it’s… fuzzy.” With her eyes still closed, Adora takes a few breathes in and out, trying to remember, “When I was chipped… it was like I was connected to him and everyone else.”

“Go on.” The magicat gently encourages, “What else?”

“I remember… images…” Adora says, “It’s not very clear… not anymore…”

“Okay.” Catra gently presses on.

“I remember seeing…” Catra gently squeezes her hands around Adora’s thighs as she continues, “I remember seeing a dragon.”

“A dragon?” Glimmer repeats loudly before grimacing, “Sorry… sorry…”

Adora shakes her head, her eyes still closed, “Yeah, a dragon. Not a real one. It was a statue. Gold.”

“Gold. A gold dragon.” Catra clarifies and Adora nods.

“I remember feeling cold when I saw it in my mind. Like… like it was snowing.” The blonde nods again defiantly, “Yes, definitely, it was snowing.” She shivers a little, holding herself like she’s keeping warm, “I think he wants you to steal it.”

“From the snows?” Catra asks softly.

“Yes.” Adora replies with another nod as she slowly opens her eyes and sees the magicat looking back at her with concern, the blonde reaches out and gently cups Catra’s cheek, “You can’t steal it.”

“Why not?” Catra asks despite having zero intent on doing so in the first place.

“Yetis.” Adora says, her face turning serious, “They guard it. And they won’t let anyone steal it or get close to it. Only…”

“Only?” Catra leans into Adora’s hand.

“Only the worthy.” Adora finishes, “But they won’t let you steal it. It needs to stay where it is.”

Catra’s ears perk up on her head and then it clicks in her brain, “Worthy… the winner of this stupid ass tournament…”

Adora nods, “Yeah.”

“Why take Bow and Entrapta? Or you?” The magicat frowns.

“So, you have to win.” Glimmer sighs, “They took them so that you wouldn’t lose. You’d have something to fight for. And not just… get knocked out. Both literally and well… of the tournament.”

“We’ll get them back.” Adora says to Glimmer reassuringly, “They’re not in any danger. He’s only keeping them as leverage.”

“I hope you’re right.” Glimmer sighs.

“I am. I’ve seen and felt it.” Adora replies, reaching out to her friend, intertwining their fingers, “Trust me. They’ll be fine.”

“Okay.” Glimmers says with an uncertain smile, “You’re right. We’ll get them back.”

“Sure, we will.” Catra agrees looking back at the staff on the couch, the magicat gets up and collects the item and walks it back, “Here. Take it.”

“What am I going to do with this?” Glimmer says as she takes the staff back from Catra, “I’m not magical. Or a magicat.”

Catra shrugs, “Work it out, Sparkles.”

The sparkly woman huffs, “Right.”

The magicat gives her a quick smile before going back to crouching in front of Adora, “So… let’s worry about one thing at a time, okay?”

Adora smiles, “Yeah.”

“Tell me about… Red.” Catra tilts her head as she asks.

Adora squeezes Catra’s shoulders, trying to loosen the magicat’s muscles up as they wait for the next round to be announced, she

whispers into Catra's ear, "How are you feeling?"

"Nervous." Catra simply replies, not bothering with any type of bravado as her ear flicks, "So… she's going to go like, full wolf mode on me?"

"Yep." Adora says looking around the arena, "She will."

"Great." Catra nods, swallowing down audibly as the rest of the audience file in, the magicat scratches the back of her neck, "When's the other semi final?"

"After yours." Glimmer replies as she sits down on the other side of Catra, nudging the magciat with a drink bottle, "Here. Hydrate."

"I'm good." Catra pushes the drink back to Glimmer, "You guys never told me how I'm supposed to defeat this chick?"

"There's a reason she got banned in the first place." Glimmer says as she spots her opponent and points her out to the magicat, "Oh, over there! She's there!"

Catra eyes her from afar and furrows her brows, "That's Red?"

"She may look demure, but she's anything but nice." Glimmer replies, "I was there when they kicked her out of the hybrid tournament." The sparkly woman shakes her head, "She's vicious."

"Huh." Catra tilts her head as she catches the eyes of Red, the other woman grins at her and the magicat just quirks an eyebrow up at her, "She doesn't look that tough."

"Don't underestimate her." Adora warns, "And don't let her under your skin, I've seen the way she flirts and gets under the skin of her opponents."

Catra catches a hint of jealousy in the blonde's eyes as she grins, "Are you worried she's going to charm her way into my heart?"

"No." Adora huffs out, crossing her arms over her chest.

“Then?”

“She’s worried about Red getting into your pants, dumbass.” Glimmer says with a laugh at Adora’s expense before straightening up and poking the magicat in the chest, “Don’t you dare flirt with that… wolf!”

“Stars, calm the fuck down, Sparkles.” Catra rolls her eyes, “Like I could be that easy to flirt with.”

“She’s right.” Adora sighs, “That is one of Red’s… skills, I guess?”

“Skills, huh?” Catra chuckles to herself, “Look, she’s cute and all, but not really my type.”

“What is your type?” Glimmer asks narrowing her eyes at the magicat, “Hm?”

Without missing a beat, Catra throws a thumb up and points it behind her, straight at Adora, “I thought that would be pretty obvious, Sparkles.”

“Awe, really?” Adora’s eyes light up as she looks at Catra fondly, “I like you too.”

“Just like?” Catra tilts her head and flicks an ear.

Adora rolls her eyes at the magicat, no doubt fishing for more, “You know I really like you.”

And before Catra can retort, the gong sounds and the semi final is announced. Catra looks over at the fight area and sighs, shaking her head and then her arms out to warm up a little, “Okay… here we go…”

“You got this, Cat.” Adora pulls the magicat in for a quick peck on the cheek, “Just remember what I told you about her weaknesses.”

“Uh… you didn’t tell me anything about her weaknesses…” Catra replies before she feels Glimmer’s hand start to tug her up, “But… I’m sure I’ll figure it out… or something.”

“Get up, Catra. You’re up!” Glimmer pats Catra on the shoulders in encouragement, “You can do this!”

“Sure.” Catra nods back unconvincingly, “Wish me luck?”

“You don’t need luck, Cat.” Adora rubs Catra’s back, “You’ve got this. Just… don’t let her bite you.”

“Bite me?” Catra turns back in shock, “Wait?! That was serious?!”

“Yeah.” Adora nods, “You’ll turn into one of her kind if she bites you… or even scratch you… just try not to let her touch you at all.”

“That’s a thing?!” Catra nearly screeches, “What the fuck, princess?! Woah! Get your hands off me!”

“Get moving!” A pair of large hands pull the magicat up and off her feet, dropping her into the fighting ring.

Catra growls at him when she’s dropped harshly on the ring, “Touch me again and I’ll rip you apart…”

“That’s the spirit.” The large and muscly woman snarks back, dusting her hands off and walking over to the side of the ring and taking a seat near the judges.

“Hey.” Red whispers over to Catra with a smirk, “Save it for the fight.”

“Whatever.” Catra grumbles as she shakes off the interaction with the muscly guard before finally looking Red up and down properly, she may be small, but she’s ripped. Looking like an average sized amazon with wild red curly hair, looking like the girl in movie where her mom got turned into a bear. The magicat snorts out a laugh, “Fuck, I didn’t realise I was fighting a Disney princess…”

“What?” Red frowns confused.

“You’re that chick from that movie where no one can understand her due to her accent!” Catra laughs, “Where’s your bow?”

“I’m not a fucking princess, kitty cat.” Red growls back, not appreciating the reference to a fictional princess, “Now, shut up so we can start this fight and I can eat you.”

“Woah, buy me dinner first.” Catra laughs again, “Also… I prefer to do the eating. Not the other way round… wolfy…”

“Oh, so clever.” Red rolls her eyes at the nickname, “What, brain too small to think of anything better, kitty?”

“Like you can talk?” Catra spits right back, “Then again, you’re about to turn into some demonic dog creature, aren’t you? Maybe I should just call you Lassie and you’ll come back to your boring, little, curly red haired… girl.”

“Enough!” The referee growls out at the pair, “Positions! Now!”

The magicat rolls her eyes at the ref but moves to her line, Red doing the same as the ref stares the pair down before nodding at the pair as he steps back after signalling for the gong to start and then moves out of the ring to let the two fighters get to actually start fighting.

Catra puts her hands up at the ready, her claws retracted as she watches Red just stand there and stare at her before looking up to the cloudy sky, waiting. The crowd all shout for them to start fighting loudly to the point it’s almost deafening as the pair remain in their places.

Red breaks first, though still unmoving from her spot, “Come on. What are you waiting for?”

“You.” Catra simply says staring right back at Red, “What are you waiting for?”

Looking up, Red sees the clouds part and clear, the moon now in full view as she shuts her eyes, before slowly opening up her eyes and then she smiles wide, "It's coming… It's coming…"

"Catra! You need to take her out now!" Adora's voice rings through the crowd loudly, "Before she turns!"

"Fuck." The magicat growls out, grimacing at the prospect of attacking her opponent without being attacked first, she clenches her teeth and starts to charge towards Red. "Oof!"

Red simply stops Catra, holding her at bay by the throat with supernatural strength, "That's low. Even for you."

"Nothing's too low for me." Catra grunts out, slashing wildly at Red's arm, the other woman hissing and subsequently dropping the magicat, who then slides through her legs and slashes behind her knees, "Nothing."

Red screams as her knees give way and she collapses to the ground, "Fuck! You really are a low life thief, aren't you?!"

"Sure am." Catra grins, pulling out the knife that Red had concealed in her belt, "Thanks."

Red eyes her knife in Catra's hand, "Thief! Give that back!"

"Why? Sentimental value or something?" Catra says twirling the weapon in her hand like a toy before throwing it over her shoulder which makes Red grin and then Catra instantly regrets doing that, "Oh, fuck me…"

"Gladly." Red says with the same grin back, "But I don't fuck dead people. I'm not into that."

Catra turns around to see where she's tossed the knife and before she can even move to retrieve it, she yelps when she's brought down, the back of her head hitting the ground when her legs are swept out under her, "Oof… what the?"

And then Red is on top of her, a smirk on her face as she holds Catra's arms down, pinning the magicat to the ground, "Mm… and here I thought you'd put up more of a fight…" before she knows it, Red's lips are on the magicat's in a rough and definitely unwanted kiss, Catra growls out as she struggles out of Red's hold, "I do like a fighter though…"

"Yeah?" Catra growls out once more before headbutting the other woman and throwing her off, "Well, fight this!"

The magicat slashes Red across the face, the woman screams out in pain, blood dripping from her wounds, "You fucking asshole!"

Catra gets to her feet and wipes her mouth, spitting out the taste of the other woman from her lips before rushing towards her and throwing a punch hard against Red's right cheek, "That. Was uncalled for."

Red smirks back rubbing her reddened cheek with a wince, "Doesn't matter. It's too late now."

"What?"

Red looks up at the sky, more specifically, the moon, a grin on her face as her eyes close and Catra knows it's already too late, it's started. Despite the magicat trying to get to Red, there's an invisible forcefield in the way blocking her as her opponent starts to change. No. Not change. Transform.

The sound of bones cracking. Clothes ripping and then the low and angry growl shortly later has the entire audience silent, watching the scene in front of them as the small red headed woman turns into a nearly 12ft tall werewolf, red eyes and large teeth on display. A tuft of red curls on top of Red's wolf head as the barrier between Catra and Red disappears and the magicat stumbles forward.

Catra swiftly evades the large jaws that almost come snapping down over her head, the magicat feeling the warm breath across

the top of her fur as she rolls out of the way before getting to her feet again, “What the fuck?!”

Red growls out, standing tall on two legs as a howl comes out towards the moon. The sound deafening, the majority of the crowd covering their ears as they watch on. Red drops back down to fours as she snarls at Catra, “I wasn’t joking about the eating you part.”

“Oh… I’m fucked…” Catra mutters to herself as she stands her ground and then snarls right back, unsheathing her claws and displaying her sharp teeth, “No one is eating me.” She turns to Adora and grins, “I do the eating.”

“I’m going to crush you.” Red steps forward, her claws digging into the dirt, “Then I’m going to eat you. Though… I think I’m going to have to skin you first. I don’t enjoy fur in my mouth.”

“What a shame.” Catra cynically replies as she continues to stand her ground, “More work for you.”

“Now. Stop being so difficult and let me kill you already.” Red simply says before lunging for the magicat, her speed almost catching Catra off guard. Almost. The fact that she doesn’t connect makes Red angry, “You think you can get away from me? You really think you can win?”

Red laughs out at the thought of losing as Catra just growls back, “You’re so sure of yourself, huh?”

“I’m here, aren’t I?” Red replies prowling once more, circling like a predator, “There’s a reason I’m going to win.”

“Pretty sure there was also a reason why you were banned in the first place.” Catra snarks right back, deciding to goad the wolf, “Hm… let me guess why… Woah! Hey! I’m thinking here!” Catra slaps Red on the head with her hand like a naughty child that’s done the wrong thing when she lunges at her.

Red makes a noise of confusion at being slapped on the head by the magicat, “What the fuck was that?!”

“I told you, I’m thinking!” Catra repeats, “Now… why would you get banned from a tournament for fighting…?”

“Just give up already, kitty.” Red says with a grunt as she lunges at Catra once more, leaping up and over as the magicat easily ducks down and moves out of the way, “I’m going to win this tournament. And then everyone will see!”

“See what, exactly? Oof! Fuck!” Catra asks before she’s knocked to the ground with the unexpected whip of Red’s thick tail, the other woman back on top of her again, this time slashing at Catra with her claws as the magicat growls out in pain, “FUCK!”

“You know what? Fuck eating you…” Red says breathing down into Catra’s face, “I think I’m going to turn you instead.”

“Yeah, gross. No thanks.” Catra turns her head to avoid the drop of salvia from Red’s mouth, instead landing on the magicat’s cheek as Catra grimaces and tries to wipe it from her face, “Yuck! Stop drooling on me dog!”

“When I turn you, you will be mine.” Red ignores Catra as she sniffs the top of the magicat’s head, “Mm… you have two smells…” she sniffs once more and hums out in confirmation, “Who is she? Is it… the blonde? Adora?”

Adora’s name has Catra’s eyes widening and her ears perk up before she growls out, using both legs to kick Red off of her, getting to her feet, “Don’t you fucking say her name.”

“Did I touch a nerve?” Red straightens up once more, towering over the magicat, “Don’t worry about her. Once you’re mine, I’ll make you kill her. Then bring her back to me so I can eat her.”

“That’s what it was, wasn’t it?” Catra says with the realisation, “You ate your competitors.”

Red doesn't answer and that's answer enough.

"You sick fuck." Catra shakes her head, "Really? Do you really even need to eat people? Are you even in wolf form when you do it? I bet you aren't. You're like some… cannibal…"

The word has Red letting out a chuckle that sounds distorted in her werewolf form, "Cannibal would only refer to me if I was eating people of my own kind. And no, I don't consume other werewolves." She pauses and looks over Catra, "I just make them my slaves."

"Sorry to disappoint you then, but I'm not going to be your slave or whatever sick thought you have." Catra replies as she charges towards Red, claws out as she leaps up and slashes wildly, connecting several times as she forces the werewolf back before Red throws her arms out and manages to throw the magicat off, her body landing hard against the dirt, rolling over and feeling something hard under her as she reaches to retrieve the knife she'd carelessly thrown away earlier, "Ow… that fucking sucked…"

"You can't kill me." Red declares, "Not with those puny little claws of yours."

"Maybe I need a weapon…" Catra murmurs and then spots Glimmer, "Sparkles! Throw me the spear!"

"What spear?!" Glimmer shouts back confused.

"That spear in your hand, dumbass!" Catra shouts as she starts to dodge and weave around Red's attacks, "Throw it to me!"

"It's a fucking staff, you dumbshit!" Glimmer shouts back, "And it won't work on a werewolf! Don't you remember what we told you!

"You didn't tell me shit!" Catra shouts out with an angry grunt and then a hiss as Red charges head first into her side, knocking her sideways and to the ground before rolling away and back to her feet, "Just throw me the fucking stick!"

“No! You’ll break it and we need it to save Bow and Entrapta!” Glimmer holds the staff protectively as she turns to Adora, “Tell your girlfriend to hurry the fuck up and win.”

Adora shakes her head, “She needs Red’s knife!”

The pair both look at Catra and see Red’s knife in her hand, their eyes widening as they stare at each other in surprise before they shout at Catra, their voices overlapping each other as they try to shout out what she needs to do.

Catra’s ears pick up both voices but it’s hard to make sense when they’re words are drowning each other out as she growls out and gives up on trying to make sense of either one as she manages to shove Red back with enough force to have her actually back up a few steps, “My claws might not be able to get through that thick ass of yours…”

“In this form, I am indestructible!” Red declares triumphantly, “Nothing can stop a werewolf!”

“Yeah? What about silver bullets?” Catra grasps her side from where she’s landed on it, her hands turning red from her blood bleeding through the slashes made from the werewolf and she frowns at it, “Fuck… this better not mean I’m going to turn into one of you fucks.”

“That’s a myth.” Red goes back to fours, “I decide who to turn. Scratches and slashes don’t do shit. Nothing but myths and stories.”

Catra shrugs, “Good to know.”

“Give me back my knife.” Red eyes her knife once again in Catra’s hand, “Now.”

“What is it with you with this knife, huh?” Catra asks as she looks at the knife in her hand and notices something inscribed on the blade, “RED.” She looks over at the werewolf, “Bit vain, isn’t it?”

Red reaches out, trying to snatch her knife back as Catra simply steps away, “Give it back! It’s mine!”

“Surrender and I’ll give it back to you.” Catra suggests with a smirk.

“No. I will kill you and then pry it from your cold, dead fingers.” Red threatens, “Now, give it back.”

“Mm… no.” Catra holds the knife out with just as much threat as Red had used on her, “Give up or die by your sword… uh, I mean… knife.”

“Fuck this.” Red turns her back to Catra, looking around at the crowd and then grinning when she sees someone, leaping over to the audience, scattering people until only Adora and Glimmer remain. Red sniffs over the pair and then looks at Adora, “It’s you.”

“Me?” Adora frowns as she quickly defends herself from Red’s onslaught of attacks, “What?! I’m not even competing!”

“Hey! Leave her alone!” Catra pounces, wrapping her arms around Red’s neck and pulling her back and away from Adora before flipping the werewolf over as she stands with her back to her friends, arms stretched out with her blood dripping from her fingers, “Stay behind me.”

“Catra!” Adora reaches out and puts her hand reassuringly on the magicat’s shoulder.

“Don’t risk it.” Catra turns her head quickly, “I don’t want to be disqualified on a technicality like getting help from the audience in the form of fists and kicks.”

“We’ve interfered before.” Glimmer huffs out and she holds the staff up, “See!”

“Not the same.” Catra says, “You didn’t fight. She’s goading you.”

"But…" Glimmer starts.

"No." Catra shuts the sparkly woman down, "No. I'll finish this."

"Cat…" Adora starts, but when Catra looks back at her with conviction in her eyes, the blonde sighs with a nod, "Okay. I trust you. We won't interfere."

"Thanks." Catra replies as she turns back to Red who's back on her feet, "Okay. I can do this… I can… fuck…"

Catra starts to run, charging towards Red as the werewolf does the same, clashing hard, the magicat coming off second best as she's knocked off her feet once more and onto her back, Red landing directly on top with an ear piercing roar as the magicat grits her teeth and shuts her eyes tight, waiting for the final blow…

When nothing happens, the weight on top of her getting lighter as Catra finally opens her eyes, "What the…?"

CLANG!

The gong sounds the end of the semi final as Catra looks around confused at the curtain of red curly hair covering her face as the butt of the knife digs into her stomach. Her ears quickly pick up the sound of footsteps running towards her as she blows the curtain of hair away, trying to see through it.

"Catra! Stars!" Adora's voice comes through, "Glim! Give me a hand!"

"Gross… she's naked." Glimmer groans out as Catra feels the weight on top of her lessen and then disappear completely once Red is rolled off her and to the side.

Catra breathes in heavily, “Did I win?”

Adora crouches down, looking over at a now lifeless Red on the ground next to them, the knife still embedded in her chest, piercing her heart, Adora nods as she replies somewhat solemnly, “Yeah. You won.”

“Help me up?” Catra asks and both Glimmer and Adora assist in getting the magicat into a sitting position so she can see her now defeated opponent, “Fuck. Guess she landed on her own weapon.” She observes before seeing a lot of gawking eyes on the body, “Take off your cape, Sparkles.”

“What? Why?” Glimmer says but starts to unclip the garment.

“Give her a little dignity, would you?” Catra winces in pain.

“Oh. Right.” Glimmer drapes her cape over Red’s naked form, a few sounds of disappointment can be heard as the sparkly woman scoffs, “Get out of here, perverts!”

While Glimmer assists in getting Red out of the area with the help of the tournament attendants, Adora takes a moment to assess the magicat, “That was close.”

“Still a win.” Catra says with a crooked smile, “Motivational prize, please.”

“You’re an idiot.” Adora says as she presses her lips against Catra’s, quickly breaking it off to add, “We need to get you fixed up. You’re really hurt.”

“Shh…” Catra shushes the blonde before pulling Adora back in for another kiss, “Less talking more healing lips on mine, princess.”

“Idiot.” Adora chuckles into Catra’s lips, “You need actual medical attention.”

“Uh huh…” Catra chuckles under her breath as she tries to lean in for another kiss only for the blood loss from her wounds make her

collapse into Adora’s warm and safe arms. The blonde shakes her head before calling Glimmer over for help.

Chapter End Notes

One more round to go!!!
Will she come out on TOP?!

I'm back home again this week so I should be able to get writing more again - until I head off again next week.
I've got newbs working with me so... yeah, brain is getting fried from teaching them...

Thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing!
Also for your patience! Not that you have a choice... but still... thanks for waiting.

The (first) Final

Chapter Summary

The final fight of the tournament.

Chapter Notes

It's long... like nearly 9K words long...
Enjoy!

CW - blood, violence, swearing...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“You’re kidding me.” Catra says incredulously, “How the fuck am I supposed to beat that?! How is it even fair to have a competitor that’s fucking invisible!?”

“I don’t know.” Adora breathes out a little defeatedly, “Which makes it even harder to study and figure out strategies.”

“Can’t I like, cover them in dirt or paint or something?” Catra suggests, “I’d see them that way, right?”

“Theoretically, yes.” Glimmer confirms, “Except… they’ve tried that.”

“They?”

“The other competitors, dumbass.” The sparkly woman rolls her eyes, “Who else? Have you not been watching the other matches at all?”

“Obviously not, I’ve been knocked out most times. Besides… you’re kind of snippy this morning, aren’t you, Sparkles?” Catra snarks back, “Didn’t get a good night’s sleep or something?”

“Shut it, Catra.” Glimmer huffs out, “Like you’d sleep any better if Adora was still under Prime’s control and not in bed with you.”

“That’s true.” Catra agrees as she looks over at the sleeping blonde in bed next to her, “I don’t think I would be doing too well if she was still… chipped.” The magicat sighs, “But, I feel you, Sparkles. I do. Really.”

“Yeah.” Glimmer breathes out as she flops back onto the second queen bed in the room, “Also how *do* you sleep next to her? She sleep fights, like all the time.”

“Does she?” Catra asks as she glances down once more at Adora’s sleeping form, “I didn’t notice.”

“How can you not?” Glimmer turns her head to look at Catra, “She whacked me so hard it woke me up and nearly gave me a black eye.”

The magicat chuckles and shakes her head, “Well, if she does sleep fight, I haven’t felt it.”

“Mm…” The sparkly woman hums out, “I guess maybe it’s just when she’s sleeping next to anyone else but you.”

Catra shrugs, “Maybe. I do have a calming effect on her.”

“I guess so.” Glimmer agrees easily before closing her eyes and letting out a breath, “Wake me up in an hour.”

“For breakfast?”

“Yeah. You don’t want me hangry as well, do you?” Glimmer replies flatly.

“Stars, I can barely stand you in your normal glittery state.” Catra jests with a chuckle and then winces, “What time is the final anyways?”

“Tomorrow.” Glimmer replies, “You get a day off today. Which means, I get a day off too. But it’s not really a day off because Bow isn’t here.”

“We’ll get him back.” Catra reassures once more, “We will. Or die trying.”

“Not funny.” The other woman replies but there’s a slight smile on her face and Catra takes it as a win.

“So… one hour from now?”

“Yes.”

“You got it.” Catra confirms.

“You should rest too.” Glimmer turns over, her voice muffling into the pillow.

“I literally went unconscious after the fight. Pretty sure I’ve slept plenty overnight already.” Catra returns, “Can you at least throw me the remote for the tv?”

“Ugh!” Glimmer gets up and grabs the remote, holding it out to the magicat who takes it with the biggest grin, “There. Now. One hour. From now.”

“Got it.” Catra nods and then switches the tv on, turning the volume down and putting the subtitles on, “One hour.”

“So, what am I supposed to do today?” Catra asks Adora while they sit together for breakfast, Glimmer had growled at the magicat and threatened her with violence if she woke the sparkly woman up, so the pair left their friend to rest a little more, “Sparkles says I’ve got the day off since the final is scheduled for tomorrow.”

“She’s right. You do have today off.” Adora confirms, “What did you want to do?”

“I was thinking about maybe I’d take a walk around this place.” Catra says, “I’m so sick of seeing the same places. Place to sleep.

Place to fight. Place to get stuck with needles and get bandaged up… you know, those places."

Adora chuckles, "Yes. I know those places too."

"Then, you agree." Catra says, "We should totally get out of here."

"You know we can't." Adora chastises, "Not when our friends are in danger."

"I didn't mean leave for good, princess." Catra breathes out, "I just meant, get out of this place."

"That's pretty much the same thing." The blonde giggles, her hand drapes over the magicat's, "But I get it."

"Yeah?"

"Yes." Adora nods, "And look, it's only one more round and then that's it and we'll be done."

"No, we won't." Catra sighs, "Winning is only the beginning. Who knows what Prime has installed for me."

"I have an idea." Adora stands up, tugging Catra up with her.

"What kind of idea?" Catra looks on suspiciously.

"Come on." The blonde smiles over to the magicat.

"Okay." Catra shrugs and then lets the blonde pull her along and out of the door.

"Where are we going, princess?" Catra laughs out as Adora drags her away from the mess hall, "You're going to pull my arm out of the socket."

"Sorry! Sorry!" Adora quickly let go of Catra's hand, the magicat rolling her eyes and grabbing Adora's hand back again in hers,

“Uh… what?”

“What?” The magicat repeats back to the blonde.

Adora holds up their joined hands, “This. What is… this?”

“I don’t know what you’re talking about, princess.” Catra replies nonchalantly, “How else am I going to keep my hand connected to yours?”

Adora laughs out, “Stars…”

“Nah, stars won’t do it.” Catra says with a laugh, “Sometimes you have to take what you want in your hands and hold onto it for dear life.”

“Dear life, huh?”

“Well, we only have one life. Don’t we?” Catra replies with a tilt of her head.

“Yeah, we do.” Adora smiles back as she brushes back a few strands of hair from her ponytail and then takes in a deep breath as she gathers her confidence but yelps instead when she feels Catra’s lips on hers, before relaxing from the surprise and then hums out happily. When they break apart Adora can’t help but smile back at Catra as she breathes out, “You know my lips don’t actually heal you…”

“That’s up for debate.” Catra replies with a grin, “But… I have no qualms about double or even triple checking… for science, you know?”

“For science?” The blonde’s quirks an eyebrow and then giggles, “Sure, it is.”

Catra leans back in for another kiss, smiling into it, “I’m feeling heaps better already.”

"You're an idiot." Adora replies pecking the magicat's lips, "Besides, you're ruining the motivation of my lips."

"I'm in the final, princess." Catra replies, "Pretty sure it's time for the next… motivation."

"…stars…" Adora breathes out with a shiver going down her spine, "If we get through this…"

"*When* we get through this." The magicat quickly corrects, "I'm not going to lose. I've already come too far to lose."

Adora nods, her confidence not as high as Catra's as she gives her a less than convincing look, "I know…"

"What's wrong, Adora?" Catra tilts the blonde's chin up with her finger, "You don't seem all that sure about me winning…"

"It's silly." Adora tries to brush off, but Catra stops her from moving away too far, "I'm just… worried."

"I am too." Catra admits, the words making the blonde turn sharply back to look the magicat in the eyes, "I am. It's… It's a lot. But we're at the pointy end of things so, I'm not going to go down without a fight."

Adora chuckles under her breath at the irony, "I wish I never let you take my place."

"Don't do that." Catra chastises softly, her head shaking and rubbing against Adora's forehead, "Don't do that to yourself. This is *not* your fault. And it's not my fault either." Adora furrows her brows at the magicat confused, "Prime. He's to blame. Just, don't forget that."

"He's still got our friends." Adora says a little angrily.

"We'll get them back."

"He's going to use you to steal that stupid dragon."

“Golden dragon.”

“The yetis are going to kill us.”

“Try to kill us.”

“Stop that.” Adora lightly slaps Catra on the shoulder.

“Stop what?” Catra replies, “You’re going on a downward spiral, princess. I thought you were supposed to the positive one in the relationship.”

“I am not neg-wait what did you say?” Adora pauses and stares at Catra with wide eyes.

“Come on, Adora.” Catra rolls her eyes, “You can’t be *that* oblivious.”

Adora huffs out, “I am not oblivious!”

“Do you really think your kisses are the only motivation for me to keep fighting?” Catra chuckles under her breath unbelievably, “No. If you haven’t realised, I’m not fighting to win this stupid tournament, I’m not just fighting to get my friends back. I’m also fighting for you. For the future I want to have with you. For the future I hope you want to have with me too.”

“You… you do?” Adora replies dumbly.

“Yeah.” Catra nods, “I thought the fact that I’ve nearly died for you, quite literally would be gesture enough… but I guess you must be as dense as me.”

“Hey!” Adora slaps the magicat on the shoulder affronted, “I am not dense!”

Catra laughs, “I think you are a little…”

Another slap on the shoulder, “Whatever. I am not dense.”

“Okay, okay!” Catra concedes with a grin, “You’re not dense.”

“Good.” Adora nods before grabbing Catra’s hand once more, “And yes.”

“Yes?” Catra furrows her brow at the response, “Yes… to what exactly?”

“Yes. To all of that stuff you said before about wanting a future with you.” Adora says with a small shy smile, “If-if that’s what you want after all this is over…”

“Adora.” Catra grabs Adora’s other hand and pulls the blonde closer into her body, “I’ve never wanted anything more in my life. And trust me on the wanting part, because apart from Delia and the crew, you are the only person I can imagine a future with. So, if you’re really asking if I’m sure? Then, yes. I want a future with you for as long as you’ll put up with me.”

Adora chuckles under her breath, “Honestly? I don’t think I can see a future without you. Not after everything that we’ve already been through and are still going through.” Catra just stares back at the blonde with a slight nod, “And, I guess, the same goes for me too. I want that too for as long as you’ll put up with me too.”

Catra sighs dramatically, “Well, it’s a tough job… but I guess someone’s got to do it.”

The magicat laughs out when Adora shoves her slightly before pulling her in for a kiss and then whispering into Catra’s lips, “Oh, trust me. I am a total handful.”

“I can’t wait to get my hands on you, princess.” Catra replies with another soft laugh, the blonde smiling back at her, “Speaking of hands… I think I’m going to need a hand getting back to our room.”

“Oh! What’s wrong?!” Adora quickly asks concerned as she looks Catra up and down.

“Nothing. I’m just…” Catra touches her chest and winces a little, “I think my ribs still aren’t quite healed yet is all…”

“Stars…” Adora wraps a gently arm around Catra’s waist, “You’re lucky you’re a magicat. If you weren’t… Well, I don’t want to think about it.”

“Makes two of us.” Catra agrees.

“Want me to carry you?” Adora asks teasingly.

“I think I should be alright to walk, princess.” Catra replies, “Don’t need you straining yourself.”

“It’s no strain.” Adora half shrugs, “You’re really light anyways.”

“Are you calling me fragile?” Catra muses with a quirk of an eyebrow before laughing out as they start to walk when Adora shakes her head, “Too bad I’m not light enough to fly.”

“You don’t have wings.” Adora deadpans.

“I could be like Superman or Wonder Woman.” Catra says, “They don’t have wings.”

“You’re not…” Adora rolls her eyes when Catra just looks at her with a wide grin, “You’re an idiot. Also please don’t try to fly.”

“I leap. Not fly.” Catra corrects, “I’m not crazy, princess.”

“Didn’t say you were.” Adora smiles back.

“You’re crazy.”

“Nope. That’d be you.” Adora throws back.

“No way. I’m not crazy.” Catra retorts, “You’re the one that likes to participate in these sorts of things.”

“They’re competitions.” Adora groans out, “And it’s not crazy.”

“Yeah, right.” The magicat huffs out a laugh, “Beating the crap out of another person is just a normal thing to do.”

“No! That’s not-“ Adora frowns, “Shut up. It’s not like that.”

Catra starts to laugh, “Eh, what do I know? Sports were kind of a rich person thing.”

“I guess you’re right.” Adora nods in agreeance, “Though… what about athletics or team sports?”

“Way I see it, I’m not running unless I’m being chased.” Catra replies much to Adora’s chagrin, “And also why fight unless you have to. Seems like a lot of wasted energy.”

“For fitness. Exercise. To better yourself.” Adora lists out, “It’s not purely for power and glory.”

“Who said anything about power or glory?” Catra turns her head, “Though isn’t that the point of competition? Glory. Possibly even power?”

And before Adora can retort they’re stopped when someone nearly walks into them, the taller man growls at the pair, “Watch where you’re going.”

“Watch where *you’re* going.” Catra growls right back and realises it’s not just any man, it’s Bow, “Oh, hey dude. What… uh, what’s going on?”

“Bow?” Adora says his name cautiously, “Are you… okay?”

“I’m fine.” He huffs, very unlike his normal demeanour, “Where’s Glimmer? She’s not in our room and I can’t find her.”

Catra shrugs, “No idea, dude.”

Adora makes an affronted noise when the magicat pokes her, the blonde glares back at the magicat before looking back to friend, “Where have *you* been?”

Bow looks over the pair and huffs again, “It’s none of your business. Now, do you know where she is or not?”

“Why?” Adora asks and it draws an interested look from Bow.

“Oh, so you do know where she is…” He turns and squares up to Adora, “You know there’s no use in lying to me, Adora. You’re a terrible actress. So, out with it. Where is my Glimmer?”

“Fuck off, dude.” Catra shoves him back and then notices the green glint in his eyes at the unexpected contact, “Where’s Traps?”

“Entrapta is…” Bow starts to say before a eerie grin appears on his face, “Busy.”

“Busy? How?” Catra probes trying to step forward intimidatingly despite the fact she’s being held up by Adora, “Where is she?”

“Don’t worry about Entrapta.” He simply says without blinking before turning to Adora, “Now, where is Glimmer?”

“Tell us where Entrapta is first.” Catra cuts back in as Adora struggles to keep herself from blurting out the truth, the magicat then shakes her head, “Fuck this, come on, princess. I need to get some more rest. My ribs are killing me.”

Adora nods, “Okay. Yeah, you need to rest. Especially with the final tomorrow.”

Bow grunts out as Catra pushes past him, he watches as they walk back towards their room and he quickly calls out in a tone that sounds more like Prime than Bow, “You better win tomorrow or your friends will all pay the price.”

Catra doesn’t bother responding as they continue on, instead they hear him grumble out something behind before his footsteps disappear in the opposite direction.

“Okay, good news is your boy is fine… physically.” Catra tells Glimmer as she gets back onto the bed, “Mentally… he’s got Prime

in his brain."

"Stars…" Glimmer sighs out and throws her head back, "What can we do? How do we get him back?"

"We'll think of a way." Catra replies as Adora joins her on the bed, "Did you want to get something to eat, Sparkles?"

"No, I don't have the appetite." Glimmer replies sullenly, "Maybe later."

"Sure. Whatever you want." Catra gets herself comfortable, "I asked him about Traps too."

"Oh yeah? What did he say?"

"He said that she was… busy." Adora replies with furrowed brows, "Whatever that means… it was just, incredibly vague."

"Well, the main thing is that they both are alive and from what it seems, they are more or less okay." Catra surmises, "Which means they still have use for Prime for now."

"That's not comforting, at all." Glimmer groans out, "We don't have a lot of time to save them."

"No." Catra confers, "We don't."

"Again, not comforting, at all." Glimmer repeats, "You're really not good at this."

The magicat shrugs, "I do what I can."

"It'll be alright, Glim." Adora says, "We'll get them back before anything worse happens to them."

"You don't know that!" The other woman whines out and justifiably so, "We need to get them back now!"

"And how do you propose us doing that?" Catra asks closing her eyes, "We still don't know where they're being held. Unless Adora

can shed some light on that. Can you, princess?"

Adora shakes her head, "I wish I could remember."

"It's not your fault." Glimmer consoles her friend, "At least we got you back."

"And I'm really happy for that." Adora says and then huffs out, "But I just, it's just… so frustrating! It was all so clear when I was chipped but now? ARGH! I'm so, so…"

"It's okay, Adora." Glimmer comes over and sits on the bed next to Adora, grabbing her hand reassuringly and repeats, "It's not your fault."

"She's right, princess. It's not your fault." Catra agrees and then adds, "We'll get them back. Not right now, but we will. So, just chill the fuck out for now, would you, Sparkles?"

Glimmer grabs a spare pillow and whacks it at the magicat's chest, "You're an ass."

"I know." Catra says with a grin, pushing the pillow off to the side.

"What's the plan for the rest of the day?" Glimmer asks as the pair get comfortable in bed, "You're not seriously planning to sleep the day away, are you?"

"Well, Arrow's is looking for you so if I was you, I'd get set to spend the rest of the day in here too." Catra replies, "No telling what he wants with you if Prime has his green juice inside of him still."

"Gross. Do you have to say it like that?" Glimmer grumbles as she gets up and goes back to her bed.

"Yep." The magicat grins, "I saw the green glint in his eyes. So… yeah, Prime's green juice."

"He's chipped." Adora corrects.

“Sure is.” Catra says as she shuffles a little bit to get comfortable, “But don’t worry, we’ll get both of them back. Now, shut up so I can sleep and recover.”

“You’re a magicat. You should already have recovered.” Glimmer points out.

“Should.” Catra repeats, “Should have. Not quite yet. Red really did a number on me.”

“You’re not going to turn into one, a werewolf… are you?” Adora asks, “I mean… she did, uh, kiss you…”

“Yeah, she did.” Catra says annoyed, “What the fuck was that about?!”

“Told you she was trying to get into your pants.” Glimmer smugly says, “You’re lucky that’s all she did.”

“That was totally uncalled for.” Adora adds angrily, “I mean, how dare she do… that!”

“I know!” Catra agrees, “Didn’t even buy me a drink first.”

“Catra!” Adora slaps the magicat on the chest making Catra wince a little, “Oh shit! I’m so sorry! Did I hurt you?!”

“No.” Catra chuckles out as she grabs hold of Adora’s hand and brings it closer to herself, “You’re good.”

The blonde huffs again, “I was so going to, to, to…”

“You should have seen the crazy eyes Adora was glaring at her with.” Glimmer laughs out, “I had to hold her back from interfering in your fight. Lest you get disqualified.”

Catra turns her head and cracks an eye open, “Don’t worry, princess.” The magicat presses her lips onto the back of Adora’s hand, “The only lips I want on mine, are yours.”

“Gross.” Glimmer scoffs out, “But also, good to know. Because if you try anything…”

“I’m not.” Catra quickly shuts the other woman down, “Like I said, the only lips I want are Adora’s and I have only eyes for her. Enough said.”

“And I you.” Adora replies with a beaming smile and then clears her throat, “Okay, you need to rest.”

“I guess an after breakfast nap wouldn’t hurt.” Catra laughs out as Adora leans in and presses a kiss on the magicat’s lips unexpectedly, “What was that for?”

“Just a reminder.” Adora says softly.

“A reminder? Or motivation?” Catra grins.

“Up to you how you want to process it.” The blonde mirrors Catra’s grin, “But, seriously, rest. Your body still needs to heal.”

“As long as your next to me, I think I’ll heal faster.” Catra says as she tries to lean in once more only for Adora to pull back slightly causing the magicat to make a mrrp noise, “Wha-mmm”

Adora leans in once more and kisses Catra, “Okay, that’s enough for now. Sleep. Rest.”

“Yes, ma’am.” Catra replies as she gets herself a little more comfortable, she pulls Adora into her so she can cuddle up against the blonde, “Power nap or nap nap?”

“Nap nap. No alarms.” Adora says and Catra nods, closing her arms around Adora and relaxing into the comfort of the bed and the warmth of the blonde with her.

Catra slips out of the room, the staff in her hand as she uses it as a crutch to move around while Adora and Glimmer continue to

nap a little longer. The magicat passes by a few officials milling around and then stops when she catches a glimpse of familiar purple hair in another room. The magicat quickly ducks around the corner and out of sight before the familiar woman turns around.

“Hm.” Entrapta’s voice hums out, “I thought I heard something… oh well. Not important!”

“Have you got it operational yet, little sister?” Another voice, Prime’s, asks from within the room, “You’ve been given more than enough time and resources to get this completed.”

“No, Lord Prime.” Entrapta’s voice sounds almost robotic, “But I am *very* close to getting this weapon up and running.”

“Good. See that it’s done before the final tomorrow.” Prime says as Catra hears him get up from where he was seated and the sound of his footsteps start to head for the door, “Oh, and it had better work. You and the rest of the magicat’s friends will die by my hand regardless of whether she wins or not.”

“Yes, Lord Prime.” Entrapta replies without any emotion.

Catra leans against the wall as close as she can, willing herself to melt into the surface, though she doesn’t as Prime exits the room and starts to walk in the opposite direction, his voice still audible to the magicat when he says, “Have the transport ready. I want the cage for the winner in working order. Understand?”

“Yes, Lord Prime.” One of his lackeys confirms.

“Do not disappoint me.” The parting words said in threat as he departs back to his own quarters, while the rest of his lackeys murmur and grumble amongst themselves, too preoccupied with their own lives to care about what’s happening inside the room as Catra slips past them and inside, shutting the door softly as she does so.

Entrapta doesn't notice the magicat's entrance, nor do the tired guards situated around the room, most on the verge of falling asleep while standing up as the purple haired woman moves around the room frantically whilst talking to herself.

"…hm, this wire should go here." Entrapta starts to say, picking up a few loose wires and then a soldering iron, "Where did I put that… oh, there it is!"

Catra hides behind the unused bed for a few moments as one of the guards yawns loudly, breaking Entrapta out of her concentration and tilting her head at him, he looks at her, "What? What are you looking at? Get back to work!"

"I *am* working." Entrapta replies thoroughly confused, "What else would I be doing here?"

"Shut up." He growls at her, pushing off from where he was leaning and very likely sleeping, "Talk back to me again and I'll shave your head."

The threat gets a few snickers from the others around the room, Entrapta doesn't seem phased by it though as her eyes glow green and then she growls at him, "Enough! Keep that insolence up and I'll have you lead the mission to the golden dragon in the snows."

"Yes, Lord Prime." The soldier gets to one knee and bows, "Sorry, Lord Prime."

"Get back to work." Prime's words warn as the soldier gets back into position as Entrapta shakes off the out of body experience, "Huh. I don't think I'm going to get used to that…"

The soldier makes a noise of annoyance but leaves the purple haired woman alone.

WHACK! WHACK! WHACK! WHACK! WHACK WHACK!

"Up we go." Catra picks up the smaller woman after smacking her on the back of the neck with the staff, the chip dropping to the ground as the magicat kicks it away and then slings Entrapta over her shoulder as she cautiously opens the door and looks around, "Crap!"

"HEY!" One of the two guards on the outside shout out as they reach for their weapons.

"Nope!" Catra lets Entrapta drop to the ground as gently as she can and then she swings the staff around, knocking the guards down easily before disarming the pair and then slamming her weapon hard against their heads and knocking them out, she pulls Entrapta back up over her shoulder and awkwardly hobbles away from the room.

BANG!

"FUCK!" Catra growls out as she falls forward, dropping Entrapta to the floor as she stumbles forward, leaning heavily at the staff as she manages to grab the other woman and pull her to another corner as she chances a look to see who's fired the shot when…

BANG! BANG! BANG!

"FUCK!" Catra manages to flinch back in time to not get shot again, she grits her teeth together as she looks down at her blood dripping down her leg, she quickly slices through one of the sleeves of her shirt and ties it over the wound before reaching for the staff and holding it to her chest and breathes heavily before

she shouts out, “And here I thought you were more of a bow and arrow type of guy!” she shouts out.

“I am a ‘shooting’ type of guy.” Bow replies with a smirk on his lips as he prowls forward, holding the gun in his hands at the ready in front of him, “Why don’t you come out, Catra? Stop hiding.”

“Yeah, no thanks.” Catra replies with a wince, “I think I’ve had enough of being shot at today.”

“That’s too bad.” Bow shadows the wall, “Give back Entrapta to me and you can go back to fucking my best friend.”

“I’m not fucking anyone, dude.” The magicat shouts back with a shake of her head, “Though it sounds like your head’s being fucked with.”

“I’ve never felt clearer in my life.” Bow says with a serene look on his face, “Now, give Entrapta back or I’ll have to shoot you again. And trust me when I say, you will definitely lose the final with two bullet holes in your legs.”

Just as Bow rounds the corner, ready to shoot, he finds neither Catra nor Entrapta. Though the trail of blood is a dead giveaway to where they’ve gone as he smirks down at it. Bow crouches down and draws his fingers over the blood and chuckles lowly to himself.

WHACK! WHACK!

The magicat drops from the ceiling with a soft thud, her staff cracked from striking Bow down with two deft blows, one on his chest and one on the back of his neck.

Catra kicks the gun out of Bow’s limp hand and then hisses out when she accidentally presses against the gun shot on her leg, “Fuck…” she looks at the pair and groans, “How the fuck am I supposed to get the two of you back to the room…?”

A few minutes later in an unoccupied room…

"Ooh… ow…" Bow comes to first, his hand going to the back of his head as Catra lifts the staff up once more in readiness, then he reaches behind his neck and hisses out in pain and that's when the sound of a soft 'clang' hits the ground. Bow reaches around and picks up whatever had fallen off of him and then looks up, "Oh, Catra. It's you."

"That's it?" Catra replies confused but still at the ready to strike him again.

"I think… I think I'm bleeding out…" Bow manages to say as he reaches behind his neck once more and pulsl back his hand, showing it covered in his blood to the magicat, "I think… I think I need… help…"

Catra quickly drops to his side as he suddenly goes pale, "Woah, Arrows! No, don't pass out yet!"

"But I'm so… tired." He whines out as the magicat shakes him back awake, "Where's Glimmer?"

"If you get to your feet I can take you to her." Catra bargains, "Just… help me get Traps up."

Bow looks around and he sees Entrapta laying not too far from him, "What happened to her?"

Catra ignores him and pulls back the purple haired woman's hair and checks her neck, sighing out in relief at her makeshift bandage over the back of her neck, blood starting to seep through it, "She's good. Again."

"Huh?" Bow winces again as he touches the back of his neck.

“Put pressure on that or you’re going to bleed out.” Catra tells him while she pulls Entrapta over her shoulder once more, “Can you walk?”

“Uh, yeah, I think so.” Bow nods and gets to his feet, “Woah… I feel… woozy…”

“Nope! Don’t you fucking faint on me, Arrows.” Catra nudges him with her shoulder, “We need to go. Now!”

“Okay.” Bow replies with a squeak as she uses his hand to keep the pressure on his neck that’s still bleed profusely, “Where are we going?”

“My room.” Catra simply says as she weaves in and out of the officials and tournament guards until they finally reach her room, “Get the door, bro.”

“Okay.” Bow says as she knocks on the door.

After a moment, Glimmer’s voice comes through, “Who is it?!”

“Oh, hey Glim. It’s me and Catra and Entrapta.” Bow manages to squeak out as he leans on the door and then yelps when the door is pulled open suddenly and he falls forward, “Oof…”

“Stars! Bow!” Glimmer shouts out as Catra pushes past them and deposits Entrapta onto the second bed while she makes her way to the couch. Glimmer and Adora quickly drag Bow inside and shut the door, the former cups his cheek as she leans down and presses her lips on his, “Bow… don’t die… please…”

“He’s not going to die, Sparkles.” Catra grunts out, “Get the first aid kit.”

“Right.” Glimmer nods as Adora goes over to check Catra.

“I’m fine.” Catra brushes Adora’s very valid concerns off, “Help Traps first. I’ll be fine.”

Adora gives her an unbelieving look, patting the magicat on the hand, "I'll be right back."

"I know." Catra replies fondly as she readjusts her down makeshift bandage.

"Stars…" Glimmer drops back down next to Bow, "Are you… you?"

Bow smiles softly up at Glimmer, "Yeah, Glim. It's me…"

And with that, he goes unconscious, "BOW! NO!" Glimmer shouts in a panic.

"Throw me your phone, princess." Catra calmly requests, Adora promptly does so Catra starts to dial someone, "Hey, yeah. We need medics in my room. Now. Hurry."

"Okay, thank you for helping them." Catra says to the medic that has come in to help out Entrapta and Bow, "Will they be alright?"

"Yes." The medic replies as she packs up her gear, "They should be fine. I've managed to stop the bleeding. So, try to stop them doing any activity that could rip the stitches or the bandages off until it's healed a little more."

"Well, they won't be doing anything in their knocked out state." Catra replies with a slight chuckle that is met with a look of bewilderment, the magicat tilts her head, "What? It's true. They can't exactly do anything if they aren't conscious."

"I meant you, dumbass." The medic rolls her eyes as Adora comes over and wraps an arm around the magicat possessively, the medic raising a questioning eyebrow at the blonde before turning back to Catra, "You're lucky you're a magicat."

"I know, right!" Glimmer shouts out from where she's situated next to Bow on the bed, "She's really fucking lucky!"

“Shut it, Sparkles.” Catra growls out at her.

Adora sighs, “You got shot. Again.”

“Yeah, I did.” Catra replies obviously, “By Arrows, no less.”

“You need to rest.” The blonde rests her head on the magicat’s shoulder, “You’ve got the final tomorrow to win.”

“Well, doc.” Catra looks at the medic, “Am I going to live?”

“If you’re talking about from the gun shot? Then yes.” The medic holds up the extracted bullet and grins, “But if you mean the final… well… I hope you do.”

Adora frowns but then lifts her head to press a possessive kiss on the magicat’s cheek, “You’re going to live. And you’re going to win.”

“Thanks, princess.” Catra smiles back at Adora, “I hope you’re right.”

“I am right.” Adora declares and then turns back to the medic, “So, I’m guessing… more rest?”

“You got it.” The medic nods and then turns to Catra, “Try not to move it until it heals up a little more.”

“You people must think I heal like super quick or something.” Catra throws her head back, “It’s still going to hurt like a… well you know what when I fight tomorrow.”

“It will. Yes.” The medic agrees, “But at least you should be able to put weight on that leg.”

“Can you at least give me some pain killers? Or drugs? Something that’ll numb the pain.” Catra asks with a small grin.

“If it’s still really bad tomorrow, call me back.” The medic replies, “You don’t want to be taking my painkillers too close to your final.

It’ll make you fall asleep.”

“Huh.” Catra says, “How close is too close?”

“An hour is too close.” The medic says, “You’d be very useless if you fall asleep.”

“What time is my fight?” Catra rubs her cheek against Adora head.

“It’s a night match.” Adora replies, “Closing ceremony starts at 6pm with the fight scheduled for 8pm.”

“That’s fucking late.” Catra complains, “Why do we even need a closing ceremony?”

The medic just laughs as she gathers her things and does a last once over everyone, “Okay, well, good luck.” She says and Catra nods, “I’ll be cheering for you.”

The medic winks at the magicat before exiting.

Adora catches it and is almost off the couch and after her when Catra manages to pull her back down, “Woah, leave it, princess.”

“She was totally flirting with you!” Adora huffs out.

“Yeah, so?”

“So?!” Adora nearly shrieks incredulously, “So?!”

“Yeah, so?” Catra repeats, “Let them flirt. Did you forget I’ve only got eyes for you, dummy?”

Adora huffs out, “No. I didn’t forget.”

“I’m not going to stray, princess.” Catra promises, “Besides, she’s not my type. And I’ve only got the one type. Which happens to be you.”

The blonde breathes out and sighs, “Okay, okay. I’m sorry for being all…”

“Jealous?”

“Yes. Shut up.” Adora chastises and then looks over at both beds occupied, “I guess we’ve got the couch tonight then.”

“Or… you can move Traps onto the couch and we can take our bed back.” Catra suggests much to Adora’s surprise, the magicat laughs out, “I’m joking. I’m joking. Couch is fine with me.”

“I have an idea.” Adora says as she untangles herself from Catra, “Hold on.”

“What are you…oh, nice.” Catra grins as she watches as Adora pushes the two couches together so it’s almost like a bed, “Smart and beautiful.”

“Uh huh.” Adora deadpans, “Let me just go find us a blanket…”

“Grab the one off the bed. Traps isn’t using it.” Catra says and Adora quickly retrieves it as well as a pillow, “Great, now get in here next to me.”

Adora laughs out, dropping the pillow and blanket on the couches, “I’m just going to turn out the lights.”

Once the lights are off, Adora gets onto the couch next to Catra, readjusting the blankets and pillow so they’re comfortable and then the blonde gathers the magicat into her arms, “Good?”

“Mm…” Catra replies with a yawn, “Warm…”

“Good. Sleep.” Adora whispers.

“Sleep sweet, princess.” Catra whispers back and feels the blonde nod into her back in reply.

The closing ceremonies conclude and the final match is finally announced.

Catra looks over at her opponent, dressed in a black suit, trench coat, hat, balaclava and sunglasses, the magicat narrows her eyes that them, "Why the fuck is he wearing sunglasses at night?"

"I don't know." Adora replies in a stage whisper, "Also why is he wearing a hat?"

"I guess he's really going into that invisible man persona." Catra replies, "Very… noir."

"Surprised he's not in black and white." Adora jests, squeezing the magicat's thigh, making Catra wince a little, "Oh shit, sorry! Did I hurt you?!"

"Calm down, princess." Catra pats Adora's hand, "It's still a little tender but mostly healed."

"I'm super jealous at how quick you heal." Adora says, "I wish I could do that too."

"Well, I think you're my secret weapon." Adora makes a face of disbelief as Catra grins, "Those healing lips of yours…"

"I thought you said they were motivational." The blonde quirks an eyebrow up at the magicat before laughing, "Though, I didn't kiss you much after Bow shot you…"

"Healing lips, healing hands, healing body." Catra concludes, "It's all good, princess."

"I'm really sorry about that, Catra." Bow apologises profusely as he, Glimmer and Entrapta sit behind Adora and the magicat, "I really am! And I feel really bad about it."

"No one's blaming you, bro." Catra furrows her brows at him, "Besides, you were chipped. So, your actions were Prime's. Not yours."

"But I saw myself doing it." Bow pouts out and then shivers, "I feel so dirty…"

"Me too!" Entrapta agrees loudly, startling everyone, "Except for the feeling dirty part… because I'm ALWAYS dirty!"

"Gross." Catra replies flatly and then grins, "You're so weird. I love it."

Entrapta grins back preening, "Thank you! I love you too!"

"Wait… I didn't say that…" Catra starts to say and then is interrupted by the purple haired woman.

"It was very interesting the experience. Though I don't think I want a repeat." Entrapta thinks out loud, "I did get free reign of a lot of tech! Though… my brain is having trouble remembering a lot of what I was working on. It's strange only being left with… feeling."

"I know what you mean." Adora nods back to Entrapta, "It's like… not being sure if what you remember is your memory or Prime's."

"Me too!" Bow joins in as Glimmer grasps his hand in hers and squeezes, "It was like I was watching myself doing everything but had zero control over any of it. And stars, I felt so tired. Like, all the time!"

CLANG!

"Well, I guess that's my cue." Catra stands up and pulls her hoodie over her head and holds it out to Adora's waiting hands, "Wish me luck."

"You don't need luck." Glimmer rolls her eyes with a hint of a smile laced with concern, "But… try not to die."

"That's the plan, Sparkles." Catra chuckles as Adora stands up and pulls the magicat in for a kiss, "What was that for?"

“Motivation.” Adora sighs as she rests her hands on the Catra’s chest, “Motivation.”

“I’ll be fine, princess.” Catra puts her hands on top of Adora’s, “Just… keep those lips ready for me when I win this thing.”

Adora laughs softly, “How can you be so confident?”

“Well, I kind of have to be.” Catra shrugs as the gong sounds once more, “And… I have to go.”

“Woo! Go Catra!” Bow shouts from behind and immediately wincing and putting his on the bandage on the back of his neck.

“Yeah!” Entrapta shouts out next to him, seeming not to feel any pain like Bow, “Go for his vulnerable areas!”

Catra turns on the spot to the purple haired woman, “What? What vulnerable areas?”

“Well, he’s practically human.” Entrapta shrugs in a much lower tone, “So… like most humans, his vulnerable areas are his soft spots. Like the kidney, liver, head and the obvious genital area.”

“He’s invisible.” Catra deadpans back with furrowed brows, “How exactly am I even supposed to know where they are, let alone where he’s going to be?”

“You’ll figure it out, Catra.” Entrapta gives her a thumbs up and a beaming smile, “It’ll click and you’ll figure it out.”

A strong familiar hand lands on Catra’s shoulder and the magicat grumbles, “Get your hand off me. I’m going!”

“Hurry it up.” The guard from the semi final grunts out releasing her hand, “Just because it’s the final doesn’t mean you can dilly dally.”

Catra huffs out, turning to her group of friends, “Whatever happens, you’re stronger as a group. Stay together, no matter

what happens. Got me?”

The group stare back at the magicat as they watch as Catra makes her way to the fighting area, her opponent already there waiting. Still dressed in his get up and very not invisible.

“Ladies, gentlemen and everything in between and what nots!” the announcer’s voice sounds through the outdoor arena, *“We have now reached the moment you have all been waiting for! This is the final! The GRAND FINAL! The fight that will determine who is the best fighter in this world! Fighters! Get to your marks!”*

The crowd roars out loudly as both fighters move to their marks before going silent when the referee signals for the fighters to shake hands first.

Catra sticks her hand out and is met with a gloved one, one much smaller than she had thought it’d be and that’s when she realises, the invisible man is in fact… an invisible woman.

“You’re…” Catra starts to say before she’s pushed back to her mark, shaking the thought from her head.

CLANG!

The ref steps back and out of the fighting area as the gong signals the start of the fight for the very last time.

If Catra wasn’t sure that the visible man is indeed a woman, it’s confirmed when she starts to speak, “Honestly? I wasn’t expecting you to get past the first round.”

“Well, I honestly can say I’ve had no idea who I was going to fight all throughout this thing.” Catra replies as she watches as the other fighter takes off her hat, “Do you have a name or should I just call you the invisible… woman?”

“I wasn’t aware we needed to trade pleasantries.” The invisible woman throws her hat like a frisbee at Catra, the magicat moving a little too late as the edges of the hat skim the side of her cheek and she hisses when it cuts through the skin, “Ah, the blood has started…”

“And here I thought I was low.” Catra growls as she uses her hand to wipe at the blood on her face before charging towards her opponent, “My turn.”

The magicat slashes across the balaclava, shredding it to pieces, as her opponent stumbles back a few steps as Catra goes for the rest of her, the invisible woman grunts out, managing to shove the magicat back with enough force to give her enough time to rid herself of the rest of her garments, “You! Will pay for that.”

“Yeah, I’ve heard that before, ghost girl.” Catra watches as the last of her shredded clothes fall to the ground, “Must suck that you can’t see yourself.”

“Enough!” the invisible woman growls out and then Catra can’t see her anymore, squinting her eyes at where she thinks her opponent might be, making the other woman laugh out, “Oh, I think I’m going to enjoy killing you.”

“Yeah, I’ve heard that before too… Griffin.” Catra grunts out and she swears she hears her opponent make a noise, perhaps… surprise? “What?”

“Have we met?” The invisible woman asks generally confused.

The question makes Catra laugh, “You’re kidding, right?” the magicat slaps her thigh and laughs out a little bit more, “Is that like an invisible man slash woman joke? Because, that’s classic!”

“Shut the fuck up!” The invisible woman growls out, charging at the magicat and knocking Catra down, and then she lifts Catra up and off the ground, her hands around her neck, “How do you know my name?”

“Griffin?!” Catra grunts out as she’s getting choked, she kicks up and wiggles herself out of her opponent’s hands, “Fuck…” the magicat coughs as she holds her throat, “Not cool, dude.”

“I’m very cool, I’ll have you know.” Griffen the invisible woman taunts before shoulder charging Catra and flipping the magicat hard onto the ground, “This fight is… disappointing. I thought this was supposed to be a final.”

Catra grunts as she gets to her feet, “Show yourself then!”

The comment makes Griffin laugh out and Catra is able to pin point where she is, quickly landing a few punches and a slash, “ARGH!” the invisible woman somehow gets out of Catra’s reach, a few drops of what seem like invisible blood hit the dirt, catching the magicat’s ears and eyes and Catra grins, charging once again towards her, tackling her to the ground and straddling her and then throwing a barrage of punches to whatever she can hit, “FUCK! Get off me!”

“Oof!” Catra grunts out as Griffin attacks the magicat with something that’s definitely a weapon of some sort, though Catra can’t see it, “What the… argh…”

“You know what’s the best part of being me?” Griffin says as it sounds like she’s getting to her feet and then…

THUD! SWISH!

Catra growls out as she tries to crawl away, not even sure which direction to go to as she feels sharp pain piercing through her

body until….

THUD!

The magicat grits her teeth, her body pinned to the ground and pain radiating from something stabbed through the left side of her shoulder that resembles ice though it's not cold, "Fuck…"

Griffin grabs Catra by the hair, pulling the magicat's head up and watching as Catra's eyes dart around searching, the invisible woman laughs out at her impending and very likely victory, "Even my weapons are invisible so I always, and I do always, win."

"I wouldn't have expected any less from a ghost." Catra manages to grit out through the pain, "But… There are also advantages… to being… me…"

"Oh yeah?" Griffin pushes the weapon deeper, pinning the magicat further down, "And what would that be?"

"…this." Catra rips herself off whatever has her impaled as she unsheathes her claws and instantly finds Griffin, her feet and her good arm's claws burying deep into her opponents body as the magicat listens to her scream out in shock and pain mixed together, as Catra manages to find the invisible woman's head by her hair, "I don't have to hide my weapons… they are always, and I do mean always, with me."

And before Griffin can reply, Catra slashes hard and fast with her good arm before falling to the ground, crouched over and breathing heavily as she waits for her opponent to attack again.

Except it doesn't.

Instead, the sound of something hitting the ground has her ears twitching before something a lot heavier falls to the ground as

well.

Catra winces as she looks up at the arena.

Griffin isn't there.

The crowd go quiet in confusion.

The judges look at one another with the same confusion.

The fights not over, the gong hasn't sound and Catra pushes herself to her feet. Her left arm flopping around next to her, her wound bleeding profusely as she walks over to the divots on the ground, her foot accidentally nudging something and that's when she realises.

The magicat reaches down and picks up the object and hobbles over to where the judges sit, the head judge sitting in the middle raises his eyebrow up at her as she winces and hisses as she struggles to get to them.

When she gets to them, Catra places the object into the head judge's lap and simply says, "It's over. Hit that damn gong for the last fucking time."

The head judge feels around and then his eyes widen in realisation of that he is handling and dropping Griffin's head, gasping and dropping it to the ground and grimacing before quickly standing up and signalling to end the fight.

CLANG!

"Your winner!" The announcer shouts out once the gong sounds, he comes over and lifts Catra's right arm, much to the magicat's anger as she rips her arm back, he seems unfazed by her action and continues, "Congratulations! You are the grand champion!"

“Great. Whatever. Can I go now?” Catra grumbles as Adora, Glimmer, Bow and Entrapta run over to her, the magicat looks at Adora and swings her left arm making it flop around, “I don’t think your kisses are going to heal this, princess…” Catra grins and then her eyes start to roll back…

Adora quickly catches the magicat in her arms as Glimmer screams out, “MEDIC! WE NEED MEDICS! NOW! NOW!”

“No! Stay awake, Catra!” Adora pleads, gently lowering herself down onto the ground as Bow pulls off his cropped shirt and tries to stem the blood flow while Entrapta just looks on, a mix of panic and unsureness as she goes back and forth to herself about what she should do.

“Hey, Adora…” Catra looks up with tired eyes at the blonde, “We… we won…”

“Yeas. We did.” A sinister voice comes over as everyone looks up to see Prime towering over them with a smirk on his face, “Congratulations. I knew you were the one.”

“Fuck… fuck off, you… you… coward...” Catra growls out between pained breaths.

Prime brushes his nails against his shirt and grins down at the magicat, “You’ve past the first test, little sister. One more test to go.”

He clicks his fingers and someone appears.

“Delia…” Catra breathes out upon seeing her friend, her joy is short lived when she doesn’t react in the way she expects, instead, the glint of green in her eyes has the magicat growling out at Prime, “You’re a fucking monster…”

“No I’m not a monster. But you can call me Lord.” Prime suggests before correcting himself, “No. Not Lord. You will call me… the conqueror of all worlds. A god!”

Adora holds Catra tighter in her arms, scared that the magicat is going to be taken away, the blonde whispers to the magicat, “You’re going to be okay. You’re going to get through this.”

“Yes. She will.” Prime grins as he stands with his hands behind his back and look down at the magicat, “Once I have you chipped, you will be unstoppable.”

He snaps his fingers again, his lackeys coming up and surrounding the group, a sinister smile on his face as they start to advance.

Chapter End Notes

One more chapter left! ... maybe...
This chapter took a few days to write and proofread (not very good proofreading... so excuse the copious amount of mistakes...)

I'm hoping to wrap this up in the next chapter... but, we'll see how that goes.

Thanks for reading, kudos, commenting, bookmarking and subscribing!
I really do appreciate all of them!

The Calm...

Chapter Summary

Will Catra becomes Prime's puppet?

Chapter Notes

CW - blood, injury

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Get away from them!" Someone from the audience shouts out before more people join in.

"Leave them alone!"

"Get out of here!"

"Leave our champion alone!"

"Piss off you losers!"

Prime's soldiers stop their advance and look to Prime for direction. The latter growling out, "Well? What are you waiting for? Do your jobs!"

"Get them!"

"Don't let them hurt our champion!"

"Take them out!"

And within seconds, the crowd descends on Prime's soldiers as their 'Lord' scurries away in fear all the while growling at them, pushing them away as they try to bring him down.

"You will all pay for this!" Prime threatens and then growls once more when he's nearly hit with a chair, "When I am a god, I will crush all of you!"

A few people from the attacking crowd rush towards him, fists at the ready as they are easily taken down by Prime, though not without injury. A lucky punch strikes the tall and scary pale man as he stumbles back, grasping his cheek in annoyance before pulling out his weapon and firing upon the crowd.

BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG!

Screams ring out as both good and bad duck for cover as Prime starts to randomly shoot, not caring if it's his own people or not.

"YOU WILL BOW DOWN TO ME!" Prime shouts out, his voice full of rage as his reddened cheek starts to sting, "GET DOWN ON YOUR KNEES AND BOW TO YOUR GOD!"

The only people bowing down are his own men.

Everyone else who isn't too injured, crawls or runs out of the fighting area, still seeking cover from being shot or shot at.

Prime sneers at the rest of the crowd scurrying away and to safety as he addresses his soldiers, "Kill them. Kill them all."

"What about the champion?" One of his soldiers asks still on one knee, he quickly drops his head back down hoping it hasn't earnt him a painful death, "Uh, my lord."

“Kill everyone else. Leave the magicat for me.” Prime says through gritted teeth, “I still need that wretched beast to get past those monsters.”

The guard nods once, “Yes, Lord Prime.”

“Now. Go. Kill everyone else. Leave only the champion alive.” Prime orders, “I’ll fix her and the make her my all powerful… puppet.”

“Yes, Lord Prime.” The rest of the soldiers shout out in unison before getting back to their feet and pulling out their weapons and firing indiscriminately, not caring who they hit as long as it wasn’t one of their own and that’s when they realise…

“Lord Prime!” One of the soldiers runs up to Prime, eyes wide and panting as he looks around the outdoor arena, “They’re gone!”

“WHAT!?” Prime growls out looking around as well, “FIND THEM!”

“Yes, Lord Prime!” The soldier starts moves to turn to search for them when he is shot in the back by and angry Prime, “Oof… but…”

He kicks him hard as he lays on the ground, doing his best to protect his head as his leader continues to kick out his rage at him, growling out in frustration as he shouts out angrily, “GET THAT MAGICAT BACK! NOW! FIND THEM! NOW!!!”

“Yes, Lord Prime!” The rest of his soldiers shout back and then run off to find Catra.

“Come on!” Glimmer waves her arms, ushering them towards the car park.

Adora carries her magicat in her arms as she tries not to jostle Catra too much as she runs towards Glimmer, she continues to whisper reassurances, more to herself than to the magicat,

“You’re going to be okay. We’re going to get out of here. We’ll get you fixed up.”

Bow brings up the rear as they all run towards Entrapta, the purple haired woman waving her arms frantically for them to get to her, he notices the blood trail from Catra and grimaces, whisper shouting, “We need to get her help… fast!”

“You’ll be okay.” Adora repeats like a mantra, “You’re not dying on me, Catra.”

The magicat’s body goes limp in Adora’s arms, no sounds, not even a groan as the blonde pulls her tighter into her body as she quickly gets to Entrapta. The other woman looks at Catra and swallows down hard, her hand reaches out and pokes at the magicat’s cheek. And when there’s no reaction, she grimaces. Entrapta looks at Adora, “She’s going to make it. She will.”

Adora nods and then looks around, “What are we doing in a car park?”

“Oh, right.” Entrapta grins before pulling out a device from her pocket and then pushing the green button on top. The trio look around at each other, waiting for something to happen, though, Entrapta just stands there smiling at them before she realises she didn’t elaborate or explain anything, “Oh, she’s on her way.”

“She?” Glimmer repeats as she looks around a little more.

“Yes. She.” Entrapta simply replies as she places her hands behind her back and wait patiently.

SCREECH!

“There it is.” Entrapta says with a proud look on her face when a hotted up van come to a screeching stop in front of them, “I knew

Emily would be able to procure us transport!”

“Emily?” Glimmer asks whilst being ushering inside the van, the sparkly woman and Bow taking the back seats as Adora takes the seat in the middle bench, Catra in her arms as Entrapta jumps into the front seat.

“I’m Scorpia!” The driver of the van introduces herself with a beaming smile and such positive energy, despite her large and muscular stature, the scorpini waves to her passengers, “Buckle up! We can catch up later once we are no longer in danger! Here we go!”

“Where are we?” Glimmer asks as the van pulls into a warehouse type building, the garage door opening when Entrapta pushes another button on a separate remote, “Is this place safe?”

“I hope so.” Entrapta replies unsurely, “But this will have to do if we want to save Catra, I haven’t had time to get this place up to spec as I was busy working on other projects.”

Adora looks up, “She’s lost a lot of blood.”

“She has.” Entrapta says as Scorpia pulls the van to a stop, the purple haired woman quickly gets out of the car and opens the back door, “Follow me to my lab.”

“Okay…” Adora replies as she tries to shift the magicat in her arms and realises her arms are dead, “My arms…”

“I got you.” Scorpia reaches out and gently pulls Catra up and out of the van, “Come on, Wildcat.”

Catra groans out a little bit, much to the surprise of Adora who’s eyes widen, quickly getting to her feet and out of the van, following closely behind Scorpia, “Catra!” she turns to her friends, “She made a noise!”

Glimmer and Bow both give her an encouraging look as they follow behind towards the Entrapta's lab.

Scorpia gently lays the magicat down on one of two beds in the lab, Entrapta quickly moving around and grabbing bits and pieces and placing on a table near the magicat, she looks up at Adora, "How do you feel, Adora?"

"I'm fine." Adora replies a little confused, "Why?"

"I need your blood." Entrapta says as she gestures for Adora to get onto the bed, "I need your blood to give to Catra. She's lost a lot."

"Oh, yeah. Yes. Take it. Take all of it if you need to." Adora gets up onto the table and rolls her sleeve up, "Just… save her. Please."

"I'm not going to take all of it." Entrapta nods, "Take off your jacket and lie down please."

"We'll donate too." Bow raises his hand up, "Whatever you need to help her."

"Yeah. Whatever you need." Glimmer agrees, rolling up her sleeves too.

"Mm… won't be necessary. But thank you." Entrapta says, "I would give my blood too, but it wouldn't be compatible. Magicats can only accept blood from someone that they are in love with." She turns to Adora, "She's in love with you."

"I love her too." The blonde says automatically as both her friends gasp, she turns to them, a small smile on her face at the realisation that she's just said it out loud, "I love her. How could I not?"

Bow squeals happily as Glimmer rolls her eyes fondly, the latter chuckling out, "She did say that she does have a calming effect on you."

“Did she?”

“Yeah, you don’t sleep fight when she’s next to you.” Glimmer replies.

“Oh.” Adora blushes slightly as she lays down with her sleeve rolled up as Entrapta preps a needle, “I didn’t know that.”

“Okay! Ready?” Entrapta asks, holding the needle in the air.

“Yes.” Adora replies as she looks away when Entrapta inserts the needle into her arm and before she knows it, Entrapta is already done connecting up an IV, blood already flowing from Adora’s arm and into Catra’s, the blonde turns to look at what’s going on, “Oh, that was quick. How long will this take?”

“I can’t take too much.” Entrapta replies concentrating on working on the severe injury to the magicat’s left side, “Emily will alert me when we’ve taken enough that it shouldn’t affect you but be of greatest benefit for Catra.”

“Okay.” Adora nods and lays back, biting her bottom lip in worry, “Take as much as you need.”

“*Only* what she needs.” Entrapta corrects as she starts to sew the magicat back together, “She’ll make it. She has to.”

Glimmer and Bow watch on as Scorpia comes over, “You two look like you need a break.”

“Do we really look that bad?” Glimmer asks with tired eyes.

Scorpia just gives her a sympathetic look, “Come on, I’ve got a few beds for you guys to rest in.”

Bow smiles softly back to the scorpini, “That sounds amazing.”

“Okay, over here.” Scorpia gestures for them to follow her.

A few hours later…

Adora stirs after accidentally falling asleep on the bed while still giving blood to Catra, she opens her eyes to the dim light of the lab, she looks down and her arm is tucked warmly under the blanket, though she doesn't remember having a blanket.

She's broken out of her thoughts by the sound of purring in the room and a smile instantly appears on her face. Catra's made it. She turns her head to look over and sure enough, the magicat is in the bed next to her, sleeping soundly.

The blonde flips the blanket off and swings her legs off her bed, the cold floor makes her hiss out quietly as she stands next to Catra's bed, just, watching. Enamoured by the fact that Catra's not dead and actually healing. Adora looks around to see if anyone is around and when the coast is clear, she climbs into bed with Catra, doing her best not to jostle the magicat too much. She lays on her side, moving as close to Catra carefully as the magicat rubs her cheek against Adora's head and then purrs louder.

Adora sighs out happily as she tucks herself tighter into the magicat and closes her eyes.

"Ah! I knew this would happen!" Entrapta declares loudly, waking Adora abruptly as someone shushes the purple haired woman as she says in a much softer voice, "Sorry!"

Adora winces, closing one eye when Catra's ear flicks her in the face, and for a moment she's about to tell the magicat off when she realises that it's actually a good thing and her eyes automatically looks over and then eyes the purple haired woman, "Is she going to be alright?"

"Yes!" Entrapta declares triumphantly, "Her species is incredible. I would love to study her more once we are no longer in such

perilous circumstances."

"You saved her." Adora whispers, holding onto Catra tighter.

Entrapta smiles back at the blonde and nods, "How are you feeling?"

"I'm okay." Adora replies tiredly.

"You've been sleeping for a quite a while." The other woman points out, "I have some tiny foods and drinks." She pauses and thinks for a moment and then perks up, "Actually, I believe Scorpia was talking about getting pizzas. So, there's that."

Adora smiles back, her fingers still clutching onto Catra, "That sounds great."

"She'll be fine. Your blood has helped her greatly." Entrapta says, "That was another thing I wanted to talk to you about…"

"Hm?" The blonde's eyes start to close once more.

"Don't worry. We can talk it about it later when Scorpia has food." Entrapta's voice softens, "Rest a little more."

Adora hums out in reply as she falls back asleep.

"Entrapta." Bow greets the purple haired woman as he stretches his arms up and over his head, Glimmer following suit with a yawn as they both emerge from their well needed sleep, "How are they?"

"Catra still needs to rest. Adora is resting." Entrapta replies, "I said I'd wake Adora up once Scorpia is back with sustenance."

"That's great news." Bow says genuinely and then gently puts his hand on her shoulder, "Hey."

"Hey back at you!" Entrapta grins at the gesture.

Glimmer chuckles under her breath as she rubs her eyes and goes to check on Adora, squeezing Bow's arm as she passes him to talk to Entrapta.

"Entrapta, how are you?" Bow asks to start the conversation once more before he knows the other woman can't run off, "Do you remember what we were doing when we were… you know… chipped?"

"Not really." Entrapta says after a quick think, "But I don't have a good feeling about it. Deep down inside it feels like I did something, bad."

Bow furrows her brows, "I know the feeling." He sighs, "I just can't put my finger on what it is we were doing."

"It's just feels… fuzzy. And I hate feeling fuzzy when it comes to science." Entrapta grumbles a little angrily, "I just know… whatever it was that I was working doesn't feel like it is going to be good for us…"

"That's concerning…" Bow starts to say but quickly changes his tune when he sees the look on his friend's face becoming darker, "BUT! We'll get through it. I'm sure it can't be *that* bad. I don't know about you, but I do remember having a little bit of control every now and then."

"Yes! I do remember little bits and pieces of consciousness!" Entrapta says in almost an excited shout and Bow visibly lights up, "Which means…"

"Which means?"

"There's a failsafe! I ALWAYS put in failsafe in all my projects!" Entrapta declares matter of factly, "I just have to remember what it was…"

"I'm sure we'll figure it out." Bow pats Entrapta on the shoulder, "If anyone can, it'll be the literal genius that built whatever weapon of destruction Prime wanted."

Glimmer's head pops around the corner and she shrieks out walking towards the pair, "Weapon of destruction! Are you fucking serious?!"

Catra rouses from her slumber, pain shooting through her body as she feels a comforting heavy weight on the right side of her body, "Ow… fuck me… fucking Prime… Asshole…" she looks down and sees a mess of blonde hair and grins down, "Hey, Adora."

"Mm…" Adora grumbles and tucks herself deeper into Catra's good side.

With her right hand, she gently runs it up and down Adora's side, pulling her closer as she tries to move her left, only to wince in pain and then whispers out to herself, "Well, at least Traps didn't amputate it…"

"Mm…" Adora hums out this time, rubbing her face against the magicat.

"Foods here!" Scorpia's voice thunders in from outside the door, the door swings open and the scorpini looks inside before grimacing, "Oh, gosh! I am so sorry! I thought you two were already awake…"

Catra stares at the strange woman blankly, "Uh, hey… you."

"Oh, right!" Scorpia darts forward in her huge form, making the magicat's eyes open in fear as she grabs hold of Adora and tries to get in between them, the scorpini realises her mistake and stops in her tracks, her pincers up in the air, "Woah! I'm not going to hurt you."

"Yeah, heard that before." Catra growls out at the stranger, "Who are you and what do you want?"

"Oh… maybe I should get…" Scorpia looks behind herself, "I'll be right back!"

The magicat holds herself up, keeping the growl and act up until Scorpia disappears back outside before the pain becomes too much and the groans out in pain, “Fuck…”

That seems to finally wake Adora up, she sees Catra grunting out in pain, wincing while holding her left side, that seems to wake her up big time, “Catra! Stars! What’s wrong?!”

Adora scrambles up, trying to get a good look at the magicat’s injuries, Catra hisses out in pain when Adora accidentally touches the wrong spot, “I’m alright, princess.” The magicat tries to calm Adora down, “It’s just still painful. I don’t think I’m as broken as I thought I’d be.”

“Entrapta fixed you up when you passed out… again.” Adora replies, “My kisses can’t fix everything, it seems.”

The jest has Catra smiling, the pain forgotten for a moment, “No, I guess your kisses can’t fix everything. But, no harm in trying again, right?”

Adora leans forward and presses her lips onto Catra’s in a soft kiss, resting their forwards together, “I thought I’d lost you.”

“I’m not going anywhere.” Catra replies in a whisper.

The blonde nods with a slight sniffle as Catra reaches up with her good hand and cups her cheek, “You were just… laying there… not moving.”

“I’m still here.” Catra reassures, “I’m not so easy to kill. And besides, we won.”

Adora smiles sadly back, “Yeah, we won. But Prime…”

“Fuck Prime.” Catra returns.

Just as Catra’s about to lean in again for another kiss, Scorpia comes back in and the magicat pulls back quickly and growls at her, “Woah! Woah! I brought your friends!”

Glimmer and Bow appear behind Scorpia looking at Catra confused, the former rolling her eyes, “Quit your growling. Scorpia helped us get away from Prime and those Horde fucks.”

“She’s right, Scorpia is a friend.” Bow chimes in with his hands up, “Plus she’s really sweet and nice and brought us food!”

“Food?” Adora perks up and then as if on cue, her stomach grumbles, “I could eat.”

Catra laughs, seemingly taking Bow and Glimmer’s word that Scorpia is in fact a friend when Entratpa comes waltzing back in, “Ah! You’re awake!”

“Yeah.” Catra smiles at Entrapta, “Thanks for sewing me back up again, Traps.”

“Of course!” The other woman beams, “I like putting things back together!”

“And for saving my life.” The magicat adds quietly, “But… how? I thought I’d bled out.”

“You had!” Entrapta says a little too enthusiastically, “Adora’s blood saved your life!”

“I thought I couldn’t accept human blood.” Catra furrows her eyebrows, “I’ve tried before in the past and it’s always made me feel like shit. But… I don’t feel like that at all.”

“That’s because you can’t accept just anybody’s blood.” Entrapta says as she comes over and starts to examine the magicat, while Adora pushes herself up and gets off the bed, pressing a soft kiss onto Catra’s lips once more before stepping back to give the other woman space, “Adora’s blood is special because she’s special to you.”

The magicat nods back, sighing out as she holds Adora’s stare, “She is. She’s… everything to me.”

Bow coos loudly with hearts in his eyes as Glimmer crosses her arms in front of her chest like she's known all along, "Oh, I love, love! I'm so happy for the both of you!" he gushes out.

Catra just stares at him and shakes her head, before looking at Adora who's got a wide grin on her face, "Okay… you guys can stop staring at me now."

"Why?" Glimmer asks with a smirk, "Does it make you uncomfortable that you're in love with our best friend?"

"No. I'm not uncomfortable with that." Catra replies nonchalantly and then wincing, "But I am still uncomfortable with the level of pain radiating from half of my body."

Glimmer's face changes to one of concern as she looks around to the group and then back to Catra, "Did you not get any pain relief at all?"

"What's that?" Catra deadpans back and then laughs, "I was unconscious for a while when Traps did whatever she did to put me back together. But pain relief would be great, if anyone has anything stronger than a paracetamol."

"Mm… I have some Oxy…" Entrapta starts to say, "But! It's highly addictive and honestly, I think it'd be a bad idea to give it to you as I've only got a limited supply."

"Wait, why do you have Oxy?" Glimmer quirks an eyebrow up at the other woman, "How did you even get that?"

"I'd rather not answer that question." Entrapta simply replies as she finishes her assessment of the magicat, "Can you take your shirt off so I can check on the stitches?"

"You'll have to do it for me. I don't think I can lift my arm up." Catra replies as Entrapta goes to remove the magicat's shirt.

"Woah!" Adora quickly pulls Catra's shirt back down and looks at the pair incredulously, "Can you wait until we get a little privacy?"

“Why?” Catra and Entrapta both reply at the same time.

“Well, gosh, look at the time.” Scorpia pipes up pretending to look at her watch that doesn’t exist, “I am hungry, so, yeah, I’m just going to grab some food. I got pizzas and I’m looking forward to getting into it. How about you guys?”

“Right behind you!” Bow says as he quickly walks out, Glimmer rolling her eyes and following suit until it’s just the trio left behind.

“Are you staying too, princess? Not hungry?” Catra asks as she puts a hand on Adora’s that’s still holding onto the bottom of her shirt, “Or are you staying to watch?”

Adora blushes, “Well, I wanted to see…”

Catra laughs out painfully, gently squeezing Adora’s hand, “I get it. You just want to make sure I’m alright.”

The blonde sighs out and nods, “I was so worried about you. When we were coming here, I thought I’d lost you because there was just, so much… blood.”

The magicat exhales and reaches up with her good arm, cupping Adora’s cheek, “We’re going to get through this. Together.”

Adora nods once more and adds, “Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other.”

Catra looks at her a little shocked, “Uh… when you say bad… how bad are we talking? Because I’m pretty sure I’ve already used up… half of my lives in that stupid ass tournament…”

The blonde frowns out, “Is that really even a thing?”

The magicat shrugs as Entrapta makes a discontented noise from behind them, “I really need to check her stitches, so, can we please hurry this up?”

“Sure.” Catra replies, “Help me out, princess.”

Adora nods and gently lifts Catra's shirt up and over, taking the garment and holding it in her hands, doing her best to keep her eyes above the magicat's shoulders, the blonde asks, "So? How does it look?"

"You can look, you know?" Catra teases, "It's not like you haven't seen me naked."

The blush on Adora's face comes back as she manages to retort, "Well, you've seen me naked too!"

"This isn't a competition, Adora." Catra replies with a grin and then looks down at her bare torso, "How bad is it? It's really bad, isn't it? Feels really bad."

"It's not that bad." Entrapta replies with a poke making Catra hiss out in pain, "The sutures have held nicely and the bleeding has pretty much stopped. Well, it had until you gained consciousness and began moving around."

"Oh, so I should stop moving?" Catra asks with her ears flat on her head.

"That would be preferable." The purple haired woman says with a nod.

"I need to use the bathroom." The magicat brings up, "Can I at least relieve myself first and then maybe you can knock me out for a few more hours or something?"

"Stars, no." Adora interjects, "No more getting knocked out. You probably have brain damage from all the knocks to the head."

"You too, probably." Catra replies looking at Adora, "How many times have you been knocked out."

"Yeah, I'm not answering that." Adora says narrowing her eyes.

"Why not? You might be brain damaged too." Catra grins.

“I am not brain damaged.” Adora replies flatly and then looks around to Entrapta, “Can she put her shirt back on now?”

“Yes. I was done a while ago when you two were arguing.” Entrapta simply says as she grabs one of her tablets and starts to tap away on it, she pauses for a moment, “Oh, after you relieve yourself, I suggest you hydrate and nourish yourself before I put you back to sleep again.”

“You going to knock me out?” Catra asks with a smirk.

“In a sense, but not with physical violence. I think you’ve had enough of that for a while…” Entrapta trails off at the end of her sentence, “I can have Scorpia do the thing that makes people sleep and sometimes wet their pants.”

“Nope!” Catra quickly quells that, “I do not want to get choked out.”

“Then…”

“Look, Traps. I’m fucking tired as it is.” Catra says starting to feel the exhaustion rear up again, “And honestly, if I didn’t have to really go pee right now, I’d probably just go back to sleep.”

“Oh…”

“Yeah.” The magicat nods, “Plus, if Adora sleeps with me,” she turns to the blonde, “not in the sexual sense, princess.”

“I know what you mean.” The blonde replies crossing her arms over her chest.

“No?”

“You’re injured, Catra.” Adora points out, “And having sex would be detrimental to your recovery.”

“True.” The magicat nods.

“Sorry! Can I interrupt?” Entrapta steps in between the pair, “So, should I get Scorpia in here later or not?”

“Not.” Catra simply replies as she nods to Adora to help her put her shirt back on, “I think I’ll be alright not moving after doing what my body needs first.”

“Excellent!” Entrapta beams, “Also I would advise against any form of sex currently as you’ll rip your stitches and I really don’t like blood.”

“Right.” Catra nods, “No sex.”

“Thank you!” The purple haired woman smiles before heading towards the door, “Ooh! I hope there’s tiny pizza out there for me!”

Catra and Adora look at one another, the latter holding out her hand, “Come on, I’ll help you to the bathroom.”

“Thanks, princess.” Catra smiles before grimacing when she moves off the bed, “Okay… slowly…”

3 days later…

“Okay, I think I figured it out.” Bow announces loudly to the near empty room, only Entrapta and Scorpia are there and the former is busy on her tablet, tapping away happily, he clears his throat, “Entrapta. I think I figured out what you were working on for Prime.”

“Oh.” She looks up and smiles before looking back down at her tablet and says, “That’s nice.”

“You built a weapon.” Bow continues despite no one paying attention to him, “Guys! Come on! Listen!”

“Woah.” Scorpia stands up and puts her arms up in a calming manner, “Are you okay, Bow?”

“No.” Bow shakes his head, “I figured out what Entrapta built for Prime. It’s a weapon and it’s… it’s really bad.”

“How bad?” Scorpia asks with concern on her face.

“Really bad.” Bow repeats, “Like, kill all the yetis, bad.”

“Oh, right! I remember doing that!” Entrapta looks up and grins before looking back down again.

“Yetis?” Scorpia repeats confused, “Like… for real?”

“Yes. For real.” Bow frowns at the fact that Entrapta is still not engaged in this conversation as he huffs out, “Why aren’t you like… I don’t know? Concerned, like at all?”

“It’ll only activate if Catra activates it. And as far as I’m concerned, Catra is in no condition to travel anywhere, let alone somewhere for Prime to kill a bunch of yetis to make Prime a living god.”

“Wait, hold on.” Bow breathes out harshly, “You knew this whole time?”

“Yes.”

“And you didn’t say anything because…?” Bow tries to remain calm.

“Never came up in conversation.” The purple haired woman shrugs boredly, “Besides, Prime won’t find us here.”

“We can’t stay here forever.” Bow voice starting to strain in frustration, “At some point, we’ll need to leave.”

“Why?”

“Why?” Bow repeats back incredulously.

“Yes, why? What’s wrong with here?” Entrapta tilts her head in question.

“This isn’t home. I miss my friends back home.” Bow replies as she flops himself down onto one of the chairs, “I miss my dads. I miss my brothers. I miss my home.”

“Oh.” Entrapta seems to understand that part, “I didn’t think of it that way.”

Nodding, Bow sighs as Scorpia walks over and stands in front of him, “Would a hug help?”

“I mean, it would help…” Bow replies and quickly stands up and accepts the embrace, “You give really good hugs.”

“I’m a hugger.” Scorpia replies with a grin, “You give really good hugs too.”

“Hug buddies!” Bow cheers happily as Glimmer walks out to the sight, “Glim! Come join our hug!”

“Uh, no thanks. I’m good.” Glimmer politely declines, “What’s going on?”

“Bow figured out what Entrapta was working on when she was under Prime’s control.” Scorpia explains, “He was feeling a little down because no one seemed to be listening to him. But I was listening. I was.”

“Uh huh.” Glimmer raises her eyebrows at him as the pair part and he comes over and wraps her up in her arms, she pats him on the back, “So… what was she working on?”

“It’s a weapon.” Bow says, “To kill yetis so Prime can become a god.”

“Oh.” Glimmer frowns, “That’s not good.”

“No. It really isn’t.” He agrees.

“How do we stop him from using it?” Glimmer asks.

“Only Catra can activate it.” Entrapta calls out, “So, there’s no issue right now. Since Prime doesn’t have Catra and hence Catra can’t activate it to kill the yetis.”

“So, if only Catra can activate the weapon… doesn’t that mean that Prime will be looking for her?” Glimmer asks and then…

BOOM! BOOM!

Prime’s soldiers storm the warehouse the group is hiding out in, Bow tries to fight them off, only to be overwhelmed by the intruders as he looks around to see Glimmer on the ground, unconscious.

“Glimmer!” Bow shouts out before he’s knocked out from a hit on the back of his head.

Entrapta manages to scramble out of the debris from the explosions that have rocked the building, she rushes to the room where Catra and Adora are currently resting, slamming the door shut behind her as the pair stare at her, “We need to leave! NOW!”

“What the fuck is happening out there?!” Catra throws the blankets off and grimaces, growling out in pain as she feels the stitches stretch against her skin.

Adora gets up as well, “No. Stay still.” She tells Catra as she picks the magicat up in her arms, “Entrapta, where do we go?!”

“Follow me! Prime’s here!” The purple haired woman signals for them to follow as Prime’s soldiers try to break down the door, “We don’t have much time!”

“GO! GO!” Catra growls out to Adora.

“Wait! What about Glimmer and Bow?! And Scorpia!?” Adora pants out as she follows Entrapta through a secret door, “They could be in trouble!”

The door shuts behind them as Entrapta flicks on the lights and keeps moving forward, “They’ll be fine. We won’t, if we stay here.”

Adora nods, swallowing down the guilt of leaving her friends as she tries to get to safety, “Where are we going?”

“The van.” Entrapta replies as they go through a few more doors, “We need to get to the garage!”

“Right.” Adora says.

“There it is!” Entrapta pants out and points to the lone van in the garage, “Get in!”

Adora opens the back door and gets in, managing to position Catra on the seat next to her and buckling her up while Entrapta gets behind the wheel. The magicat groans out in pain as Adora fusses over her and then something catches Catra’s eye, “Why aren’t we going, Traps?”

“I don’t know how to drive this!” Entrapta turns back with a grimace, “Scorpia usually does all the driving…”

“Can you drive, Adora?” Catra asks, “It’s manual.”

Adora looks over at the front and shakes her head, “No… but I can try?”

“Stars no.” Catra shakes her head at the suggestion, “Help me into the front.”

“Okay.” Adora and Entrapta both help Catra into the driver’s seat, Adora sitting in shot gun, “Now what?”

“Now, I’m going need you to shift gears for me.” Catra winces as she reaches her good arm up to the wheel, “Can you do that, princess?”

“Yes.” Adora replies confidently as Entrapta sits in the seats behind them and look around.

“We need to go… now!” Entrapta’s voice trembles, “My security systems can only hold them off for so long…”

“Right. Let’s go.” Catra grunts out and then turns to Adora, “First gear, please.”

Chapter End Notes

I've extended this fic for another 2 chapters as I realised that for me to finish this in one would be like... 20K words.
I think 2 chapters should be enough for me to get this fic done and dusted.
But... we'll see.
I've been busy with working away and all...
I chucked a quick video of one of my climbs on tumblr - @masternoveller

Thanks for reading, kudos, commenting, subscribing and bookmarking.

Making It Out

Chapter Summary

the aftermath of escaping Prime.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Traps." Catra winces out, "Do we have a plan? Where am I driving us to?"

Entrapta looks up from her device that's currently in her hands and then bites her bottom lip before sighing out defeatedly, "I don't know."

"So… we're going to keep driving until this thing runs out of fuel then?" Catra slumps forward slightly trying to get a little more comfortable from the pain, as she adds, "Because we're starting to run on empty if the little fuel light has come on."

"Oh. That's not good." Entrapta replies emotionlessly.

Adora turns around to look at the purple haired woman looking down, "Hey. It's okay. We'll figure something out." Entrapta looks up and twitches her nose a little as Adora smiles back reassuringly, "We will. And we'll get our friends back. No matter what it takes."

"Yeah, Traps." Catra grunts out in agreeance, "Whatever Adora just said. Whatever it takes."

"You really think so?" Entrapta asks softly.

"I know so, Traps." Catra breathes out trying not to hiss, "Now, I know you have a kagillion ideas in that head of yours. We just need one."

Adora looks on with the same soft smile as Entrapta hums out in thought then then sits up straight with a giant grin on her face, "I got it!"

"Great. Tell me where we're going." Catra tries to smile back through the pain.

After a few turns, they end up at what looks like another warehouse, though, this one looks abandoned.

"Uh, Entrapta? Are you sure this is the right place?" Adora asks as she looks at the broken windows and graffiti scattered along the walls, "It doesn't exactly look… safe."

"It's a front, princess." Catra replies confidently before dropping the pretence as she glances in the rearview mirror, "Right Traps?"

"Right!" Entrapta beams as she taps a few thing on her tablet as the garage door on the side opens up, "Onward!"

"Sure." Catra winces as she drives inside and stops when she's about to hit the wall at the front, "Uh, now what?"

The door behind them shuts and then the room lights up bright white, "What the…?" Adora mumbles out as the vehicle is spun 180 degrees and then they start to descend, "Entrapta?"

"Underground!" Entrapta shouts out excitedly before adding, "I hoped this would work. It's a little temperamental at times…"

"We're not going to like… fall and die, are we?" Catra asks wincing.

"No. Probably not." The purple haired woman replies, "Though there's always a chance though."

"That's not reassuring at all." Adora mumbles out, "What is this place?"

“It’s an underground facility that I complete forgot about.” Entrapta replies, “I built my first Emily prototype down here.”

“So you’re saying that it’s bomb proof.” Catra suggests and Entrapta nods happily, “Great… just as long as you don’t blow us up while we’re down there…”

“Okay!” Entrapta agrees.

“Wait! That was a possibility?!” Adora eyes widen as the van finally stops descending, “Please tell me you’re not planning to blow anything up while we’re down there.”

“I have no plans to.” The purple haired woman replies confused, “We are simply taking refuge for now and to let Catra recuperate.”

“What have you got down here?” Catra asks as she unbuckles her seatbelt with a slight groan.

“I’m not really too sure…” Adora quickly exits the vehicle and goes to help Catra out as Entrapta continues, “It’s been a while since I’ve been back here.”

“Well, can you at least find the lights?” Catra asks as she slumps into Adora’s arms, “Also I think my bandages need changing. Think I’ve painted them red again.”

“Oh no!” Adora looks down and sees the bloodied bandages, “Entrapta! Where’s your first aid kit?!”

The lights all of a sudden flicker on and the underground areas are lit up with white lights, Entrapta jumping out of the vehicle and signalling for the pair to follow her, “This way!”

Adora climbs into the bed next to Catra once all her bandages have been changed, carefully wrapping herself around the magicat, “Are you okay?”

“M’fine.” Catra replies tiredly, “Just… tired.”

“You lost a lot of blood.” Adora whispers out as she hears Entrapta buzzing around outside, “You need to rest. And drink and eat.”

“Can’t eat and drink while I’m asleep.” Catra mumbles out as her eyes close.

“One thing at a time.” The blonde softly says as she rubs her cheek on Catra’s shoulder, “We get you better first. And then get our friends back.”

“Your friends.” Catra grumbles out.

“Our friends.” Adora corrects with a small smile, “You’re family to us now.”

“Gross.” Catra says with a small grin, “We better not be related.”

“No!” Adora laughs out, doing her best not to knock the magicat in anywhere that is still injured, “I was kind of thinking…”

“Yeah?”

“Girlfriend?” Adora shyly suggests.

Catra shakes her head, opening her eyes to see Adora frown a little, the magicat smiles down at the blonde, “Not girlfriend.”

“Please, for the love of the stars, do not say sister.” Adora narrows her eyes in warning to the magicat.

Catra laughs lightly, trying not to move too much as she finally says, “Wife.”

Adora’s eyes widen and her jaw drops as she shakes her head like she’s misheard, “Wait. What did you just say?”

“You heard me, princess.” Catra shuts her eyes again, a smirk firmly on her face, “I’m not repeating it again until we’re standing

in front of all those people we call friends who are really family and declaring it."

Adora can't help but smile, hugging Catra tighter, "One thing at a time, Cat."

"If we survive this… I'm whisking you away and spending some proper naked time with you where we won't only be sleeping." Catra declares, "And then… we can do wife stuff…"

"Wife stuff?" Adora giggles out, "What exactly is wife stuff?"

Catra shrugs and then grins again, "You know, wife stuff." The magicat yawns, "Rest time, princess. I'm not going to get better with all this talking about wife stuff that hasn't happened yet."

"Well, there isn't going to be any wife stuff unless *somebody* asks me." Adora points out.

"Or you can ask me." Catra throws back.

"Would you say yes?" Adora asks.

"Or I'll beat you to it." The magicat deflects, "But, don't ask me until after we are no longer in imminent danger. I wouldn't want to go out wondering about a life we can't have."

"Don't say that." Adora sighs, "You're not going to… to…"

"Sorry, princess." Catra sighs out too, lifting her arm up and resting it on top of Adora, "We'll get through this. And we'll get everyone back. And we'll beat Prime."

"We will." Adora nods in agreement, "He's not going to win."

"No. He won't." Catra yawns once more, "Okay… no more talk… sleep."

"Okay." Adora closes her eyes too and they fall into a tired slumber.

"Catra. My champion." Prime's voice drips with anger despite his efforts to keep a cool and calm demeanour, *"I have your friends. Meet me in the Snows by the end of the week or I will do more than simply kill them. That you have my word on."*

The transmission cuts out afterwards as Catra hands the tablet device back to Entrapta, the magicat breathes out harshly, the pain significantly better but still there as she looks between Adora and Entrapta, clearing her throat, "Well, I guess we better get going to the Snows."

"It's a trap. "Adora says.

"Yep, it sure is." Catra agrees readily.

"But it's a trap." Adora repeats.

"I know." Catra replies, "But there's no other way. We're out of options, princess."

"He could have them under mind control." Adora brings up, "Or… they could jump us."

"Definitely possibilities." Catra nods as she turns to Entrapta, "Any idea on that weapon you were working on for Prime?"

"Still kind of blurry." Entrapta replies, "Well not the kill yeti thing, that's fairly fresh. But how you activated is still missing from my data banks…"

"I think she means her brain." Catra stage whispers to Adora knowing Entrapta isn't even paying attention anymore, "Okay. Now. How are we getting to the Snows?"

"The van!" Entrapta suggests enthusiastically.

Catra shakes her head, "No go. That thing is pretty much running on fumes… unless you've got an extra fuel down here, in which case I'm surprised we haven't been blown to pieces."

"Okay, I don't know what's worse…" Adora says out loud, concern and a hint of fear in her voice.

"What? We needed fuel. Traps had plutonium." Catra replies nonchalantly like it's an everyday thing to say, "As long as we don't hit many bumps…"

Bang!

"Catra!" Adora shrieks out when they accidentally roll over a pothole, "You're going to kill us!"

"My bad, princess!" Catra grimaces and grips the wheel a little tighter, "Uh, won't happen again…"

"Don't worry!" Entrapta pops up from the backseat, scaring the crap out of the pair in the front as she shouts out, "It'll need to be much bigger than that for this baby to blow!"

"Stars! Fucking… Traps!" Catra growls out as she tries not to swerve off the road and into another pothole, "Inside voice!"

"Oh, I thought that was my inside voice…" Entrapta tilts her head, "I am technically inside of this van and hence I thought that constituted an *inside voice."*

"I think Catra meant just a little bit softer." Adora corrects with a stern look over at the magicat, "She didn't mean to growl at you. Right, Cat?"

“Right.” Catra agrees readily, “You just scared the crap out of me, is all.”

“I do that, yes.” Entrapta nods in agreeance and then turns to Adora, “Not to worry, Adora. This van is perfectly safe from blowing up and killing us from simply driving.”

“That’s… good?” Adora replies looking between Catra and Entrapta, “I think?”

“It’s better than good! It’s amazing!” Entrapta sits up and grins, “We’ll only blow up if we get shot at and a bullet hypothetically pierces the exact spot, the weak spot that is located within the engine and then **BOOM!** Dead.”

This time Catra groans out loudly, “And how likely is that going to happen, Traps?”

“Mm…” Entrapta takes a moment to think, “I guess…it depends on how many people are shooting at us and where they are standing, which direction the wind is blowing, the air temperature, the shooter’s distance and height of the shooter…”

“Traps.” Catra interrupts the purple haired woman’s ramblings, “How likely is this thing going to go boom?”

“We have between a 1 and 17% chance of being killed by the van exploding.” Entrapta finally answers and then looks at Adora with a sure look, “It’s never zero.”

“It’s too bad, this hunk of junk can’t fly.” Catra jests to herself, “It’s going to be long drive to the Snows is all I’m saying.”

“It can fly.”

“Say, what?” Catra glances back when Entrapta doesn’t reply straight away, “What did you say?”

“It can fly.” Entrapta repeats.

“How?” Adora looks sceptically at Entrapta, “This van is not exactly the most… technologically advanced.”

“Yes, it is.”

Catra snickers, “Sure it is. That’s why it’s a manual.”

“Oh, the manual feature is to deter people from stealing her. Darla is very advanced.” Entrapta preens from the backseat.

“Darla?” Adora repeats back to Entrapta, “…and who is Darla?”

“We’re inside of her right now. Right, Darla?” Entrapta says as a strange purple light illuminates within the vehicle.

"You are correct, Entrapta." A strange robotic voice replies as Catra and Adora look at one another.

“Everyone. This is Darla!” Entrapta introduces the occupants of the van to … the van, “Darla, this is Catra and Adora!”

"Welcome Catra and Adora. I am Darla." Darla greets.

“Uh, hey.” Catra looks around the inside of the van, Adora doing the same, the magicat spotting a red button that she didn’t see the first time round on back of the gear shifter, “What’s this button for?”

“Don’t push the red button!” Adora quickly slaps Catra’s hand away, “You don’t even know what it does!”

“That’s why I’m asking, princess.” Catra chuckles as she shakes her slapped hand, “I wasn’t really going to push it…”

“I don’t believe you.” Adora pouts crossing her arms over her chest as the magicat laughs under her breath, “Shut up.”

“The red button doesn’t do anything.” Entrapta finally answers, “I thought it was a good addition to Darla. And besides, you’ve

already inadvertently pushed it multiple times when we got away from Prime from the warehouse the first time."

"That's… concerning." Adora hums out biting her bottom lip and frowning a little bit at that fact.

"I wasn't surprised by that though. My data had predicted as much." Entrapta says matter of factly.

"So, Traps. How do we get this rust bucket to fly?" Catra asks.

"Darla is *not* a rust bucket." Entrapta corrects as the magicat snickers, "Besides, all you have to do is ask her."

"Right." Catra nods like talking to a robotic voice in the highly blow-up-able van is normal.

"Yeah, Cat. *Ask her."* Adora adds with a cheeky grin, "Ask Darla to get this van to fly."

"I will." The magicat replies back with a roll of her eyes but doesn't do it right away.

"Well?" Adora questions playfully, "What's wrong, Catra?"

"Nothing." Catra shrugs, "I just prefer to drive is all."

"Uh huh." The blonde raises an eyebrow up, "Then why ask if it could fly in the first place?"

"I was just curious." The magicat smirks back, "Besides, you know what they say about cats and curiosity…"

"Oh! I know this one!" Entrapta beams from the backseat, a hand raised up in the air like she's answering a question and wants to be picked, "I know this one!"

Adora laughs and nods as she says, "Well, I guess you better get some satisfaction later. Because I'm not letting you die."

“Good to know.” Catra grins back at the blonde and then looks around the roof of the van and sighs out, “Darla? Can you make this thing fly?”

Darla doesn’t respond as Entrapta takes out her tablet and starts tapping away, “That’s… strange…”

“Darla?” Catra tries again and then glances back to Entrapta, “Maybe she didn’t hear me?”

“Try again?” Adora prompts.

The magicat nods, “Darla? Let’s fly?”

Again, they are met with silence.

“Uh, Traps?” Catra asks unsurely, “I think Darla might be broken.”

“Hang on…” Entrapta puts a finger up as she continues to tap away on her device, “I’m almost…”

Catra sighs again, perhaps it was just wishful thinking as Adora wonders to herself and says, “Maybe if you asked Darla nicely? Maybe if you asked her and with a please?”

“Really, princess?” Catra replies bewildered, “You think she’d respond if I said *please?”*

“Well, yeah.” Adora shrugs, “You know… just say, *Darla, can you please activate flight mode?”*

CRANK! WHOOSH! BOOM!

“What the…?” Catra eyes widen as the van sprouts literally wings and begins to take off from the road into the air, “I did not do that.”

"Command acknowledged, welcome She-Ra." Darla responds.

"She-Ra?" Catra and Adora say at the same time.

"She-Ra?! Where?!" Entrapta leaps up from the back seat, almost dropping her tablet in the process, "Darla! Where is She-Ra?"

"She-Ra is currently on board." Darla replies.

"Where?!" The purple haired woman nearly screams out in excitement, "Where, Darla?! Where?!"

"I think the rust bucket means you, princess." Catra nudges Adora with her elbow, "You must be this… She-Ra. Whoever that is."

"I am not She-Ra." Adora rolls her eyes back at the magicat, "I don't even know who that is."

"Adora! You're She-Ra!" Entrapta shouts out happily, "I knew there was something special about you when Catra could accept your blood and get better so quickly!"

"Uh… what?" Adora's mind boggles, "What are you talking about?"

"She-Ra is legendary!" Entrapta grins out, "Now I know we're going to beat Prime!"

Catra and Adora look at each other and shrug, the magicat looking around and then back at Entrapta, "Hey Traps, does Darla know where she's going?"

"Did you tell her where you wanted to go?" Entrapta asks right back.

"Does she not know?" Catra asks with a glance backwards briefly.

"How is Darla supposed to know where you want to go if you haven't told her?" Entrapta narrows her eyes and tilts her head in response.

“How am I supposed to do that when she doesn’t respond to me?” The magicat starts to grow irritated.

And before Entrapta can fuel the magicat’s ire anymore, the blonde pipes up, “Darla. Please take us to the Snows.”

“Course has been updated to the Snows.” Darla acknowledges and the now flying van speeds up and gets onto course towards the snows.

“How long does it take to fly to the snows?” Catra releases the steering wheel cautiously and finds that she doesn’t need to steer anymore now that Darla has taken over, “Woah, it’s like cruise control.”

“Darla will run on autopilot now that she’s got a mission.” Entrapta replies, “And since we’re now flying, we should get to the snows by this time tomorrow if we don’t stop.”

“Nope. We are not going nonstop.” Catra declares, “What about toilet breaks? Or DVT?!”

“DVT?” The purple haired woman tilts her head at the magicat, “I… I don’t understand what that is or how that affects our travel plans right now?”

“Deep vein thrombosis.” Catra explains, “You know that thing when you sit down for too long and blood clots form and then float around your body when you get back and get stuck in your heart?”

“Pretty sure it gets stuck in the lungs.” Adora softly says as Catra looks at her surprised, “What? I travel a lot and it’s a real thing.”

“I know, princess.” Catra smiles and then turns back to Entrapta, “Bathroom breaks?”

“I think I have some stuff in the back you can use if you need to… relieve yourself.” Entrapta starts to rummage around behind her

seat before moving to the back of the van, "AHA! We can use these!"

Adora shakes her head when she sees Entrapta holding up a few empty water bottles that don't look all that clean, not that that's what matters, "Stars, no."

"Yeah, I'm not pissing into a bottle, Traps." Catra agrees, "I don't know how you plan to even fill those bottles up with pee in the first place. And secondly, no. Definitely not."

"I'm with Catra on this one." Adora says as Entrapta makes a face at the pair, the blonde tacking on, "I mean, it's not exactly the most… hygienic or… private."

"I have a blanket I can put up if you want privacy." Entrapta suggests as she grabs hold of the old blanket from the back with a few rather large holes in it, "Or we can just turn around."

"No." Catra says with emphasis, "We stop every three hours. Stretch our legs, go to the bathroom. Get some food or whatever. No peeing in the rust bucket, Darla."

"I concur with Catra. Please refrain from relieving yourself within my walls." Darla's robotic voice says.

"Well, you heard Darla." Catra smirks before softening, "We can't stay in the van for 24 hours straight. It's not healthy and definitely not beneficial to our well beings."

After a little while, Entrapta thinks it over and then comes around, conceding, "Okay. This is only because data never lies and you two need to be at your optimal to defeat Prime and possibly those yetis and then get everyone back."

Adora sighs, "How are we going to get them back?"

Catra takes Adora's hand in hers, "We will. You, me and Traps will find a way."

“I hope you’re right.” Adora sighs.

Catra leans in and presses her lips onto Adora’s, breathing out, “I know I’m right.”

Chapter End Notes

One more chapter to go!
I haven't forgotten about this fic, I've just been busy.

Thanks for reading, kudos, commenting, bookmarking and subscribing.
I think it's time for me to sleep now...

One Life

Chapter Summary

Getting to the golden dragon.

Chapter Notes

CW: Blood. Violence.

Chapter is just under 15K word long... so yeah, it's a long one.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Darla comes to an abrupt stop, waking up the occupants within.

Catra stirs first, her eyes opening tiredly as she cricks her neck as she looks out the windows and sees nothing but white. The magicat reaches up and wipes the window with her hand and is instantly met with coldness as she realises that this isn't a good situation.

Not at all.

She clears her throat, "Darla? Where are we?"

"In the snows." Darla replies.

"Guess that explains why everything is white…" Catra mutters under her breath as she shakes awake Adora and Entrapta, "Hey, wake up. We're here… apparently."

"Hm?" Adora slowly rouses from her sleep, "What's going on?"

"We're here." Catra repeats.

"Darla? Where are we?" Entrapta asks, now wide awake and looking around at the white in the windows, "Also… where are we?"

“That’s the same question… twice, Traps.” Catra turns her head to the purple haired woman.

“We are in the Snows.” Darla repeats, “We are currently stuck in the snow.”

“Stuck. In the snow.” Catra repeats incredulously, “We are… stuck. In the snow. At the snows.”

“Yes. Yes, we are.” Entrapta nods not understanding what Catra is saying, “We’re at the Snows!”

“Open the doors, Darla. Let us out.” Catra sighs out and then adds, “Please.”

“Doors are unlocked.” Darla says.

“No, Darla.” Catra groans out with another sigh, “Open the doors and let us out of here, please.”

“Unable to open doors.” Darla says.

“Uh… why not, Darla?” Adora asks with a yawn as she stretches her arms out, “I could stretch my legs. We’ve been sitting down for way too long.”

“Doors are stuck.” Darla says.

“Stuck?” Adora says with a slight bit of panic.

“How are the doors stuck?” Entrapta asks.

“We haven’t landed yet.” Catra says, Adora and Entrapta look at her confused, “Pretty sure we’ve crashed into the side of the mountain.”

“How?” Adora asks as she tries to force the door open, “If we crashed, how did we not feel it?”

“Snow.” Catra simply says and then looks around the inside of the van, “Darla?”

"Yes, Catra?"

"Can we back it up and out of this white?" Catra asks, "Please?"

"Can planes fly backwards?" Adora questions, "They can't fly backwards, right?"

"Planes can't fly backwards." Entrapta says, "BUT! We aren't in a plane!"

Catra chuckles under her breath, "We're in a flying van."

"Reverse thrusters!" Entrapta practically screams out excitedly, "Darla! Reverse thrustors now!"

"Powering up reverse thrustors now." Darla says, *"One minute until reverse thrustors are online."*

Adora shivers in the cool, "We should have got those jackets at the last stop…"

"I did." Catra replies and the blonde grins back, "Even though you argued with me because we don't exactly have money."

"You stole them?" Adora ask as the van starts to hum around them, "Catra!"

"What? I'm a thief by trade." Catra defends herself, "And for the record I didn't steal them."

"You've got no money." Adora points out.

"Doesn't mean I stole them." Catra replies.

"Then how did you pay for them?" The blonde asks, concern in her voice that the magicat actually did steal them.

"I traded my fighting clothes for them." The magicat replies and Adora looks her up and down, "Did you seriously not notice my change of attire, princess?"

“Well, you know… I’m not exactly concentrating on what you’re wearing.” Adora rolls her eyes.

“Ah, you just want to see what’s under, huh?” Catra teases.

“What?! No! That’s so not what I said!” Adora blushes as she shoves Catra back into her seat and takes in the fact that the magicat is wearing black slacks with a long sleeve maroon shirt.

The magicat shrugs, “If it makes you feel any better I tend to find myself daydreaming about what you feel like underneath your clothes too.”

“Catra!” Adora blushes more as the magicat laughs out and pulls the blonde into her for a kiss, “Mm…”

“Still cold?” Catra asks rubbing Adora’s arms.

Adora shakes her head, “No. I’m feeling much warmer now. But, I’d still like a jacket.”

“You’ll get one, princess.” Catra grins with a purr and then turns to Entrapta, “I’ve got one for you too.”

“Yay!” Entrapta cheers from the backseat, “Darla! How long until we get the thrusters online?!”

“Ten seconds.” Darla answers, “Nine. Eight. Seven. Six. Five. Four. Three. Two. One. Thrusters are now online.”

“Fire her up, Darla.” Adora looks up at the roof of the ceiling as she says it.

“Reverse thrusters engaging now.” Darla announces as the van starts up, shaking harshly around them, *“Getting ready to disengage from the mountain.”*

Catra snickers as she nudges Adora once more, “Told you we hadn’t landed yet.”

The flying van powers out of the side of the mountain and back into the air, the white around them clearing to a blue cloudless sky as Entrapta squeals happily in the backseat, "Woo! Science!"

"I think you mean, thrusters." Catra laughs out as Darla just hovers in the air, "Darla, bring us down to land."

"Affirmative. Coming into land now." Darla responds and guides the van to descend towards land and once they make landfall she says, *"We have now landed."*

"Thank the stars for that." Catra breathes out in relief, "I think my butt fell asleep."

Adora giggles at that as the magicat crawls over to the backseat with Entrapta and pulls out the jackets she got from their last stop, the purple haired woman's eyes widen when Catra holds out the puffy jacket towards her, "Is that for me?"

"Hell yeah, it is." Catra grins, shoving the article of clothing into Entrapta's arms, "It's huge. But they're all huge since there weren't exactly sizes. We're going to look tiny."

"You two are tiny." Adora laughs at her own joke as the pair stare at her not so amused, "I'm a giant compared to the both of you."

Entrapta tilts her head at the blonde and then widely grins back, "It's funny you should say that…"

"Huh?" Adora stops laughing a little bemused but it's quickly interrupted when Catra holds her hand up to tell everyone to be quiet, the blonde looking around cautiously as she whispers to the magicat, "What is it?"

Catra doesn't reply as her ears swivel around her head trying to pinpoint whatever has caught her attention and when she doesn't pick up anything else she breathes out, "I thought I saw something outside."

Entrapta and Adora both look out the windows of the van to the white snow covered landscape around them, the blue sky a nice contrast, the former narrows her eyes, “I don’t see anything.”

“Me neither.” Adora concurs as they both continue to look outside, the blonde grimacing a little, “Do you think it’s safe out?”

“Let me check the terrain.” Entrapta sits back and starts tapping away on her tablet.

“How are you still getting reception here, Traps?” Catra asks as she goes back to distributing the jackets, “We’re in the middle of nowhere.”

“Satellites.” Entrapta simply replies and then adds, “There’s not enough information for this place to determine whether it’s safe or not.”

“Uh, okay.” Adora swallows down and then shuffles a little uncomfortably in her seat.

“Need to stretch your legs, princess?” Catra asks and Adora nods, “Bet you’re regretting getting that large drink with your food, huh?”

“Yes.” Adora quickly replies as she shuffles again.

“Come on, I need to go too.” Catra simply says with a shrug, “I’ll keep watch while you go and then you do the same for me.” The magicat turns to Entrapta, “What about you, Traps?”

“I’m good.” Entrapta replies, “It’s hasn’t been exactly three hours yet.”

“That’s… good to know.” Catra says slowly before opening the door and getting out, “We’ll be back.”

“I’ll be here!” Entrapta continues to tap away on her tablet, “You two go. I’ll keep Darla company.”

The pair shrug and walk over to the snow covered trees.

"What's the plan?" Adora asks once they are back inside Darla, "We're still a day early."

"Prime didn't exactly give us coordinates where to go." Catra brings up, "So… I think I'm going to go scope out this place and see what's around. While the sun is up anyways."

"I'm coming with you." The blonde declares.

"Me too!" Entrapta puts her hand up, "Safety in numbers."

"What about *Darla?"* Catra asks with a grin.

"She'll be fine." The purple haired woman reassures, "She's still on camo mode."

"She… is?" Adora says unsurely, "But we managed to get back here before…"

"You were looking for it, so you found it." Entrapta replies confusing her companions even more.

Catra shakes her head at Adora, "Just go with it."

Nodding, Adora smiles back, "Okay."

"Okay, well, daylight's a burning." Catra announces and steps outside, shrugging on her oversized jacket and zipping it up, much to Adora's delight, "What?"

"You're just so cute!" Adora coos out as Catra rolls her eyes at the blonde.

"Put your jacket on too, princess. Don't want you freezing out here either." Catra tells her, "You too, Traps."

Adora's jacket is definitely not as huge as just a little oversized as the blonde goes over and wraps Catra up in her arms, "Mm… warm."

Catra laughs out, "Dork."

"Hey! I'm cool. Totally cool." Adora refutes with a grin.

"Nope." Catra replies back with a chuckle.

"You're really not!" Entrapta sing songs as she emerges, "Data never lies!"

That makes Catra laugh out even louder as the blonde slaps the magicat on the shoulder in protest, "Shut up, Cat. You're not cool either."

"Never claimed I was." Catra replies still laughing.

"Catra is cool!" Entrapta declares loudly as she shuts the door of the van and zips up her jacket, "I think it's to do with magicat traits. Or maybe because she can literally growl."

"*Do not* encourage her." Adora drawls as she groans out dramatically, "Can we get going now?"

"Yes." Catra nods as Entrapta stands next to them, "Maybe we'll be able to get something for dinner too."

"Good idea!" Entrapta bounces up and down excitedly before realising what that means, "You're not talking about foraging, are you?"

"No." The magicat replies, "But there's no telling if I'm going to catch anything."

"Oh." Entrapta says, "Though, I guess it'd be beneficial if you did catch something since we don't have anything left in the van."

“Wait. I thought we got supplies.” Adora questions, “You know? After our last stop?”

“It’s gone.” The purple haired woman simply says and then starts to walk away with no further explanation as Adora just stares after her confused, “Onwards!”

“Don’t question it, princess.” Catra says, “She sleep eats is all I’m going to say.”

Catra starts to walk after Entrapta before backtracking back and coming back for Adora, grabbing her hand and pulling her forward.

Catra quickly ducks down behind a snow covered bush, promptly doing the same to Adora and Entrapta who both yelp out in surprise as the magicat shushes them with serious intent. She gestures behind her and whispers, “There’s someone down there.”

“Who?” Entrapta whispers right back.

“Prime and his crew.” Catra tells them in hushed tones and then turns to Adora, “I haven’t seen Sparkles or Arrows.” Then to Entrapta, “Or Scorp.”

Adora frowns, moving silently closer to the bush to look over and see for herself before crouching back down and sighing, “They’re not there.”

“I just told you that.” Catra tilts her head at Adora.

“I know. I was just hoping you were wrong.” The blonde sighs out.

The magicat reaches out and puts her hand on Adora’s arm and says quietly, “We’ll get them back.”

“You promise?” Adora looks up hopefully.

Catra nods despite not being confident, “Yeah. I promise.”

The blonde nods back in confirmation and then whispers out to the group, “So, what’s the plan? Do we have a plan?”

“Observe.” Catra simply says.

“We don’t have any weapons.” Entrapta adds as she peeks over quickly as well before retreating back behind the bush with the others, “But I do see the weapon I worked on for Prime…”

“Crap.” Catra says under her breath as she does a quick look around their surroundings, “I don’t see any yetis yet.”

“You won’t see them unless they want to be seen.” Entrapta says matter of factly in a whisper, “We better get going back to Darla…”

“Yeah. Come on.” The magicat agrees and signals for her companions to start moving in the opposite direction and back to Darla.

“Catra. I have sent you the coordinates at the Snows. Come with Adora and Entrapta unarmed.” Prime snickers to himself, “I will not consider your claws weapons in this case. I wouldn’t want to deprive you of them when you face the yetis after all.”

Prime smirks into the camera and continues.

“No tricks, little sister.” The words tinged with warning, “Sundown. Tomorrow. Do not be late.”

He clicks his fingers and Glimmer, Bow and Scorpia are marched out, bound and gagged but otherwise okay.

“I am not wasting my chips on your friends.” He snarks out as the trio are forced to their knees by Prime’s soldiers, “Every minute you are late, I will not hesitate to make your friends into Swisse cheese, one bullet at a time.”

He stares into camera once more, "You, little sister, are a champion. My champion. And I will expect no less than perfection."

"Well, they're alive." Catra says as she skins the small game she managed to catch for the trio while Adora works on getting a fire going, "Could be worse."

"How? How could it be worse?!" Adora looks up with a frustrated gaze back, "He's got them. And if we stuff up, he's going to shoot them."

"That's not going to happen." The magicat drops the last of the game onto the pile and wipes her hands on her pants, "He's not going to win."

Adora shakes her head and then looks up, "We should do a surprise attack. Like tonight. Or right now!"

"No." Catra replies bluntly, "We're not ready."

"And you think we'll be ready tomorrow?!" Adora huffs out.

"I'm hungry and tired." The magicat replies, "And so are you. Plus you're angry. You're hangry."

"You're an ass." Adora throws back weakly and sticks her tongue out, "Should we really start a fire? They're going to see us."

"Ah, I've devised a plan for that." Catra grins as she gets up and walks over to the blonde and then crouches down next to her, "Hey, can I borrow those gloves of yours?"

"Sure. My hands are sweating anyways." Adora takes off her gloves and hands them to Catra who promptly puts them on and then goes back to trying to start a fire, "Ugh! They do it so easily on tv!"

The magicat chuckles and then starts to dig up the snow, like a dog digging up the dirt, scraping the dirt out with her gloved hands until she's about a metre deep and half a metre wide square, "There. Done."

"I don't get it." Adora says looking at Catra incredulously, "Also, you've ruined my gloves."

"Nah, they're all good." Catra holds her hands up and sure enough, the gloves are ruined where Catra's claws have shredded the materials, "Uh, I'll get you another pair when we get back, princess. Promise."

Adora rolls her eyes at the magicat and then her eyes widen at the red on the fabric of the gloves, "You're bleeding."

Looking at her gloved hands she realises Adora is right, "Huh. Not my blood."

"What?"

"Game." Catra points to the small pile of game she's skinned, "Not my blood."

"So, what is this hole for exactly?" Adora looks down at the hole that Catra's just dug.

"Cooking." The grin on Catra's face not doing much to help answer Adora's question as the magicat rolls her eyes, "I'm not done yet. I still need to dig out a chimney, so the smoke doesn't lead back here."

"Uh…"

"Keep trying, princess. I should be too long now I've got these beauties." Catra does some spirit fingers with her gloves and grins, "Okay, no rest for the wicked."

"You're not wicked, Cat." Adora rolls her eyes as she continues to rub two sticks together, "Doesn't Entrapta have something to light

a fire with?”

“Have you asked her?” The magicat asks right back.

“No?”

“Well, there’s your answer.” Catra shrugs, “Right. Uh, don’t stand behind me unless you want to get covered in dirt and snow, princess.”

The sun is starting to set as the trio sit inside Darla and enjoy their hot meal.

“It’s too bad there’s no seasoning around here.” Adora sighs as she picks at the meat and then smiles at Catra, “Still mighty good though.”

“Mighty, mighty.” Catra smiles back ripping the flesh off and eating the steaming portion into her mouth, “How are you going there, Traps?”

The purple haired woman narrows her eyes at the meat in front of her and scrunches up her nose, “It’s not tiny.”

Adora looks at Catra, the magicat shrugs but moves over to the other woman, “Close your eyes, Traps.”

“Why?”

“Just trust me.” Catra says with a calm tone and Entrapta nods, closing her eyes as Catra quickly shreds Entrapta’s meal into tiny pieces and when she’s done, the magicat goes back to her seat and nods to Adora, “Open your eyes, Traps.”

Entrapta’s eyes open and looks down, her eyes wide and shining with her food now in tiny pieces, “Thanks!” then turns to Adora as she pops a piece into her mouth, “See. Totally cool.”

“Ugh!” Adora scoffs out, “Not cool, Entrpata!”

Catra tries not to spit her food out as she bursts out laughing.

“These coordinates aren’t too far away from here.” Entrapta says as they settle in for the night, “Is everyone warm enough?”

“Are you?” Catra asks back as her and Adora snuggle on the very back seats of the van together, “Or did you want to join us in this nonsexual cuddlefest?”

Entrapta considers it for a moment before shaking her head when she sees Adora’s eyes close and her body relax on top of the magicat before she replies, “No, thank you. I do not plan to sleep until after whatever happens tomorrow.”

“You have to sleep, Traps. It’s not good for you.” Catra softly says as she wraps her arms around Adora tighter, keeping them warm, “You need rest too. That big data bank you have in that head of yours too. Power down, Traps. Power down.”

Entrapta watches the magicat yawn and smack her lips a few times, Catra’s eyes settle on Entrapta’s, the purple haired woman sighs and shuts off her device and puts it down, “Okay.”

“Get in here, Traps.” Catra rasps out sleepily, “Always room for more.”

“Mm…” Adora grunts out seemingly unhappy at sharing the magicat with anyone else.

“On second thoughts, I think you might have to fight Adora here to get in this.” Catra chuckles under her breath, “Are you all right up there by yourself?”

“Yes.” Entrapta wraps herself tighter in her jacket and then grabs the blanket with holes in it that she’d initially offered as a privacy

screen, then she realises something, “Darla? Please keep the van at optimal sleeping temperature.”

“Yes, Entrapta. Temperature has been set to sleep mode.” Darla replies as the inside of the van hums quietly and heating up the inside to a comfortable temperature, “Sleep mode activated. Power levels will be on standby otherwise.”

“Thank you, Darla.” Entrapta grins up and around the inside of the van as they fall asleep to the soft hums around them.

“Are we good on the plan?” Catra asks Adora and Entrapta as they trio shrug on their jackets, “Because if we aren’t going to agree on this now, then you two may as well stay here and I’ll go deal with Prime.”

“No. We’re good.” Adora answers for herself and Entrapta, “But we have to stick to it. No… veering off.”

“Only if things go without a hitch.” The magicat replies seriously as she zips up the jacket, “If shit hits the fan, you two need to get our friends and then get the fuck out. Got me?”

“No.” Adora frowns back at Catra, “We’re not leaving without you. I’m not leaving you behind.”

“We’re not leaving you behind.” Entrapta corrects.

“You guys are nuts.” Catra smiles back at the pair and sighs, “I didn’t see my crew though. Delia wasn’t there.”

“They probably have your crew somewhere else.” Entrapta says and then regrets it, “Which might not be a bad thing…”

Adora takes Catra by the hand, “When we beat Prime, we’ll get them back. We’ll get everyone back.”

Sighing out, Catra nods trying to feel that reassurance but not feeling it, "Yeah. Okay."

The blonde grabs Catra by her jacket and pulls her close, pressing her lips against the magicat's, breathing out, "We will."

Catra nods her head against Adora's and smiles up, the sun getting lower in the sky, "Yeah. We need to get going."

Adora doesn't move straight away, holding Catra close for a little but longer, "No. You told me yesterday that we would get them back. Get everyone back. Now, you need to believe it too."

Sighing once more, Catra nods and says, "We'll get them back. All of them."

The blonde smiles and presses her lips against Catra's, "My lips don't lie."

"No. Your lips are magical, princess." Catra chuckles, "And I bet whatever else you can give me is going to be… life altering."

Adora laughs out, "Such a line." She pulls Catra back in for another kiss, "But yes, it will be life altering for sure."

Entrapta pops up next to them, "We need to get going now."

"On it, Traps." Catra says without taking her eyes off Adora, instead reaching down and grabbing each of their hands, "Let's go kick Prime's ass."

The trio come into view as Prime spots them approaching, a smirk on his face as he straightens up, clicking his fingers to his soldiers, "Get into position."

"Yes, Lord Prime." The soldiers dressed in white reply as they scurry off and essentially blend into the white snow around them.

"Ah, here comes my champion." Prime announces as the trio stop in front of him as he puts his hands on his hips trying to intimidate them.

"Prime." Adora says before Catra just growls at him, "Where are our friends?"

"Safe." He simply says and then shrugs and adds, "For now."

"If you hurt them…" Catra starts to threaten and then is promptly cut off by Prime's dark chuckle.

"You'll what? Growl at me more?" Prime taunts the magicat, "Simmer down, little sister. You'll get them back once you've completed this task for me."

Catra's eye twitches in anger as she grits out, "What is it that you need me to do that you are not worthy of doing yourself?"

Prime's face changes for a moment, the looks of calm slipping for a moment as he quickly schools himself back, "You will retrieve that golden dragon for me."

"Why can't you get it yourself?" Catra asks, "Oh, right. Because you're not worthy, Primey."

This time Prime's façade does crack and he reaches out and grabs Catra, pulling her up by her oversized winter jacket and lifting her up off the ground, snarling out, "Do not cross me, little sister."
"I. AM. NOT. YOUR. LITTLE. SISTER!" The magicat swipes her claws across his face, three red lines across his face that start to bleed green as he throws Catra to the ground hard as she grunts out, "You throw like a weakling."

He wipes his face and growls out when he looks at his bloodied green hand, a look of rage on his face as he tries to grab Catra once more, this time the magicat able to avoid his grasp as Adora quickly pulls Catra back onto her feet and stepping in between Prime and the magicat, "Stop."

"Hiding behind your lover?" Prime taunts, "And here I thought you were a champion…"

"Enough!" Adora shouts out, shutting Prime down in his place, "Where are our friends?"
"I already told you, they are safe." Prime repeats with a roll of his eyes.

"I don't believe you." Adora narrows her eyes at him, "I want to see them."

Prime smirks back at the blonde, "Yes. Of course." He clicks his fingers, "Bring out the… prisoners."

Glimmer, Bow and Scorpia are brought out, bound by chains but not gagged this time as they are forced onto their knees behind Prime. Adora's eyes widen upon seeing their friends, "Guys! Are you okay?!"

"We're fine!" Bow shouts back "We're not chipped!"

Prime clicks his fingers once more and the soldiers taser the trio, they all drop to the ground unconscious as Adora screams out for them to stop, Catra and Entrapta both having to hold the blonde back from rushing towards them, "Woah, princess…" Catra tries to calm Adora down, "Woah… stop, Adora."

Adora glares at Prime and then her face turns to one of concern for their friends, she looks back at Prime, "Where's the rest of them?"

"Rest of them?" Prime raises an eyebrow up at her and laughs, "What rest of them?"

"Where's Delia and the rest of my crew?" Catra fills in the blanks for him, despite the fact that he already knows, "Where are they? I'm not doing shit until I know they're safe too."

This time Prime shakes his head, "That isn't part of the deal, little sister."

"It was always part of the deal." Catra growls out, "Where are they?"

"Again, safe." Prime replies as he clicks his fingers and a figure walks out in white, hooded, as he gestures for them to come towards him, "Come here and meet our champion."

The figure nods, bowing curtly to Prime before he turns the figure around and green eyes glow under the hood as it finally is pulled back to reveal Delia, "Hello, Catra."

"Delia." Catra says slack jawed at the sight and then turns to Prime, "She goes free too once this is over. No arguments."

"I'm not arguing." Prime says smugly, "Though, you might want to ask if she'll go back with you once this is all done."

"What?" Catra tilts her head and then looks at Delia.

"I do not want to leave, Catra. I am happy here." Delia's tone robotic and not of her own, "Lord Prime has freed me from my old life. I no longer worry about… anything. At all."

"I think she's chipped." Entrpata nudges Catra as she stage whispers the obvious.

"Yeah, I got that." Catra shakes her head before turning back to Prime, "Do we have a deal?"

"Yes. If you retrieve that golden dragon for me, I'll release all your friends back to you." Prime smirks, "But, that's only if you come out alive."

"What does that mean?" Catra tilts her head and glares at him.

"It means, everyone will go free when I get my prize." Prime places his hands on Delia's shoulder and squeezes as he adds,

"Only if you come back out alive."

"You get your stupid gold dragon and everyone goes free." Catra says.

"No." Prime shakes his head, "No deal."

"That's not fair." Catra growls out.

"Life's not fair." Prime says condescendingly, "Now, are you done whining or should I show you what little sister here can do?"

The magicat looks between the pair and has to concede as she grunts out, "Where's the fucking dragon?"

"Ah, good. Glad you asked." Prime cynically says as he removes his hands from Delia's shoulders and clicks his fingers as one of his shoulders comes around with a device in their hands, he takes it and waves the soldier away, "Here. This is where you'll find it."

Catra looks at the device in Prime's outstretched hand, the item quickly snatched away by Entrapta who's taken great interest in it, "Ooh! I've never seen one of these before!"

"It's Horde technology." Catra says as gentle brings Entrapta back in line with them, "What does it say?"

"Hm…"

"Hm, what?" the magicat huffs out at not getting an immediate answer, "Traps!"

"This is not good." Entrapta finally says.

"What is it?" Adora asks keeping an eye on Prime and the soldiers around them.

"The route up there isn't too bad." Entrapta starts to explain and then makes a face, "The item itself is quite… large."

"Large?" The blonde repeats in question.

Entrapta taps on the device a few more times and then looks at her companions, "If it's made of solid gold… we're going to need a crane or something to drag it out. There's no way we can pull that out by ourselves."

"You will not need to pull it out." Prime interrupts, "We only need you to get to it and open the door."

"Tell the whole story." Catra scoffs out, "What are you not telling us?"

"There are creatures far worse than me that keep guard of it." Prime states, "They cannot be bribed or reasoned with. You must remove them to give me full access to the prize."

"The yetis…" Adora says under her breath.

"Yes. Those vile creatures." Prime confirms, "They… cannot be influenced."

"Then why the fuck do you need me? They'll kill me on sight." Catra asks confused.

"They only allow the worthy to enter. And as the writings I have researched have said, only the winner of the tournament is able to pass by them unscathed." Prime explains, disdain dripping in his voice, "I would have simply killed them if I could get remotely close to them."

"Why not aerial attacks?" Entrapta sticks her hand up in question.

"Don't give him ideas, Traps." Catra nudges Entrapta with her elbow.

"Avalanches!" Entrapta answers her own question, "Oh, that would mean it'd be buried further under the snow…"

"Yes. I need that golden dragon to rule over those beasts." Prime lets slip before growling out to his soldiers, "Bring out the weapon!"

"Yes, Lord Prime!" A solider quickly rushes off to retrieve what has been asked, returning promptly and holding it out to their leader, "Here, Lord Prime."

Prime snatches the weapon out of the soldiers hand, who scurries off and away from Prime's possibly wrath, the former holds the weapon out to Catra, "This is for you."

The weapon looks like a blaster from outer space as she takes the item out of Prime's hands and holds it gingerly in her own, finding her footing and pointing the weapon at him. Prime looks at her and laughs, the magicat narrows her eyes at him, "What's so funny?"

"That does not work on anything but those creatures from the snows." Prime points out, "Isn't that right, Entrapta?"

"Traps?" Catra turns her head to her friend.

"He is correct." Entrapta replies sheepishly, "I am still yet to figure out how to activate it as that memory is still missing…"

"If you are not back by sunrise, I will execute every one of your friends." Prime threatens.

"Midday." Catra negotiates.

"You have until 10am. No later." Prime says with a smirk thinking he's won, "Better get moving. Time is ticking, champion."

"Fuck you." Catra spits out and looks to Entrapta, "Which way?"

"Up!" Entrapta points up at the mountain, "There's a cave just above that cliff face!"

Catra quickly pulls Entrapta back by the hair, "Woah. You. Stay."

"Why?" Entrapta whines out.

"I need to you to work with Darla." Catra whispers despite Prime able to hear but not quite understand, "You'll need to save me if shit hits the fan."

Entrapta narrows her eye at the magicat ready to argue, but the look Catra gives her makes her rethink, sighing out with a nod, "Okay."

"Okay." Catra nods back and turn to Adora, "Come on, princess."

Prime puts his hand up and smirks, "Where do you think you're going?" He says to Adora with amusement in his voice, "Those yetis won't kill the champion. But you?" Prime shrugs and chuckles once more, "Go ahead and follow your lover. You'll die sooner because of it."

"Well, it's her decision." Catra shoves Prime back, the taller man takes one step back and crosses his arms over his chest at being touched, "Fuck off and let me do it my fucking way."

"Go ahead then." Prime steps aside and smirks and then taunts, "You'll be the reason she dies tonight."

Catra holds her hand out to Adora, "You coming?"

Adora looks at the outstretched hand and takes a deep breath in before nodding, reaching out for the magicat's hand and taking in, "Yes. Let's go."

"Why are you still holding that?" Adora asks as she looks down at the weapon in Catra's hand, "Just throw it away and then Prime can't use it."

"Yeah, tried that." Catra replies much to Adora's confusion as she sighs, "It won't let me."

"It won't let you…" Adora repeats a little bit slower, "What do you mean, it won't let you?"

"Like, it won't let me." Catra repeats and she knows it's not making any sense as she tries to figure out a way to explain it, "Uh, Traps has done something to it that sort of makes it stick to me."

"Give it here." Adora holds her hand out.

"Sure." Catra holds the weapon out to Adora, "Go on."

"Let go." The blonde says tugging at the weapon, "You need to let go, Cat."

"I literally can't." Catra winces as she tries to unclench her fingers from around it, "My hand won't let it go."

Adora tries to tug it out of Catra's hand, instead pulling the magicat towards her, "Hey! Quit playing around, Cat."

"You're going to pull my arm off if you keep doing that." Catra says, as she manages to unwrap her fingers around the weapon, but it's to no avail, the magicat winces as Adora continues to tug at the weapon, "Okay, that's starting to really hurt, princess."

"Oh! Fuck! Sorry!" Adora gives up and looks at Catra's hand, the magicat swapping hands with the weapon as Adora just stares at her, "I didn't mean to hurt you!"

"It's fine, princess." Catra reassures, "I've got a feeling the only way this thing is going to leave me is when it's activated."

"And we don't even know how it's activated." Adora grumbles out unhappily.

The magicat shakes her head, 'No. We don't. We only kind of know what it's going to do."

"To the yetis." Adora points out, "I don't think we should hurt them."

"I don't plan to." Catra says as she looks at the weapon in her hands, "But I guess we'll find out when we get to that bridge."

"On the plus side, this climb is making me warm." Adora says with an air of positivity, "Though… it's going to be bad when I stop and I get cold."

Catra chuckles, "Yeah, try not to sweat too much."

"Pfft, like that's possible." Adora throws back with a cynical laugh, "I'm just going to stop sweating."

The comment makes Catra laugh out loud and squeaky, "You're such an idiot."

"Am not." Adora pouts but then smiles over at the magicat, "How are you feeling? Physically?"

"Nearly optimal." Catra replies touching her ribs unconsciously before realising and then looking at the concerned look on Adora's face, "Sorry, it's become a bad habit. But it really doesn't hurt much."

Adora pokes Catra on the side making her flinch over with a slight wince, "I knew it! You're still hurt!"

"You literally just attacked me, princess." Catra deadpans back rubbing her side, "Also you've got like really pointy fingers."

"I do not. My fingers are perfect." Adora argues as the magicat smirks back, "Oh, really? That's what you're thinking about?!"

Catra laughs again, "Better than thinking about my impending doom."

The blonde rolls her eyes at magicat, "We'll figure this out."

"Yep, I'm sure we'll figure out a way to get past those yetis to the golden dragon and somehow signal Prime to come get the stupid thing and then he hopefully keeps his word and lets all our friends

go." Catra says flatly, "I mean, that's totally what's going to happen."

"Well, it won't if you keep talking like that." Adora says a little irately, "We'll get through this. We will."

Catra nods, "Yeah." And then looks up towards their destination turning her head back to Adora, "I don't think you should come with me."

"What?!"

"The yetis are only going to let me through." Catra says, "I don't want them to hurt you, princess."

"I'm not leaving you, Catra." Adora declares defiantly, "Not a chance."

Catra sighs, knowing that she wouldn't be winning this argument against the blonde, "Just… Just be careful."

"I will." Adora promises, "Besides, technically I'm the champion."

"Huh?"

"Well, you took my place because of what happened to my leg." Adora surmises, "If my leg wasn't hurt, you wouldn't have had to take my spot. But at the end of the day, it was still my spot. And you basically fought in my place. So, technically that makes me the champion."

Catra chuckles under her breath, "I'm glad I took your spot, princess. I don't think I could handle watching you go up against who I went against." Adora gives her a strange look, "Not saying that you wouldn't have won, but, I don't think I'd handle you getting hurt as bad as I did too well."

"Well, if I was fighting, I wouldn't have gotten hurt." Adora says before laughing out, "Who am I kidding, you literally fought an angel, Catra."

"Did I?"

"Yes! How could you forget?" Adora replies incredulously.

"I did get a lot of knocks to the head." Catra replies rubbing her head, "Plus I got knocked out a few times too. I'm probably brain damaged and just don't know it yet."

The blonde reaches out and gently pets between Catra's ear, eliciting a soft purr, "You did get hurt a lot, Catra. And when this is all over, I'm going to get you checked out by the healers and medics properly. Make sure you haven't sustained anything too concerning."

"If we get out of this alive and with all our friends, I'll let you take out me to whatever healer or medical person you want." Catra replies and then adds, "But only after I get to see what kind of healing properties I'll get from you when it's not just kisses."

"I'm not a magical healer, Cat." Adora rolls her eyes and laughs, "But I would be more than happy to try to heal you with all this."

Catra watches as Adora gestures to all of herself, grinning widely, "Oh yeah."

"But only after you get checked out and fixed up properly." Adora argues and then smiles reassuringly as Catra groans out dramatically, "But you heal fast anyways. So, it won't be much of a wait."

"I guess." The magicat sighs out with a small smile before looking up, "Okay, we're getting close. We need a plan."

"I can see the dragon." Adora whispers to Catra as they stay close to the walls of the cave, she's turned off her torch but the golden dragon is lit up somehow.

The magicat nods and unmoving, "Something's not right."

Adora's eyes dart around the inside of the cave, "What?"

"It's too quiet." Catra whispers back as her ears twitch around on her head, "It's seems too perfect… too easy…"

"I'll go first. Cause a distraction and you get to the dragon." Adora suggests softly.

"No."

"Catra, come on." Adora says quietly with a frown, "We don't have a lot of time."

"I know."

"So? Come on." Adora repeats, "I can handle myself."

Catra grabs onto Adora's jacket, "Wait."

"What?" Adora pauses upon hearing the urgency in Catra's voice, the blonde looks around once more and sees nothing, "I don't see anything."

"That's the thing." Catra replies closing her eyes.

"Catra. We need to go. Now." Adora harshly whispers back, "We're wasting time."

Catra shakes her head, "Slow down."

The blonde frowns, eyes darting around once more, "Catra."

"No. Trust me, princess." The magicat says opening her eyes, "It's too easy. It's never this easy."

"There's no one and nothing in there. We would have seen or at least heard something by now." Adora reasons, "All we need to do is get a signal to Prime that it's all clear."

Catra stares at the blonde, "What did you say?"

"I said, we need to get a signal to Prime that it's all clear." Adora repeats, "And right now that seems like the best time to do it. There's no yetis. They aren't in there."

Catra grins at the blonde, "See, this is why I love you."

"I don't… what?" Adora replies a little confused, "I love you too. But, what?"

"I love you, princess." The magicat repeats with a wider, leaning in and pecking Adora on the lips, "You're a genius!"

"Thank you…?"

"I've got an idea, thanks to you." Catra says as she looks over to the golden dragon and then grins once more, "But you're not going to the be distraction."

Adora tilts her head and furrows her brow, "I don't like this…"

"I'm going to be the distraction while you give the signal to Prime that it's all clear." Catra explains her plan.

"What about the yetis?" Adora asks.

"I've got this." Catra holds up the blaster.

"You don't even know how it works." Adora argues.

"I'll figure it out." The magicat replies with a shrug.

"This is a terrible idea." Adora groans out, "You're going to get hurt or worse. And I'm not going to stand around and just let that happen."

"I'll be fine." Catra tries to reassure, "I just need him to come up here."

"He's not going to fall for it, Catra.' The blonde points out, "And if he finds out… he's going to hurt our friends or maybe do something even worse."

"Fuck." Catra sighs out, "You're right. We can't risk it."

Adora gives her a consolatory look, "Let's go with my idea?"

"No." Catra replies defiantly, "I'm not letting you put yourself in danger."

"I'm not letting you do it either." Adora crosses her arms over her chest.

"Those yetis aren't going to hurt me. I'm the champion or whatever." Catra replies, "And don't give me that crap about how you're the champion technically." The magicat reaches out for Adora's hand, squeezing it in hers, "Look. Stay here and give the signal when I tell you."

Adora shakes her head, "No."

"Yes." Catra huffs out, "I'm not going to risk your life in this."

"No."

"Yes." Catra repeats, "Take this."

The blonde looks down at the tablet that Prime had given Catra for directions up to the dragon, "Why?"

"So, you can give him the signal. Go out to where we came in and wait ten minutes and then give him the signal that it's all clear." Catra says as she peeks towards the dragon once more, "I'll be fine. They won't hurt me."

Adora sighs, "You're not going to back down, are you?"

"Nope."

"Fine." Adora takes the tablet out of Catra's hand, "But if anything happens, get the heck out of there as fast as you can. Or call out for me and I'll come running."

"Look, princess." Catra sighs out, "If anything happens, I'm glad that you've got my back."

"I've got you. All of you." Adora pulls Catra in for a hug, resting her forehead on the magicat's, "I can fight you know? I'm not some damsel in distress."

"I know." Catra grins back, "You'd kick my ass in a heartbeat."

"I'd also defend your ass too." Adora jests lightly.

"You've already saved mine." Catra replies as she swallows down the fear of the next part, "I'll be fine."

Adora breathes out, "Just be careful."

"Always am." Catra grins once more, "Okay, get going. The sooner we do this, the sooner it ends."

The words strike something within Adora, but she isn't sure and shakes that feeling away, but it lingers as she nods, "Okay. Hurry." And as Catra turns to head towards the dragon, Adora pulls her back and kisses her deeply, "This is not goodbye. You got me, Cat?"

"I got you, princess." Catra smiles back and chuckles under her breath, "Okay, quit distracting me and let me do my thing."

Without another moment to spare, the pair turn from one another and take off in opposite directions, not looking back.

Something glistens in the ice outside the cave as Adora steps outside into the darkness, the feeling of being watched and even at times a ghost feeling of someone of something trying to grab at her subsides once she's outside. The moonlight softly covering the surface as the blonde looks around her surroundings. She looks at the time on the tablet device and takes a breath in, not feeling the cold around her as she count downs the ten minutes.

10 minutes later…

"Prime. It's all clear." Adora says into the device and then yelps when it lights up with his face, she glares at the image on the screen, "Now, release my friends."

"No. Not until I get my dragon." Prime simply replies.

Adora holds back from growling at him, "It's all clear. Get up here now and then give me back my friends."

"Oh, my dear, Adora." Prime's voice condescending, "Do you think I am foolish enough not to know what game you and my champion are playing?"

"I don't know what you're talking about." Adora replies defiantly, trying to mask the lie, "I already told you, twice, that it's all clear."

"If that is the case…" Prime's tone turning menacing, "Then you'll have no issue with walking me inside that cave and showing me the dragon in its full glory then, will you?"

"Of course not." Adora lies again, hoping that he's buying it, as she clenches her fists off screen,

"Lead the way." Prime simply says, "If it's not a trap, then you'll have no trouble walking me through it before I get up there too."

"Fine." Adora replies, her confidence unwavering despite herself, "But you better start getting up here too."

Prime nods, "We are on our way."

Adora watches as he steps onto a skiff, the video panning around to the multiple skiffs along with her captive friends as she swallows own her nerves, preparing herself to go inside.

"Well, move along." Prime insists and Adora glares at him once more.

"Let's go." Adora grunts out and then trips over something, the tablet falling from her hands as, landing face up so all Prime can see is the moonlit sky as the blonde swears under the breath as her fingers graze over something in the snows, a bracelet, a gold bracelet with a white jewel on it, "What the…?"

"You're wasting time." Prime's voice grows irate.

Adora rolls her eyes, reaching out and picking up the device one more and glaring at him, the bracelet in her hand as his eyes spot it, "Thanks for your concern." The words are said sarcastically as she gets back to her feet and brushes herself off. When Prime doesn't snark anymore, she looks at the screen and sees his face light up, "What?"

"That's a nice piece you've just found." Prime says as their convoy begins to move and then adds, "There must be more treasures there than just the golden dragon…"

Adora scoffs at the man's greediness, "Whatever."

"Show me my dragon, Adora." Prime instructs, "And then show me my champion."

Scoffing once more, Adora turns on her torch and starts walking back into the dark cave, hoping that Catra is okay.

"Adora?" Catra says surprised to see the blonde walk in, "What are you doing here?"

"Little sister. My champion." Prime's voice comes from device in Adora's hand, "I see that Adora was telling the truth if you are alive and well and there have been no encounters with these so called mythical yetis."

"Yeah, whatever." Catra replies frowning back at the screen, "When are you getting here?"

"I will be there soon. Patience little one." Prime replies snidely, "Patience."

"Fuck you, Prime." Catra mutters under her breath as she turns her back on the device and goes back to inspecting the golden dragon.

Adora turns the device to face herself, "Let our friends go."

Prime grins tauntingly, the camera turning to the skiff holding her friends on board as he hands the device to one of his soldiers so they can film him, pointing to the other skiff in a gesturing manner, "Your wish…" he gives the signal to the other skiff and the two soldiers piloting it leap into Prime's skiff, the other skiff loses control and drops out of the camera's vision as it points back to Prime who finally says, "Is granted."

"No!" Adora screams out at the screen as it cuts off and turns black, "No! No! NO!"

Catra comes over and wraps her arms around the blonde, "What? What happened?!"

"He… he… Prime…" Adora says with stuttered rage, "I have to go!"

"Wait, Adora!" Catra pulls her back, "What happened?!"

"They could be in trouble! Or hurt!" Adora tries to break free as Catra tries to follow, "He crashed them on the skiff coming here!"

"Fuck…" Catra says under her breath as she squeezes the blonde, "Go. I'll call Traps to get over there."

"What about you?" Adora asks holding the magicat by her cheeks.

"I'll be fine." Catra replies giving her the most reassuring smile she can muster, "Go. You need to help them. Trust me."

Adora nods, "Okay. I'll…"

"I love you." Catra presses her lips onto Adora's, "Now, go."

The magicat pushes Adora away, the blonde stumbles back before taking a breath and nodding, "I love you too."

Catra nods as Adora rushes out to help their friends, the magicat turns back to the golden dragon and sighs and says under her breath, "Hurry up, Prime."

"Adora!" Entrapta pulls up next to the blonde descending the icy mountain, "Get in!"

"Entrapta?!" Adora nearly trips over as she comes to a stop, "What are you doing here?"

"Get in!" Entrapta replies, "I saw everything! Get in! Darla will get us to them!"

Adora pulls herself into Darla as Entrapta slams the door shut, "Are they okay?" the blonde asks as she catches her breath, "How do you even know about what happened?!"

Darla starts up, the force of van propelling them forward has Adora flopping backwards, Entrapta grimaces looking from her seat she's strapped herself into, "Oh, hold on."

"Thanks…" Adora grumbles as she pulls herself up onto a seat and puts the seatbelt on, "Are they okay? Hurt? Dead?!"

"Their skiff hit a tree." Entrapta replies, "I came down from circling the air when I heard the transmission between you and Prime."

"Are they okay, Entrapta?!" Adora repeats with a lot more grunt, "Please! Just tell me!"

"I… I don't know." The other woman replies with another grimace, "I… I only saw the crash and then I saw you."

"Oh." Adora furrows her brows, "How far are we from them?"

"Not far." Entrapta replies, "Darla? How far until we get to the skiff?"

"We are approximately 3 minutes away." Darla replies.

"Thank you, Darla!" Entrapta says as she pulls out another device and starts to tap on it, "Did you find the dragon?"

"Yes."

"And the weapon?"

"What of it?"

"Did it work?" Entrapta asks giddily, "What was the activation point?"

"I don't know. We didn't run into any yetis." Adora replies confused.

"Huh."

"Why?"

"It's just strange." Entrapta taps on the device and then hands it over to Adora, "Look at this."

"What am I looking at?" Adora asks.

Entrapta makes a face like Adora should know, "The two blue dots are you and Catra."

"Okay…" Adora says staring at the screen, "What are the yellow dots all around us?"

"You didn't see them?" Entrapta asks confused, "How did you not see them?"

"See what?" Adora huffs out not understanding, "It looks like we were surrounded."

"You were. Completely." Entrapta replies, "By yetis."

"There weren't any yetis there. I would have known." Adora says with an air of certainty, "They would have attacked me."

"They wouldn't have attacked you." The other woman simply says without looking at the blonde, "You were with Catra."

"But Prime said…" Adora starts to say.

"And you are a champion in your own right." Entrapta continues, "If they were going to attack you, they would have done so when you left Catra's company. But they didn't. Not the second time. Say, that's a very interesting bracelet you have there."

Adora looks at her wrist, "Oh, I found this outside the cave when I sent the signal to Prime."

"Hm." The purple haired woman hums, "Interesting."

"Why is that…" Adora is cut off when the sight of flames outside the front windscreen catches her eyes, "Oh no…"

"Little sister." Prime says as he enters the cave, low growls echo within its walls as his soldiers visibly shudder at the prospect of something unseen attacking them as they all ready their weapons. Prime, however, walks ahead without a care in the world, "I see

those yetis are nothing but stories told to scare away treasure hunters."

Catra doesn't respond.

The non-response has Prime snarling loudly into the cavernous space, "Show yourself, little sister. No more games."

A soft rumbling sound emits from around the walls of the cave as Prime's men start to murmur amongst themselves, he growls at them for silence as they all turn to each other and reluctantly obey his order.

Finally, Prime's entourage's flashlights shine around towards the main cave where the golden dragon is situated. The look of satisfaction clear on Prime's face as his eyes are drawn to large gold dragon in the middle of the moonlit room, the dragon itself illuminated by the gold of the dragon.

He stays on the edge of the opening and then spots Catra, laying on her back on top of the large dragon's back lazily, waiting with eyes closed.

"Ah! Excellent work, my champion." Prime puts his hands together, "I take it the weapon worked like a treat. Entrapta is very talented under the right… conditions." He looks around and sees no sign of yetis or anyone else for that matter, "Where is the weapon, little sister?"

Catra holds the weapon straight up into the air with her left hand, "Right here."

"Excellent." Prime repeats as he takes one step inside the cave only to met with the sounds of loud growling and then glowing yellow eyes and sharp teeth. Prime's enthusiasm turns to anger as not one, but a room full of yetis appear practically out of nowhere, "You tricked me!"

Catra turns her head in surprise, "Huh. I didn't even know they were there."

"Use the weapon!" Prime orders loudly and then threatens, "Or I will kill ALL your friends!"

"No, you won't." Catra simply replies as his soldiers are picked off one by one.

"Yes, I will!" Prime shrieks, his voice high and angry as he gestures for someone to come forward, "Use the weapon or I throw your precious Delia to the yetis!"

"Delia." Catra sits up and watches as the yetis rip apart Prime's soldiers, body parts thrown everywhere along with the ever growing pool of blood and bodies piling up. But they leave Prime alone, Delia standing still and seemingly awaiting orders, "You let her go! You've got your stupid prize!"

"You broke the deal, little sister!" Prime snarls out, "But I'll give you one last chance. Use the weapon and strike down these… monsters. And I will give her to you."

Delia looks up at Catra, her eyes clearing from green back to brown, her conscious awakened as her eyes widen and focus on the magicat, "Catra!"

"Dee!" Catra jumps down just as her eyes go back to green, "No!"

"Hello Catra." Delia says this time, "Do as Prime says and I will come back to you."

"Let her go!" Catra demands as Prime grunts while pushing back the yetis.

"Use the weapon." He growls out as he has Delia fight for him, "Do it!"

Catra growls out, "I don't know how to!"

"Liar!" Prime shouts out, "Use it!"

Catra looks down at the weapon in her hand and furrows her brows, "I don't know how to activate it, you fucking asshat!"

Delia turns around after shoving back one of the yetis, pulling out a sword Catra didn't even know she had, unsheathing it and running it straight through the magicat just as the green disappears and she's released from Prime's grasp. Delia looks through her own eyes and they widen, "No! Catra!" the sword still embedded inside the magicat, skewered through as Catra touches the sword and her wound with her hand holding the weapon, her blood brushing against it as she looks to her friend.

"Hey Dee…" Catra manages to say as she feels the weapon charge up in her hand, her other hand holds the sword in place, she looks to her friend and says, "No… don't pull it out…"

Delia rushes to Catra's side, just as the magicat's legs collapse, "Catra! No! Just hold on! I'll get you help!"

"It's okay, Dee." Catra tries to reassure as the weapon reaches full charge and she feels herself involuntarily pulling the trigger, "Fuck…"

ROAR! SCREECH!

The yetis all back away, screeching out as they cover their ears at whatever sound is emitting from the weapon activated by Catra's blood as Prime starts to laugh out manically.

"Ah! YES! It's working! It WORKS!" He shouts out, raising his arms up victoriously as Delia and Catra watch on. He turns back to them and claps, "Thank you. Now, for my prize."

Catra can't do anything but whimper out in pain as she lies in Delia's arms, unable to form words as she tries to take her finger off the weapon, she looks to her friend, "My… my hand…"

"Shh…" Delia shushes the magicat in her arms, "Save your breath, Cat. Stay awake."

"My… my hand…" Catra repeats gritting her teeth, "The… the… weapon…"

Prime walks past the pair, grinning in happily down at the pair, "Delia is yours, little sister. I have no more use for her." and as he passes, he strikes her hard on the back of her neck causing her to scream out and fall forward, "This deal is complete. Well done."

Delia falls forward, convulsing next to Catra as her eyes roll back and the green goo leaks out of her body, "Dee… hold… on…"

The magicat reaches out and grabs Delia's hand and squeezes it, for a moment while her friend recovers she doesn't get a reaction back until…

Delia squeezes Catra's hand back and the magicat visibly lets out a sigh of relief, "You're going… to… be… okay…"

Delia's eyes remain shut as she breathes heavily next to Catra, the magicat on her side catching the sight of Prime walking up to the golden dragon. His hand reaches out and touches the dragon and he starts to laugh.

"I did it!" He shouts out, pulling out a radio, "I've got it. Get the ship in position to get this on board." The request is acknowledged by whoever Prime has communicated with on his radio as he walks around the entire gold dragon, "You are beautiful. And now, you're mine."

"Get a room." Catra coughs out interrupting Prime's 'chat' with the gold dragon, "You sick prick."

"Perhaps I should pull that sword out of you, little sister." Prime turns around to see Catra on her side, breathing harshly on her side, "Would you like me to grant you that bit of mercy, my champion? End this pain faster?"

"What… pain…?" Catra scowls out, breath laboured, "The… the… the only pain… is you."

Prime glares at her, "I think my mercy is wasted on you. I think I will enjoy watching your slow death. Knowing that you'll see me take away my prize before I bury you in this cave."

As Catra is about to jibe back at Prime, she hears the familiar voice of the woman she loves, along with the footsteps and of someone else that the magicat recognises as Entratpa and she can't help but smile, despite not being able to see them from how she's positioned.

"Catra!" Adora voice calls out, "Catra! No!"

The blonde comes sliding to down, bringing Catra up and into her arms, the magicat smiling up at Adora, "Oh, hey Adora."

"Catra! You're hurt!" Adora states the obvious loudly, "No, no, no, no, no…"

"Kiss me? Make me better?" Catra says, a lilt of amusement in her voice despite the fact that she's very much bleeding out, albeit not as quickly if the sword had been pulled out, "Use… use your magic, princess…"

Entrapta tries to pull the yeti weapon out of Catra's hand unsuccessfully as she frowns and tilts her head down at the magicat, "It was your blood, wasn't it?"

Catra nods weakly.

Adora looks up and sees Prime coming towards them, his form towering over them as Entrapta steps in between them, "Stay back!"

Prime sneers at her, shoving her to the side harshly away, "I have no use for you now. Go. I am only showing you this mercy thanks to your weaponry talents."

Entrapta lands with a thud on the ground, wincing as she lands harshly, "Ow…"

"Leave her alone!" Adora shouts out as Prime takes another step forward, "You've got what you wanted! Leave us alone!"

Prime grins looking down at them as he says, "My condolences, Adora."

"What?" the blonde looks up at him confused before she shouts out, "NO!"

Prime grabs the swords handle, wrapping his fingers around it with a sick grin on his face and pulls the swords out of Catra's body with enough force that he practically lifts the magicat up with it until the blade eventually slides out before stabbing it back into the magicat and then pulling it out once more, laughing maniacally all the while until Adora pushes him back, making him fall to the ground.

Catra groans out, the pain now unbearable as she curls up into a tight ball and takes short rapid breaths, "Fuck… I'm… I'm… dying, dying…"

"Catra, no!" Adora pulls Catra up and into her arms, her eyes close as she whispers, "You're not dying. You're not. You can't. Remember?"

"It's… it's my time…" Catra sputters out, blood filling her mouth and blood, as she smiles weakly a bloody smile, "My time…"

"No…" Adora pulls Catra even closer, practically crushing her in her arms as the gem in the bracelet she found starts to glow bright white as she feels her body thrumming with a new kind of magical energy.

Entrapta's eyes widen and her jaw drops before she squeals out excitedly.

Prime's eyes widen also, taking in the bright light emanating from Adora's bracelet before if consumes the pair entirely as he shields himself with his hands and grits his teeth together. And then the light finally fades back, he's met with the sight of Adora, no longer the small figure from before but now an amazon in white with long flowing blonde hair and gold tiara on her head holding Catra in her arms.

And all he can say is, "No."

Adora's eyes open to a blinding blue hue as she glares at him and says, "You will pay for what you've done."

He growls out at her as he tries to grab at Catra only to be shoved back so hard by Adora that his back hits the rocky wall of the cave on the far side.

"Ah! She-Ra!" Entrapta beams as she runs over to Adora and Catra, "I knew it! I knew it!" then her face goes pale upon seeing Catra unconscious and seemingly dead, "Oh no! Catra!"

"Entrapta?" Adora says, "Can you get Delia out of here? Get Darla here ready for evacuation please."

"Okay!" Entrapta nods with her eyes still firmly on Catra's limp form, "Is she… is Catra…?"

"I don't know." Adora replies sullenly, she pulls Catra closer and whispers into the magicat's ear, "You can't give up, Catra. You can't."

Adora turns to Entrapta in her She-Ra form, "Please, get Delia out of here and to safety. We'll be right behind you."

Entrapta nods, doing her best of get Delia up, her hair doing most of the work as she turns back to the blonde, "Don't take too long."

"I won't." Adora promises, "Now, go. Please."

Without another word, Entrapta manages to get herself and Delia out of the cave as Prime comes charging back, landing a hit on the back of Adora's head, causing the blonde grunt out, doing her best not to drop Catra in her arms.

"You're too late, She-Ra." Prime taunts, "Little sister is dead. You've failed."

Adora kicks him back, he stumbles back and falls over once again, "You're a monster."

"I am a god!" Prime growls out as he gets back to his feet, "Once I have the golden dragon on board my ship, nothing can stop me from using all the magic within it to crush every planet that refuses to see my light."

Catra's body makes a scoffing noise and Adora's eyes quickly run over the magicat in her arms, a small smile graces her lips upon seeing the nearly impossible to see the rise and fall of her chest. But to make sure, Adora presses her ear to Catra's chest and sure enough, there's a steady heartbeat. The thought of losing Catra makes Adora furious as she watches Prime come back towards her.

Whispering into Catra ear, "I'll be right back." She gently lowers the magicat to the ground and squares herself up against Prime, "You've underestimated her and me."

"Doesn't matter." Prime replies smugly, "I'll just kill her again. My champion is not invincible by any means."

He picks up the sword that had fallen when Adora had knocked him to the ground and charges towards Catra's weakened form, ready to inflict more injury only to be pushed back by Adora once more. This time the blonde picks him up and body slams him causing him to groan out in pain, "Stay. Down."

Adora quickly picks up Catra in her arms, her ears pick up the sound of the magicat's breath returning harshly as her eyes open

and she gasps. Adora quickly stops and brings her close, reassuringly, "A-Adora?"

"Hey. It's okay. I'm here." Adora says not realising she isn't the same as before, "I've got you, Cat."

"You're… huge." Catra looks up at Adora.

Adora giggles, "You're such an idiot."

"That… that's my line… princess." Catra rubs her face against Adora's chest, she looks into the blue eyes of Adora's new form, "Prime?"

"That's Lord Prime!" Prime growls out again, this time tackling the pair to the ground, "You miscalculated! You should have killed me, now, I'm going to kill you. Both of you!"

Catra rolls out of Adora's arms as the blonde takes the fight to Prime. And on unsteady legs, Catra pulls herself over to the golden dragon, putting her bloody hand on the side of it as she uses to get herself upright, the other one unable to let go of the weapon.

Suddenly the solid mass under her hand changes from smooth to scaly and she tries to step back but realises she can't without falling over. The golden dragon no longer just a statue, no, it was a real life dragon. And right now, it had its eyes on the magicat.

"Oh, fuck." Catra grumbles out, stumbling back but keeping her eyes on the dragon that's come to life, she clears her throat and even with the residual pain from the multiple stab wounds she's been inflicted with manages to say, "We got problems…"

Prime and Adora ignore her as they continue to fight, not noticing the huge ass dragon animating and stretching out like it hasn't moved for a really long time. The creature seems to increase in size dramatically until it's practically hitting the roof of the cave with its head as Catra finally breaks eye contact with it and rushes

towards Prime and Adora, shoving the pair of them and making them both stumble sideways.

"Catra! You will pay for that!" Prime snarls out as Adora winces at the claws accidentally pricking her skin.

"Shut the fuck up, Prime!" Catra snarls right back, "I'm trying to save your fucking life from a fucking dragon!"

"Save my li-oh my stars! A-a DRAGON!" Prime's eyes widen as the so-called mythical beast turns its head and looks directly at the trio, tilting its head for a bit, seemingly contemplating something. Prime grunts out and shoves the magicat forward towards the dragon, "What have you done to my prize, little sister?!"

"Me?!" Catra stumbles forward and drops to her knees in front of the dragon as Adora goes to pull her back only for Prime to attack her again as they go back to struggling and fighting, "Hey! Leave her alone!"

"Get out of here, Cat!" Adora shouts out as she continues to grapple with Prime, "I got this!"

ROAR!

All three of them still, Prime and Adora mid fight as they all give their full attention to the real threat in the room. Instead of running, Prime grabs Catra up her torn up jacket, brings her up into the air with her feet dangling as he turns to the dragon, "Over here! I have what you want!"

"No!" Adora tries to rush over, just as the dragon decides to test out its fire breathing powers, actively aiming at the blonde who manages to get out of the way with a shriek, "Woah!"

"It breathes fire…" Catra says under her breath.

Prime glares at her, "My golden dragon… you will pay for this."

"I got you up here. You got your stupid gold dragon. It's not my fucking fault that it's come alive!" Catra kicks him hard in the chest, being dropped in the process, the magicat turns around to face the dragon, "Hey! Dragon dude!"

ROAR!

"Woah!" Catra leaps out of the way as does Prime, splitting them apart. The dragon looks around the room like it's lost something and roars once more loudly, looking at Catra and then the device in the magicat's hand before breathing out fire once more. Catra yelps as she manages to leap out of the way once more, before she's yanked out of the way by Adora, the blonde somehow animating a shield stopping the fire from hitting them, the magicat looks up from where she was cowering and her eyes widen, "Adora? How… how are you doing that?"

"I don't know!" Adora admits as the flames continue to go around them as they take cover behind the shield as the blonde jests a little awkwardly, "It's kind hot here, isn't it?"

Catra chuckles, "You're such an idiot."

That earns her a smile from the blonde, "I-I don't know how long I can keep this up, Cat…"

Prime scrambles along the cave walls, looking for something to take down the dragon with, probably something to turn it back, but finds nothing as he growls out and instead eyes the sword from before on the ground, making his way over to it and picking it up.

Catra sees him approach the dragon, "Keep our friend here distracted. I'll be right back!"

"Wait! What are you doing?!" Adora shouts out as Catra quickly rolls out and away, the dragon not paying any attention to her as the bright white light of Adora's shield keeps the focus on her, "Catra!"

"Hey!" Catra shouts out, surprising Prime getting ready to stab into the underbelly of the dragon, the magicat slashes at his shoulder making him drop the sword with a loud clang as the dragon's attention moves to closer to itself and then eyes the pair of them, "Oh fuck…"

SNAP! SNAP! SNAP! SNAP!

The dragon snaps its huge jaws down, barely missing both Prime and Catra as the pair scramble around the cave to avoiding being eaten, Adora doing her best to draw the dragon away from the magicat to no avail as it focuses its eyes on Catra. And just as she's about to make a run for the magicat, Prime tackles her to the ground in a surprise attack, trying to pull the gold bracelet off Adora's arm, "Give me that! That must be what turns it back into that golden object my prize is supposed to be!"

Adora pushes him away, the bracelet transforms into a sword and both of their eyes widen in surprise. The blonde quickly regaining her composure first and gets into an attacking stance against Prime who snarls at her.

"ARGH! FUCK!" Catra screams out in pain.

Adora shoves Prime back, knocking him out as his head makes harsh contact with hard surface of the cave wall. The blonde watches as the dragon hauls Catra up and into the air, its jaws clamped around her arm that's holding the weapon as the magicat grits her teeth together in pain.

"Catra!" Adora shouts out as she rushes towards the dragon, sword at the ready to strike at the beast that has her magicat's arm in its mouth.

"No! Stay back, princess!" Catra growls out and then screams out when the dragon bites down on her arm and then all of a sudden, she's falling to the ground, "…fuck."

"Catra!" Adora shouts out again, running out to catch the magicat as the dragon swallows down the appendage in its mouth, the blonde managing to catch Catra just before she makes impact with the ground. The magicat cupping her severed limb close to her chest as she hisses out in pain, "Shit! Shit! Shit!" She looks around and sees the dragon staring at the pair of them, "We need to go."

ROAR!

The pair both wince at the increased volume of the dragon's roar, waiting in anticipation for the beast to finish them off.

But it doesn't come.

Adora and Catra both look at the dragon as the dragon looks right back at them.

It stares at them.

Just breathing.

And then…

ROAR!

The sound of a different type of roar.

No. Not from the dragon, but from somewhere else.

Something else.

Catra grimaces in Adora's arms, ignoring whatever else is coming to get them, her face going pale from blood loss, "My belt."

"What?!"

"My belt. Take it off." Catra instructs as calmly as she can, her ears twitching around the top of her head, "Tie it around my arm, please."

Adora looks around, the dragon still looming over them, "But what about…?"

"Don't worry about them." Catra brushes off the blonde's concern, "They're cool."

"They're cool?!" Adora shrieks out as she looks at the dragon that's just staring at them shaking her head, "They are not cool!"

"I'm cool." Catra replies with another wince and a weak smirk, "My belt… please, princess. My… belt."

The dragon makes a sort of noise that seems… encouraging… as Adora looks around in utter bewilderment, "If I get eaten by a dragon, it'll be totally your fault."

"We're not getting eaten." Adora unbuckles Catra's belt as the magicat chuckles, "Trap's thinks I'm cool…"

BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG! BANG!

Gun fire rings out within the cave as Horde soldiers rush in. Bullets flying every which way as Adora quickly ties the belt tourniquet around Catra's arm and then shields her from the gun fire.

ROAR!

The dragon roars out angrily, snapping down onto the soldiers advancing towards it, their eyes open in fear as it starts to chomp down on their compatriots, leaving just their feet in their boots as they are consumed one by one.

Just as the soldiers turn around to retreat, yetis come running back in. Now that the weapon is deep inside the belly of the golden dragon, the yetis are very angry. Attacking everyone trying to leave the cave, limbs ripped off and then used to beat them with as the sound of Horde soldiers shrieking out in pain and fear fill the cave.

"Adora?" Catra says looking up at the blonde still in her She-Ra form.

"Yeah?" Adora replies pulling her eyes away from the carnage happing around them.

"You kind of look cool like this." Catra says with a shit eating grin as she pokes the tiara on top of Adora's head, "Still not cooler than me though."

"Shut up." Adora replies with a laugh and then sighs looking around the room, "I don't think we're going to get out of this, Cat."

"Sure, we will, princess." Catra replies with a slow and tired blink, "Just pick me up and walk us out."

"Just like that, huh?" Adora huffs out at the absurdity, "That's crazy."

"Yeah. Just like that." Catra says leaning her head against Adora's chest, "Just, walk us out."

"You're crazy." Adora rolls her eyes and then her breath catches when she sees Prime running towards them with the sword once more.

The manic look in his eyes and rage on his face says it all for his intent to kill them as he charges full speed from the other side of the cave towards the pair. Adora tries to grab her sword, but it's futile as she's still holding onto Catra in her arms.

"I'm sorry…" Adora whispers to Catra as she braces for Prime's sword to stab the two of them…

There's a muffled scream but no impact as Adora opens her eyes to Catra grinning widely.

"What? What happened?" Adora asks looking around for Prime and then she sees what Catra has already spotted.

"Well… his fancy boots are right there." Catra gestures to the right and then up, "They don't seem to like the taste of Prime if they didn't eat all of him. Boots and all…"

Adora looks up and watches as the dragon swallows a second time, "Stars… did that just…"

"Yeah." Catra replies and winces, "We need to go, princess. Or I am going to bleed out, despite your amazing belt tying skills."

The sounds of Horde soldiers still screaming out and grunting as they continue to face a double attack on them fills the cave, Catra rubbing her face tiredly on Adora's chest once more, "Just stand up, Adora. Walk out. Trust me."

Adora nods though not completely convinced or confident.

She takes a deep breath and stands up.

Looking around and then at Catra in her arms, "Are you sure they aren't going to get me?"

"I'm absolutely certain… champion." Catra replies as her eyes roll back in her head.

"Catra?" Adora shakes the magicat in her arms, Catra's head lolling from side to side and then she finds herself on her feet, eyes on Catra's slow breaths as she calmly walks out through the mass of yetis, Horde soldiers and the dragon's jaws snapping down and around her, she presses her lips onto Catra's forehead, ignoring everything going on around them as she simply walks out. I gentle buzz on her lips as she presses them against the magicat's again.

"Argh…" Catra groans out once they are back outside, her shivers and shaking exacerbating the pain, "F-fucking… fff… cold…"

"I got you, Cat." Adora whispers as Darla finally comes into view, Entrapta waving her arms in the air to signal them to her, "Hold on. We're going home."

"…home…" Catra mumbles as her face contorts into pain.

"Yeah." Adora smiles wetly, not realising tears are coming down her face as she finally gets to Darla and looks to Entrapta, "She's hurt. Again…"

"Bring her inside!" Entrapta shouts out but the magicat reaches out and stops them, grabbing the side of the door before Adora can bring her inside, "What are you doing?! You're bleeding out!"

"Can't… can't leave… dragon… yetis…" Catra groans out.

ROAR!

The sound of the dragon roaring and the yetis screeching out has everyone looking back towards the cave shining out with the golden light of the dragon. And then there's the loud sound of rumbling, mixed with cracking of ice has the trio looking up.

"Traps… go. Go now!" Catra grunts out, her consciousness fading in and out, "…now."

"Get in! AVALANCHE! AVALANCHE!" Entrapta shouts out as Adora gets herself and Catra inside, "Darla! Go! NOW!"

"Affirmative." Darla replies.

"Hold on!" Entrapta screams out as Darla lifts off and accelerates away at great speed.

"Oof…" Catra grumbles as she finally loses consciousness once more, her breathing becoming so shallow it's almost unseeable as the belt around her arm loosens and comes off, the blood flowing out freely and pooling around the Darla's floor.

"Catra?" Adora whispers, gently shaking the magicat before grabbing the belt and wrapping it back on around the magicat's arm, "Catra? Wake up. Don't fall asleep!"

Catra doesn't respond, her body feeling heavier in Adora's arms as Entrapta rushes over to help, "What happened?!"

Adora lifts Catra's body up, putting an ear to her chest, listening, "She's not breathing… her heart…"

Entrapta rushes back to the front, pulling open the glove box and pulling out a defibrillator, "Let me shock her!"

"You can't shock a heart that's not beating!" Adora cries out as Entrapta sets the box next to them, "No. Come on, Catra! You can't die! Not after everything! Not now!"

Silence.

"Adora?" Entrapta softly says after hooking up the defibrillator to Catra with a little manoeuvring around the blonde to put the pads on and avoiding the blood on the floor, the machine blaring out a solid beep as the purple haired woman reaches out to Adora's arm, "She's gone, Adora."

"No." Adora whispers and shakes her head, wrapping her arms around Catra, closing her eyes and pressing her lips onto the magicat's forehead. The white light returns full force, Entrapta winces from the light as she scoots back and away from being blinded.

Beep. Beep. Beep. Beep.

When the light dims back down, Adora She-Ra's form has disappeared.

The sound on the machine loud and clear as Entrapta scrambles up to investigate it as she gasps and turns her head.

Adora's face remains buried in Catra's chest, she doesn't even notice the beeping on the machine until she feels a gentle rubbing on the top of her head and looks up. Her eyes widen as the magicat's look into hers half lidded.

"Hey, Adora…" Catra rasps out, she brings her injured limb and sees that it's no longer bleeding but also the end of it not being there.

Adora breathes out in relief, bringing Catra up for a proper kiss, the magicat returning it weakly as she chuckles softly under her breath.

"You look like someone died, princess…" Catra blinks slowly at the blonde.

Adora doesn't bother answering, instead pressing her lips back onto Catra's.

The magicat lifting her injured arm and realising something not right, gently pulling back from the kiss as she looks at her arm, "Can your lips grow this back?"

Adora looks at the bloodied stump and shakes her head, "No. I don't think so."

"I can!" Entrapta pops up between the pair making Catra laugh, "Though it won't be the same…"

Catra waves her stump around and sighs, turning to Adora, "Fuck it. Let's see if you can anyways." The magicat dives back in for more kisses as Entrapta grabs the magicat's injured arm and start to work on it.

"Hey, how are you feeling?" Adora asks as she sits on the bed next to Catra.

"Where am I?" Catra asks blinking her eyes open to what looks like a very fancy room.

"Brightmoon. Home." Adora replies with a soft smile, "Well… technically my home. But now it's your home. Or our home… I guess… Unless you don't want to stay here and we can go somewhere else. I don't really know where, but if you have somewhere in mind…"

"Adora." Catra interrupts the blonde's rambling with a small smile, "Home is anywhere with you, princess."

"Oh." Adora replies, her mouth still in the shape of the word before it transforms into a smile as well, "How are you feeling?"

"Tired. Broken. But not completely… if that makes sense." Catra replies lifting her arm up to rub her head, only to realise that her hand is missing, "Oh, that happened…"

Adora brings the bandaged up stump to her lips and kisses it, "I guess my lips don't work too well on missing limbs."

"I bet Traps has a bunch of prototypes ready to go though, huh?" Catra muses and Adora nods automatically as the magicat sighs, "How long have I been out for?"

"A few days." Adora replies, "You slept like a very cute baby…"

"I'm not cute." Catra quickly denies, "And it's kitten. Not baby."

"Whatever you say…" The blonde teases good naturedly, "Kitten…"

Catra chuckles under her breath, shaking her head in good humour and then asks, "What about Delia? And our friends?" The magicat looks around the fairly empty room, "Where is everyone?"

"They've got a few scratches and bruises but otherwise, they're fine." Adora answers, "Delia's been worried about you."

"I've been worried about her." Catra replies, "And what about the rest of my crew?"

"Entrapta and Darla found where Prime had been hiding them. Scorpia, Glimmer and Bow are heading there now to get them back." Adora explains, "I volunteered to go with them, but they told me to stay. Said they didn't need She-Ra."

There's a slight pout on Adora's lips as Catra looks up at her incredulously, instead asking, "Where's Delia?"

"She's gone with them too." Adora sighs out, "It's literally just you and me defending this place."

"Defending Brightmoon? From whom or what?" Catra asks amusedly, "Prime is gone. Literally in the belly of the golden

beast. Who else is there to be worried about?"

Adora shrugs, "You never know."

"True."

"Can I get in there with you?" Adora asks eyeing the spot next to the magicat on the bed.

"Get in, princess." Catra grins, "I was wondering how long it'd take you to get in here with me."

The blonde rolls her eyes with a grin as she gets in, "Shove over, Cat. You're taking over my entire bed."

"Oh, is this your bed?" Catra smirks, "I knew I'd get in here at some point."

The blonde sighs happily once she's finally settled in next to the magicat, her arms wrapped loosely around Catra as she whispers, "I almost lost you…"

"Yeah, like a heap of times." Catra tries to jest only for Adora to glare at her, "Sorry…"

Another sigh from Adora, "That's it. No more scaring me like that. I'm going to wrap you up in cotton or bubble wrap to keep you safe."

Catra laughs under her breath and then contemplates out loud, "I must be on my last life by now…"

"We only have one life, Cat." Adora points out as she presses her lips onto the side of Catra's head, "You've just been extremely lucky."

Catra agrees with a nod, "I am extremely lucky."

"And I am too." Adora smiles at her magicat.

"Well, who needs a tonne of lives when I only need one to spend the rest of it with you?" Catra says with a grin, "Now, I know what your kisses can do. Let's see what the rest of you can do, princess…"

"Stars…" Adora laughs out as she presses her lips against Catra's.

Chapter End Notes

And... that's it.
I'll leave it up to your imaginations of what the rest of Adora can do to 'heal' Catra. 😂🤔

Thanks for sticking it out.
It's taken a while to get this last chapter done without breaking it up into more chapters... but it's done!
And it's been grating on me to finish since I updated the last chapter...

Anywho, thanks to everyone that's read, commented, thrown some love (kudos), subscribed and bookmarked.
You peeps are awesome! 🥰🥰
Now... I'm back to one fic...
Not for long though... hehe. 😉😌😂

End Notes

Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!